

Theaetetus

ΘΕΑΙΤΗΤΟΣ

Plato

translated by David Horan

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142a

EK: Ah, Terpsion, have you arrived from the country just now, or was it some time ago?¹

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TP: Quite some time ago. Indeed, I was looking for you around the marketplace and was surprised that I could not find you.

142a

EK: Actually, I wasn't in the city.

142a

TP: Where were you then?

142a

EK: As I was going down to the harbour, I came across Theaetetus being carried back to Athens from the army camp at Corinth.²

142a

TP: Was he alive or dead?

142a

EK: Alive, but just barely so. He is in a bad way on account of his wounds, but worse still, he has caught the disease that broke out in the army.

ΕΥ. ἄρτι, ὦ Τερψίων, ἢ πάλαι ἐξ ἀγροῦ; ΤΕΡ. ἐπιεικῶς πάλαι. καὶ σέ γε ἐζήτουν κατ' ἀγορὰν καὶ ἐθαύμαζον ὅτι οὐχ οἷός τ' ἦ εὐρεῖν. ΕΥ. οὐ γὰρ ἦ κατὰ πόλιν. ΤΕΡ. ποῦ μήν; ΕΥ. εἰς λιμένα καταβαίνων Θεαιτήτῳ ἐνέτυχον φερομένῳ ἐκ Κορίνθου ἀπὸ τοῦ στρατοπέδου Ἀθήναζε. ΤΕΡ. ζῶντι ἢ τετελευτηκότι;

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TP: Oh, the dysentery?

142b

EK: Yes.

142b

TP: What a man he is! And you say he is in peril of his life?

142b

ΕΚ: A noble and good man, Terpsion. In fact, I also heard some people just now, full of praise for his role in the battle.

142b

ΤΡ: That is nothing particularly unusual. Indeed, it would have been much more surprising if he hadn't played such a role. More to the point, why did the man not stay here in Megara?

ΕΥ. ζῶντι καὶ μάλα μόλις· χαλεπῶς μὲν γὰρ ἔχει καὶ ὑπὸ τραυμάτων τινῶν, μᾶλλον μὴν αὐτὸν αἰρεῖ τὸ γεγονὸς νόσημα ἐν τῷ στρατεύματι.
ΤΕΡ. μῶν ἢ δυσεντερία; **ΕΥ.** ναί. **ΤΕΡ.** οἷον ἄνδρα λέγεις ἐν κινδύνῳ εἶναι. **ΕΥ.** καλὸν τε καὶ ἀγαθόν, ὃ Τερψίων, ἐπεὶ τοι καὶ νῦν ἤκουόν τινων μάλα ἐγκωμιαζόντων αὐτὸν περὶ τὴν μάχην. **ΤΕΡ.** καὶ οὐδέν γ' ἄτοπον, ἀλλὰ πολὺ θαυμαστότερον εἰ

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ΕΚ: He was in a hurry to get home. Indeed, I asked him myself and advised him to stay, but he did not want to. So, I saw him on his way, and as I was coming back I was reminded of Socrates, and how prophetically he spoke in general, and about Theaetetus in particular. Socrates met him as a young man, I believe, shortly before his own death, and from the company and the discussions he was very pleased with his character. He recounted their discussions to me when I arrived in Athens, and they are well worth hearing, and he said that Theaetetus really must become famous, if he actually lived long enough.

μὴ τοιοῦτος ᾔην. ἀτὰρ πῶς οὐκ αὐτοῦ Μεγαροῖ κατέλυεν; **ΕΥ.** ἠπείγετο οἴκαδε· ἐπεὶ ἔγωγ' ἐδεόμην καὶ συνεβούλευον, ἀλλ' οὐκ ᾔθελεν. καὶ δῆτα προπέμψας αὐτόν, ἀπιὼν πάλιν ἀνεμνήσθην καὶ ἐθαύμασα Σωκράτους ὡς μαντικῶς ἄλλα τε δὴ εἶπε καὶ περὶ τούτου. δοκεῖ γάρ μοι ὀλίγον πρὸ τοῦ θανάτου ἐντυχεῖν αὐτῷ μεираκίῳ ὄντι, καὶ συγγενόμενός τε καὶ διαλεχθεὶς πάννυ ἀγασθῆναι αὐτοῦ τὴν φύσιν. καὶ μοι ἐλθόντι Ἀθήναζε τούς τε λόγους οὕς διελέχθη

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TP: Well, it seems he was right about that anyway. But what were these discussions? Can you recount them?

αὐτῷ διηγήσατο καὶ μάλα ἀξιους ἀκοῆς, εἴπε τε ὅτι πᾶσα ἀνάγκη εἴη τοῦτον ἐλλόγιμον γενέσθαι, εἴπερ εἰς ἡλικίαν ἔλθοι. ΤΕΡ. καὶ ἀληθῆ γε, ὡς ἔοικεν, εἶπεν. ἀτὰρ τίνες ἦσαν οἱ λόγοι; ἔχouis ἂν διηγήσασθαι; ΕΥ. οὐ μὰ τὸν Δία, οὐκουν οὕτω γε ἀπὸ στόματος·

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EK: No, by Zeus, not from memory at any rate. But I made notes at the time as soon as I arrived home, and later on I recollected them at my leisure and wrote them out. And whenever I went to Athens, I would ask Socrates again about whatever I did not remember, and once I got back here I would make corrections, so that I have now written out almost the entire discussion.

143a

TP: Yes, I have heard you say that before, and in fact I had always intended to ask you to present it, but I have put it off until now. But why don't we go through it now? Having just come in from the country, I really need to rest.

ἀλλ' ἐγραψάμην μὲν τότε εὐθὺς οἴκαδ' ἐλθὼν ὑπομνήματα, ὕστερον δὲ κατὰ σχολὴν ἀναμνησκόμενος ἔγραφον, καὶ ὁσάκις Ἀθήναζε ἀφικοίμην, ἐπανηρώτων τὸν Σωκράτη ὃ μὴ ἐμεμνήμην, καὶ δεῦρο ἐλθὼν ἐπνηροθούμην· ὥστε μοι σχεδόν τι πᾶς ὁ λόγος γέγραπται. ΤΕΡ. ἀληθῆ ἤκουσά σου καὶ πρότερον, καὶ μέντοι αἰεὶ μέλλων κελεύσειν ἐπιδείξαι διατέτριφα δεῦρο. ἀλλὰ τί κωλύει νῦν ἡμᾶς διελθεῖν; πάντως ἔγωγε καὶ ἀναπαύσασθαι δέομαι ὡς ἐξ ἀγροῦ ἦκων.

143b

EK: Actually, rest is not an unpleasant prospect for me either, as I accompanied Theaetetus as far as Erineos. So let's go inside, and this servant can read to us while we rest.

143b

TP: Well said.

143b

ΕΚ: Now, this is the book, Terpsion. See the way I wrote the account not as Socrates recounted it to me, but as a dialogue with the men he was talking to, and he said these were the geometers Theodorus and Theaetetus. I wished to avoid inserting phrases between the words that were spoken, such as ‘and I declared’ or ‘said’, whenever Socrates spoke, or again ‘he concurred’ or ‘he disagreed’, whenever the respondent spoke. For this reason I wrote it as direct discourse, omitting all such phrases.

ΕΥ. ἀλλὰ μὲν δὴ καὶ αὐτὸς μέχρι Ἑρινοῦ Θεαίτητον προέπεμψα, ὥστε οὐκ ἂν ἀηδῶς ἀναπαυοίμην. ἀλλ’ ἴωμεν, καὶ ἡμῖν ἅμα ἀναπαυομένοις ὁ παῖς ἀναγνώσεται. ΤΕΡ. ὀρθῶς λέγεις. ΕΥ. τὸ μὲν δὴ βιβλίον, ὃ Τερψίων, τουτί· ἐγραψάμην δὲ δὴ οὕτως τὸν λόγον, οὐκ ἐμοὶ Σωκράτη διηγούμενον ὡς διηγείτο, ἀλλὰ διαλεγόμενον οἷς ἔφη διαλεχθῆναι. ἔφη δὲ τῷ τε γεωμέτρῃ Θεοδώρῳ καὶ τῷ Θεαιτήτῳ. ἵνα οὖν ἐν τῇ

143c

ΤΡ: There is no problem with that, Euclides.

143c

ΕΚ: Well then, take the book and read it, boy.

γραφῇ μὴ παρέχοιεν πράγματα αἱ μεταξὺ τῶν λόγων διηγήσεις περὶ αὐτοῦ τε ὁπότε λέγοι ὁ Σωκράτης, οἷον καὶ ἐγὼ ἔφην ἢ καὶ ἐγὼ εἶπον, ἢ αὖ περὶ τοῦ ἀποκρινομένου ὅτι συνέφη ἢ οὐχ ὡμολόγει, τούτων ἕνεκα ὡς αὐτὸν αὐτοῖς διαλεγόμενον ἔγραψα, ἐξελὼν τὰ τοιαῦτα. ΤΕΡ. καὶ οὐδέν γε ἀπὸ τρόπου, ὃ Εὐκλείδῃ. ΕΥ. ἀλλὰ, παῖ, λαβὲ τὸ βιβλίον καὶ λέγε.

143d

Σ: Theodorus, if I cared more about people in Cyrene,³ I would ask you about its affairs and its populace, and whether any of the young folk there are showing any interest in geometry or any other branch of wisdom. But, in fact, my love for them is less than for the Athenians, so I am more eager to know which of our young people are likely to turn out well. I watch out for such young men myself as best I can, and I also ask others, once I see that the young want to associate with them. Of

course, they come to you in no small numbers, and rightly so, as you deserve it in general, and also because of your knowledge of geometry. So, if you have come across anyone worthy of report, I would be glad to hear about them.

ΣΩ. εἰ μὲν τῶν ἐν Κυρήνῃ μᾶλλον ἐκηδόμην, ὧς Θεόδωρε, τὰ ἐκεῖ ἂν σε καὶ περὶ ἐκείνων ἀνηρώτων, εἴ τινες αὐτόθι περὶ γεωμετρίαν ἢ τινα ἄλλην φιλοσοφίαν εἰσὶ τῶν νέων ἐπιμέλειαν ποιούμενοι νῦν δὲ ἤττον γὰρ ἐκείνους ἢ τούσδε φιλῶ, καὶ μᾶλλον ἐπιθυμῶ εἰδέναι τίνες ἡμῖν τῶν νέων ἐπίδοξοι γενέσθαι ἐπικεικίς. ταῦτα δὲ αὐτός τε σκοπῶ καθ' ὅσον δύναμαι, καὶ τοὺς ἄλλους ἐρωτῶ οἷς ἂν ὁρῶ τοὺς νέους ἐθέλοντας συγγίγνεσθαι. σοὶ δὲ οὐκ ὀλίγιστοι πλησιάζουσι,

143e

TD: Well, Socrates, I have come across one such young man among your citizenry, and it is well worth hearing what I have to say about him. Now, if he were handsome, I would be afraid to speak enthusiastically lest I might seem to have feelings for him. Now, and I hope I don't upset you when I say, he is not handsome and he is quite like you, with the snub nose and bulging eyes, though they are less pronounced in his case. So I am speaking without fear. You may rest assured that of all the youths I met previously – and there have been many – I have seen none with such wonderful natural endowments. I never imagined that a man who learns so keenly what others find difficult could still be extremely modest and also as manly as anyone else, and I do not see this happening elsewhere. But those who are sharp-witted and intelligent and have good memories, like this fellow, are often quick to anger and are borne hither and thither like ships without ballast, being more mad than manly, while the slower sort approach study with some reluctance and are full of forgetfulness. But this youth takes to learning and enquiry so smoothly, steadily and productively, with great modesty, like a stream of silently flowing oil, that you are amazed that one so young could achieve so much.

καὶ δικαίως ἄξιός γάρ τά τε ἄλλα καὶ γεωμετρίας ἔνεκα. εἰ δὴ οὖν τινι ἐνέτυχες ἀξίῳ λόγου, ἡδέως ἂν πυθοίμην. ΘΕΟ. καὶ μὴν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐμοί τε εἰπεῖν καὶ σοὶ ἀκοῦσαι πάνυ ἄξιον οἶώ ὑμῖν τῶν πολιτῶν μεираκίῳ ἐντετύχηκα. καὶ εἰ μὲν ἦν καλός, ἐφοβούμην ἂν σφόδρα λέγειν, μὴ καὶ τῷ δόξῳ ἐν ἐπιθυμίᾳ αὐτοῦ εἶναι. νῦν δέ—καὶ μή μοι ἄχθου—οὐκ ἔστι καλός, προσέεικε δὲ σοὶ τήν τε σιμότητα καὶ τὸ ἔξω τῶν ὁμμάτων· ἦττον δὲ ἢ σὺ ταῦτ' ἔχει. ἀδεῶς δὴ λέγω. εὖ γὰρ ἴσθι ὅτι ὦν δὴ πώποτε ἐνέτυχον —καὶ πάνυ πολλοῖς πεπλησίακα—οὐδένα πω ἠσθόμην οὕτω θαυμαστώως εὖ πεφυκότα. τὸ γὰρ εὖμαθῇ ὄντα ὡς ἄλλω χαλεπὸν πρᾶον αὖ εἶναι διαφερόντως, καὶ ἐπὶ τούτοις ἀνδρεῖον παρ' ὄντινον, ἐγὼ μὲν οὐτ' ἂν ὥόμην γενέσθαι οὔτε ὁρῶ γιγνόμενον· ἀλλ' οἷ τε ὀξεῖς ὥσπερ οὗτος καὶ ἀγχίνοι καὶ μνήμονες ὡς τὰ πολλὰ καὶ πρὸς τὰς ὀργὰς ὀξύρροποι εἰσι, καὶ ἄττοντες φέρονται ὥσπερ τὰ ἀνερμάτιστα

144b

S: That is good news. But which of our citizens is his father?

144b

TD: I have heard his name, but do not remember it. But look, he is the one in the middle of the group coming towards us. The young man and these companions of his were oiling themselves a moment ago on the running track outside, and they seem to have finished that now, so they are coming in here. See if you recognise him.

πλοῖα, καὶ μανικώτεροι ἢ ἀνδρειότεροι φύονται, οἷ τε αὖ ἐμβριθέστεροι νωθοὶ πως ἀπαντῶσι πρὸς τὰς μαθήσεις καὶ λήθης γέμοντες. ὁ δὲ οὕτω λείως τε καὶ ἀπταιστώως καὶ ἀνυσίμως ἔρχεται ἐπὶ τὰς μαθήσεις τε καὶ ζητήσεις μετὰ πολλῆς πρᾶότητος, οἷον ἐλαίου ῥεῦμα ἀσφογητὶ ῥέοντος, ὥστε θαυμάσαι τὸ τηλικούτον ὄντα οὕτως ταῦτα διαπράττεσθαι. ΣΩ. εὖ ἀγγέλλεις. τίνος δὲ καὶ ἔστι τῶν πολιτῶν; ΘΕΟ. ἀκήκοα μὲν τοῦνομα, μνημονεύω δὲ οὐ. ἀλλὰ

144c

S: I do recognise him. It is the son of Euphronios of Sounion,⁴ a man who was very like the boy you described and generally well regarded;

and, indeed, he also left quite a substantial inheritance. But I do not know the young man's name.

144c

TD: Socrates, his name is Theaetetus. However, I believe that the inheritance has been squandered by the trustees. But, nevertheless, he is wonderfully generous with his money, Socrates.

γάρ ἐστι τῶνδε τῶν προσιόντων ὁ ἐν τῷ μέσῳ· ἄρτι γὰρ ἐν τῷ ἔξῳ δρόμῳ ἡλείφοντο ἑταῖροί τέ τινες οὗτοι αὐτοῦ καὶ αὐτός, νῦν δέ μοι δοκοῦσιν ἀλειψάμενοι δεῦρο ἰέναι. ἀλλὰ σκόπει εἰ γινώσκεις αὐτόν. ΣΩ. γινώσκω· ὁ τοῦ Σουნიῶς Εὐφρονίου ἐστίν, καὶ πάνυ γε, ὦ φίλε, ἀνδρὸς οἶον καὶ σὺ τοῦτον διηγῇ, καὶ ἄλλως εὐδοκίμου, καὶ μέντοι καὶ οὐσίαν μάλα πολλὴν κατέλιπεν. τὸ δ' ὄνομα οὐκ οἶδα τοῦ μεираκίου.

144d

S: You are describing an excellent man. Ask him to come here and sit beside me.

144d

TD: I shall. Theaetetus, sit here beside Socrates.

144d

S: Yes, indeed, Theaetetus, so that I can scrutinise for myself the sort of face I have, for Theodorus says that I have a face like yours. However, if we both had lyres, and he said that they were tuned in like manner, would we just believe him or would we find out whether he was speaking as a musician?

ΘΕΟ. Θεαίτητος, ὦ Σώκρατες, τό γε ὄνομα· τὴν μέντοι οὐσίαν δοκοῦσί μοι ἐπίτροποί τινες διεφθαρκεῖναι. ἀλλ' ὅμως καὶ πρὸς τὴν τῶν χρημάτων ἐλευθεριότητα θαυμαστός, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. γεννικὸν λέγεις τὸν ἄνδρα. καὶ μοι κέλευε αὐτὸν ἐνθάδε παρακαθίζεσθαι. ΘΕΟ. ἔσται ταῦτα. Θεαίτητε, δεῦρο παρὰ Σωκράτη. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν, ὦ Θεαίτητε, ἵνα καὶ γὰρ ἐμαυτὸν ἀνασκέψωμαι ποῖόν τι ἔχω τὸ πρόσωπον· φησὶν γὰρ Θεόδωρος

144e

TT: We would find that out.

144e

S: We would believe him, would we not, if we discovered he was a musician, but we would be unconvinced if he were not?

144e

TT: True.

144e

S: Now, I presume that if the similarity of our faces is of any concern to us, we would ask if the speaker was a portrait artist or not.

ἔχειν με σοὶ ὅμοιον. ἀτὰρ εἰ νῶν ἐχόντοιν ἐκατέρου λύραν ἔφη αὐτὰς ἡρμόσθαι ὁμοίως, πότερον εὐθὺς ἂν ἐπιστεύομεν ἢ ἐπεσκεψάμεθ' ἂν εἰ μουσικὸς ὦν λέγει; ΘΕΑΙ. ἐπεσκεψάμεθ' ἂν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τοιοῦτον μὲν εὐρόντες ἐπειθόμεθ' ἂν, ἄμουςον δέ, ἡπιστοῦμεν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ. ΣΩ. νῦν δέ γ', οἶμαι, εἴ τι μέλει ἡμῖν τῆς τῶν προσώπων

145a

TT: I think so.

145a

S: And does Theodorus know portraiture?

145a

TT: Not as far as I know anyway.

145a

S: Nor geometry either?

145a

TT: He certainly does know geometry, Socrates.

145a

S: What about astronomy, calculation, music and the various branches of education?

145a

TT: Well, I think so.

145a

S: Well then, if he says that there is some physical resemblance between us, which he either praises or criticises, it is not worth paying much attention to him.

145a

Tt: Perhaps not.

145a

S: However, what if he were to praise either of our souls for wisdom or excellence? Wouldn't it be good for the recipient of the praise to exhibit his quality eagerly, while the other watches him closely?

ὁμοιότητος, σκεπτέον εἰ γραφικὸς ὦν λέγει ἢ οὐ. ΘΕΑΙ. δοκεῖ μοι. ΣΩ. ἢ οὖν ζωγραφικὸς Θεόδωρος; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐχ, ὅσον γέ με εἰδέναι. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὐδὲ γεωμετρικὸς; ΘΕΑΙ. πάντως δήπου, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἢ καὶ ἀστρονομικὸς καὶ λογιστικὸς τε καὶ μουσικὸς καὶ ὅσα παιδείας ἔχεται; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ. ΣΩ. εἰ μὲν ἄρα ἡμᾶς τοῦ σώματός τι ὁμοίους φησὶν εἶναι ἐπαινῶν πῃ ἢ ψέγων, οὐ πάνυ αὐτῷ ἄξιον τὸν νοῦν προσέχειν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἴσως οὐ.

145b

Tt: Yes certainly, Socrates.

145b

S: Now, the time has come, dear Theaetetus, for you to give your demonstration whilst I watch closely, since, mark my words, Theodorus has praised many strangers and citizens to me, but never in the way that he praised you just now.

145b

Tt: That's all very well, Socrates, but take care that he was not speaking in jest.

ΣΩ. τί δ' εἰ ποτέρου τὴν ψυχὴν ἐπαινοῖ πρὸς ἀρετὴν τε καὶ σοφίαν; ἄρ' οὐκ ἄξιον τῷ μὲν ἀκούσαντι προθυμεῖσθαι ἀνασκέψασθαι τὸν ἐπαινεθέντα, τῷ δὲ προθύμως ἑαυτὸν ἐπιδεικνύναι; ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ὦρα τοίνυν, ὦ φίλε Θεαίτητε, σοὶ μὲν ἐπιδεικνύναι, ἐμοὶ δὲ σκοπεῖσθαι· ὡς εὔ ἴσθι ὅτι Θεόδωρος πολλοὺς δὴ πρὸς με ἐπαινέσας ξένους τε καὶ ἀστούς οὐδένα πω ἐπῆνεσεν ὡς σὲ νυνδὴ. ΘΕΑΙ. εὔ ἂν ἔχοι, ὦ Σώκρατες· ἀλλ' ὅρα μὴ παίζων

145c

S: No, that is not Theodorus' way. But do not be hesitant about our agreement by pretending that this man is jesting, in case we have to call him as a witness. No one will doubt his words, so just stand bravely by our agreement.

145c

TT: Well, if it seems right to you, that is what I must do.

145c

S: Now, tell me this. I presume you are learning some geometry from Theodorus?

145c

TT: I am indeed.

ἔλεγεν. ΣΩ. οὐχ οὗτος ὁ τρόπος Θεοδώρου· ἀλλὰ μὴ ἀναδύου τὰ ὁμολογημένα σκηπτόμενος παίζοντα λέγειν τόνδε, ἵνα μὴ καὶ ἀναγκασθῇ μαρτυρεῖν—πάντως γὰρ οὐδεὶς ἐπισκῆψετ' αὐτῷ—ἀλλὰ θαρρῶν ἔμμενε τῇ ὁμολογίᾳ. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ χρή ταῦτα ποιεῖν, εἰ σοὶ δοκεῖ. ΣΩ. λέγε δὴ μοι· μανθάνεις που παρὰ Θεοδώρου γεωμετρίας ἄττα; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔγωγε.

145d

S: And astronomy, harmony and calculation?

145d

TT: Well, I am trying to, anyway.

145d

S: Yes. And so am I, my boy, from Theodorus and others who, I believe, have some knowledge of these topics. And although I fare quite well with them in most respects, I am perplexed over a minor issue that I must consider with you, and our friends here. Now, tell me. Does learning not consist in becoming wiser about whatever one is learning?

145d

TT: How could it be otherwise?

145d

S: And it is on account of wisdom, I imagine, that the wise are wise.

145d

TT: Yes.

ΣΩ. καὶ τῶν περὶ ἀστρονομίαν τε καὶ ἀρμονίας καὶ λογισμούς; ΘΕΑΙ. προθυμοῦμαι γε δῆ. ΣΩ. καὶ γὰρ ἐγώ, ὦ παῖ, παρὰ τε τούτου καὶ παρ' ἄλλων οὓς ἂν οἶωμαι τι τούτων ἐπαίειν. ἀλλ' ὅμως τὰ μὲν ἄλλα ἔχω περὶ αὐτὰ μετρίως, μικρὸν δέ τι ἀπορῶ ὃ μετὰ σοῦ τε καὶ τῶνδε σκεπτέον. καὶ μοι λέγε· ἄρ' οὐ τὸ μανθάνειν ἐστὶν τὸ σοφώτερον γίγνεσθαι περὶ ὃ μανθάνει τις; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. σοφία δέ γ' οἶμαι σοφοὶ οἱ σοφοί. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί.

145e

S: And does this differ in any way from knowledge?

145e

TT: Does what differ?

145e

S: Wisdom! Aren't people wise in the matters in which they are knowledgeable?

145e

TT: Of course.

145e

S: So are knowledge and wisdom the same?

145e

TT: Yes.

ΣΩ. τοῦτο δὲ μὴν διαφέρει τι ἐπιστήμης; ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. ἡ σοφία. ἢ οὐχ ἅπερ ἐπιστήμονες ταῦτα καὶ σοφοί; ΘΕΑΙ. τί μήν; ΣΩ. ταῦτ' ἄρα ἐπιστήμη καὶ σοφία; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. τοῦτ' αὐτὸ τοῖνυν ἐστὶν ὃ ἀπορῶ καὶ οὐ δύναμαι λαβεῖν ἱκανῶς παρ' ἑμαυτῶ, ἐπιστήμη ὅτι ποτὲ τυγχάνει ὄν.

146a

S: Well now, this is what perplexes me, and I cannot grasp adequately for myself what knowledge actually is. So now can we speak of this? What do you say? Which of us will speak first? If he goes wrong he will sit down, and whoever goes wrong after him will also sit down and be 'donkey', as the children say in the ball game. But whoever comes

through without error will be our king, and may order us to answer any question he likes. Why are you silent? Hopefully I am not being ill-mannered, Theodorus, due to my love of discourse, and eagerness to make us engage in discourse, and become friendly and familiar with one another.

ἄρ' οὖν δὴ ἔχομεν λέγειν αὐτό; τί φατέ; τίς ἂν ἡμῶν πρῶτος εἴποι; ὁ δὲ ἁμαρτῶν, καὶ ὃς ἂν αἰὲ ἁμαρτάνῃ, καθεδεῖται, ὥσπερ φασὶν οἱ παῖδες οἱ σφαιριζόντες, ὅνος ὃς δ' ἂν περιγένηται ἀναμάρτητος, βασιλεύσει ἡμῶν καὶ ἐπιτάξει ὅτι ἂν βούληται ἀποκρίνεσθαι. τί σιγᾶτε; οὐ τί που, ὦ Θεόδωρε, ἐγὼ ὑπὸ φιλολογίας ἀγροικίζομαι, προθυμούμενος ἡμᾶς ποιῆσαι διαλέγεσθαι καὶ φίλους τε καὶ προσηγόρους ἀλλήλοις γίγνεσθαι;

146b

TD: Oh there is nothing ill-mannered about that, Socrates. But direct one of the young men to respond to you, since I am unaccustomed to such discussions as these, and I am too old to get used to them now. It would be suitable for these chaps, and they would make much more progress, since in truth the young make more progress in everything. So go on, just as you began. Don't give up on Theaetetus. Question him.

146b

S: Now, Theaetetus, you hear what Theodorus is saying, and I doubt if you would wish to disbelieve him, nor is it proper for a younger man to disobey the directions of a wise man in such matters. Come on, declare clearly and nobly what you think knowledge is.

ΘΕΟ. ἥκιστα μέν, ὦ Σώκρατες, τὸ τοιοῦτον ἂν εἴῃ ἀγροικον, ἀλλὰ τῶν μειρακίων τι κέλεύε σοι ἀποκρίνεσθαι· ἐγὼ μὲν γὰρ ἀθήνης τῆς τοιαύτης διαλέκτου, καὶ οὐδ' αὖ συνεθίζεσθαι ἡλικίαν ἔχω. τοῖσδε δὲ πρέποι τε ἂν τοῦτο καὶ πολὺ πλεον ἐπιδιδόειν· τῷ γὰρ ὄντι ἡ νεότης εἰς πᾶν ἐπίδοσιν ἔχει. ἀλλ', ὥσπερ ἤρξω, μὴ ἀφίεσο τοῦ Θεαιτήτου ἀλλ' ἐρώτα. ΣΩ. ἀκούεις δὴ, ὦ Θεαίτητε, ἃ λέγει Θεόδωρος, ὦ

146c

Tt: Well, Socrates, I must, since you are both telling me to do so. In any event, if I make any error you will correct it.

146c

S: Yes, certainly, if we are able to.

146c

Tt: I think that whatever one learns from Theodorus is knowledge – geometry and those subjects you listed just now – and so also is cobbling and the other manufacturing skills. Each of these and all of these are knowledge, and not something else.

ἀπειθεῖν, ὥς ἐγὼ οἶμαι, οὔτε σὺ ἐθελήσεις, οὔτε θέμις περὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα ἀνδρὶ σοφῷ ἐπιτάττοντι νεώτερον ἀπειθεῖν. ἀλλ’ εὖ καὶ γενναίως εἰπέ· τί σοι δοκεῖ εἶναι ἐπιστήμη; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ χρή, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐπειδὴ περ ὑμεῖς κελεύετε. πάντως γάρ, ἅν τι καὶ ἀμάρτω, ἐπανορθώσετε. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν, ἅνπερ γε οἷοί τε ὤμεν. ΘΕΑΙ. δοκεῖ τοίνυν μοι καὶ ἅ παρὰ Θεοδώρου ἂν τις μάθοι ἐπιστήμαι εἶναι, γεωμετρία τε καὶ ἅς νυνδὴ σὺ διῆλθες,

146d

S: How noble and generous, my friend. You are asked for one thing and you provide many, favouring variety over simplicity.

146d

Tt: Why do you say that, Socrates?

146d

S: Well, perhaps it is nothing, but I shall tell you what I think anyway. Whenever you refer to cobbling, are you talking about anything other than the knowledge of making shoes?

146d

Tt: Nothing else.

146d

S: And what about carpentry? Do you mean anything other than the knowledge of making wooden objects?

καὶ αὖ σκυτοτομική τε καὶ αἱ τῶν ἄλλων δημιουργῶν τέχναι, πᾶσαι τε καὶ ἐκάστη τούτων, οὐκ ἄλλο τι ἢ ἐπιστήμη εἶναι. ΣΩ. γενναίως γε καὶ

φιλοδώρως, ὦ φίλε, ἐν αἰτηθεῖς πολλὰ δίδως καὶ ποικίλα ἀντὶ ἀπλοῦ. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς τί τοῦτο λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. ἴσως μὲν οὐδέν· ὃ μέντοι οἶμαι, φράσω. ὅταν λέγῃς σκυτικήν, μή τι ἄλλο φράζεις ἢ ἐπιστήμην ὑποδημάτων ἐργασίας; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδέν.

146e

TT: No, that's it.

146e

S: In both cases, aren't you defining what each is knowledge of?

146e

TT: Yes.

146e

S: But, Theaetetus, you were not asked what knowledge is of, or how many kinds there are. That was not the point. Indeed, we did not ask the question from a desire to count them, but we wanted to know what knowledge itself actually is. Or am I making no sense?

146e

TT: No, you are absolutely correct.

146e

S: Well, consider this also. If someone were to ask us about one of the ordinary things around us – for example, what clay is – would we not be silly to answer potters' clay, ovenmakers' clay, brick-makers' clay?

ΣΩ. τί δ' ὅταν τεκτονικήν; μή τι ἄλλο ἢ ἐπιστήμην τῆς τῶν ξυλίνων σκευῶν ἐργασίας; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδὲ τοῦτο. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἐν ἀμφοῖν, οὗ ἑκάτερα ἐπιστήμη, τοῦτο ὀρίζεις; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. τὸ δέ γ' ἐρωτηθέν, ὦ Θεαίτητε, οὐ τοῦτο ἦν, τίνων ἢ ἐπιστήμη, οὐδὲ ὁπόσαι τινές· οὐ γὰρ ἀριθμῆσαι αὐτὰς βουλόμενοι ἠρόμεθα ἀλλὰ γινῶναι ἐπιστήμην αὐτὸ ὅτι ποτ' ἐστίν. ἢ οὐδὲν λέγω; ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν ὀρθῶς.

147a

TT: Surely.

147a

S: Firstly, we would be silly to imagine that the questioner understands anything from our answers whenever we say 'clay', whether we add 'of

modellers' or of any other craftsmen. Or do you think anyone understands any name of anything without knowing what that thing is?

ΣΩ. σκέψαι δὴ καὶ τόδε. εἴ τις ἡμᾶς τῶν φαύλων τι καὶ προχείρων ἔροιτο, οἷον περὶ πηλοῦ ὅτι ποτ' ἐστίν, εἰ ἀποκρινάμεθα αὐτῷ πηλὸς ὁ τῶν χυτρίων καὶ πηλὸς ὁ τῶν ἵπνοπλαθῶν καὶ πηλὸς ὁ τῶν πλινθουργῶν, οὐκ ἂν γελοῖοι εἶμεν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἴσως. ΣΩ. πρῶτον μὲν γέ που οἰόμενοι συνιέναι ἐκ τῆς ἡμετέρας ἀποκρίσεως τὸν ἐρωτῶντα, ὅταν εἴπωμεν πηλός, εἴτε ὁ τῶν

147b

TT: Not at all.

147b

S: Then neither does anyone understand knowledge of shoe-making who does not know knowledge.

147b

TT: He does not.

147b

S: So, whoever is ignorant of knowledge does not understand cobbling or any other skill.

147b

TT: That's it.

147b

S: So, when we respond with the name of some skill when we are asked what knowledge is, that is a ridiculous answer. Indeed the answer says 'knowledge of something', and that does not answer the question.

κοροπλαθῶν προσθέντες εἴτε ἄλλων ὠντινωνοῦν δημιουργῶν. ἢ οἷε τίς τι συνίησιν τινος ὄνομα, ὃ μὴ οἶδεν τί ἐστίν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδαμῶς. ΣΩ. οὐδ' ἄρα ἐπιστήμην ὑποδημάτων συνίησιν ὃ ἐπιστήμην μὴ εἰδώς. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ γάρ. ΣΩ. σκυτικὴν ἄρα οὐ συνίησιν ὃς ἂν ἐπιστήμην ἀγνοῇ, οὐδέ τινα ἄλλην τέχνην. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστιν οὕτως. ΣΩ. γελοία ἄρα ἡ ἀπόκρισις τῷ ἐρωτηθέντι ἐπιστήμη τί ἐστίν, ὅταν ἀποκρίνηται τέχνης τινὸς ὄνομα. τινὸς γὰρ

147c

Tt: So it seems.

147c

S: Well then, we seem to be going the long way around instead of answering plainly and briefly. Thus, on the question about clay, we could say, plainly and simply, that it is earth mixed with water, regardless of whose clay it is.

147c

Tt: Oh it seems easy when you put it like that, Socrates. However, it is very likely that what you are asking about is like what came up recently in conversation between myself and your namesake here, Socrates.⁵

ἐπιστήμην ἀποκρίνεται οὐ τοῦτ' ἐρωτηθεῖς. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. ἔπειτά γέ που ἐξὸν φαύλως καὶ βραχέως ἀποκρίνασθαι περιέρχεται ἀπέραντον ὁδόν. οἷον καὶ ἐν τῇ τοῦ πηλοῦ ἐρωτήσει φαῦλόν που καὶ ἀπλοῦν εἰπεῖν ὅτι γῇ ὑγρῷ φυραθεῖσα πηλὸς ἂν εἴη, τὸ δ' ὅτου ἔαν χαίρειν. ΘΕΑΙ. ῥᾴδιον, ὦ Σώκρατες, νῦν γε οὕτω φαίνεται· ἀτὰρ κινδυνεύεις ἐρωτᾶν οἷον καὶ αὐτοῖς ἡμῖν ἔναγχος εἰσῆλθε

147d

S: Like what, Theaetetus?

147d

Tt: Theodorus here was illustrating something about powers to us, showing that a threefoot square and a five-foot square do not have a common measure with respect to a single foot. He dealt with each in this way until he reached seventeen, and then he stopped for some reason. Now, since the number of powers appeared unlimited, it occurred to us to try to comprehend them into a unity by which we could refer to all these powers.

διαλεγόμενοις, ἐμοί τε καὶ τῷ σὺ ὁμωνύμῳ τούτῳ Σωκράτει. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον δῆ, ὦ Θεαίτητε; ΘΕΑΙ. περὶ δυνάμεων τι ἡμῖν Θεόδωρος ὅδε ἔγραφε, τῆς τε τρίποδος πέρι καὶ πεντέποδος ἀποφαίνων ὅτι μήκει οὐ σύμμετροι τῇ ποδιαίᾳ, καὶ οὕτω κατὰ μίαν ἐκάστην προαιρούμενος

μέχρι τῆς ἑπτακαίδεκάποδος· ἐν δὲ ταύτῃ πως ἐνέσχετο. ἡμῖν οὖν εἰσῆλθέ τι τοιοῦτον, ἐπειδὴ ἄπειροι τὸ πλῆθος αἱ δυνάμεις ἐφαίνοντο, πειραθῆναι συλλαβεῖν εἰς ἓν, ὅτω πάσας

147e

S: And did you find something like this?

147e

TT: I think that we did. But see if you agree.

147e

S: Tell me.

147e

TT: We divided all number into two. Those that arise by multiplying equal numbers we likened to a square shape, and called them both square and equilateral numbers.

147e

S: Yes, that's good.

147e

TT: However, between these numbers are all those, such as three and five, which cannot be generated by multiplying equal numbers. These are produced by multiplying greater by lesser, or lesser by greater, and the sides that enclose them are of different lengths, so we likened them to an oblong shape, and called them oblong numbers.

ταύτας προσαγορεύσομεν τὰς δυνάμεις. ΣΩ. ἦ καὶ ἡῦρετέ τι τοιοῦτον; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔμοιγε δοκοῦμεν· σκόπει δὲ καὶ σύ. ΣΩ. λέγε. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸν ἀριθμὸν πάντα δίχα διελάβομεν· τὸν μὲν δυνάμενον ἴσον ἰσάκεις γίγνεσθαι τῷ τετραγώνῳ τὸ σχῆμα ἀπεικάσαντες τετράγωνόν τε καὶ ἰσόπλευρον προσείπομεν. ΣΩ. καὶ εὖ γε. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸν τοίνυν μεταξὺ τούτου, ὧν καὶ τὰ τρία καὶ

148a

S: Excellent. But what did you do next?

148a

TT: Whatever lines form an equilateral flat number⁶ when they are made into squares, we defined as magnitudes, while the lines whose

squares form an oblong flat number, we defined as powers, as they do not have a measure, common in magnitude, with the other magnitudes, though the flat numbers they can form do have such a measure. Similar considerations apply to solid structures.

τὰ πέντε καὶ πᾶς ὃς ἀδύνατος ἴσος ισάκεις γενέσθαι, ἀλλ' ἢ πλείων ἐλαττονάκεις ἢ ἐλάττων πλεονάκεις γίγνεται, μείζων δὲ καὶ ἐλάττων ἀεὶ πλευρὰ αὐτὸν περιλαμβάνει, τῷ προμήκει αὖ σχήματι ἀπεικάσαντες προμήκη ἀριθμὸν ἐκαλέσαμεν. ΣΩ. κάλλιστα. ἀλλὰ τί τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο; ΘΕΑΙ. ὅσαι μὲν γραμμαὶ τὸν ισόπλευρον καὶ ἐπίπεδον ἀριθμὸν τετραγωνίζουσι, μήκος ὠρισάμεθα, ὅσαι δὲ τὸν ἑτερομήκη,

148b

S: Well that is excellent, my boys, and I don't think that Theodorus will be open to a charge of perjury.

148b

TT: Very well, Socrates, but I would not be able to answer what you are asking about knowledge in the very way I spoke about magnitudes and powers. However, I think that's the sort of wording you are looking for, so Theodorus may prove false after all.

δυνάμεις, ὡς μήκει μὲν οὐ συμμέτρους ἐκείναις, τοῖς δ' ἐπιπέδοις ἂ δύνανται. καὶ περὶ τὰ στερεὰ ἄλλο τοιοῦτον. ΣΩ. ἄριστά γ' ἀνθρώπων, ὦ παῖδες· ὥστε μοι δοκεῖ ὁ Θεόδωρος οὐκ ἔνοχος τοῖς ψευδομαρτυρίαις ἔσεσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ μὲν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὅ γε ἐρωτᾷς περὶ ἐπιστήμης οὐκ ἂν δυναίμην ἀποκρίνασθαι ὥσπερ περὶ τοῦ μήκους τε καὶ τῆς δυνάμεως. καίτοι σύ γέ μοι δοκεῖς τοιοῦτόν τι ζητεῖν· ὥστε πάλιν αὖ φαίνεται ψευδὴς ὁ Θεόδωρος.

148c

S: Well, suppose he had praised you as a runner, saying that he had never come across a young man who could run like this, and you were then beaten in a race by the champion in his prime. Do you think that his praise would be any less true?

148c

TT: I do not.

148c

S: And do you think that the search for knowledge, in the manner I have just described, is something trivial, or a task for those at the pinnacle in every respect?

148c

TT: Oh, by Zeus, I really believe it is for those at the absolute pinnacle.

ΣΩ. τί δέ; εἴ σε πρὸς δρόμον ἐπαινῶν μηδενὶ οὕτω δρομικῶ ἔφη τῶν νέων ἐντετυχηκέναι, εἴτα διαθέων τοῦ ἀκμάζοντος καὶ ταχίστου ἡττήθης, ἥττόν τι ἂν οἶε ἀληθῆ τόνδ' ἐπαινέσαι; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκ ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ τὴν ἐπιστήμην, ὥσπερ νυνδὴ ἐγὼ ἔλεγον, σμικρόν τι οἶε εἶναι ἐξευρεῖν καὶ οὐ τῶν πάντη ἄκρων; ΘΕΑΙ. νῆ τὸν Δί' ἔγωγε καὶ μάλα γε τῶν ἀκροτάτων. ΣΩ. θάρρει τοίνυν περὶ σαυτῶ καὶ τὸ οἶον Θεόδωρον

148d

S: Well then, be confident about yourself. Believe that Theodorus is right, and exert yourself in every way, both in general and to arrive at an account of what knowledge actually is.

148d

TT: If exertion is all we need, Socrates, it will come to light.

148d

S: Go on then. Indeed, you showed the approach very nicely just now, so try imitating your answer about powers. Just as you encompassed the many powers in a single form, so also describe the many types of knowledge in a single account.

λέγειν, προθυμήθητι δὲ παντὶ τρόπῳ τῶν τε ἄλλων πέρι καὶ ἐπιστήμης λαβεῖν λόγον τί ποτε τυγχάνει ὄν. ΘΕΑΙ. προθυμίας μὲν ἔνεκα, ᾧ Σώκρατες, φανεῖται. ΣΩ. ἴθι—καλῶς γὰρ ἄρτι ὑφηγήσω—πειρῶ μιμούμενος τὴν περὶ τῶν δυνάμεων ἀπόκρισιν, ὥσπερ αὐτάς πολλὰς οὖσας ἐνὶ εἴδει περιέλαβες, οὕτω καὶ τὰς πολλὰς ἐπιστήμας ἐνὶ λόγῳ προσειπεῖν.

148e

TT: Be assured, Socrates, that I have embarked upon this enquiry many times on hearing reports of the questions you ask. However, I am never

able to persuade myself that I have anything useful to say, nor have I heard anyone else speaking in the way you are exhorting me. Then again, I can't give up the preoccupation either.

148e

S: For you are in labour, dear Theaetetus, because you have conceived and are not barren.

ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλ' εὔ ἴσθι, ὦ Σώκρατες, πολλάκις δὴ αὐτὸ ἐπεχείρησα σκέψασθαι, ἀκούων τὰς παρὰ σοῦ ἀποφερομένας ἐρωτήσεις. ἀλλὰ γὰρ οὔτ' αὐτὸς δύναμαι πεῖσαι ἑμαυτὸν ὡς ἱκανῶς τι λέγω οὔτ' ἄλλου ἀκοῦσαι λέγοντος οὕτως ὡς σὺ διακελεύῃ, οὐ μὲν δὴ αὖ οὐδ' ἀπαλλαγῆναι τοῦ μέλιν. ΣΩ. ὠδίνεις γάρ, ὦ φίλε Θεαίτητε, διὰ τὸ μὴ κενὸς ἀλλ' ἐγκύμων εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκ οἶδα, ὦ Σώκρατες· ὁ μέντοι πέπονθα λέγω.

149a

ΤΤ: I don't know about that, Socrates. I am only describing what I experience.

149a

S: How comical! Have you not heard that I am the son of a fine, burly midwife named Phaenarete?⁷

149a

ΤΤ: Yes, I heard that before.

149a

S: Now, have you also heard that I practise the same skill?

149a

ΤΤ: Not at all.

149a

S: Well it is true, believe me! But you must not tell everyone else about me, my friend, as they are unaware that I have this skill. And since they do not know this about me, they never say it. But they do say that I am very strange, and that I make men perplexed. Surely you have also heard that?

ΣΩ. εἴτα, ὦ καταγέλαστε, οὐκ ἀκήκοας ὡς ἐγὼ εἶμι υἱὸς μαίας μάλα γενναίας τε καὶ βλοσυρᾶς, Φαιναρέτης; ΘΕΑΙ. ἤδη τοῦτό γε ἤκουσα. ΣΩ. ἄρα καὶ ὅτι ἐπιτηδεύω τὴν αὐτὴν τέχνην ἀκήκοας; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδαμῶς. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' εὖ ἴσθ' ὅτι μὴ μέντοι μου κατείπης πρὸς τοὺς ἄλλους. λέληθα γάρ, ὦ ἐταῖρε, ταύτην ἔχων τὴν τέχνην· οἱ δέ, ἅτε οὐκ εἰδότες, τοῦτο μὲν οὐ λέγουσι περὶ ἐμοῦ, ὅτι δὲ ἀτοπώτατός εἰμι καὶ ποιῶ τοὺς ἀνθρώπους ἀπορεῖν. ἦ καὶ τοῦτο ἀκήκοας;

149b

TT: I have, indeed.

149b

S: Well, shall I tell you the reason?

149b

TT: Yes, certainly.

149b

S: Well, if you consider the status of all midwives overall, you will understand what I mean more easily. Indeed, I presume you know that no women, who are themselves still conceiving and bearing children, act as midwives to others, but only those who can no longer bear children.

149b

TT: Yes, certainly.

149b

S: Artemis is responsible for this, so they say, because she has been allotted responsibility for child-bearing, though she is childless.⁸ So she did not give the midwife's role to those who are barren, since human nature is too weak to understand a skill of which it has no experience. Instead, she assigned it to those who are past child-bearing age, in honour of their likeness to herself.

ΘΕΑΙ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. εἴπω οὖν σοι τὸ αἴτιον; ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. ἐννόησον δὴ τὸ περὶ τὰς μαίας ἅπαν ὡς ἔχει, καὶ ῥᾶον μαθήσῃ ὁ βούλομαι. οἴσθα γάρ που ὡς οὐδεμία αὐτῶν ἔτι αὐτὴ κυῖσκομένη τε καὶ τίκτουσα ἄλλας μαιεύεται, ἀλλ' αἱ ἤδη ἀδύνατοι τίκτειν. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν

οὖν. ΣΩ. αἰτίαν δέ γε τούτου φασὶν εἶναι τὴν Ἄρτεμιν, ὅτι ἄλοχος οὔσα τὴν λοχείαν εἴληχε. στερίφαις μὲν οὖν ἄρα

149c

TT: Quite likely.

149c

S: And isn't it both likely, and necessarily the case, that the midwives recognise, better than anyone, which women are with child and which are not?

149c

TT: Yes, indeed.

149c

S: And, indeed, the midwives are able to arouse the pangs or allay them as they so wish by administering potions or incantations. They can deliver difficult births, and if they believe the embryo should miscarry, they bring on miscarriage.

οὐκ ἔδωκε μαιεύεσθαι, ὅτι ἡ ἀνθρωπίνη φύσις ἀσθενεστέρα ἢ λαβεῖν τέχνην ὣν ἂν ἡ ἄπειρος ταῖς δὲ δι' ἡλικίαν ἀτόκοις προσέταξε τιμῶσα τὴν αὐτῆς ὁμοίότητα. ΘΕΑΙ. εἰκός. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τόδε εἰκός τε καὶ ἀναγκαῖον, τὰς κυούσας καὶ μὴ γιγνώσκεσθαι μᾶλλον ὑπὸ τῶν μαιῶν ἢ τῶν ἄλλων; ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν καὶ διδοῦσαί γε αἱ μαῖαι φαρμάκια καὶ

149d

TT: This is so.

149d

S: Well, have you noticed something else about them? That they are the most ingenious matchmakers since they are omniscient when it comes to knowing the types of men with whom various women should consort to produce the most excellent children?

149d

TT: No, I didn't know that at all.

149d

S: Then rest assured that they value this skill more than the cutting of the umbilical cord. Yes, think about it. Do you believe that tending and harvesting the fruits of the earth is the same skill as knowing the types of plants that should be sown in various types of soil?

ἐπάδουσαι δύνανται ἐγείρειν τε τὰς ὠδῖνας καὶ μαλθακωτέρας ἂν βούλωνται ποιεῖν, καὶ τίκτειν τε δὴ τὰς δυστοκούσας, καὶ ἐὰν νέον ὄν δόξῃ ἀμβλίσκειν, ἀμβλίσκουσιν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστι ταῦτα. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν ἔτι καὶ τόδε αὐτῶν ἥσθησαι, ὅτι καὶ προμνήστριαί εἰσι δεινόταται, ὡς πάσσοφοι οὔσαι περὶ τοῦ γινῶναι ποίαν χρὴ ποίῳ ἀνδρὶ συνοῦσαν ὡς ἀρίστους παῖδας τίκτειν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ πάνυ τοῦτο οἶδα. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἴσθ' ὅτι ἐπὶ τούτῳ μεῖζον φρονοῦσιν ἢ ἐπὶ

149e

TT: It is the same skill.

149e

S: And with a woman, my friend, do you think there is one skill dealing with types and another dealing with offspring?

149e

TT: That is not very likely.

149e

S: No, it is not. However, because men and women are brought together in an improper and unskilled manner, which is called procuring, the midwives shun matchmaking, as they are respectable women who fear that through involvement in matchmaking they may be accused of procuring. Yet proper matchmaking is somehow a role only for the true midwives.

τῇ ὁμωφλητομίᾳ. ἐννῶει γάρ· τῆς αὐτῆς ἢ ἄλλης οἶει τέχνης εἶναι θεραπείαν τε καὶ συγκομιδὴν τῶν ἐκ γῆς καρπῶν καὶ αὖ τὸ γινώσκειν εἰς ποίαν γῆν ποῖον φυτόν τε καὶ σπέρμα καταβλητέον; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκ, ἀλλὰ τῆς αὐτῆς. ΣΩ. εἰς γυναῖκα δέ, ὦ φίλε, ἄλλην μὲν οἶει τοιοῦτου, ἄλλην δὲ συγκομιδῆς; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκουν εἰκός γε.

150a

TT: So it appears.

150a

S: Such is the role of the midwives, but it is a lesser role than mine. Indeed, it is not the custom of women to bring forth images on some occasions, and at other times true offspring, which are not easy to distinguish. If women did this, the greatest and noblest task of midwives would be to decide which was true and which was not. Do you not agree?

ΣΩ. οὐ γάρ. ἀλλὰ διὰ τὴν ἄδικόν τε καὶ ἄτεχνον συναγωγὴν ἀνδρὸς καὶ γυναικός, ἥ δὴ προαγωγία ὄνομα, φεύγουσι καὶ τὴν προμνηστικὴν ἄτεσεμναὶ οὔσαι αἱ μαῖαι, φοβούμεναι μὴ εἰς ἐκείνην τὴν αἰτίαν διὰ ταύτην ἐμπέσωσιν· ἐπεὶ ταῖς γε ὄντως μαῖαις μόναις που προσήκει καὶ προμνήσασθαι ὀρθῶς. ΘΕΑΙ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. τὸ μὲν τοίνυν τῶν μαῖων τοσοῦτον, ἔλαττον δὲ τοῦ ἐμοῦ δράματος. οὐ γὰρ πρόσσεσι γυναιξὶν ἐνίστε μὲν

150b

TT: I do, indeed.

150b

S: Now, my skill of midwifery is, in general, similar in character to theirs, but it differs by delivering men and not women, and by looking after their souls rather than their bodies when in labour. But the greatest thing about my skill is that it is able to test, in every respect, whether the mind of the young man is bringing forth an image and a lie, or something genuine and true. Now, I do have this in common with the female midwives: I bring to birth no wisdom. And many people reproach me for this, since I ask questions of others while I myself proclaim nothing about anything, because I have no wisdom. Their reproach is true, but the reason is that the god compels me to act as a midwife and has prevented me from giving birth. So, of course, I myself am not at all wise, nor have I any invention that is born of my own soul. However, it is different for those who associate with me. Some of them also appear quite ignorant at first, but as our relationship proceeds, all whom the god allows, progress to a wonderful degree. Such is their own belief and that of others, and it is

obvious that they have never learned anything from me. Rather, they have discovered from themselves much that is beautiful, and have brought it to birth. However, both I and the god are responsible for the delivery. The proof is that over the years, many who were ignorant of this regarded themselves as responsible, despised me, and went away sooner than they should, persuaded either by themselves or by others. But once they had left me, they miscarried whatever remained within them through bad company, and destroyed through improper care whatever fruits I had delivered from them. Placing more value on images and lies than upon the truth, they ended up being regarded as ignorant both by themselves and by everyone else. One such person was Aristides, the son of Lysimachus,⁹ and there have been many others. If these men ever come back again, imploring my company with extraordinary imprecations, the familiar daimon¹⁰ forbids me from associating with some of them, while it allows me to associate with others, and these men make progress once more. Now, my associates have another experience in common with women in childbirth. They are pained and full of distress both night and day, even more than the women, but my skills can arouse or relieve this pain, and that is the plight they are in. But, Theaetetus, some who seem to me to have nothing within them to bring forth, I matchmake favourably with someone else, and with God's help I guess quite competently whose company will benefit them, knowing that they have no need for me. I have handed many over to Prodicus,¹¹ and many to other wise and inspired men. Now, excellent friend, the reason I am speaking to you at such length is that I suspect, as you yourself believe, that you are pained by something you are carrying within. So come to me, the son of a midwife, who is skilled in the midwife's art, and strive to answer my questions as best you can. And if I consider something you have been saying to be an image and untrue, and I take it out and discard it, do not be angry with me like new mothers over their children. Indeed, many before you, dear friend, had such an attitude towards me as to actually bite me whenever I take something

nonsensical away from them. They do not believe that I do this with good intentions, and they are far from realising that no god ever intends harm towards humanity, nor do I act in this way from ill intentions. But I am not allowed to accept falsehood or to conceal the truth. So start again, Theaetetus, and try to state what knowledge actually is. And do not say that you are not able, for if God wills it and you summon up your manhood, you will be able.

εἶδωλα τίκτειν, ἔστι δ' ὅτε ἀληθινά, τοῦτο δὲ μὴ ῥάδιον εἶναι διαγνῶναι. εἰ γὰρ προσῆν, μέγιστόν τε καὶ κάλλιστον ἔργον ἦν ἂν ταῖς μαίαις τὸ κρίνειν τὸ ἀληθές τε καὶ μή ἢ οὐκ οἶε; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. τῇ δέ γ' ἐμῇ τέχνῃ τῆς μαιεύσεως τὰ μὲν ἄλλα ὑπάρχει ὅσα ἐκείναις, διαφέρει δὲ τῷ τε ἄνδρας ἀλλὰ μὴ γυναῖκας μαιεύεσθαι καὶ τῷ τὰς ψυχὰς αὐτῶν τικτούσας ἐπισκοπεῖν ἀλλὰ μὴ τὰ σώματα. μέγιστον δὲ τοῦτ' ἔνι τῇ ἡμετέρᾳ τέχνῃ, βασανίζειν δυνατόν εἶναι παντὶ τρόπῳ πότερον εἶδωλον καὶ ψεῦδος ἀποτίκτει τοῦ νέου ἢ διάνοια ἢ γόνιμόν τε καὶ ἀληθές. ἐπεὶ τόδε γε καὶ ἐμοὶ ὑπάρχει ὅπερ ταῖς μαίαις· ἄγονός εἰμι σοφίας, καὶ ὅπερ ἤδη πολλοὶ μοι ὠνείδισαν, ὥς τοὺς μὲν ἄλλους ἐρωτῶ, αὐτὸς δὲ οὐδὲν ἀποφαίνομαι περὶ οὐδενὸς διὰ τὸ μηδὲν ἔχειν σοφόν, ἀληθές ὠνειδίζουσιν. τὸ δὲ αἴτιον τούτου τόδε· μαιεύεσθαι με ὁ θεὸς ἀναγκάζει, γεννᾶν δὲ ἀπεκώλυσεν. εἰμὶ δὴ οὖν αὐτὸς μὲν οὐ πάνυ τι σοφός, οὐδὲ τί μοι ἔστιν εὐρημα τοιοῦτον γεγονὸς τῆς ἐμῆς ψυχῆς ἔκγονον· οἱ δ' ἐμοὶ συγγιγνώμενοι τὸ μὲν πρῶτον φαίνονται ἔνιοι μὲν καὶ πάνυ ἀμαθεῖς, πάντες δὲ προϊούσης τῆς συνουσίας, οἷσπερ ἂν ὁ θεὸς παρείκη, θαυμαστὸν ὅσον ἐπιδιδόντες, ὥς αὐτοῖς τε καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις δοκοῦσι καὶ τοῦτο ἐναργές ὅτι παρ' ἐμοῦ οὐδὲν πώποτε μαθόντες, ἀλλ' αὐτοὶ παρ' αὐτῶν πολλὰ καὶ καλὰ εὐρόντες τε καὶ τεκόντες. τῆς μέντοι μαιείας ὁ θεός τε καὶ ἐγὼ αἴτιος. ὥδε δὲ δῆλον· πολλοὶ ἤδη τοῦτο ἀγνοήσαντες καὶ ἑαυτοὺς αἰτιασάμενοι, ἐμοῦ δὲ καταφρονήσαντες, ἢ αὐτοὶ ἢ ὑπ' ἄλλων πεισθέντες ἀπῆλθον πρῳαίτερον τοῦ δέοντος, ἀπελθόντες δὲ τὰ τε λοιπὰ ἐξήμβλωσαν διὰ πονηρὰν συνουσίαν καὶ τὰ ὑπ' ἐμοῦ μαιευθέντα κακῶς τρέφοντες ἀπώλεσαν, ψευδῇ καὶ εἶδωλα περὶ πλείονος ποιησάμενοι τοῦ ἀληθοῦς, τελευτώντες δ' αὐτοῖς τε καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις ἔδοξαν ἀμαθεῖς εἶναι. ΣΩ. ὦν εἷς γέγονεν Ἀριστείδης ὁ

Λυσιμάχου καὶ ἄλλοι πάνυ πολλοί· οὐς, ὅταν πάλιν ἔλθωσι δεόμενοι τῆς ἐμῆς συνουσίας καὶ θαυμαστὰ δρῶντες, ἐνίοις μὲν τὸ γιγνόμενόν μοι δαιμόνιον ἀποκωλύει συνεῖναι, ἐνίοις δὲ ἔξ, καὶ πάλιν οὗτοι ἐπιδιδόασιν. πᾶσχοι δὲ δὴ οἱ ἐμοὶ συγγιγνόμενοι καὶ τοῦτο ταῦτόν ταῖς τικτούσαις· ὠδίνουσι γὰρ καὶ ἀπορίας ἐμπίμπλονται νύκτας τε καὶ ἡμέρας πολὺ μᾶλλον ἢ ῥεῖναι ταύτην δὲ τὴν ὥδινά ἐγείρειν τε καὶ ἀποπαύειν ἢ ἐμὴ τέχνη δύναται. καὶ οὗτοι μὲν δὴ οὕτως. ἐνίοις δέ, ὧς Θεαίτητε, οἱ ἂν μοι μὴ δόξωσί πως ἐγκύμονες εἶναι, γνοὺς ὅτι οὐδὲν ἐμοῦ δέονται, πάνυ εὐμενῶς προμνῶμαι καί, σὺν θεῷ εἰπεῖν, πάνυ ἱκανῶς τοπάζω οἷς ἂν συγγενόμενοι ὄναιτο· ὧν πολλοὺς μὲν δὴ ἐξέδωκα προδίκω, πολλοὺς δὲ ἄλλοις σοφοῖς τε καὶ θεσπεσίοις ἀνδράσι. ταῦτα δὴ σοι, ὧς ἄριστε, ἔνεκα τοῦδε ἐμήκυνα· ὑποπτεύω σε, ὥσπερ καὶ αὐτὸς οἶει, ὠδίνειν τι κυοῦντα ἔνδον. προσφέρου οὖν πρὸς με ὡς πρὸς μαιᾶς ὑὸν καὶ αὐτὸν μαιευτικόν, καὶ ἃ ἂν ἐρωτῶ προθυμοῦ ὅπως οἷός τ' εἶ οὕτως ἀποκρίνασθαι· καὶ ἐὰν ἄρα σκοπούμενός τι ὧν ἂν λέγῃς ἡγήσωμαι εἰδῶλον καὶ μὴ ἀληθές, εἴτα ὑπεξαίρωμαι καὶ ἀποβάλλω, μὴ ἀγρίαινε ὥσπερ αἱ πρωτοτόκοι περὶ τὰ παιδία. πολλοὶ γὰρ ἤδη, ὧς θαυμάσιε, πρὸς με οὕτω διετέθησαν, ὥστε ἀτεχνῶς δάκνειν ἔτοιμοι εἶναι, ἐπειδάν τινα λῆρον αὐτῶν ἀφαιρῶμαι, καὶ οὐκ οἶοντάι με εὐνοίᾳ τοῦτο ποιεῖν, πόρρω ὄντες τοῦ εἰδέναι ὅτι

151d

ΤΤ: Well now, Socrates, with such encouragement from you, it would be a disgrace if a man did not strive to the utmost to say what he can. So then, it seems to me that whoever knows something perceives that which he knows. So, for now anyway, it appears that knowledge is nothing other than perception.

οὐδεὶς θεὸς δύσνους ἀνθρώποις, οὐδ' ἐγὼ δυσνοίᾳ τοιοῦτον οὐδὲν δρῶ, ἀλλὰ μοι ψευδός τε συγχωρῆσαι καὶ ἀληθὲς ἀφανίσαι οὐδαμῶς θέμις. πάλιν δὴ οὖν ἐξ ἀρχῆς, ὧς Θεαίτητε, ὅτι ποτ' ἐστὶν ἐπιστήμη, πειρῶ λέγειν· ὡς δ' οὐχ οἷός τ' εἶ, μηδέ ποτ' εἴπῃς. ἐὰν γὰρ θεὸς ἐθέλῃ καὶ ἀνδρίζῃ, οἷός τ' ἔσῃ. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ μέντοι, ὧς Σώκρατες, σοῦ γε οὕτω παρακλεινομένου αἰσχρὸν μὴ οὐ παντὶ τρόπῳ προθυμεῖσθαι ὅτι

151e

S: Spoken nobly and courageously, my boy. That is how you should speak when proclaiming your views. Come on, let us examine it together and whether it happens to be genuine or a wind-egg. Are you saying that knowledge is perception?

151e

TT: Yes.

151e

S: Now, it really seems that you have made no ordinary statement about knowledge, but one that Protagoras¹² also made, though he said the same things in a somewhat different way. He says, as you know, that man is the measure of all things: of those that are, that they are, and of those that are not, that they are not. Indeed, I presume you have read this?

τις ἔχει λέγειν. δοκεῖ οὖν μοι ὁ ἐπιστάμενός τι αἰσθάνεσθαι τοῦτο ὃ ἐπίσταται, καὶ ὥς γε νυνὶ φαίνεται, οὐκ ἄλλο τί ἐστὶν ἐπιστήμη ἢ αἴσθησις. ΣΩ. εὖ γε καὶ γενναίως, ὦ παῖ· χρὴ γὰρ οὕτως ἀποφαινόμενον λέγειν. ἀλλὰ φέρε δὴ αὐτὸ κοινῇ σκεψώμεθα, γόνιμον ἢ ἀνεμιαῖον τυγχάνει ὄν. αἴσθησις, φήs, ἐπιστήμη; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. κινδυνεύεις μέντοι λόγον οὐ φαῦλον εἰρηκέναι περὶ

152a

TT: Yes, I have read it many times.

152a

S: Does this not somehow mean that, in each case, as something appears to me, so it is for me, and again, as it appears to you, so it is for you – you and I being ‘man’.

152a

TT: Yes, this is what it means.

152a

S: Now, a wise man is not likely to talk nonsense, so let us follow his argument. Is it true that sometimes when the same wind is blowing, one of us may be cold while the other is not, or one of us a little cold while the other is very cold?

ἐπιστήμης, ἀλλ' ὃν ἔλεγε καὶ Πρωταγόρας. τρόπον δέ τινα ἄλλον εἴρηκε τὰ αὐτὰ ταῦτα. φησὶ γάρ που πάντων χρημάτων μέτρον ἄνθρωπον εἶναι, τῶν μὲν ὄντων ὡς ἔστι, τῶν δὲ μὴ ὄντων ὡς οὐκ ἔστιν. ἀνέγνωκας γάρ που; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀνέγνωκα καὶ πολλάκις. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν οὕτω πως λέγει, ὡς οἷα μὲν ἕκαστα ἐμοὶ φαίνεται τοιαῦτα μὲν ἔστιν ἐμοί, οἷα δὲ σοί, τοιαῦτα δὲ αὖ σοί· ἄνθρωπος δὲ σύ τε κἀγώ; ΘΕΑΙ. λέγει γὰρ οὕτω.

152b

TT: Of course.

152b

S: Now, at that time, can we say whether this wind, in itself, is cold or not? Or should we accept from Protagoras that it is cold for the person who feels cold, but not for the person who doesn't?

152b

TT: It seems we should.

152b

S: And is that how it appears to each person?

152b

TT: Yes.

152b

S: But does 'it appears' mean 'it is perceived'?

152b

TT: It does.

152b

S: Then appearance and perception are the same in the case of warmth, and all such matters. Indeed, how things are perceived is how things are likely to be for each person.

ΣΩ. εἰκὸς μέντοι σοφὸν ἄνδρα μὴ ληρεῖν· ἐπακολουθήσωμεν οὖν αὐτῷ. ἄρ' οὐκ ἐνίστε πνέοντος ἀνέμου τοῦ αὐτοῦ ὁ μὲν ἡμῶν ῥιγῶ, ὁ δ' οὐ; καὶ ὁ μὲν ἡρέμα, ὁ δὲ σφόδρα; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ μάλα. ΣΩ. πότερον οὖν τότε αὐτὸ ἐφ' ἑαυτοῦ τὸ πνεῦμα ψυχρὸν ἢ οὐ ψυχρὸν φήσομεν; ἢ πεισόμεθα τῷ Πρωταγόρᾳ ὅτι τῷ μὲν ῥιγῶντι ψυχρὸν, τῷ δὲ μὴ οὐ; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔοικεν.

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ φαίνεται οὕτω ἑκατέρω; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. τὸ δέ γε φαίνεται αἰσθάνεσθαι ἔστιν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστιν γάρ.

152c

TT: So it seems.

152c

S: So, perception is always of what is, and it is not false since it is knowledge.

152c

TT: So it appears.

152c

S: Well then, by the Graces, was Protagoras an utterly wise person who spoke this riddle to us common crowd while he divulged the truth¹³ to his disciples in secret?

152c

TT: Whatever do you mean by that, Socrates?

ΣΩ. φαντασία ἄρα καὶ αἴσθησις ταὐτὸν ἔν τε θερμοῖς καὶ πᾶσι τοῖς τοιούτοις. οἷα γὰρ αἰσθάνεται ἕκαστος, τοιαῦτα ἑκάστῳ καὶ κινδυνεύει εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. αἴσθησις ἄρα τοῦ ὄντος ἀεὶ ἔστιν καὶ ἀψευδὲς ὥς ἐπιστήμη οὐσα. ΘΕΑΙ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν πρὸς Χαρίτων πάσσοφός τις ἦν ὁ Πρωταγόρας, καὶ τοῦτο ἡμῖν μὲν ἠνίξατο τῷ πολλῷ συρφετῷ, τοῖς δὲ μαθηταῖς ἐν ἀπορρήτῳ τὴν ἀλήθειαν ἔλεγεν;

152d

S: I shall tell you, and this is surely no ordinary account. It states that nothing just by itself is one, nor may you correctly refer to it as some thing, nor as any kind of thing. But if you say it is large, it will also appear to be small; and if you say it is heavy, it will also appear light; and so it is for everything, because nothing is one, or some thing, or of a particular kind. In fact, everything arises from movement and change and intermingling, and we actually say that these things are, but we are not referring to them correctly, for nothing ever is, but is always becoming. The entire tradition of the wise, except Parmenides, also agrees about this, including both Protagoras and Heraclitus, and

Empedocles and the supreme poets from each branch of poetry – Epicharmus of the comic, and Homer of the tragic.¹⁴ And when Homer said, “Ocean is the source of the gods, and Tethys is their mother”,¹⁵ he meant that everything is born from flux and change. Or don’t you think this is what he meant?

ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δὴ, ὦ Σώκρατες, τοῦτο λέγεις; ΣΩ. ἐγὼ ἐρῶ καὶ μάλ’ οὐ φαῦλον λόγον, ὥς ἄρα ἐν μὲν αὐτὸ καθ’ αὐτὸ οὐδέν ἐστιν, οὐδ’ ἄν τι προσείποις ὀρθῶς οὐδ’ ὅποιονοῦν τι, ἀλλ’ ἐὰν ὡς μέγα προσαγορεύης, καὶ σμικρὸν φανεῖται, καὶ ἐὰν βαρὺ, κοῦφον, σύμπαντά τε οὕτως, ὡς μηδενὸς ὄντος ἐνὸς μήτε τινὸς μήτε ὁποιοῦν ἐκ δὲ δὴ φορᾶς τε καὶ κινήσεως καὶ κράσεως πρὸς ἄλληλα γίνεταί πάντα ἃ δὴ φαμεν εἶναι, οὐκ ὀρθῶς προσαγορεύοντες·

152e

TT: I do, indeed.

ἔστι μὲν γὰρ οὐδέποτ’ οὐδέν, ἀεὶ δὲ γίνεταί. καὶ περὶ τούτου πάντες ἐξῆς οἱ σοφοὶ πλὴν Παρμενίδου συμφερέσθων, Πρωταγόρας τε καὶ Ἡράκλειτος καὶ Ἐμπεδοκλῆς, καὶ τῶν ποιητῶν οἱ ἄκροι τῆς ποιήσεως ἑκατέρας, κωμωδίας μὲν Ἐπίχαρμος, τραγωδίας δὲ Ὅμηρος, ὃς εἰπὼν — Ὡκεανόν τε θεῶν γένεσιν καὶ μητέρα Τηθύν πάντα εἴρηκεν ἔκγονα ῥοῆς τε καὶ κινήσεως· ἢ οὐ δοκεῖ τοῦτο λέγειν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔμοιγε.

153a

S: Is there anyone who could do battle against such a vast army, with Homer as their general, and not become a laughing stock?

153a

TT: That would not be easy, Socrates.

153a

S: It would not, Theaetetus, as there are also the following cogent indications that the account is correct, since movement produces becoming and what seems to be, while inactivity produces non-being and destruction. Indeed, heat and fire, which actually generate and regulate everything else, are themselves generated from movement

and friction, and these are both activities. Aren't these the origins of fire?

ΣΩ. τίς οὖν ἂν ἔτι πρὸς γε τοσοῦτον στρατόπεδον καὶ στρατηγὸν Ὅμηρον δύναιτο ἀμφισβητήσας μὴ οὐ καταγέλαστος γενέσθαι; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ ῥάδιον, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. οὐ γάρ, ὦ Θεαίτητε. ἐπεὶ καὶ τάδε τῷ λόγῳ σημεία ἱκανά, ὅτι τὸ μὲν εἶναι δοκοῦν καὶ τὸ γίγνεσθαι κίνησις παρέχει, τὸ δὲ μὴ εἶναι καὶ ἀπόλλυσθαι ἡσυχία· τὸ γὰρ θερμόν τε καὶ πῦρ, ὃ δὴ καὶ τᾶλλα γεννᾷ καὶ ἐπιτροπεύει, αὐτὸ γεννᾶται ἐκ φορᾶς καὶ τρίψεως· τούτῳ δὲ κινήσεις· ἢ οὐχ αὗται γενέσεις πυρός;

153b

Tt: They certainly are.

153b

S: And, indeed, the race of living creatures is sprung from the same processes.

153b

Tt: It must be.

153b

S: And isn't the condition of our bodies corrupted by inactivity and idleness, but preserved for the most part by exercise and movement?

153b

Tt: Yes.

153b

S: And what of the condition of the soul? Isn't it through instruction and attention, which are activities, that it acquires learning and is preserved and becomes better, while through inactivity, which is both lack of attention and ignorance, it does not understand anything and forgets whatever it does understand?

ΘΕΑΙ. αὗται μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν τό γε τῶν ζώων γένος ἐκ τῶν αὐτῶν τούτων φύεται. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΣΩ. τί δέ; ἢ τῶν σωμάτων ἕξις οὐχ ὑπὸ ἡσυχίας μὲν καὶ ἀργίας διόλλυται, ὑπὸ γυμνασίων δὲ καὶ κινήσεως ἐπὶ πολὺ σῶζεται; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. ἢ δ' ἐν τῇ ψυχῇ ἕξις οὐχ ὑπὸ μαθήσεως μὲν

καὶ μελέτης, κινήσεων ὄντων, κτᾷται τε μαθήματα καὶ σώζεται καὶ γίνεται βελτίων, ὑπὸ δ' ἡσυχίας, ἀμελετησίας τε καὶ

153c

TT: It certainly does.

153c

S: So, activity is good for both body and soul, while inactivity is the opposite.

153c

TT: So it seems.

153c

S: I can tell you more about such matters as absence of wind and calm seas, where the stillness decays and corrupts things, while different conditions will preserve them. But in addition to this, the ultimate evidence I bring forward is the golden cord that Homer declares to be the very sun itself, and he explains that as long as the heavens and the sun are in motion, all things are, and are preserved among both gods and men. However, should this cease and be tied down, everything would be destroyed, and as they say the world would be turned upside down.¹⁶

ἀμαθίας οὐσης, οὔτε τι μανθάνει ἅ τε ἂν μάθῃ ἐπιλανθάνεται; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ μάλα. ΣΩ. τὸ μὲν ἄρα ἀγαθὸν κίνησις κατὰ τε ψυχὴν καὶ κατὰ σῶμα, τὸ δὲ τοῦναντίον; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. ἔτι οὖν σοι λέγω νηνεμίας τε καὶ γαλήνας καὶ ὅσα τοιαῦτα, ὅτι αἱ μὲν ἡσυχίαι σήπουσι καὶ ἀπολλύασι, τὰ δ' ἕτερα σώζει; καὶ ἐπὶ τούτοις τὸν κολοφῶνα, ἀναγκάζω προσβιβάζω τὴν χρυσὴν σειρὰν ὡς οὐδὲν ἄλλο ἢ τὸν ἥλιον

153d

TT: Yes, Socrates, it seems to me that that is exactly what he is explaining.

153d

S: Therefore, my friend, you must appreciate to begin with that in the case of the eyes, what you refer to as white colour is not something separate outside of your eyes, nor is it in your eyes, nor should you

assign any location to it, for it would then be abiding in that place and would not be in the process of becoming.

Ὅμηρος λέγει, καὶ δηλοῖ ὅτι ἕως μὲν ἂν ἡ περιφορὰ ἧ κινουμένη καὶ ὁ ἥλιος, πάντα ἔστι καὶ σώζεται τὰ ἐν θεοῖς τε καὶ ἀνθρώποις, εἰ δὲ σταίη τοῦτο ὥσπερ δεθὲν, πάντα χρήματ' ἂν διαφθαρείη καὶ γένοιτ' ἂν τὸ λεγόμενον ἄνω κάτω πάντα; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλ' ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ, ὦ Σώκρατες, ταῦτα δηλοῦν ἅπερ λέγεις. ΣΩ. ὑπόλαβε τοίνυν, ὦ ἄριστε, οὕτωςί κατὰ τὰ ὅμματα πρῶτον, ὃ δὴ καλεῖς χρῶμα λευκόν, μὴ εἶναι αὐτὸ ἕτερόν τι ἔξω τῶν σῶν ὁμμάτων μηδ' ἐν τοῖς ὅμμασι μηδέ

153e

TT: But how does it work?

153e

S: Let us pursue the current argument by proposing that nothing just by itself is one. And thus it will be evident that black or white or any other colour has arisen from the eyes hitting upon the relevant motion. Indeed, each so-called colour will be neither that which strikes nor that which is struck, but something that has arisen in between, private to each. Or would you maintain that each colour appears to you just as it does to a dog, or any other animal?

τιν' αὐτῷ χώραν ἀποτάξης· ἤδη γὰρ ἂν εἴη τε δήπου ἐν τάξει καὶ μένον καὶ οὐκ ἂν ἐν γενέσει γίγνοιτο. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ πῶς; ΣΩ. ἐπώμεθα τῷ ἄρτι λόγῳ, μηδὲν αὐτὸ καθ' αὐτὸ ἐν ὃν τιθέντες· καὶ ἡμῖν οὕτω μέλαν τε καὶ λευκὸν καὶ ὅτιοῦν ἄλλο χρῶμα ἐκ τῆς προσβολῆς τῶν ὁμμάτων πρὸς τὴν προσήκουσαν φορὰν φανεῖται γεγεννημένον, καὶ ὃ δὴ ἕκαστον

154a

TT: By Zeus, I would not!

154a

S: What about this? Does anything at all appear similar to you and to another person? Are you certain of this? Or are you even more certain that it does not appear the same even to yourself, because you are never in the same state as yourself?

154a

TT: That's even truer than your first example.

154a

S: Now, if whatever we measured ourselves by, or touched, was large or white or hot, it would never become different through encountering something else, unless it itself actually changed. But on the other hand, if whatever is measuring or touching was large or white or hot, it would not have become different when another thing drew near or underwent some process, while nothing happened to itself. As things stand now, my friend, we are forced so easily into extraordinary and comical utterances, as Protagoras, and anyone who tries to make the same point as he does, would maintain.

εἶναί φαμεν χρώμα οὔτε τὸ προσβάλλον οὔτε τὸ προσβαλλόμενον ἔσται, ἀλλὰ μεταξύ τι ἑκάστῳ ἴδιον γεγονός ἢ σὺ δισχυρίσαιο ἂν ὡς οἶον σοὶ φαίνεται ἕκαστον χρώμα, τοιοῦτον καὶ κυνὶ καὶ ὀτφοῦν ζῶω; ΘΕΑΙ. μὰ Δί' οὐκ ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. τί δέ; ἄλλω ἀνθρώπῳ ἄρ' ὅμοιον καὶ σοὶ φαίνεται ὅτιοῦν; ἔχεις τοῦτο ἰσχυρῶς, ἢ πολὺ μᾶλλον ὅτι οὐδὲ σοὶ αὐτῷ ταῦτόν διὰ τὸ μηδέποτε ὁμοίως αὐτὸν σεαυτῷ ἔχειν; ΘΕΑΙ. τοῦτο μᾶλλον μοι δοκεῖ ἢ ἐκεῖνο.

154b

TT: What sort of utterances do you mean?

154b

S: Take a simple example, and you will know all that I have in mind. Presume there are six dice and you introduce four dice beside them. We say that they are more than the four, indeed one-and-a-half times the four. However, if you introduce twelve dice, the six will be fewer, in fact half of twelve, and that is the only acceptable description. Or would you accept any other?

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἰ μὲν ᾧ παραμετρούμεθα ἢ οὗ ἐφαπτόμεθα μέγα ἢ λευκὸν ἢ θερμὸν ἦν, οὐκ ἂν ποτε ἄλλω προσπεσὸν ἄλλο ἂν ἐγγέγονει, αὐτό γε μὴδὲν μεταβάλλον· εἰ δὲ αὖ τὸ παραμετρούμενον ἢ ἐφαπτόμενον ἕκαστον ἦν τούτων, οὐκ ἂν αὖ ἄλλου προσελθόντος ἢ τι παθόντος αὐτὸ μὴδὲν παθὸν ἄλλο ἂν ἐγένετο. ἐπεὶ νῦν γε, ὦ φίλε, θαυμαστά τε καὶ

γελοῖα εὐχερῶς πως ἀναγκαζόμεθα λέγειν, ὥς φαίη ἂν Πρωταγόρας τε καὶ πᾶς ὁ τὰ αὐτὰ ἐκείνῳ ἐπιχειρῶν λέγειν. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δὴ καὶ ποῖα λέγεις;

154c

TT: I would not.

154c

S: Well then, what if Protagoras or someone else were to ask you, ‘Theaetetus, is there any way for something to become bigger or more numerous, other than by being increased?’ What would be your response?

154c

TT: Socrates, if I were to give my immediate opinion on this question, I would answer that it is not possible. But based on your previous question, being wary of contradicting myself, I would say that it is possible.

ΣΩ. σμικρὸν λαβὲ παράδειγμα, καὶ πάντα εἴση ἃ βούλομαι. ἀστραγάλους γάρ που ἔξ, ἂν μὲν τέτταρας αὐτοῖς προσενέγκῃς, πλείους φαμέν εἶναι τῶν τεττάρων καὶ ἡμιολίους, ἐὰν δὲ δώδεκα, ἐλάττους καὶ ἡμίσεις, καὶ οὐδὲ ἀνεκτὸν ἄλλως λέγειν· ἢ σὺ ἀνέξῃ; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκ ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; ἂν σε Πρωταγόρας ἔρηται ἢ τις ἄλλος· ὧ θεαίτητε, ἔσθ’ ὅπως τι μεῖζον ἢ πλεον γίγνεται ἄλλως ἢ αὐξηθέν; τί ἀποκρινῇ; ΘΕΑΙ. ἐὰν μὲν, ὧ Σώκρατες, τὸ δοκοῦν πρὸς τὴν νῦν

154d

S: By Hera, my friend, a good and divine response. However, it seems that if you do say that this is possible, the consequences of Euripides’ words will befall you, for your tongue will be beyond refutation, but your heart will not.¹⁷

154d

TT: True.

154d

S: Now, if you and I were clever and wise, and had searched all the contents of our hearts, we would now spend the remaining time

probing the abundant resources at our disposal, as we joined in some sort of sophistical contest, banging our arguments against one another. But now, seeing that we are common men, we shall first prefer to review, in their own terms, the exact thoughts that we ourselves are thinking, and whether they seem to us to be concordant with one another or entirely discordant.

ἐρώτησιν ἀποκρίνωμαι, ὅτι οὐκ ἔστιν· ἐὰν δὲ πρὸς τὴν προτέραν, φυλάττων μὴ ἐναντία εἶπω, ὅτι ἔστιν. ΣΩ. εὖ γε νῆ τὴν Ἥραν, ὦ φίλε, καὶ θείως. ἀτάρ, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἐὰν ἀποκρίνη ὅτι ἔστιν, Εὐριπίδειόν τι συμβήσεται· ἢ μὲν γὰρ γλῶττα ἀνέλεγκτος ἡμῖν ἔσται, ἢ δὲ φρὴν οὐκ ἀνέλεγκτος. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἰ μὲν δεινοὶ καὶ σοφοὶ ἐγώ τε καὶ σὺ ἤμεν, πάντα τὰ τῶν φρενῶν ἐξητακότες, ἤδη ἂν τὸ λοιπὸν

154e

TT: Yes, certainly, I would prefer that.

154e

S: And so would I. Now since that is so, shall we examine ourselves faithfully and patiently, considering once more what these appearances within us actually are? On considering the first of them, I believe we shall say that nothing would ever become greater or lesser, either in bulk or numerically, as long as it is equal to itself. Isn't this the case?

ἐκ περιουσίας ἀλλήλων ἀποπειρώμενοι, συνελθόντες σοφιστικῶς εἰς μάχην τοιαύτην, ἀλλήλων τοὺς λόγους τοῖς λόγοις ἐκρούομεν· νῦν δὲ ἅτε ιδιωῖται πρῶτον βουλησόμεθα θεάσασθαι αὐτὰ πρὸς αὐτὰ τί ποτ' ἔστιν ἃ διανοούμεθα, πότερον ἡμῖν ἀλλήλοις συμφωνεῖ ἢ οὐδ' ὁπωστιοῦν. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν ἔγωγε τοῦτ' ἂν βουλοίμην. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν ἐγώ. ὅτε δ' οὕτως ἔχει, ἄλλο τι ἢ ἡρέμα, ὡς πάνυ πολλὴν σχολὴν ἄγοντες, πάλιν ἐπανασκεψόμεθα,

155a

TT: Yes.

155a

S: And the second of them will have us say that if nothing is either added to or removed from something, it will neither increase nor diminish, but it will remain equal.

155a

TT: Yes, certainly.

οὐ δυσκολαίνοντες ἀλλὰ τῷ ὄντι ἡμᾶς αὐτοὺς ἐξετάζοντες, ἅττα ποτ' ἐστὶ ταῦτα τὰ φάσματα ἐν ἡμῖν; ὧν πρῶτον ἐπισκοποῦντες φήσομεν, ὡς ἐγὼ οἶμαι, μηδέποτε μηδὲν ἂν μεῖζον μηδὲ ἔλαττον γενέσθαι μήτε ὄγκῳ μήτε ἀριθμῷ, ἕως ἴσον εἶη αὐτὸ ἑαυτῷ. οὐχ οὕτως; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. δεύτερον δέ γε, ὧ μήτε προστιθοῖτο μήτε ἀφαιροῖτο, τοῦτο μήτε ἀυξάνεσθαι ποτε μήτε φθίνειν, ἀεὶ δὲ ἴσον εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ μὲν οὖν.

155b

S: And won't the third have us say that nothing can be what it was not before, without becoming and a process of becoming?

155b

TT: It certainly seems so.

155b

S: Now, I believe that these admissions are battling with one another in our soul, whenever we discuss the matter of the dice, or whenever we say that I, who at my age am neither getting bigger nor going in the opposite direction, am now taller than a youth like you, but later on that I am shorter, over the course of one year. This happens without my frame being reduced, but through yours becoming bigger. But note that I am, at a later time, what I was not before, though I have not undergone a process of becoming. But without such a process it is impossible to become smaller, and without losing any of my bulk I would not have become shorter. And there are, of course, thousands upon thousands of such instances once we accept all this. I presume you are following, Theaetetus. You actually seem to have some familiarity with such issues.

ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν οὐ καὶ τρίτον, ὃ μὴ πρότερον ἦν, ὕστερον ἀλλὰ τοῦτο εἶναι ἄνευ τοῦ γενέσθαι καὶ γίγνεσθαι ἀδύνατον; ΘΕΑΙ. δοκεῖ γε δή. ΣΩ.

ταῦτα δὴ, οἶομαι, ὁμολογήματα τρία μάχεται αὐτὰ αὐτοῖς ἐν τῇ ἡμετέρᾳ ψυχῇ, ὅταν τὰ περὶ τῶν ἀστραγάλων λέγωμεν, ἢ ὅταν φῶμεν ἐμὲ τηλικόνδε ὄντα, μήτε ἀυξηθέντα μήτε τούναντίον παθόντα, ἐν ἐνιαυτῷ σοῦ τοῦ νέου νῦν μὲν μείζω εἶναι, ὕστερον δὲ ἐλάττω, μηδὲν τοῦ ἐμοῦ ὄγκου

155c

ΤΤ: I am, Socrates, and by the gods, I wonder intensely what they actually mean. And the truth is I sometimes get dizzy from looking at them.

ἀφαιρεθέντος ἀλλὰ σοῦ ἀυξηθέντος. εἰμὶ γὰρ δὴ ὕστερον ὃ πρότερον οὐκ ἦ, οὐ γενόμενος ἄνευ γὰρ τοῦ γίγνεσθαι γενέσθαι ἀδύνατον, μηδὲν δὲ ἀπολλὺς τοῦ ὄγκου οὐκ ἂν ποτε ἐγίγνομην ἐλάττων. καὶ ἄλλα δὴ μυρία ἐπὶ μυρίοις οὕτως ἔχει, εἴπερ καὶ ταῦτα παραδεξόμεθα. ἔπη γάρ που, ὦ Θεαίτητε· δοκεῖς γοῦν μοι οὐκ ἄπειρος τῶν τοιούτων εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ νῆ τοὺς θεοὺς γε, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὑπερφυῶς ὡς θαυμάζω τί ποτ' ἐστὶ ταῦτα, καὶ ἐνίστε ὡς ἀληθῶς βλέπων εἰς αὐτὰ σκοτοδινίῳ.

155d

S: Well, my friend, Theodorus here seems to have made no poor estimate of your endowments. Indeed, this wonder is the particular characteristic of a philosopher, since philosophy has no other origin than this, and it seems that whoever said that Iris was born from Thaumas was not a bad genealogist.¹⁸ But do you now understand why these things are so, based on the statement we are attributing to Protagoras? Or is it not yet clear?

155d

ΤΤ: It is not clear to me yet.

155d

S: Now, will you feel grateful to me if I assist you in a thorough examination of the truth hidden in the thought of a famous man? Nay, of famous men?

ΣΩ. Θεόδωρος γάρ, ὦ φίλε, φαίνεται οὐ κακῶς τοπάζειν περὶ τῆς φύσεώς σου. μάλα γὰρ φιλοσόφου τοῦτο τὸ πάθος, τὸ θαυμάζειν· οὐ

γὰρ ἄλλη ἀρχὴ φιλοσοφίας ἢ αὕτη, καὶ ἔοικεν ὁ τὴν Ἴριν Θαύμαντος ἔκγονον φήσας οὐ κακῶς γενεαλογεῖν. ἀλλὰ πότερον μανθάνεις ἤδη δι' ὃ ταῦτα τοιαῦτ' ἐστὶν ἐξ ὧν τὸν Πρωταγόραν φαμὲν λέγειν, ἢ οὐπω; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐπω μοι δοκῶ. ΣΩ. χάριν οὖν μοι εἴσῃ ἐάν σοι ἀνδρός, μᾶλλον δὲ ἀνδρῶν ὀνομαστῶν τῆς διανοίας τὴν ἀλήθειαν ἀποκεκρυμμένην

155e

TT: How could I feel anything other than huge gratitude?

155e

S: Then look about, and take care lest any of the uninitiated is listening in. These are the fellows who believe that there is nothing except what they can hold fast with both hands and do not accept that activities and processes, and all that is unseen, have a share in being.

συνεξερευνήσωμαι αὐτῶν; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐκ εἴσομαι, καὶ πάνυ γε πολλήν; ΣΩ. ἄθρει δὴ περισκοπῶν μή τις τῶν ἀμυήτων ἐπακούῃ. εἰσὶν δὲ οὗτοι οἱ οὐδὲν ἄλλο οἰόμενοι εἶναι ἢ οὗ ἂν δύνωνται ἀπρίξ τοῖν χεροῖν λαβέσθαι, πράξεις δὲ καὶ γενέσεις καὶ πᾶν τὸ ἀόρατον οὐκ ἀποδεχόμενοι ὥς ἐν οὐσίας μέρει. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ μὲν δή, ὦ Σώκρατες, σκληρούς γε λέγεις καὶ

156a

TT: Yes of course, Socrates. You are describing some quite tough and obstinate characters.

156a

S: Yes, my boy, they are indeed most ill-educated. But there are others, much more refined, whose mysteries I am about to reveal to you. Now, their first principle, on which hangs all we have been discussing just now, is that all is motion and there is nothing else besides this. The motion has two forms, and each is unlimited in multiplicity, though one has an active power while the other is passive. From the mutual intercourse and friction of these two with one another, numerous offspring arise that are limitless in number but always twins. One twin is the perceptible, and the other is the perception that constantly accompanies the perceptible and is born along with it. For the

perceptions, then, we have such names as seeings and hearings, smellings, cold and hot, and of course pleasures and pains, desires and fears, as they are called, and others. Indeed, those without names are innumerable, and those that have been given names are very numerous. On the other hand, the category of perceptibles has, in turn, a common origin with each of the perceptions, so with variegated seeings there are variegated colours, and the same applies to hearings and sounds, and for the other perceptions the other kindred perceptibles arise. Now, Theaetetus, what does this story tell us about the previous subjects? Can you see?

ἀντιτύπους ἀνθρώπους. ΣΩ. εἰσὶν γάρ, ὦ παῖ, μάλ' εὖ ἄμουςοι· ἄλλοι δὲ πολὺ κομψότεροι, ὧν μέλλω σοι τὰ μυστήρια λέγειν. ἀρχὴ δέ, ἐξ ἧς καὶ ἃ νυνδὴ ἐλέγομεν πάντα ἥρτηται, ἥδε αὐτῶν, ὡς τὸ πᾶν κίνησις ἦν καὶ ἄλλο παρὰ τοῦτο οὐδέν, τῆς δὲ κινήσεως δύο εἶδη, πλήθει μὲν ἄπειρον ἐκάτερον, δύναμιν δὲ τὸ μὲν ποιεῖν ἔχον, τὸ δὲ πάσχειν. ἐκ δὲ τῆς τούτων ὁμιλίας τε καὶ τρίψεως πρὸς ἄλληλα γίγνεται ἔκγονα πλήθει μὲν ἄπειρα, δίδυμα δέ, τὸ μὲν αἰσθητὸν, τὸ δὲ αἰσθησις, αἰὲ συνεκρίπτουσα καὶ γεννωμένη μετὰ τοῦ αἰσθητοῦ. αἱ μὲν οὖν αἰσθήσεις τὰ τοιαῦδε ἡμῖν ἔχουσιν ὀνόματα, ὄψεις τε καὶ ἀκοαὶ καὶ ὁσφρήσεις καὶ ψύξεις τε καὶ καύσεις καὶ ἡδοναὶ γε δὴ καὶ λύπαι καὶ ἐπιθυμίαι καὶ φόβοι κεκλημένα καὶ ἄλλαι, ἀπέραντοι μὲν αἱ ἀνώνυμοι, παμπληθεῖς δὲ αἱ ὀνομασμένα· τὸ δ' αὖ αἰσθητὸν γένος τούτων ἐκάσταις ὁμόγονον,

156c

Tt: Not very well, Socrates.

156c

S: Well, let us see if we can bring it to a conclusion. It does indeed mean, just as we are saying, that all things are in motion, though some are quick in their movements and others are slow. Now, anything slow has its motion in the same place and relative to whatever comes near, and it produces offspring in this way. But whatever is produced is quicker, and moves from place to place, and its motion naturally involves a place to place movement. Therefore, whenever an eye and

something that can be evaluated by it draw near and generate whiteness and its associated perception – neither of which would ever have arisen if either of them had encountered something different – there is movement between them at that time. This movement is sight on the part of the eyes, and whiteness on the part of whatever joins in the production of the colour. So the eye becomes full of sight, and then it sees and becomes not sight but a seeing eye, while its partner in the production of colour is saturated in whiteness and becomes, for its part, not whiteness but something white, be it wood or stone or anything else that happens to be coloured with a colour of this sort. And this is actually how things work in general. Hard and hot and all else should be understood in the same way, to be nothing just by itself, as we were saying before, but in their mutual intercourse everything of every kind arises from the movement, since there is actually no firm basis for thinking that the active or passive is something in isolation. For there is not an active until it is joined to a passive, nor a passive until it is joined to an active. And that which joins one thing and is active turns out to be passive when it encounters something else. And the consequence of all this, just as we were saying at the beginning, is that nothing just by itself is one, but is constantly coming into being with something, and ‘to be’ should be entirely removed from use, not that we have not been compelled to use it just now, through habit and ignorance. But the account of these wise men says we must not do this, nor should we accept the word ‘something’ or ‘of something’ or ‘mine’ or ‘this’ or ‘that’ or any other name that would make it fixed. Instead we should declare, in accord with nature, that they are coming into being, being produced and being destroyed or changed, since if anyone fixes anything with a word, whoever does this will be easily refuted. This is also how we should refer to particulars and to aggregates of many, aggregates that are designated as ‘man’ or ‘stone’, and each living creature and form. Now, Theaetetus, don’t you think this is delightful, and so delicious that you could eat it?

ὅψεσι μὲν χρώματα παντοδαπαῖς παντοδαπά, ἀκοαῖς δὲ ὡσαύτως φωναί, καὶ ταῖς ἄλλαις αἰσθήσεσι τὰ ἄλλα αἰσθητὰ συγγενῇ γιγνόμενα. τί δὴ οὖν ἡμῖν βούλεται οὗτος ὁ μῦθος, ὃ θεαίτητε, πρὸς τὰ πρότερα; ἄρα ἐννοεῖς; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ πάνυ, ὢ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἄθρει ἐάν πως ἀποτελεσθῇ. βούλεται γὰρ δὴ λέγειν ὡς ταῦτα πάντα μὲν ὡσπερ λέγομεν κινεῖται, τάχος δὲ καὶ βραδυτῆς ἔνι τῇ κίνησει αὐτῶν. ὅσον μὲν οὖν βραδύ, ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ καὶ πρὸς τὰ πλησιάζοντα τὴν κίνησιν ἴσχει καὶ οὕτω δὴ γεννᾷ, τὰ δὲ γεννώμενα οὕτω δὴ θάπτω ἐστίν. φέρεται γὰρ καὶ ἐν φορᾷ αὐτῶν ἡ κίνησις πέφυκεν. ἐπειδὴν οὖν ὅμμα καὶ ἄλλο τι τῶν τούτῳ συμμέτρων πλησιάσαν γεννήσῃ τὴν λευκότητά τε καὶ αἴσθησιν αὐτῇ σύμφυτον, ἃ οὐκ ἂν ποτε ἐγένετο ἐκατέρου ἐκείνων πρὸς ἄλλο ἐλθόντος, τότε δὴ μεταξὺ φερομένων τῆς μὲν ὀψεως πρὸς τῶν ὀφθαλμῶν, τῆς δὲ λευκότητος πρὸς τοῦ συναποτίκτοντος τὸ χρῶμα, ὁ μὲν ὀφθαλμὸς ἄρα ὀψεως ἔμπλεως ἐγένετο καὶ ὀρᾷ δὴ τότε καὶ ἐγένετο οὐ τι ὄψις ἀλλ' ὀφθαλμὸς ὀρῶν, τὸ δὲ συγγενήσαν τὸ χρῶμα λευκότητος περιεπλήσθη καὶ ἐγένετο οὐ λευκότης αὖ ἀλλὰ λευκόν, εἴτε ζύλον εἴτε λίθος εἴτε ὀτρωῶν συνέβη χρῆμα χρωσθῆναι τῷ τοιοῦτῳ χρώματι. ΣΩ. καὶ τᾶλλα δὴ οὕτω, σκληρὸν καὶ θερμὸν καὶ πάντα, τὸν αὐτὸν τρόπον ὑποληπτέον, αὐτὸ μὲν καθ' αὐτὸ μὴδὲν εἶναι, ὃ δὴ καὶ τότε ἐλέγομεν, ἐν δὲ τῇ πρὸς ἄλληλα ὁμιλίᾳ πάντα γίνεσθαι καὶ παντοῖα ἀπὸ τῆς κινήσεως, ἐπεὶ καὶ τὸ ποιοῦν εἶναι τι καὶ τὸ πάσχον αὐτῶν ἐπὶ ἐνὸς νοῆσαι, ὡς φασιν, οὐκ εἶναι παγίως. οὔτε γὰρ ποιοῦν ἐστὶ τι πρὶν ἂν τῷ πάσχοντι συνέλθῃ, οὔτε πάσχον πρὶν ἂν τῷ ποιοῦντι· τό τέ τινα συνελθὼν καὶ ποιοῦν ἄλλω αὖ προσπεσὼν πάσχον ἀνεφάνη. ὥστε ἐξ ἀπάντων τούτων, ὅπερ ἐξ ἀρχῆς ἐλέγομεν, οὐδὲν εἶναι ἐν αὐτὸ καθ' αὐτό, ἀλλὰ τινα δεῖ γίνεσθαι, τὸ δ' εἶναι πανταχόθεν ἐξαιρετέον, οὐχ ὅτι ἡμεῖς πολλὰ καὶ ἄρτι ἠναγκάσμεθα ὑπὸ συνηθείας καὶ ἀνεπιστημοσύνης χρῆσθαι αὐτῷ. τὸ δ' οὐ δεῖ, ὡς ὁ τῶν σοφῶν λόγος, οὔτε τι συγχωρεῖν οὔτε του οὔτ' ἐμοῦ οὔτε τόδε οὔτ' ἐκεῖνο οὔτε ἄλλο οὐδὲν ὄνομα ὅτι ἂν ἰσθῇ, ἀλλὰ κατὰ φύσιν φθέγγεσθαι γιγνόμενα καὶ ποιούμενα καὶ ἀπολλύμενα καὶ ἀλλοιούμενα· ὡς ἐάν τις στήσῃ τῷ λόγῳ, εὐέλεγκτος ὁ τοῦτο ποιῶν. δεῖ δὲ καὶ κατὰ μέρος οὕτω λέγειν καὶ περὶ πολλῶν ἀθροισθέντων, ὧ δὴ ἀθροίσματι

157c

Tt: Well, I don't know, Socrates. Indeed, I cannot understand you, and whether you believe what you are saying or testing me.

157c

S: My friend, you are forgetting that I know nothing of such matters, nor do I regard them as my own offspring, since I am barren. However, I am acting as midwife to you, and on this account I am charming you, and offering pieces of wisdom for you to taste until I draw out that belief of yours into the light. Once it is out, I shall evaluate whether it shows itself to be a wind-egg or a genuine birth. So take heart, and persist! Answer truly and courageously, and tell us how things appear to you, no matter what I ask you about.

ἄνθρωπόν τε τίθενται καὶ λίθον καὶ ἕκαστον ζῶν τε καὶ εἶδος. ταῦτα δὴ, ὦ Θεαίτητε, ἄρ' ἡδέα δοκεῖ σοι εἶναι, καὶ γεύοιο ἂν αὐτῶν ὡς ἀρεσκόντων; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκ οἶδα ἔγωγε, ὦ Σώκρατες· καὶ γὰρ οὐδὲ περὶ σοῦ δύναμαι κατανοῆσαι πότερα δοκοῦντά σοι λέγεις αὐτὰ ἢ ἐμοῦ ἀποπειρᾷ. ΣΩ. οὐ μνημονεύεις, ὦ φίλε, ὅτι ἐγὼ μὲν οὐτ' οἶδα οὔτε ποιοῦμαι τῶν τοιούτων οὐδὲν ἐμόν, ἀλλ' εἰμὶ αὐτῶν ἄγονος, σὲ δὲ μαιεῖσθαι καὶ τούτου ἕνεκα ἐπάδω τε καὶ παρατίθημι

157d

Tt: Very well, ask me.

157d

S: Then tell me if you agree that nothing is good or beautiful, or anything else we just mentioned, but is constantly becoming so.

157d

Tt: Well, I think so, since it appears marvellously reasonable when I hear you describing it like this, and it should be accepted exactly as you have recounted it.

ἐκάστων τῶν σοφῶν ἀπογεύσασθαι, ἕως ἂν εἰς φῶς τὸ σὸν δόγμα συνεξαγάγω· ἐξαχθέντος δὲ τότε ἤδη σκέψομαι εἴτ' ἀνεμιαῖον εἶτε γόνιμον ἀναφανήσεται. ἀλλὰ θαρρῶν καὶ καρτερῶν εὖ καὶ ἀνδρείως ἀποκρίνου ἃ ἂν φαίνεται σοι περὶ ὧν ἂν ἐρωτῶ. ΘΕΑΙ. ἐρώτα δὴ. ΣΩ.

λέγε τοίνυν πάλιν εἴ σοι ἀρέσκει τὸ μή τι εἶναι ἀλλὰ γίγνεσθαι ἀεὶ ἀγαθὸν καὶ καλὸν καὶ πάντα ἃ ἄρτι διήμην. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλ' ἔμοιγε, ἐπειδὴ σοῦ ἀκούω οὕτω διεξιόντος, θαυμασιῶς φαίνεται ὡς ἔχειν λόγον καὶ ὑποληπτέον ἥπερ διελήλυθας.

157e

S: In that case, let us not leave out anything that is missing from it. What is missing is consideration of dreaming, diseases in general, and also madness, and the extent to which we are said to err in hearing and seeing and in our other perceptions. Indeed, you know that in all these cases the account we gave just now seems to be proved wrong by common consent, as false perceptions certainly arise in us under such circumstances, and so for each person the appearances are far removed from what is. Rather, on the contrary, nothing at all that appears to be, is.

ΣΩ. μὴ τοίνυν ἀπολίπωμεν ὅσον ἐλλεῖπον αὐτοῦ. λείπεται δὲ ἐνυπνίων τε πέρι καὶ νόσων τῶν τε ἄλλων καὶ μανίας, ὅσα τε παρακούειν ἢ παρορᾶν ἢ τι ἄλλο παραισθάνεσθαι λέγεται. οἶσθα γάρ που ὅτι ἐν πᾶσι τούτοις ὁμολογουμένως ἐλέγχεσθαι δοκεῖ ὃν ἄρτι διήμην λόγον,

158a

TT: What you say is perfectly true, Socrates.

158a

S: Well then, what argument is left for the one who proposes that perception is knowledge, and that for the person to whom they appear, whatever appears to be, is, in each case?

158a

TT: Well, Socrates, I hesitate to say that I don't know what to say, since you rebuked me for saying that just now. Yet the truth is that I could never dispute that madmen and dreamers have false opinions, when one group believes they are gods, or the others, in their sleep, think that they have wings and are flying.

ὡς παντὸς μᾶλλον ἡμῖν ψευδεῖς αἰσθήσεις ἐν αὐτοῖς γιγνομένας, καὶ πολλοῦ δεῖ τὰ φαινόμενα ἐκάστῳ ταῦτα καὶ εἶναι, ἀλλὰ πᾶν τούναντίον

οὐδὲν ὧν φαίνεται εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθέστατα λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. τίς δὴ οὖν, ὦ παῖ, λείπεται λόγος τῷ τὴν αἴσθησιν ἐπιστήμην τιθεμένῳ καὶ τὰ φαινόμενα ἐκάστω ταῦτα καὶ εἶναι τοῦτῳ ᾧ φαίνεται; ΘΕΑΙ. ἐγὼ μὲν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὁκνῶ εἰπεῖν ὅτι οὐκ ἔχω τί λέγω, διότι μοι νυνδὴ ἐπέπληξας εἰπόντι αὐτό. ἐπεὶ ὥς

158b

S: Are you not aware of a similar dispute about these, and about sleeping and waking in particular?

158b

Tt: What sort of dispute?

158b

S: It is a question that I believe you have heard asked many times. What proof could you provide if someone were to ask, right now, whether we are asleep at present and are dreaming everything that we are thinking, or awake and talking to one another in the waking state?

ἀληθῶς γε οὐκ ἂν δυναίμην ἀμφισβητῆσαι ὥς οἱ μαινόμενοι ἢ οἱ ὄνειρώττοντες οὐ ψευδῇ δοξάζουσιν, ὅταν οἱ μὲν θεοὶ αὐτῶν οἴωνται εἶναι, οἱ δὲ πτηνοὶ τε καὶ ὥς πετόμενοι ἐν τῷ ὕπνῳ διανοῶνται. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν οὐδὲ τὸ τοιόνδε ἀμφισβήτημα ἐννοεῖς περὶ αὐτῶν, μάλιστα δὲ περὶ τοῦ ὄναρ τε καὶ ὕπαρ; ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. ὃ πολλάκις σε οἶμαι ἀκηκοέναι ἐρωτώντων, τί ἂν τις ἔχοι τεκμήριον ἀποδείξαι, εἴ τις ἔροίτο νῦν οὕτως ἐν τῷ παρόντι πότερον καθεύδομεν καὶ πάντα ἃ διανοούμεθα ὄνειρώττομεν,

158c

Tt: Yes, indeed, Socrates, I am at a loss as to what sort of proof should be provided since they both correspond so closely, just like mirrored dance movements. Indeed, there's no reason why our present conversation couldn't be a discussion with one another imagined in sleep. And, of course, whenever we are asleep, and imagine we are recounting dreams, the resemblance of one to the other is uncanny.

158c

S: You see then that there is plenty of room for dispute, when it is even disputed whether we are awake or asleep! And, indeed, as we spend a similar amount of time asleep and awake, in either state our soul contends that the opinions held at that time are completely true. Consequently, we spend an equal time asserting that this realm is real, and we are equally confident in each case.

ἢ ἐγρηγόραμέν τε καὶ ὕπαρ ἀλλήλοις διαλεγόμεθα. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ μήν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἄπορόν γε ὅτω χρη ἐπιδείξαι τεκμηρίω· πάντα γὰρ ὥσπερ ἀντίστροφα τὰ αὐτὰ παρακολουθεῖ. ἅ τε γὰρ νυνὶ διειλέγμεθα οὐδὲν κωλύει καὶ ἐν τῷ ὕπνῳ δοκεῖν ἀλλήλοις διαλέγεσθαι· καὶ ὅταν δὴ ὄναρ ὀνειράτα δοκῶμεν διηγεῖσθαι, ἄτοπος ἡ ὁμοιότης τούτων ἐκείνοις. ΣΩ. ὁρᾷς οὖν ὅτι τό γε ἀμφισβητῆσαι οὐ χαλεπόν, ὅτε

158d

TT: Entirely so.

158d

S: Doesn't the same argument apply to madness and disease, except that the durations are not equal?

158d

TT: Correct.

158d

S: Well then, is truth to be determined by longer or shorter duration of time?

καὶ πότερόν ἐστιν ὕπαρ ἢ ὄναρ ἀμφισβητεῖται, καὶ δὴ ἴσου ὄντος τοῦ χρόνου ὃν καθεύδομεν ὧς ἐγρηγόραμεν, ἐν ἑκατέρῳ διαμάχεται ἡμῶν ἡ ψυχὴ τὰ αἰεὶ παρόντα δόγματα παντὸς μᾶλλον εἶναι ἀληθῆ, ὥστε ἴσον μὲν χρόνον τάδε φαμέν ὄντα εἶναι, ἴσον δὲ ἐκεῖνα, καὶ ὁμοίως ἐφ' ἑκατέροις διισχυρίζομεθα. ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασιν μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ περὶ νόσων τε καὶ μανιῶν ὁ αὐτὸς λόγος, πλὴν τοῦ χρόνου ὅτι οὐχὶ ἴσος; ΘΕΑΙ. ὁρθῶς. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; πλήθει χρόνου καὶ ὀλιγότητι τὸ ἀληθὲς ὁρισθήσεται;

158e

TT: That would be entirely ridiculous.

158e

S: Well, have you any other obvious way of demonstrating which of these sets of opinions are true?

158e

TT: I don't think so.

158e

S: Then you can hear from me how people talk about these matters when they designate the appearances of the moment as true for the person to whom they appear. I believe they would ask a question such as, "Theaetetus, would something that is completely different have the same capacity as that from which it is different? And let us not assume that we are asking about something that is the same in one respect but different in another. No, this is completely different."

ΘΕΑΙ. γελοῖον μεντ' ἂν εἶη πολλαχῇ. ΣΩ. ἀλλά τι ἄλλο ἔχεις σαφές ἐνδείξασθαι ὅποια τούτων τῶν δοξασμάτων ἀληθῆ; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ μοι δοκῶ. ΣΩ. ἐμοῦ τοίνυν ἄκουε οἷα περὶ αὐτῶν ἂν λέγοιεν οἱ τὰ αἰὲν δοκοῦντα ὀριζόμενοι τῷ δοκοῦντι εἶναι ἀληθῆ. λέγουσι δέ, ὥς ἐγὼ οἶμαι, οὕτως ἐρωτῶντες· ὦ Θεαίτητε, ὃ ἂν ἕτερον ᾗ παντάπασιν, μή πῃ τινα δύναμιν τὴν αὐτὴν ἔξει τῷ ἐτέρῳ; καὶ μὴ ὑπολάβωμεν τῇ μὲν ταὐτὸν εἶναι ὃ ἐρωτῶμεν τῇ δὲ ἕτερον, ἀλλ' ὅλως ἕτερον.

159a

TT: In that case, it cannot have anything that is the same, either in capacity or anything else whatsoever, once it is altogether different.

159a

S: Now, must we not concede that such a thing is also unlike?

159a

TT: Well, I think so.

159a

S: And if it happens to become like or unlike something, either itself or another, shall we say that in becoming like, it is becoming the same, while in becoming unlike, it is becoming different?

159a

Tt: It must be so.

159a

S: And didn't we say before that there are many – indeed, unlimited – active elements, and that the same applies to passive elements?

159a

Tt: Yes.

159a

S: And also that anything that is paired with one thing and then with another will not produce the same things but different things.

159a

Tt: Yes, certainly.

ΘΕΑΙ. ἀδύνατον τοίνυν ταυτόν τι ἔχειν ἢ ἐν δυνάμει ἢ ἐν ἄλλῳ ὁτῶ οὖν, ὅταν ἢ κομιδῇ ἕτερον. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν οὐ καὶ ἀνόμοιον ἀναγκαῖον τὸ τοιοῦτον ὁμολογεῖν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ. ΣΩ. εἰ ἄρα τι συμβαίνει ὁμοίον τῷ γίγνεσθαι ἢ ἀνόμοιον, εἴτε ἑαυτῷ εἴτε ἄλλῳ, ὁμοιούμενον μὲν ταυτόν φήσομεν γίγνεσθαι, ἀνομοιούμενον δὲ ἕτερον; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν πρόσθεν ἐλέγομεν ὡς πολλὰ μὲν εἶη τὰ ποιοῦντα καὶ ἄπειρα, ὡσαύτως δὲ γε τὰ πάσχοντα; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν ὅτι γε ἄλλο ἄλλῳ συμμειγνύμενον καὶ ἄλλῳ οὐ ταῦτ' ἀλλ' ἕτερα γεννήσει;

159b

S: Now, let us discuss me and you and things in general, based upon the same argument. Take Socrates when healthy and Socrates when ill. Shall we say they are like one another or unlike one another?

159b

Tt: Are you referring to the unhealthy Socrates as a whole compared to the healthy Socrates as a whole?

159b

S: You have understood perfectly. I mean just that.

159b

Tt: Then of course they are unlike.

159b

S: And is he different then to the extent that he is unlike?

159b

TT: He must be.

159b

S: And will you say the same about Socrates asleep, and in all the other conditions we mentioned just now?

ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. λέγωμεν δὴ ἐμέ τε καὶ σὲ καὶ τᾶλλα ἤδη κατὰ τὸν αὐτὸν λόγον, Σωκράτη ὑγιαίνοντα καὶ Σωκράτη αὖ ἄσθενοῦντα. πότερον ὅμοιον τοῦτ' ἐκείνῳ ἢ ἀνόμοιον φήσομεν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἄρα τὸν ἄσθενοῦντα Σωκράτη, ὅλον τοῦτο λέγεις ὅλῳ ἐκείνῳ, τῷ ὑγιαίνοντι Σωκράτει; ΣΩ. κάλλιστα ὑπέλαβες· αὐτὸ τοῦτο λέγω. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀνόμοιον δήπου. ΣΩ. καὶ ἕτερον ἄρα οὕτως ὥσπερ ἀνόμοιον; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀνάγκη.

159c

TT: I think so.

159c

S: Now, will each of the things whose nature is to act upon something else treat me in one way when it encounters healthy Socrates, and in a different way when it encounters unhealthy Socrates?

159c

TT: Inevitably.

159c

S: Then is it the case that I who am passive, and this active, will produce different outcomes in each case?

159c

TT: Indeed.

159c

S: So when I drink wine when healthy, would it appear pleasant and sweet to me?

159c

TT: Yes.

159c

S: Indeed, based upon what we agreed before, the active and the passive, both moving simultaneously, produce both sweetness and

perception. Since perception is associated with the passive, it turns the tongue into something that perceives, while the sweetness associated with the wine moves about it and makes the wine both appear sweet and be sweet to the healthy tongue.

ΣΩ. καὶ καθεύδοντα δὴ καὶ πάντα ἅ νυνδὴ διήλθομεν, ὡσαύτως φήσεις;
ΘΕΑΙ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. ἕκαστον δὴ τῶν πεφυκότων τι ποιεῖν, ἄλλο τι, ὅταν μὲν λάβῃ ὑγιαίνοντα Σωκράτη, ὡς ἐτέρῳ μοι χρήσεται, ὅταν δὲ ἀσθενοῦντα, ὡς ἐτέρῳ; ΘΕΑΙ. τί δ' οὐ μέλλει; ΣΩ. καὶ ἕτερα δὴ ἐφ' ἑκατέρου γεννήσομεν ἐγὼ τε ὁ πάσχων καὶ ἐκεῖνο τὸ ποιοῦν; ΘΕΑΙ. τί μήν; ΣΩ. ὅταν δὴ οἶνον πίνω ὑγιαίνων, ἡδύς μοι φαίνεται καὶ γλυκύς; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. ἐγέννησε γὰρ δὴ ἐκ τῶν προωμολογημένων τό τε

159d

TT: Yes. What we said before certainly concurs with this.

159d

S: But when it encounters the unhealthy Socrates, is that in truth someone different, and not the same person? Indeed, it approaches something that is unlike the first.

159d

TT: Yes.

159d

S: Now, a Socrates such as this, along with the draught of wine, gives rise to different outcomes, a perception of bitterness in the region of the tongue, while in the region of the wine, bitterness arises and moves, and so the wine becomes not bitterness but bitter, while I become not perception but a perceiver.

ποιοῦν καὶ τὸ πάσχον γλυκύτητά τε καὶ αἴσθησιν, ἅμα φερόμενα ἀμφοτέρω, καὶ ἡ μὲν αἴσθησις πρὸς τοῦ πάσχοντος οὕσα αἰσθανομένην τὴν γλῶτταν ἀπηργάσατο, ἡ δὲ γλυκύτης πρὸς τοῦ οἶνου περὶ αὐτὸν φερομένη γλυκὺν τὸν οἶνον τῇ ὑγιαίνουσῃ γλῶττι ἐποίησεν καὶ εἶναι καὶ φαίνεσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν τὰ πρότερα ἡμῖν οὕτως ὡμολόγητο. ΣΩ. ὅταν δὲ ἀσθενοῦντα, ἄλλο τι πρῶτον μὲν τῇ ἀληθείᾳ οὐ τὸν αὐτὸν ἔλαβεν; ἀνομοίω γὰρ δὴ προσήλθεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί.

159e

Tt: Yes, indeed.

159e

S: So, I shall never come to perceive any other thing in this way, for there is another perception of the other thing, and this makes the perceiver different, and different in kind. Nor would that which is active towards me ever produce the same thing, or itself be the same sort of thing, in its encounter with something different. For having produced another from another, it will become different in kind.

ΣΩ. ἕτερα δὴ αὖ ἐγεννησάτην ὃ τε τοιοῦτος Σωκράτης καὶ ἡ τοῦ οἴνου πόσις, περὶ μὲν τὴν γλῶτταν αἴσθησιν πικρότητος, περὶ δὲ τὸν οἶνον γιγνομένην καὶ φερομένην πικρότητα, καὶ τὸν μὲν οὐ πικρότητα ἀλλὰ πικρόν, ἐμὲ δὲ οὐκ αἴσθησιν ἀλλ' αἰσθανόμενον; ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ μὲν οὔν. ΣΩ. οὐκ οὐν ἐγὼ τε οὐδὲν ἄλλο ποτὲ γενήσομαι οὕτως αἰσθανόμενος· τοῦ γὰρ ἄλλου ἄλλη αἴσθησις, καὶ ἄλλοιον

160a

Tt: This is so.

160a

S: Nor indeed shall I become such a perceiver by myself, nor will the active element become different by itself.

160a

Tt: No, it will not.

160a

S: No. But whenever I come to be perceiving, I must be perceiving something, for it is impossible to come to be perceiving and yet be perceiving nothing. And whenever sweet or bitter or such like arise, they must arise for some person, for it is impossible to become sweet, but sweet to no one.

καὶ ἄλλον ποιεῖ τὸν αἰσθανόμενον· οὐτ' ἐκεῖνο τὸ ποιοῦν ἐμὲ μήποτ' ἄλλω συνελθὼν ταῦτον γεννῆσαν τοιοῦτον γένηται· ἀπὸ γὰρ ἄλλου ἄλλο γεννῆσαν ἄλλοιον γενήσεται. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστι ταῦτα. ΣΩ. οὐδὲ μὴν ἔγωγε ἐμαυτῷ τοιοῦτος, ἐκεῖνό τε ἑαυτῷ τοιοῦτον γενήσεται. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ

γὰρ οὖν. ΣΩ. ἀνάγκη δέ γε ἐμέ τε τινὸς γίγνεσθαι, ὅταν αἰσθανόμενος γίγνωμαι αἰσθανόμενον γάρ, μηδενὸς δὲ αἰσθανόμενον,

160b

TT: Entirely so.

160b

S: What remains for us then, I believe, is that if we are, we are for one another, and if we become, we become for one another, since in fact necessity conjoins our being, yet it binds us to none of the others, or even to ourselves. So it leaves us bound to one another. Consequently, if someone says that something is, or becomes, he should say that ‘it is or becomes for someone’ or ‘of something’ or ‘in relation to something’. But he should never say, nor allow someone else to say, that it is or becomes just by itself. That is what the argument we have been expounding indicates.

ἀδύνατον γίγνεσθαι ἐκεῖνό τε τινὶ γίγνεσθαι, ὅταν γλυκὺ ἢ πικρὸν ἢ τι τοιοῦτον γίγνηται· γλυκὺ γάρ, μηδενὶ δὲ γλυκὺ ἀδύνατον γενέσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασιν μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. λείπεται δὴ οἶμαι ἡμῖν ἀλλήλοις, εἴτ’ ἐσμέν, εἶναι, εἴτε γιγνόμεθα, γίγνεσθαι, ἐπεὶ περ ἡμῶν ἡ ἀνάγκη τὴν οὐσίαν συνδεῖ μὲν, συνδεῖ δὲ οὐδενὶ τῶν ἄλλων οὐδ’ αὖ ἡμῖν αὐτοῖς. ἀλλήλοις δὴ λείπεται συνδεδέσθαι. ὥστε εἴτε τις εἶναι τι ὀνομάζει, τινὶ εἶναι ἢ τινὸς ἢ πρὸς τι ῥητέον αὐτῷ, εἴτε γίγνεσθαι· αὐτὸ δὲ ἐφ’ αὐτοῦ τι ἢ ὄν ἢ γιγνόμενον οὔτε

160c

TT: Entirely so, Socrates.

160c

S: Now, since whatever is active towards me, is for me and for no one else, mustn’t I also perceive it and no one else?

160c

TT: It must be so.

160c

S: So, my perception is true for me, for it always belongs to what I am, and as Protagoras says, I am judge of the things that are for me, that

they are, and also of the things that are not, that they are not.¹⁹

160c

TT: So it seems.

αὐτῷ λεκτέον οὐτ' ἄλλου λέγοντος ἀποδεκτέον, ὡς ὁ λόγος ὃν διεληλύθαμεν σημαίνει. ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὅτε δὴ τὸ ἐμὲ ποιοῦν ἐμοί ἐστιν καὶ οὐκ ἄλλω, ἐγὼ καὶ αἰσθάνομαι αὐτοῦ, ἄλλος δ' οὐ; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. ἀληθὲς ἄρα ἐμοὶ ἢ ἐμῇ αἴσθησις—τῆς γὰρ ἐμῆς οὐσίας ἀεὶ ἐστιν—καὶ ἐγὼ κριτὴς κατὰ τὸν Πρωταγόραν τῶν τε ὄντων ἐμοὶ ὡς ἔστι, καὶ τῶν μὴ ὄντων ὡς οὐκ ἔστιν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔοικεν.

160d

S: Now, if I am not being deceived or erring in my thinking about things that are, or things that become, how could I fail to have knowledge of the things that I perceive?

160d

TT: There is no way this could happen.

160d

S: Knowledge is nothing other than perception. That was an excellent saying of yours! So the various accounts turn out to be the same. Homer and Heraclitus and all their tribe say everything changes like a flowing stream; Protagoras, the wise, says man is the measure of all things; and now Theaetetus says that since these things are so, knowledge turns out to be perception. Is this so, Theaetetus? Shall we declare that this is like your newborn baby, which I have brought to birth? What do you say?

ΣΩ. πῶς ἂν οὖν ἀψευδὴς ὦν καὶ μὴ πταίων τῇ διανοίᾳ περὶ τὰ ὄντα ἢ γιγνόμενα οὐκ ἐπιστήμων ἂν εἶην ὥνπερ αἰσθητής; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδαμῶς ὅπως οὐ. ΣΩ. παγκάλως ἄρα σοι εἴρηται ὅτι ἐπιστήμη οὐκ ἄλλο τί ἐστιν ἢ αἴσθησις, καὶ εἰς ταῦτόν συμπέπτωκεν, κατὰ μὲν Ὅμηρον καὶ Ἡράκλειτον καὶ πᾶν τὸ τοιοῦτον φύλον οἷον ρεύματα κινεῖσθαι τὰ πάντα, κατὰ δὲ Πρωταγόραν τὸν σοφώτατον πάντων χρημάτων ἀνθρώπον μέτρον εἶναι, κατὰ

160e

TT: It must be so, Socrates.

160e

S: So, it seems that this is what we have at last produced with some difficulty, whatever it turns out to be. After the birth comes its infant ceremony, and we should faithfully carry it around the hearth²⁰ in the circle of discussion, on the lookout lest the offspring be unworthy of rearing, since it is false and a wind-egg. Or do you believe that your offspring should be reared in any case, and not be set aside? Could you endure seeing it tested in argument, and not get violently angry if someone were to take away this, your first-born?

δὲ Θεαίτητον τούτων οὕτως ἔχόντων αἴσθησιν ἐπιστήμην γίγνεσθαι. ἥ γάρ, ὦ Θεαίτητε; φῶμεν τοῦτο σὸν μὲν εἶναι οἷον νεογενὲς παιδίον, ἐμὸν δὲ μαίευμα; ἢ πῶς λέγεις; ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως ἀνάγκη, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. τοῦτο μὲν δὴ, ὡς ἔοικεν, μόλις ποτὲ ἐγεννήσαμεν, ὅτι δὴ ποτε τυγχάνει ὄν. μετὰ δὲ τὸν τόκον τὰ ἀμφιδρόμια αὐτοῦ ὡς ἀληθῶς ἐν κύκλῳ περιθρεκτέον τῷ λόγῳ, σκοπούμενους μὴ λάθῃ ἡμᾶς οὐκ ἄξιον ὄν τροφῆς τὸ γιγνόμενον,

161a

TD: Socrates, Theaetetus will endure, for he is not at all bad-tempered. But by the gods, do tell us exactly why this is not the case.

161a

S: You are a veritable lover of discourse, Theodorus, and it is kind of you to believe that I am some bag of arguments and will easily pull one out to explain that all this is not the case after all. But you do not understand what is going on, that none of these arguments ever comes forth from me, but from the one who is conversing with me, and I know nothing more than the little matter of how to take some argument from someone wise and receive it appropriately. This is what I shall now try to test from this young man, while I myself proclaim nothing.

ἀλλὰ ἀνεμιαῖόν τε καὶ ψεῦδος. ἢ σὺ οἶει πάντως δεῖν τό γε σὸν τρέφειν καὶ μὴ ἀποτιθέναι, ἢ καὶ ἀνέξῃ ἐλεγχόμενον ὁρῶν, καὶ οὐ σφόδρα χαλεπανεῖς ἔαν τις σοῦ ὡς πρωτοτόκου αὐτὸ ὑφαιρῇ; ΘΕΟ. ἀνέξεται, ὦ Σώκρατες, Θεαίτητος· οὐδαμῶς γὰρ δύσκολος. ἀλλὰ πρὸς θεῶν εἰπέ ἢ αὖ οὐχ οὕτως ἔχει; ΣΩ. φιλόλογός γ' εἶ ἀτεχνῶς καὶ χρηστός, ὦ Θεόδωρε, ὅτι με οἶει λόγων τινὰ εἶναι θύλακον καὶ ῥαδίως ἐξελόντα

161b

TD: You are putting that very well, Socrates. Go ahead and do as you say.

161b

S: Now, Theodorus, do you know what amazes me about your friend, Protagoras?

161b

TD: What is it?

161b

S: Well, in general I am very pleased with his statement that for each person, what seems, also is. However, I wonder why he did not say at the beginning of ‘Truth’ that pig is the measure of all things, or baboon, or some other more unusual creature that has perception, is the measure. He could then have begun to speak to us grandly and contemptuously, demonstrating that while we admired him for his wisdom, like a god, he was actually no more intelligent than a tadpole, let alone another human being. How else can we express this, Theodorus? For if the opinions formed through perception are indeed true for each person, and no one judges a person’s experience better than himself, nor is anyone superior in deciding if the opinion of another is right or wrong, but as we have said many times, each person is himself the sole judge of his own affairs, and all these opinions are right and true, what, my friend, is the status of wise Protagoras? Does he properly deserve to be the teacher of others, for huge fees, and should we, in our relative ignorance, have recourse to Protagoras when each of us is himself the measure of his own wisdom? Should we conclude that Protagoras is saying all this in a popularist vein? I am

staying quiet about myself and my art of midwifery for fear of the ridicule we shall incur, as will the conduct of dialectic in its entirety. For it is a vast and vain pursuit, is it not, to undertake the scrutiny and refutation of each other's notions and opinions, if the 'Truth' of Protagoras is true and each of us is right, and this truth is not a jest uttered from the inner sanctuary of the book.

ἐρεῖν ὡς οὐκ αὖ ἔχει οὕτω ταῦτα· τὸ δὲ γιγνόμενον οὐκ ἐννοεῖς, ὅτι οὐδεὶς τῶν λόγων ἐξέρχεται παρ' ἐμοῦ ἀλλ' αἰεὶ παρὰ τοῦ ἐμοὶ προσδιαλεγομένου, ἐγὼ δὲ οὐδὲν ἐπίσταμαι πλέον πλὴν βραχέος, ὅσον λόγον παρ' ἐτέρου σοφοῦ λαβεῖν καὶ ἀποδέξασθαι μετρίως. καὶ νῦν τοῦτο παρὰ τοῦδε πειράσομαι, οὗ τι αὐτὸς εἶπεῖν. ΘΕΟ. σὺ κάλλιον, ὦ Σώκρατες, λέγεις· καὶ ποίει οὕτως. ΣΩ. οἶσθ' οὖν, ὦ Θεόδωρε, ὃ θαυμάζω τοῦ ἐταίρου σου Πρωταγόρου; ΘΕΟ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. τὰ μὲν ἄλλα μοι πάνυ ἡδέως εἶρηκεν, ὡς τὸ δοκοῦν ἐκάστῳ τοῦτο καὶ ἔστιν· τὴν δ' ἀρχὴν τοῦ λόγου τεθαύμακα, ὅτι οὐκ εἶπεν ἀρχόμενος τῆς Ἀληθείας ὅτι πάντων χρημάτων μέτρον ἐστὶν ὅς ἢ κυνοκέφαλος ἢ τι ἄλλο ἀτοπώτερον τῶν ἐχόντων αἰσθησιν, ἵνα μεγαλοπρεπῶς καὶ πάνυ καταφρονητικῶς ἥρξατο ἡμῖν λέγειν, ἐνδεικνύμενος ὅτι ἡμεῖς μὲν αὐτὸν ὥσπερ θεὸν ἐθαυμάζομεν ἐπὶ σοφίᾳ, ὃ δ' ἄρα >ἐτύγχανεν ὦν εἰς φρόνησιν οὐδὲν βελτίων βατράχου γυρίνου, μὴ ὅτι ἄλλου του ἀνθρώπων. ἢ πῶς λέγωμεν, ὦ Θεόδωρε; εἰ γὰρ δὴ ἐκάστῳ ἀληθὲς ἔσται ὃ ἂν δι' αἰσθήσεως δοξάζῃ, καὶ μήτε τὸ ἄλλου πάθος ἄλλος βέλτιον διακρινεῖ, μήτε τὴν δόξαν κυριώτερος ἔσται ἐπισκέψασθαι ἕτερος τὴν ἐτέρου ὀρθὴ ἢ ψευδὴς, ἀλλ' ὃ πολλακίς εἴρηται, αὐτὸς τὰ αὐτοῦ ἕκαστος μόνος δοξάσει, ταῦτα δὲ πάντα ὀρθὰ καὶ ἀληθῆ, τί δὴ ποτε, ὦ ἐταῖρε, Πρωταγόρας μὲν σοφός, ὥστε καὶ ἄλλων διδάσκαλος ἀξιοῦσθαι δικαίως μετὰ μεγάλων μισθῶν, ἡμεῖς δὲ ἀμαθέστεροί τε καὶ φοιτητέον ἡμῖν ἦν παρ' ἐκείνου, μέτρῳ ὄντι αὐτῷ ἐκάστῳ τῆς αὐτοῦ σοφίας; ταῦτα πῶς μὴ φῶμεν δημούμενον λέγειν τὸν Πρωταγόραν; τὸ δὲ δὴ ἐμόν τε καὶ τῆς ἐμῆς τέχνης τῆς μαιευτικῆς σιγῷ ὅσον γέλῳτα ὀφλισκάνομεν, οἶμαι δὲ καὶ σύμπασα ἢ τοῦ διαλέγεσθαι πραγματεία. τὸ γὰρ ἐπισκοπεῖν καὶ ἐπιχειρεῖν ἐλέγχειν τὰς ἀλλήλων φαντασίας τε καὶ δόξας, ὀρθὰς ἐκάστου οὕσας, οὐ μακρὰ

162a

TD: Socrates, as you said just now, Protagoras was my friend, so I could not bear to cooperate in his refutation. Nor, however, could I oppose you, contrary to my own opinion. So involve Theaetetus once more. He seemed to be responding very appropriately just now.

162a

S: Well, Theodorus, if you were to go to Sparta, would you have the right to watch other men, some quite paltry, exercising naked in the wrestling schools and not undress yourself and expose your own form alongside theirs?

μὲν καὶ διωλύγιος φλυαρία, εἰ ἀληθὴς ἡ Ἀλήθεια Πρωταγόρου ἀλλὰ μὴ παίζουσα ἐκ τοῦ ἀδύτου τῆς βίβλου ἐφθέγγετο; ΘΕΟ. ὦ Σώκρατες, φίλος ἀνὴρ, ὥσπερ σὺ νυνδὴ εἶπες. οὐκ ἂν οὖν δεξαίμην δι' ἐμοῦ ὁμολογοῦντος ἐλέγχεσθαι Πρωταγόραν, οὐδ' αὖ σοὶ παρὰ δόξαν ἀντιτείνειν. τὸν οὖν Θεαίτητον πάλιν λαβέ' πάντως καὶ νυνδὴ μάλ' ἐμμελῶς σοὶ ἐφαίνετο ὑπακούειν.

162b

TD: But why ever not, if they were prepared to trust me and be persuaded by me? Just as I think that I shall persuade you now to let me watch and not drag me into the gymnasium, stiff with age, when you can wrestle with a younger, healthier man.

162b

S: Well, Theodorus, whatever pleases you does not displease me, as the proverb says, and so we should go back again to wise Theaetetus. First, Theaetetus, tell us about what we were saying just now, and whether you are surprised at suddenly proving to be just as wise as anyone else, whether man or god. Or would you say that the Protagorean measure applies any less to gods than to humans?

ΣΩ. ἄρα κἂν εἰς Λακεδαίμονα ἐλθὼν, ὦ Θεόδωρε, πρὸς τὰς παλαίστρας ἀξιοῖς ἂν ἄλλους θεώμενος γυμνοῦς, ἐνίους φαύλους, αὐτὸς μὴ ἀντεπιδεικνύναι τὸ εἶδος παραποδύμενος; ΘΕΟ. ἀλλὰ τί μὴν δοκεῖς, εἴπερ μέλλοιέν μοι ἐπιτρέψειν καὶ πείσεσθαι; ὥσπερ νῦν οἶμαι ὑμᾶς

πείσειν ἐμὲ μὲν ἔαν θεᾷσθαι καὶ μὴ ἔλκειν πρὸς τὸ γυμνάσιον σκληρὸν ἥδη ὄντα, τῷ δὲ δὴ νεωτέρῳ τε καὶ ὑγροτέρῳ ὄντι προσπαλαίειν. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' εἰ οὕτως, ὦ Θεόδωρε, σοὶ φίλον, οὐδ' ἐμοὶ

162c

TT: By Zeus, I would not. And to answer your question – yes, I am very surprised. Indeed when we recounted how men argue, when they assert that whatever seems, also is, for the person who thinks so, this sounded very good to me, but now the very opposite suddenly turns out to be the case.

ἐχθρόν, φασὶν οἱ παροϊμιαζόμενοι. πάλιν δὴ οὖν ἐπὶ τὸν σοφὸν Θεαίτητον ἰτέον. λέγε δὴ, ὦ Θεαίτητε, πρῶτον μὲν ἃ νυνδὴ διήλομεν, ἄρα οὐ σὺ θαυμάζεις εἰ ἐξαίφνης οὕτως ἀναφανήση μηδὲν χείρων εἰς σοφίαν ὅτουοῦν ἀνθρώπων ἢ καὶ θεῶν; ἢ ἥττον τι οἶει τὸ Πρωταγόρειον μέτρον εἰς θεοὺς ἢ εἰς ἀνθρώπους λέγεσθαι; ΘΕΑΙ. μὰ Δί' οὐκ ἔγωγε· καὶ ὅπερ γε ἐρωτᾷς, πάνυ θαυμάζω. ἥνίκα γὰρ διήμην ὃν τρόπον λέγοιεν τὸ δοκοῦν

162d

S: Well, you are young, dear boy, so you listen intently to common talk and you believe it. Indeed, Protagoras or any of his spokesmen will reply to these arguments and say, “Noble youths and elders, you sit together indulging in common talk and you bring in the gods, whose existence or non-existence I exclude from my discourses and from my writings.²¹ And you say things that the multitude would accept when they hear them, like how terrible it would be if every person differed not in wisdom from the cattle in the fields. But proof and necessity never enter your pronouncements, and you rely on likelihood.” Yet, if Theodorus, or some other geometer, decided to use this method in geometry, he would not be worth one jot. So, in such important matters as these, both you and Theodorus must consider whether you will accept arguments based on persuasiveness and likelihood.

ἐκάστῳ τοῦτο καὶ εἶναι τῷ δοκοῦντι, πάνυ μοι εὖ ἐφαίνετο λέγεσθαι· νῦν δὲ τοῦναντίον τάχα μεταπέπτωκεν. ΣΩ. νέος γὰρ εἶ, ὦ φίλε παῖ· τῆς

οὖν δημηγορίας ὀξέως ὑπακούεις καὶ πείθῃ. πρὸς γὰρ ταῦτα ἔρεϊ Πρωταγόρας ἢ τις ἄλλος ὑπὲρ αὐτοῦ ὧ γενναῖοι παῖδες τε καὶ γέροντες, δημηγορεῖτε συγκαθεζόμενοι, θεούς τε εἰς τὸ μέσον ἄγοντες, οὓς ἐγὼ ἔκ τε τοῦ λέγειν καὶ τοῦ γράφειν περὶ αὐτῶν ὡς εἰσὶν ἢ ὡς οὐκ εἰσὶν, ἐξαιρῶ, καὶ ἃ οἱ πολλοὶ ἂν ἀποδέχοιντο ἀκούοντες, λέγετε ταῦτα, ὡς δεινὸν εἰ μὴδὲν διοίσει εἰς σοφίαν ἕκαστος τῶν ἀνθρώπων βοσκήματος ὅτουοῦν· ἀπόδειξιν δὲ καὶ ἀνάγκην οὐδ' ἡντινοῦν λέγετε ἀλλὰ τῷ εἰκότι χρῆσθε, ᾧ εἰ ἐθέλοι Θεόδωρος ἢ ἄλλος τις τῶν γεωμετρῶν χρώμενος γεωμετρεῖν, ἄξιός οὐδ' ἐνὸς μόνου ἂν εἴῃ. σκοπεῖτε οὖν σύ τε καὶ Θεόδωρος εἰ ἀποδέξεσθε πιθανολογία τε καὶ εἰκόσι

163a

TT: No, it's not right, Socrates. You would not say so, and neither would we.

163a

S: Then it seems we should think in a different way, based on the word of yourself and Theodorus.

163a

TT: A different way. Yes, certainly.

163a

S: So, let us consider, in this different way, whether knowledge and perception are the same or different. Indeed, our entire discussion has somehow been dealing with this question, and for the sake of this we set in train this plethora of strange topics. Is this not true?

περὶ τηλικούτων λεγομένους λόγους. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλ' οὐ δίκαιον, ὧ Σώκρατες, οὔτε σὺ οὔτε ἂν ἡμεῖς φαῖμεν. ΣΩ. ἄλλη δὴ σκεπτέον, ὡς ἔοικεν, ὡς ὅ τε σὸς καὶ ὁ Θεοδώρου λόγος. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν ἄλλη. ΣΩ. τῇδε δὴ σκοπῶμεν εἰ ἄρα ἐστὶν ἐπιστήμη τε καὶ αἴσθησις ταῦτόν ἢ ἕτερον. εἰς γὰρ τοῦτό που πᾶς ὁ λόγος ἡμῖν ἔτεινεν, καὶ τούτου χάριν τὰ πολλὰ καὶ ἄτοπα ταῦτα ἐκινήσαμεν. οὐ γάρ; ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασιν μὲν οὖν.

163b

Tt: Entirely so.

163b

S: Shall we agree then that whatever we perceive by seeing or hearing is also known at the same time? In the case of foreigners, before we learn their language, shall we either maintain that we do not hear them when they speak or that we hear them and know what they mean? Or again, if we look at writing with no knowledge of it, shall we assert that we do not see it or that we know it if we actually see it?

163b

Tt: Socrates, we shall say that we know this about them anyway, what we see and hear. Their form and their colour are both seen and known, while high and low pitch are heard and also known at the same time. But whatever the scribe or the linguist teaches about these, we neither perceive by seeing nor by hearing, nor do we know it.

ΣΩ. ἢ οὖν ὁμολογήσομεν, ἃ τῷ ὁρᾶν αἰσθανόμεθα ἢ τῷ ἀκούειν, πάντα ταῦτα ἅμα καὶ ἐπίστασθαι; οἷον τῶν βαρβάρων πρὶν μαθεῖν τὴν φωνὴν πότερον οὐ φήσομεν ἀκούειν ὅταν φθέγγωνται, ἢ ἀκούειν τε καὶ ἐπίστασθαι ἃ λέγουσι; καὶ αὖ γράμματα μὴ ἐπιστάμενοι, βλέποντες εἰς αὐτὰ πότερον οὐχ ὁρᾶν ἢ ἐπίστασθαι εἴπερ ὁρῶμεν δισχυριούμεθα; ΘΕΑΙ. αὐτό γε, ὦ Σώκратες, τοῦτο αὐτῶν, ὅπερ ὁρῶμέν τε καὶ ἀκούομεν, ἐπίστασθαι φήσομεν· τῶν μὲν γὰρ τὸ σχῆμα καὶ τὸ χρῶμα ὁρᾶν τε καὶ ἐπίστασθαι, τῶν δὲ τὴν

163c

S: Excellent, Theaetetus, and it is best not to argue that point with you in order that your development may continue. But look, there is another issue looming. Figure out how to keep this one at bay.

163c

Tt: What sort of issue?

ὁξύτητα καὶ βαρύτητα ἀκούειν τε ἅμα καὶ εἰδέναι· ἃ δὲ οἱ τε γραμματισταὶ περὶ αὐτῶν καὶ οἱ ἐρμηνῆς διδάσκουσιν, οὔτε αἰσθάνεσθαι τῷ ὁρᾶν ἢ ἀκούειν οὔτε ἐπίστασθαι. ΣΩ. ἄριστά γ', ὦ Θεαίτητε, καὶ οὐκ ἄξιόν σοι πρὸς ταῦτα ἀμφισβητῆσαι, ἵνα καὶ αὐξάνῃ.

ἀλλ' ὅρα δὴ καὶ τόδε ἄλλο προσιόν, καὶ σκόπει πῇ αὐτὸ διωσόμεθα.
ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον δὴ;

163d

S: Something like this. If someone were to ask, “Suppose someone comes to know something at a certain time and still retains and preserves memory of that very thing, is it possible for him not to know it when he is remembering that very thing?” It seems I am being very long-winded, when I just want to ask if someone who has learned something could be remembering it, but not know it.

163d

TT: How could he, Socrates? What you are describing would be bizarre.

163d

S: Am I talking nonsense then? But consider this. Don't you say seeing is perceiving, and sight is perception?

163d

TT: I do.

ΣΩ. τὸ τοιόνδε· εἴ τις ἔροιτο· ἄρα δυνατόν ὅτου τις ἐπιστήμων γένοιτό ποτε, ἔτι ἔχοντα μνήμην αὐτοῦ τούτου καὶ σφζόμενον, τότε ὅτε μέμνηται μὴ ἐπίστασθαι αὐτὸ τοῦτο ὃ μέμνηται; μακρολογῶ δέ, ὡς ἔοικε, βουλόμενος ἐρέσθαι εἰ μαθὼν τίς τι μεμνημένος μὴ οἶδε. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ πῶς, ὦ Σώκρατες; τέρας γὰρ ἂν εἴη ὃ λέγεις. ΣΩ. μὴ οὖν ἐγὼ ληρῶ; σκόπει δέ. ἄρα τὸ ὁρᾶν οὐκ αἰσθάνεσθαι λέγεις καὶ τὴν ὄψιν αἴσθησιν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔγωγε.

163e

S: And someone who has seen something has acquired knowledge of that which he has seen, according to what we said just now.

163e

TT: Yes.

163e

S: What about this? Do you agree that there is such a thing as memory?

163e

TT: Yes.

163e

S: And is it memory of nothing or of something?

163e

TT: Of something surely.

163e

S: Of things one has learned or perceived. Isn't it memory of things of this sort?

163e

TT: What else could it be?

163e

S: Does a person, on occasion, remember what he has seen?

163e

TT: He remembers.

163e

S: And does he forget it when his eyes are closed?

163e

TT: What an odd thing to say, Socrates!

163e

S: Yet we must say so if we are to salvage our previous argument, otherwise it is eliminated.

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὁ ἰδὼν τι ἐπιστήμων ἐκείνου γέγονεν ὃ εἶδεν κατὰ τὸν ἄρτι λόγον; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. τί δέ; μνήμην οὐ λέγεις μέντοι τι; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. πότερον οὐδενὸς ἢ τινός; ΘΕΑΙ. τινὸς δήπου. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὧν ἔμαθε καὶ ὧν ἥσθητο, τοιουτωνί τινων; ΘΕΑΙ. τί μὴν; ΣΩ. ὃ δὴ εἶδε τις, μέμνηται που ἐνίοτε; ΘΕΑΙ. μέμνηται. ΣΩ. ἧ καὶ μύσας; ἢ τοῦτο δράσας ἐπελάθετο; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ δεινόν, ὦ Σώκратες, τοῦτό γε φάναι.

164a

TT: Yes, by Zeus, that's what I suspect too. But I don't quite understand why, so you tell me.

164a

S: Well, we say that whoever is seeing comes to have knowledge of that which he is seeing, for we have agreed that sight, perception and

knowledge are the same.

164a

Tt: Yes, indeed.

164a

S: And yet the person who sees, and has come to have knowledge of what he has seen, does not see it when his eyes are closed though he does remember it. Is this so?

164a

Tt: Yes.

164a

S: But ‘does not see’ is the same as ‘does not know’, if in fact ‘to see’ is ‘to know’.

ΣΩ. δεῖ γε μέντοι, εἰ σώσομεν τὸν πρόσθε λόγον· εἰ δὲ μή, οἴχεται. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ ἐγώ, νῆ τὸν Δία, ὑποπεύω, οὐ μὴν ἱκανῶς γε συννοῶ· ἀλλ’ εἰπέ πῃ. ΣΩ. τῇδε· ὁ μὲν ὁρῶν ἐπιστήμων, φαμέν, τούτου γέγονεν οὐπὲρ ὁρῶν· ὄψις γὰρ καὶ αἴσθησις καὶ ἐπιστήμη ταῦτὸν ὠμολόγηται. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ὁ δὲ γε ὁρῶν καὶ ἐπιστήμων γεγονῶς οὐ ἔώρα, ἐὰν μύση, μέμνηται μὲν, οὐχ ὁρᾷ δὲ αὐτό. ἦ γάρ; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί.

164b

Tt: True.

164b

S: So, it turns out that someone who has come to know something, and still remembers it, does not know it since he does not see it. And we said it would be bizarre if this were the case.

164b

Tt: What you say is very true.

164b

S: Then an impossible conclusion appears to follow if someone says that knowledge and perception are the same.

164b

Tt: So it seems.

164b

S: So, we have to say that they are different.

164b

TT: Very likely.

164b

S: Well in that case, whatever is knowledge? It seems we must discuss this again from the beginning. But, Theaetetus, what on earth are we trying to do?

ΣΩ. τὸ δέ γε οὐχ ὁρᾷ οὐκ ἐπίσταταί ἐστιν, εἴπερ καὶ τὸ ὁρᾷ ἐπίσταται. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ. ΣΩ. συμβαίνει ἄρα, οὗ τις ἐπιστήμων ἐγένετο, ἔτι μεμνημένον αὐτὸν μὴ ἐπίστασθαι, ἐπειδὴ οὐχ ὁρᾷ ὃ τέρας ἔφαμεν ἂν εἶναι εἰ γίγνοιτο. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθέστατα λέγεις. ΣΩ. τῶν ἀδυνάτων δὴ τι συμβαίνει φαίνεται ἐάν τις ἐπιστήμην καὶ αἴσθησιν ταὐτὸν φῇ εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. ἄλλο ἄρα ἐκάτερον φατέον. ΘΕΑΙ. κινδυνεύει.

164c

TT: What are you referring to?

164c

S: We seem to me like uncouth fighting cocks that turn away and start to crow before we have won a victory over this argument.

164c

TT: How do you mean?

164c

S: We seem to be satisfied that we have defeated the proposition by coming to an understanding, quite argumentatively, about the similarities between words. We claim to be philosophers, not debaters, yet we behave unconsciously just like these clever fellows.

ΣΩ. τί οὖν δῆτ' ἂν εἴη ἐπιστήμη; πάλιν ἐξ ἀρχῆς, ὡς ἔοικεν, λεκτέον. καίτοι τί ποτε μέλλομεν, ὦ Θεαίτητε, δρᾶν; ΘΕΑΙ. τίνος πέρι; ΣΩ. φαινόμεθ' αἰ ἀλεκτρυόνος ἀγεννοῦς δίκην πρὶν νενικηκέναι ἀποπηδήσαντες ἀπὸ τοῦ λόγου ἄδειν. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δῆ; ΣΩ. ἀντιλογικῶς εἰκάμεν πρὸς τὰς τῶν ὀνομάτων ὁμολογίας ἀνομολογησάμενοι καὶ τοιοῦτ' ἅ τι περιγενόμενοι τοῦ λόγου ἀγαπᾶν, καὶ οὐ φάσκοντες ἀγνωσताὶ ἀλλὰ φιλόσοφοι

164d

TT: I still do not understand what you are saying.

164d

S: Well, I shall try to clarify my own thoughts on the matter in any case. Now, we were asking if someone who has learned something and is remembering it could fail to know it, and we took the example of a person who has seen something and closed his eyes and is remembering it. We demonstrated that he does not know, and at the same time is remembering, and we said that that is impossible. And so, the Protagorean story met its downfall, and yours too – your statement that knowledge and perception are the same.

164d

TT: So it appears.

εἶναι λανθάνομεν ταῦτὰ ἐκείνοις τοῖς δεινοῖς ἀνδράσιν ποιοῦντες. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐπω μανθάνω ὅπως λέγεις. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἐγὼ πειράσομαι δηλῶσαι περὶ αὐτῶν ὃ γε δὴ νοῶ. ἡρόμεθα γὰρ δὴ εἰ μαθὼν καὶ μεμνημένος τίς τι μὴ ἐπίσταται, καὶ τὸν ἰδόντα καὶ μύσαντα μεμνημένον ὀρῶντα δὲ οὐ ἀποδείξαντες, οὐκ εἰδότα ἀπεδείξαμεν καὶ ἅμα μεμνημένον· τοῦτο δ' εἶναι ἀδύνατον. καὶ οὕτω δὴ μῦθος ἀπώλετο ὁ Πρωταγόρειος, καὶ ὁ σὸς ἅμα ὁ τῆς ἐπιστήμης καὶ αἰσθήσεως ὅτι ταῦτόν ἐστιν.

164e

S: My friend, I believe this would never have happened if the father of that other proposal were alive, since he would have defended it in all sorts of ways. But now we are mistreating his orphan, and even the trustees left by Protagoras have no desire to help it, Theodorus here being one of them. Well then, for the sake of justice, we ourselves must come to its aid.

ΘΕΑΙ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. οὐ τι ἄν, οἶμαι, ὦ φίλε, εἴπερ γε ὁ πατὴρ τοῦ ἑτέρου μύθου ἔζη, ἀλλὰ πολλὰ ἂν ἤμυνε· νῦν δὲ ὀρφανὸν αὐτὸν ἡμεῖς προπηλακίζομεν. καὶ γὰρ οὐδ' οἱ ἐπίτροποι, οὓς Πρωταγόρας κατέλιπεν, βοηθεῖν ἐθέλουσιν, ὧν Θεόδωρος εἷς ὅδε. ἀλλὰ δὴ αὐτοὶ

κινδυνεύσομεν τοῦ δικαίου ἔνεκ' αὐτῷ βοηθεῖν. ΘΕΟ. οὐ γὰρ ἐγώ, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀλλὰ μᾶλλον Καλλίας

165a

TD: Yes, Socrates, since I was not Protagoras' trustee. That was Callias, the son of Hipponicus.²² I somehow turned quickly away from pure discourse and inclined towards geometry, though I would be grateful to you if you came to his aid.

165a

S: Well spoken, Theodorus. Now consider the aid I shall proffer. For we could agree to even stranger things than before if, in our usual fashion, we do not pay attention to what we are saying in our affirmations and denials. Shall I explain this to you or to Theaetetus?

ὁ Ἰππονίκου τῶν ἐκείνου ἐπίτροπος· ἡμεῖς δέ πως θᾶττον ἐκ τῶν ψιλῶν λόγων πρὸς τὴν γεωμετρίαν ἀπενεύσαμεν. χάριν γε μέντοι σοὶ ἔξομεν ἐὰν αὐτῷ βοηθῇς. ΣΩ. καλῶς λέγεις, ὦ Θεόδωρε. σκέψαι οὖν τὴν γ' ἐμὴν βοήθειαν. τῶν γὰρ ἄρτι δεινότερα ἄν τις ὁμολογήσειεν μὴ προσέχων τοῖς ῥήμασι τὸν νοῦν, ἢ τὸ πολὺ εἰθίσμεθα φάναι τε καὶ ἀπαρνεῖσθαι. σοὶ λέγω ὅτι, ἢ Θεαιτήτῳ. ΘΕΟ. εἰς τὸ κοινὸν μὲν οὖν, ἀποκρινέσθω δὲ ὁ νεώτερος·

165b

TD: No, explain it to the company. But let the younger man respond to you since he will be less shamed if he goes wrong.

165b

S: Let me then put the most formidable question, that goes something like this: Is it possible for the same person to know something and not know the thing that he knows?

165b

TD: Well, what answer shall we give, Theaetetus?

165b

TT: Presumably it is impossible, in my opinion anyway.

165b

S: Not if you propose that seeing is the same as knowing. For how will you respond to the inescapable question that, as they say, traps you in a well shaft, when some audacious fellow puts his hand over one of your eyes and asks if you can see his cloak with that covered eye?

σφαλείς γὰρ ἦττον ἀσχημονήσει. ΣΩ. λέγω δὴ τὸ δεινότατον ἐρώτημα, ἔστι δὲ οἶμαι τοιόνδε τι· ἄρα οἷόν τε τὸν αὐτὸν εἰδότα τι τοῦτο ὃ οἶδεν μὴ εἰδέναι; ΘΕΟ. τί δὴ οὖν ἀποκρινούμεθα, ὦ Θεαίτητε; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀδύνατόν που, οἶμαι ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. οὐκ, εἰ τὸ ὁρᾶν γε ἐπίστασθαι θήσεις. τί γὰρ χρήσι ἀφύκτω ἐρωτήματι, τὸ λεγόμενον ἐν φρεάτι συσχόμενος, ὅταν ἐρωτᾷ ἀνέκπληκτος ἀνὴρ, καταλαβὼν τῇ χειρὶ

165c

TT: I think I would say that I cannot see it with that eye, but I can see it with the other one.

165c

S: So, do you both see and not see the same thing at the same time?

165c

TT: Yes, in the way we have described it anyway.

165c

S: “That is not the question I put to you,” he will say. “I was asking if you do not know the thing that you know, regardless of how this occurs. What is not seen now turns out to be seen, yet you happen to have agreed that seeing is knowing, and not seeing is not knowing. Now work out the conclusion from all this.”

σοῦ τὸν ἕτερον ὀφθαλμόν, εἰ ὁρᾷς τὸ ἱμάτιον τῷ κατελειμμένῳ; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ φήσω οἶμαι τούτῳ γε, τῷ μέντοι ἑτέρῳ. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὁρᾷς τε καὶ οὐχ ὁρᾷς ἅμα ταυτόν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτω γέ πως. ΣΩ. οὐδὲν ἐγώ, φήσει, τοῦτο οὔτε τάττω οὔτ' ἠρόμην τὸ ὅπως, ἀλλ' εἰ ὃ ἐπίστασαι, τοῦτο καὶ οὐκ ἐπίστασαι. νῦν δὲ ὃ οὐχ ὁρᾷς ὁρῶν φαίνει. ὡμολογηκῶς δὲ τυγχάνεις τὸ ὁρᾶν ἐπίστασθαι καὶ τὸ μὴ ὁρᾶν μὴ ἐπίστασθαι. ἐξ οὖν τούτων λογίζου τί σοι συμβαίνει.

165d

Tt: I am coming to conclusions contrary to what I was proposing before.

165d

S: Yes, my friend, and perhaps you would have had more experiences like this, if someone had gone on to ask you if it is possible to know accurately and dimly, or to know from close up but not from afar, or know the same thing thoroughly and vaguely. There are lots of other questions that a combative professional debater, lying in wait, would ask you, once you propose that knowledge and perception are the same. He would go on to attack hearing and smelling and all such perceptions, and would keep refuting you relentlessly until you were in awe of his enviable wisdom and totally entangled by him. And once he had overpowered you and tied you up, you would be released for a ransom amount that you both agreed upon. Perhaps you may ask what argument Protagoras will now proffer in defence of his own proposition. Shall we try to state it?

ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ λογίζομαι ὅτι τάναντία οἷς ὑπεθέμην. ΣΩ. ἴσως δέ γ', ὃ θαυμάσιε, πλείω ἂν τοιαῦτ' ἔπαθες εἴ τις σε προσηρώτα εἰ ἐπίστασθαι ἔστι μὲν ὁξύ, ἔστι δὲ ἀμβλύ, καὶ ἐγγύθεν μὲν ἐπίστασθαι, πόρρωθεν δὲ μή, καὶ σφόδρα καὶ ἡρέμα τὸ αὐτό, καὶ ἄλλα μυρία, ἃ ἐλλοχῶν ἂν πελταστικός ἀνὴρ μισθοφόρος ἐν λόγοις ἐρόμενος, ἡνίκ' ἐπιστήμην καὶ αἴσθησιν ταῦτ' ἔθου, ἐμβαλὼν ἂν εἰς τὸ ἀκούειν καὶ ὁσφραίνεισθαι καὶ τὰς τοιαύτας αἰσθήσεις, ἥλεγχεν

165e

Tt: Yes, certainly.

ἂν ἐπέχων καὶ οὐκ ἀνιῖς πρὶν θαυμάσας τὴν πολυάρατον σοφίαν συνεποδίσθης ὑπ' αὐτοῦ, οὗ δὴ σε χειρωσάμενός τε καὶ συνδήσας ἤδη ἂν τότε ἐλύτρου χρημάτων ὅσων σοὶ τε κάκείνω ἐδόκει. τίν' οὖν δὴ ὁ Πρωταγόρας, φαίης ἂν ἴσως, λόγον ἐπίκουρον τοῖς αὐτοῦ ἐρεῖ; ἄλλο τι πειρώμεθα λέγειν; ΘΕΑΙ. πάνν μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. ταῦτά τε δὴ πάντα ὅσα ἡμεῖς ἐπαμύνοντες αὐτῷ

166a

S: Well, no doubt he will say all the things we say in his defence, and I believe he will also engage in dispute, despising us and saying:

“This Socrates, the simpleton! He tries to argue that I am the one who is ridiculous, because some little boy is frightened when Socrates asks him if the same person can remember something and not know it at the same time, and the boy, out of fear, says no because he cannot foresee the consequences. But the position is as follows, O idle Socrates! Whenever you investigate any of my propositions through questioning, then I am refuted only if the person questioned is defeated while answering exactly as I would answer. But if he answers in another way, it is the actual person questioned who is refuted.

“In this instance, do you think anyone will agree that someone’s present memory of things that he experienced is anything like the experience he was having at the time, and is no longer experiencing? Far from it. Or again, would anyone be reluctant to agree that the same person can both know and not know the same thing? Or even, if he was afraid of that proposition, would he ever concede that someone who is becoming unlike is the same as he was before becoming unlike? Indeed, if he must be on the lookout for the verbal traps that we each lay, will he ever agree there is a single person, and not a number of persons, and that these become unlimited, as long as the process of becoming unlike actually continues.

“Dear fellow,” he will say, “come to terms generously with what I actually propose, and prove if you can that private perceptions are not arising for each of us, or that if the perceptions that arise are private, what appears is not something that especially arises only for that person, or ‘is’ for that person, if we must use the word ‘is’.

“Now when you refer to pigs and baboons, you not only act like a pig yourself, but you persuade your hearers to treat my writings as you do,

which is most improper.

“Indeed, I assert that what I have written is the truth, that each of us is indeed the measure of things that are and are not. However, there are countless differences between one person and another in this respect, because to one person certain things are and appear, while to another other things are and appear. I am far from denying that there is wisdom or a wise man, but the particular man whom I call wise is one who brings about change, and will make things appear and be good to us, when they both appear, and are, bad. And again, do not go chasing after this argument based on how I have expressed it, but note this clarification of what I mean. Recall how this was expressed in the earlier conversation, that to a sick man whatever he eats appears sour and is sour, while the opposite appears to be the case, and is the case, for a healthy man. Now, we should not portray one as wiser than the other, nor could we. Neither should we allege that the infirm man is ignorant because he holds such opinions, nor that the healthy man is wise because his views are different. No, one condition should be changed to the other because the other is better. And in education too, we should effect just such a change from one particular condition to a better one. And while the doctor effects the change with medicine, the sophist does it with his words. Indeed, no one ever made a man hold true opinions who previously held false opinions, for it is not possible either to think of things that are not, or of anything outside of what is experienced, and these are always true. I believe rather that in a degenerate condition of the soul he holds opinions appropriate to that condition, while in a sound condition of the soul he is made to hold opinions of a different sort – a set of appearances that some naively refer to as true. However, I say that one set is better than the other, but not any truer.

“My dear Socrates, I am far from referring to the wise as tadpoles, but when it comes to the body I call them doctors, and when it comes to

plants I call them farmers. Indeed, I say that these farmers engender sound, healthy and true perceptions in the plants whenever they are sick, in place of the degenerate perceptions, while the good and wise orators make whatever is beneficial rather than degenerate seem right to cities. Now, whatever seems right to each city is good and right for that city, as long as it is believed. But the wise man makes whatever is beneficial rather than degenerate seem right and be right for them, in each case. And on the same basis, the sophist is wise, and worth his large fees, as he too can educate pupils in this manner. And this is how some people are wiser than others while no one holds a false opinion, and you must put up with being a measure, whether you like it or not, as the salvation of this argument lies in these assertions.

“Now, if you intend to contradict it all over again, conduct your disputation by presenting a complete argument. Or if you prefer to use questions, then use questions, for we should not avoid that method either. Indeed an intelligent person should follow that approach rather than any other.

“However, heed the precept that your questioning be not unjust, as it is very unreasonable that a man who says that he cares about excellence should constantly pursue an unfair line of argument. Now, it is unfair in this context for someone to carry on this business without distinguishing between disputation and dialogue. In disputation he may play and trip up his opponent as often as he can, but in dialectic he should be serious and also set his partner back on his feet, pointing out to him only those pitfalls into which he has been misled by himself or his former acquaintances. Once you act in this way, whoever spends time with you will blame themselves for their confusion and perplexity, and not you. And they will follow you and love you, and will hate themselves and flee from themselves into philosophy, so that they may become different people and be freed from what they were before. But if you do the opposite, as do most people, the consequences

will be opposite, and instead of philosophers you will produce followers who hate the subject once they become older.

“Now if you listen to me, as I said before, you will settle down, without impatience and aggression but with a gracious mind, and really consider what precisely we mean when we proclaim that everything is motion, and that for each person, or city, whatever seems, also is. And based on this, you will reflect on whether knowledge and perception are the same or different, but not as you did just now, on the basis of familiar expressions and terminology that many people employ, in whatever manner occurs to them, causing endless confusion to one another.” Theodorus, this is the best I can do from my slender resources to offer assistance to your friend, but if the man himself were alive he would have defended his offspring more expansively.

λέγομεν, καὶ ὁμοσε οἶμαι χωρήσεται καταφρονῶν ἡμῶν καὶ λέγων· οὗτος δὴ ὁ Σωκράτης ὁ χρηστός, ἐπειδὴ αὐτῷ παιδίον τι ἐρωτηθὲν ἔδεισεν εἰ οἷόν τε τὸν αὐτὸν τὸ αὐτὸ μεμνησθαι ἅμα καὶ μὴ εἰδέναι, καὶ δεῖσαν ἀπέφησεν διὰ τὸ μὴ δύνασθαι προορᾶν, γέλωτα δὴ τὸν ἐμὲ ἐν τοῖς λόγοις ἀπέδειξεν. τὸ δέ, ὦ ῥαθυμότατε Σώκρατες, τῇδ' ἔχει· ὅταν τι τῶν ἐμῶν δι' ἐρωτήσεως σκοπῆς, ἐὰν μὲν ὁ ἐρωτηθεὶς οἴαπερ ἂν ἐγὼ ἀποκριναίμην ἀποκρινάμενος σφάλλῃται, ἐγὼ ἐλέγχομαι, εἰ δὲ ἄλλοῖα, αὐτὸς ὁ ἐρωτηθεὶς. αὐτίκα γὰρ δοκεῖς τινὰ σοι συγχωρήσεσθαι μνήμην παρεῖναι τῷ ὧν ἔπαθε, τοιοῦτόν τι οὔσαν πάθος οἷον ὅτε ἔπασχε, μηκέτι πάσχοντι; πολλοῦ γε δεῖ. ἢ αὖ ἀποκνήσκειν ὁμολογεῖν οἷον τ' εἶναι εἰδέναι καὶ μὴ εἰδέναι τὸν αὐτὸν τὸ αὐτό; ἢ ἐάνπερ τοῦτο δεῖσῃ, δώσειν ποτὲ τὸν αὐτὸν εἶναι τὸν ἀνομοιούμενον τῷ πρὶν ἀνομοιοῦσθαι ὄντι; μᾶλλον δὲ τὸν εἶναι τινὰ ἄλλ' οὐχὶ τούς, καὶ τούτους γιγνομένους ἀπείρους, ἐάνπερ ἀνομοιώσις γίγνηται, εἰ δὴ ὀνομάτων γε δεήσει θηρεύσεις διευλαβεῖσθαι ἀλλήλων; ἀλλ', ὦ μακάριε, φήσει, γενναιοτέρως ἐπ' αὐτὸ ἐλθὼν ὃ λέγω, εἰ δύνασαι, ἐξέλεγξον ὥς οὐχὶ ἴδιαι αἰσθήσεις ἐκάστῳ ἡμῶν γίνονται, ἢ ὥς ἰδίων γιγνομένων οὐδέν τι ἂν μᾶλλον τὸ φαινόμενον μόνῳ ἐκείνῳ γίγνοιτο, ἢ εἰ εἶναι δεῖ ὀνομάζειν, εἴη ὥπερ φαίνεται· ὅς δὲ δὴ καὶ κυνοκεφάλους λέγων οὐ

μόνον αὐτὸς ὑπενεῖς, ἀλλὰ καὶ τοὺς ἀκούοντας τοῦτο δρᾶν εἰς τὰ συγγράμματά μου ἀναπείθεις, οὐ καλῶς ποιῶν. ἐγὼ γάρ φημι μὲν τὴν ἀλήθειαν ἔχειν ὡς γέγραφα· μέτρον γὰρ ἕκαστον ἡμῶν εἶναι τῶν τε ὄντων καὶ μὴ, μυρίον μὲντοι διαφέρειν ἕτερον ἐτέρου αὐτῷ τούτῳ, ὅτι τῷ μὲν ἄλλα ἔστι τε καὶ φαίνεται, τῷ δὲ ἄλλα. καὶ σοφίαν καὶ σοφὸν ἄνδρα πολλοῦ δέω τὸ μὴ φάναι εἶναι, ἀλλ' αὐτὸν τοῦτον καὶ λέγω σοφόν, ὃς ἂν τινι ἡμῶν, ᾧ φαίνεται καὶ ἔστι κακά, μεταβάλλων ποιήσῃ ἀγαθὰ φαίνεσθαι τε καὶ εἶναι. τὸν δὲ λόγον αὖ μὴ τῷ ῥήματί μου δίδωκε, ἀλλ' ὧδε ἔτι σαφέστερον μάθε τί λέγω. οἷον γὰρ ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν ἐλέγετο ἀναμνήσθητι, ὅτι τῷ μὲν ἀσθενοῦντι πικρὰ φαίνεται ἃ ἐσθίει καὶ ἔστι, τῷ δὲ ὑγιαίνοντι τάναντία ἔστι καὶ φαίνεται. ΣΩ. σοφώτερον μὲν οὖν τούτων οὐδέτερον δεῖ ποιῆσαι—οὐδὲ γὰρ δυνατόν—οὐδὲ κατηγορητέον ὡς ὁ μὲν κάμνων ἀμαθὴς ὅτι τοιαῦτα δοξάζει, ὁ δὲ ὑγιαίνων σοφὸς ὅτι ἄλλοιᾶ, μεταβλητέον δ' ἐπὶ θάτερα· ἀμείνων γὰρ ἢ ἑτέρα ἔξις. οὕτω δὲ καὶ ἐν τῇ παιδείᾳ ἀπὸ ἑτέρας ἕξεως ἐπὶ τὴν ἀμείνων μεταβλητέον· ἀλλ' ὁ μὲν ἱατρὸς φαρμάκοις μεταβάλλει, ὁ δὲ σοφιστὴς λόγοις. ἐπεὶ οὐ τί γε ψευδῇ δοξάζοντά τις τινα ὕστερον ἀληθῆ ἐποίησε δοξάζειν· οὔτε γὰρ τὰ μὴ ὄντα δυνατόν δοξάσαι, οὔτε ἄλλα παρ' ἃ ἂν πάσῃ, ταῦτα δὲ αἰεὶ ἀληθῆ. ἀλλ' οἶμαι πονηρᾶς ψυχῆς ἕξει δοξάζοντα συγγενῇ ἑαυτῆς χρηστῇ ἐποίησε δοξάσαι ἕτερα τοιαῦτα, ἃ δὴ τινες τὰ φαντάσματα ὑπὸ ἀπειρίας ἀληθῆ καλοῦσιν, ἐγὼ δὲ βελτίω μὲν τὰ ἕτερα τῶν ἐτέρων, ἀληθέστερα δὲ οὐδέν. καὶ τοὺς σοφοὺς, ὧ φίλε Σώκρατες, πολλοῦ δέω βατράχους λέγειν, ἀλλὰ κατὰ μὲν σώματα ἱατροὺς λέγω, κατὰ δὲ φυτὰ γεωργοὺς. φημί γὰρ καὶ τούτους τοῖς φυτοῖς ἀντὶ πονηρῶν αἰσθήσεων, ὅταν τι αὐτῶν ἀσθενῇ, χρηστὰς καὶ ὑγιεινὰς αἰσθήσεις τε καὶ ἀληθεῖς ἐμποιεῖν, τοὺς δὲ γε σοφοὺς τε καὶ ἀγαθοὺς ῥήτορας ταῖς πόλεσι τὰ χρηστὰ ἀντὶ τῶν πονηρῶν δίκαια δοκεῖν εἶναι ποιεῖν. ἐπεὶ οἷά γ' ἂν ἐκάστη πόλει δίκαια καὶ καλὰ δοκῇ, ταῦτα καὶ εἶναι αὐτῇ, ἕως ἂν αὐτὰ νομίζῃ· ἀλλ' ὁ σοφὸς ἀντὶ πονηρῶν ὄντων αὐτοῖς ἐκάστων χρηστὰ ἐποίησεν εἶναι καὶ δοκεῖν. κατὰ δὲ τὸν αὐτὸν λόγον καὶ ὁ σοφιστὴς τοὺς παιδευομένους οὕτω δυνάμενος παιδαγωγεῖν σοφός τε καὶ ἄξιος πολλῶν χρημάτων τοῖς παιδευθεῖσιν. καὶ οὕτω σοφώτεροί τέ εἰσιν ἕτεροι ἐτέρων καὶ οὐδεὶς ψευδῇ δοξάζει, καὶ σοί,

έάντε βούλη έάντε μή, άνεκτέον όντι μέτρω· σφύζεται γάρ έν τούτοις ό λόγος ούτος. ώ σϋ εί μέν έχεις έξ άρχής άμφισβητείν, άμφισβήτει λόγω άντιδιεξεληθών· εί δέ δι' έρωτήσεων βούλει, δι' έρωτήσεων· ούδέ γάρ τουτό φευκτέον, αλλά πάντων μάλιστα διωκτέον τώ νοϋν έχοντι. ποίει μέντοι ούτωςί· μή άδίκει έν τώ έρωτάν. και γάρ πολλή άλογία άρετής φάσκοντα έπιμελεΐσθαι μηδέν άλλ' ή άδικούντα έν λόγοις διατελεΐν. ΣΩ. άδικεΐν δ' έστιν έν τώ τοιούτῳ, όταν τις μή χωρίς μέν ως άγωνιζόμενος τās διατριβās ποιήται, χωρίς δέ διαλεγόμενος, και έν μέν τώ παίξει τε και σφάλλη καθ' όσον άν δύνηται, έν δέ τώ διαλέγεσθαι σπουδάζει τε και έπανορθοΐ τόν προσδιαλεγόμενον, εκείνα μόνα αυτώ ένδεικνύμενος τὰ σφάλματα, α αυτὸς ύφ' έαυτοϋ και τών προτέρων συνουσιών παρεκέκρουστο. άν μέν γάρ ούτω ποιής, έαυτούς αιτιάσονται οί προσδιατρίβοντές σοι τής αυτών ταραχής και άπορίας άλλ' ου σέ, και σέ μέν διώξονται και φιλήσουσιν, αυτούς δέ μισήσουσι και φεύξονται άφ' έαυτών εις φιλοσοφίαν, ίν' άλλοι γενόμενοι άπαλλαγώσι τών οί πρότερον ήσαν· έάν δέ τάναντία τούτων δρᾶς ώσπερ οί πολλοί, τάναντία συμβήσεται σοι και τούς συνόντας άντι φιλοσόφων μισοϋντας τουτό τὸ πρᾶγμα άποφανείς έπειδάν πρεσβύτεροι γένωνται. έάν οϋν έμοι πείθῃ, ό και πρότερον έρρήθῃ, ου δυσμενῶς ούδέ μαχητικῶς άλλ' ίλεω τῇ διανοίᾳ συγκαθείς ως αληθῶς σκέψη τί ποτε λέγομεν, κινεΐσθαι τε άποφαινόμενοι τὰ πάντα, τό τε δοκοϋν εκάστῳ τουτό και εΐναι ιδιώτῃ τε και πόλει. και εκ τούτων έπισκέψη είτε ταϋτὸν είτε και άλλο έπιστήμη και αΐσθησις, άλλ' ουχ ώσπερ ἄρτι εκ συνηθείας

168c

TD: You are joking, Socrates. You have defended the man most vigorously.

ρήμάτων τε και όνομάτων, α οί πολλοί όπη άν τύχωσιν έλκοντες άπορίας άλλήλοις παντοδαπās παρέχουσι. ταϋτα, ώ Θεόδωρε, τώ έταίρω σου εις βοήθειαν προσηρξάμην κατ' έμήν δύναμιν σμικρά από σμικρῶν· εί δ' αυτὸς έξει, μεγαλειότερον άν τοίς αυτοϋ έβοήθησεν. ΘΕΟ. παίξεις, ώ Σώκρατες· πάνυ γάρ νεανικῶς τώ άνδρι βεβοήθηκας. ΣΩ. εϋ

λέγεις, ὦ ἑταῖρε. καί μοι εἰπέ· ἐνενόησάς που λέγοντος ἄρτι τοῦ Πρωταγόρου καὶ ὀνειδίζοντος ἡμῖν ὅτι

168d

S: It is nice of you to say so, my friend. But tell me, did you note what Protagoras was saying just now when he reproached us for directing our arguments against a little child and using childish fear in refuting his views? He accused us of mere cleverness, extolled ‘the measure of all things’, and urged us to be serious about his argument.

168d

TD: How could I fail to notice that point, Socrates?

168d

S: In that case, do you think we should heed his injunction?

168d

TD: I certainly do.

168d

S: You see then that all the people here, except you, are small children. So if we are going to obey the man, you and I must be serious about this argument, as we ask and answer one another. Then at least we shall not be accused of boyish sport as we reconsider the argument.

πρὸς παιδίον τοὺς λόγους ποιούμενοι τῷ τοῦ παιδὸς φόβῳ ἀγωνιζοίμεθα εἰς τὰ ἑαυτοῦ, καὶ χαριεντισμόν τινα ἀποκαλῶν, ἀποσεμνύνων δὲ τὸ πάντων μέτρον, σπουδάσαι ἡμᾶς διεκελεύσατο περὶ τὸν αὐτοῦ λόγον; ΘΕΟ. πῶς γὰρ οὐκ ἐνενόησα, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. τί οὖν; κελεύεις πείθεσθαι αὐτῷ; ΘΕΟ. σφόδρα γε. ΣΩ. ὁρᾷς οὖν ὅτι τάδε πάντα πλὴν σοῦ παιδία ἐστίν. εἰ οὖν πεισόμεθα τῷ ἀνδρί, ἐμὲ καὶ σὲ δεῖ ἐρωτῶντάς τε καὶ

168e

TD: What? Surely Theaetetus could follow the scrutiny of an argument better than many a man with a long beard?

168e

S: Not better than you however, Theodorus. So do not presume that I should make every effort to defend your deceased companion while

you do nothing. Come now, my friend, follow me for a while, at least until we establish whether it turns out that you are the measure when it comes to diagrams, or whether everyone is just like you, and sufficient unto themselves in astronomy and those other subjects in which you are indeed said to excel.

ἀποκρινομένους ἀλλήλοις σπουδάσαι αὐτοῦ περὶ τὸν λόγον, ἵνα μὴ τοῦτό γε ἔχη ἐγκαλεῖν, ὥς παίζοντες πρὸς μειράκια διεσκεψάμεθ' αὐτοῦ τὸν λόγον. ΘΕΟ. τί δ'; οὐ πολλῶν τοι Θεαίτητος μεγάλους πώγωνας ἐχόντων ἄμεινον ἂν ἐπακολουθήσειε λόγῳ διερευνημένῳ; ΣΩ. ἀλλ' οὐ τι σοῦ γε, ὦ Θεόδωρε, ἄμεινον. μὴ οὖν οἴου ἐμὲ μὲν τῷ σῷ ἐταίρῳ τετελευτηκότι δεῖν παντὶ τρόπῳ

169a

TD: Socrates, it is not easy for someone to avoid entering into an argument when they are sitting beside you, and I spoke nonsense just now, saying that you would not force me to undress and wrestle as the Spartans do, but would leave the decision up to me. No, you are inclined to the trickery of Sciron!²³ Indeed, the Spartans ask you to undress or go away, but you behave more like Antaeus, for once someone draws near you won't let him go until you have undressed him and forced him into a verbal wrestling match.²⁴

ἐπαμύνειν, σὲ δὲ μηδενί. ἀλλ' ἴθι, ὦ ἄριστε, ὀλίγον ἐπίσπου, μέχρι τούτου αὐτοῦ ἕως ἂν εἰδῶμεν εἴτε ἄρα σὲ δεῖ διαγραμμαμάτων περί μέτρον εἶναι, εἴτε πάντες ὁμοίως σοὶ ἱκανοὶ ἑαυτοῖς εἰς τε ἀστρονομίαν καὶ τᾶλλα ὧν δὴ σὺ περί αἰτίαν ἔχεις διαφέρειν. ΘΕΟ. οὐ ῥάδιον, ὦ Σώκρατες, σοὶ παρακαθήμενον μὴ διδόναι λόγον, ἀλλ' ἐγὼ ἄρτι παρελήρησα φάσκων σε ἐπιτρέψειν μοι μὴ ἀποδύεσθαι, καὶ οὐχὶ ἀναγκάσειν καθάπερ Λακεδαιμόνιοι· σὺ δέ μοι δοκεῖς πρὸς τὸν Σκίρωνα μᾶλλον

169b

S: Theodorus, you have presented an excellent image for the malady that afflicts me. However, I am even more stubborn than the characters you mention. Many a Heracles and Theseus have crossed my

path, powerful speakers who have taken me apart, but I shall never back down at all, such is the awful passion for these exercises that has gripped me. So do not refuse to enter the ring with me, as you will benefit yourself as well as me.

τείνειν. Λακεδαιμόνιοι μὲν γὰρ ἀπιέναι ἢ ἀποδύεσθαι κελεύουσι, σὺ δὲ κατ' Ἀνταϊόν τί μοι μᾶλλον δοκεῖς τὸ δρᾶμα δρᾶν· τὸν γὰρ προσελθόντα οὐκ ἀνίης πρὶν ἂν ἀναγκάσης ἀποδύσας ἐν τοῖς λόγοις προσπαλαῖσαι. ΣΩ. ἄριστά γε, ὦ Θεόδωρε, τὴν νόσον μου ἀπήκασας· ἰσχυρικώτερος μέντοι ἐγὼ ἐκείνων. μυρίοι γὰρ ἤδη μοι Ἡρακλέες τε καὶ Θησέες ἐντυχόντες καρτεροὶ πρὸς τὸ λέγειν μάλ' εὖ συγκεκρικόφασιν, ἀλλ' ἐγὼ οὐδέν τι μᾶλλον ἀφίσταμαι·

169c

TD: I have no argument against this, so lead me wherever you wish. I must fully accept the destiny you decree in these matters, and submit to being cross-examined. However, I shall not be able to surrender myself to you beyond what you are proposing.

169c

S: Well, that is far enough. Now, there is one thing you must help me to guard against. We should not slip into a childish form of discussion and be reproached again for this.

οὕτω τις ἔρως δεινὸς ἐνδέδυκε τῆς περὶ ταῦτα γυμνασίας, μὴ οὖν μηδὲ σὺ φθονήσης προσανατριψάμενος σαυτόν τε ἅμα καὶ ἐμὲ ὀνήσαι. ΘΕΟ. οὐδὲν ἔτι ἀντιλέγω, ἀλλ' ἄγε ὅπη θέλεις· πάντως τὴν περὶ ταῦτα εἰμαρμένην ἦν ἂν σὺ ἐπικλώσης δεῖ ἀνατλήναι ἐλεγχόμενον. οὐ μέντοι περαιτέρω γε ὧν προτίθεσαι οἷός τ' ἔσομαι παρασχεῖν ἐμαυτόν σοι. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἄρκεϊ καὶ μέχρι τούτων. καὶ μοι πάνυ τήρει τὸ τοιόνδε, μή που παιδικὸν τι λάθωμεν εἶδος τῶν λόγων

169d

TD: Well, I shall do the best I can.

169d

S: In that case, let us take this up again at the same point as before, and see if we were right or wrong to find fault in and criticise this

proposition because it made each person self-sufficient in intelligence, and made Protagoras concede to us that, in matters of better and worse, some excel over others, and these are, in fact, wise. Isn't this where we were?

169d

TD: Yes.

169d

S: Now, if Protagoras himself were actually present and had agreed, and we had not made this concession on his behalf in order to help him, there would be no need to seek certainty by resuming the discussion. But now, perhaps, someone will suggest that we lack authority to agree on his behalf, and that it would be better to agree this particular point fully with greater clarity, because whether or not this is the case is no small matter.

ποιούμενοι, καὶ τις πάλιν ἡμῖν αὐτὸ ὀνειδίσῃ. ΘΕΟ. ἀλλὰ δὴ πειράσομαι γε καθ' ὅσον ἂν δύνωμαι. ΣΩ. τοῦδε τοίνυν πρῶτον πάλιν ἀντιλαβόμεθα οὐπὲρ τὸ πρότερον, καὶ ἴδωμεν ὀρθῶς ἢ οὐκ ὀρθῶς ἐδυσχεραίνομεν ἐπιτιμῶντες τῷ λόγῳ ὅτι αὐτάρκη ἕκαστον εἰς φρόνησιν ἐποίει, καὶ ἡμῖν συνεχώρησεν ὁ Πρωταγόρας περὶ τε τοῦ ἀμείνονος καὶ χείρονος διαφέρειν τινάς, οὓς δὴ καὶ εἶναι σοφούς. οὐχί; ΘΕΟ. ναί. ΣΩ. εἰ μὲν τοίνυν αὐτὸς παρὼν ὠμολόγει ἀλλὰ μὴ ἡμεῖς

169e

TD: What you say is true.

169e

S: Then let us get this agreement as concisely as possible from his own argument rather than anything else.

βοηθοῦντες ὑπὲρ αὐτοῦ συνεχώρησαμεν, οὐδὲν ἂν πάλιν ἔδει ἐπαναλαβόντας βεβαιοῦσθαι· νῦν δὲ τάχ' ἂν τις ἡμᾶς ἀκύρους τιθεῖ τῆς ὑπὲρ ἐκείνου ὁμολογίας. διὸ καλλιόνως ἔχει σαφέστερον περὶ τούτου αὐτοῦ διομολογήσασθαι· οὐ γάρ τι σμικρὸν παραλλάττει οὕτως ἔχον ἢ ἄλλως. ΘΕΟ. λέγεις ἀληθῆ. ΣΩ. μὴ τοίνυν δι' ἄλλων ἀλλ' ἐκ τοῦ ἐκείνου λόγου ὥς

170a

TD: How?

170a

S: As follows. He says, I believe, that whatever seems also is, for the person to whom it seems.

170a

TD: Yes, he does say that.

170a

S: So then, Protagoras, we too are describing the opinions of a man, in fact of all men, and we declare that there is no one who does not believe himself wiser than others in some respects, while others are wiser in other respects. Indeed, in the greatest dangers, whether in battle or disease or storms at sea, they will regard those in authority as gods, who are expected to act as saviours, though their superiority lies in knowledge and in nothing else. And the entire human race is full of people in search of teachers and leaders for themselves, for other creatures, and for their activities, while others think themselves capable of teaching and leading. Now, in all these cases, what else can we say except that the people themselves believe that there is wisdom and ignorance among them?

διὰ βραχυτάτων λάβωμεν τὴν ὁμολογίαν. ΘΕΟ. πῶς; ΣΩ. οὕτωςί· τὸ δοκοῦν ἐκάστῳ τοῦτο καὶ εἶναί φησί· που ᾧ δοκεῖ; ΘΕΟ. φησὶ γὰρ οὖν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν, ᾧ Πρωταγόρα, καὶ ἡμεῖς ἀνθρώπου, μᾶλλον δὲ πάντων ἀνθρώπων δόξας λέγομεν, καὶ φαμὲν οὐδένα ὄντινα οὐ τὰ μὲν αὐτὸν ἡγεῖσθαι τῶν ἄλλων σοφώτερον, τὰ δὲ ἄλλους ἑαυτοῦ, καὶ ἔν γε τοῖς μεγίστοις κινδύνοις, ὅταν ἐν στρατείαις ἢ νόσοις ἢ ἐν θαλάττῃ χειμάζωνται, ὥσπερ πρὸς θεοὺς ἔχειν τοὺς ἐν ἐκάστοις ἄρχοντας, σωτῆρας σφῶν

170b

TD: Nothing else.

170b

S: Don't they believe that wisdom is true thought, while ignorance is false opinion?

προσδοκῶντας, οὐκ ἄλλω τῷ διαφέροντας ἢ τῷ εἰδέναι· καὶ πάντα που μεστὰ τάνθρώπινα ζητούντων διδασκάλους τε καὶ ἄρχοντας ἑαυτῶν τε καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ζώων τῶν τε ἐργασιῶν, οἰομένων τε αὖ ἱκανῶν μὲν διδάσκειν, ἱκανῶν δὲ ἄρχειν εἶναι. καὶ ἐν τούτοις ἅπασι τί ἄλλο φήσομεν ἢ αὐτοὺς τοὺς ἀνθρώπους ἡγεῖσθαι σοφίαν καὶ ἀμαθίαν εἶναι παρὰ σφίσι; ΘΕΟ. οὐδὲν ἄλλο. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὴν μὲν σοφίαν ἀληθῆ διάνοιαν ἡγοῦνται, τὴν δὲ ἀμαθίαν ψευδῆ δόξαν;

170c

TD: Of course.

170c

S: So what will become of the proposition, Protagoras? Should we say that people always think what is true, or do they sometimes think what is true and at other times what is false? Indeed, it seems to follow from either option that people do not always think what is true. Rather, they think both. Consider this, Theodorus. Would you yourself, or any follower of Protagoras, be prepared to contend that no one ever believes that someone else is ignorant and thinks falsely?

170c

TD: No one would accept that, Socrates.

ΘΕΟ. τί μήν; ΣΩ. τί οὖν, ὦ Πρωταγόρα, χρῆσόμεθα τῷ λόγῳ; πότερον ἀληθῆ φῶμεν αἰεὶ τοὺς ἀνθρώπους δοξάζειν, ἢ τοτὲ μὲν ἀληθῆ, τοτὲ δὲ ψευδῆ; ἐξ ἀμφοτέρων γάρ που συμβαίνει μὴ αἰεὶ ἀληθῆ ἀλλ' ἀμφοτέρα αὐτοὺς δοξάζειν. σκόπει γάρ, ὦ Θεόδωρε, εἰ ἐθέλοι ἄν τις τῶν ἀμφὶ Πρωταγόραν ἢ σὺ αὐτὸς διαμάχεσθαι ὥς οὐδεὶς ἡγεῖται ἕτερος ἕτερον ἀμαθῆ τε εἶναι καὶ ψευδῆ δοξάζειν. ΘΕΟ. ἀλλ' ἄπιστον, ὦ Σώκρατες.

170d

S: And yet this is where the proposition inevitably leads, the proposition which states that man is the measure of all things.

170d

TD: How so?

170d

S: Whenever you have formed a judgement by yourself, and you present an opinion to me about something, we should say that this opinion is true for you, based upon Protagoras' proposition. But don't the rest of us become judges of your judgement? Or do we decide that you always form true opinions? Or do thousands who hold different views oppose you every time, in the belief that your thought and judgement is false?

ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν εἰς τοῦτό γε ἀνάγκης ὁ λόγος ἦκει ὁ πάντων χρημάτων μέτρον ἄνθρωπον λέγων. ΘΕΟ. πῶς δῆ; ΣΩ. ὅταν σὺ κρίνας τι παρὰ σαυτῷ πρὸς με ἀποφαίνῃ περὶ τίνος δόξαν, σοὶ μὲν δὴ τοῦτο κατὰ τὸν ἐκείνου λόγον ἀληθὲς ἔστω, ἡμῖν δὲ δὴ τοῖς ἄλλοις περὶ τῆς σῆς κρίσεως πότερον οὐκ ἔστιν κριταῖς γενέσθαι, ἢ αἰεὶ σὲ κρίνομεν ἀληθῆ δοξάζειν; ἢ μυρίοι ἐκάστοτέ σοι μάχονται ἀντιδοξάζοντες, ἡγούμενοι ψευδῇ κρίνειν τε καὶ οἶεσθαι;

170e

TD: They do indeed, by Zeus, Socrates – thousands, and more, as Homer says,²⁵ who inflict all the troubles of mankind upon me.

170e

S: What then? Do you like us to say that in this case, you are forming opinions that are true for you, but false for thousands?

170e

TD: It seems that this must follow from the proposition.

170e

S: And what about Protagoras himself? Mustn't it follow that if he himself did not believe that man was the measure, nor did the world in general – which, in fact, it does not – this truth that the man has written down would be true for no one? However, if he believed it himself but the majority did not agree, note firstly that insofar as more people disagree than agree, to that extent it is more not so than so.

ΘΕΟ. νῆ τὸν Δία, ὦ Σώκρατες, μάλα μυρίοι δῆτα, φησὶν Ὅμηρος, οἳ γέ μοι τὰ ἐξ ἀνθρώπων πράγματα παρέχουσιν. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; βούλει λέγωμεν ὥς σὺ τότε σαυτῷ μὲν ἀληθῆ δοξάζεις, τοῖς δὲ μυρίοις ψευδῇ; ΘΕΟ.

ἔοικεν ἔκ γε τοῦ λόγου ἀνάγκη εἶναι. ΣΩ. τί δὲ αὐτῷ Πρωταγόρα; ἄρ' οὐκ ἀνάγκη, εἰ μὲν μηδὲ αὐτὸς ᾧετο μέτρον εἶναι ἄνθρωπον μηδὲ οἱ πολλοί, ὥσπερ οὐδὲ οἴονται, μηδενὶ δὴ εἶναι ταύτην τὴν ἀλήθειαν

171a

TD: It must, if it is to be so, and not so, based upon individual opinion.

171a

S: Secondly – and this is the cleverest aspect – since Protagoras agrees that everyone thinks things that are, presumably he accepts as true the thinking of those who hold a view contrary to his own thinking, and they think that Protagoras is speaking falsely.

171a

TD: Yes, certainly.

ἦν ἐκεῖνος ἔγραψεν; εἰ δὲ αὐτὸς μὲν ᾧετο, τὸ δὲ πλῆθος μὴ συνοίεται, οἷσθ' ὅτι πρῶτον μὲν ὅσω πλείους οἷς μὴ δοκεῖ ἢ οἷς δοκεῖ, τοσούτω μᾶλλον οὐκ ἔστιν ἢ ἔστιν. ΘΕΟ. ἀνάγκη, εἴπερ γε καθ' ἐκάστην δόξαν ἔσται καὶ οὐκ ἔσται. ΣΩ. ἔπειτά γε τοῦτ' ἔχει κομψότατον· ἐκεῖνος μὲν περὶ τῆς αὐτοῦ οἰήσεως τὴν τῶν ἀντιδοξαζόντων οἴησιν, ἣ ἐκεῖνον ἡγοῦνται ψεύδεσθαι, συγχωρεῖ που ἀληθῆ εἶναι ὁμολογῶν τὰ ὄντα δοξάζειν ἅπαντας. ΘΕΟ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν.

171b

S: Wouldn't he be accepting that his own thinking is false, if he agrees that the thinking of those who believe him to be speaking falsely, is true?

171b

TD: He must.

171b

S: And yet the opponents do not accept that they themselves are speaking falsely.

171b

TD: No, they do not.

171b

S: While Protagoras again agrees that this opinion is true on the basis of what he has written.

171b

TD: So it appears.

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὴν αὐτοῦ ἂν ψευδῇ συγχωροῖ, εἰ τὴν τῶν ἡγουμένων αὐτὸν ψεύδεσθαι ὁμολογεῖ ἀληθῆ εἶναι; ΘΕΟ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. οἱ δέ γ' ἄλλοι οὐ συγχωροῦσιν ἑαυτοῖς ψεύδεσθαι; ΘΕΟ. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. ΣΩ. ὁ δέ γ' αὖ ὁμολογεῖ καὶ ταύτην ἀληθῆ τὴν δόξαν ἐξ ὧν γέγραφεν. ΘΕΟ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. ἐξ ἀπάντων ἄρα ἀπὸ Πρωταγόρου ἀρξαμένων ἀμφισβητήσεται, μᾶλλον δὲ ὑπὸ γε ἐκείνου ὁμολογήσεται, ὅταν τῷ τάναντία λέγοντι συγχωρῇ ἀληθῆ αὐτὸν δοξάζειν,

171c

S: Then it will be disputed by everyone, beginning with Protagoras, who adds his own agreement whenever he concedes that someone who says the very opposite is forming a true opinion. In that case, Protagoras himself will be accepting that neither a dog, nor any random person, is the measure of anything which he has not learned. Isn't this so?

171c

TD: It is so.

171c

S: Well, since it is disputed by everyone, the 'Truth of Protagoras' would be true for no one, neither for the man himself nor for anyone else.

171c

TD: We are running my old friend too hard, Socrates!

171c

S: But it is not actually clear whether we are running along the right course. Now, it is quite likely that the man is wiser than we, since he is older. And if he suddenly popped his head up from below, as far as the neck, he would expose me as talking a lot of nonsense – yes, that is likely; you too for agreeing with me – and then he would dive back

down, disappear and be gone. However, I think that we must accept ourselves just as we are, and always state how things seem to us. Accordingly, shouldn't we declare that any person at all will probably agree that some men are wiser than others, and some are more ignorant than others?

τότε καὶ ὁ Πρωταγόρας αὐτὸς συγχωρήσεται μήτε κύνα μήτε τὸν ἐπιτυχόντα ἄνθρωπον μέτρον εἶναι μηδὲ περὶ ἑνὸς οὐδ' ἂν μὴ μάθῃ. οὐχ οὕτως; ΘΕΟ. οὕτως. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἐπειδὴ ἀμφισβητεῖται ὑπὸ πάντων, οὐδενὶ ἂν εἴῃ ἡ Πρωταγόρου Ἀλήθεια ἀληθής, οὔτε τινὶ ἄλλῳ οὐτ' αὐτῷ ἐκείνῳ. ΘΕΟ. ἄγαν, ὦ Σώκρατες, τὸν ἐταῖρόν μου καταθέομεν. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ τοι, ὦ φίλε, ἄδηλον εἰ καὶ παραθέομεν τὸ ὀρθόν. εἰκὸς γε ἄρα ἐκείνον πρεσβύτερον ὄντα σοφώτερον

171d

TD: Well, I think so anyway.

171d

S: Yes. The best way to establish the argument is by means of the addition we made as we defended Protagoras. We said that in most cases, such as hot, dry, sweet, and any matters of that sort, as it seems to each, so it also is for each. However, if the argument is somehow to concede that one person excels over another in some matters, it will prefer to state that when it comes to health and disease, it is not every woman, child or beast who is competent to cure itself and realise what is healthy for itself, but in these cases, if any, one person does excel over another.

ἡμῶν εἶναι καὶ εἰ αὐτίκα ἐντεῦθεν ἀνακύψει μέχρι τοῦ αὐχένος, πολλὰ ἂν ἐμέ τε ἐλέγξας ληροῦντα, ὡς τὸ εἰκὸς, καὶ σὲ ὁμολογοῦντα, καταδὺς ἂν οἴχοιτο ἀποτρέχων. ἀλλ' ἡμῖν ἀνάγκη οἶμαι χρῆσθαι ἡμῖν αὐτοῖς ὅποιοί τινές ἐσμεν, καὶ τὰ δοκοῦντα ἀεὶ ταῦτα λέγειν. καὶ δῆτα καὶ νῦν ἄλλο τι φῶμεν ὁμολογεῖν ἂν τοῦτό γε ὄντινον, τὸ εἶναι σοφώτερον ἕτερον ἐτέρου, εἶναι δὲ καὶ ἀμαθέστερον; ΘΕΟ. ἐμοὶ γοῦν δοκεῖ. ΣΩ. ἦ καὶ ταύτη ἂν μάλιστα ἴστασθαι τὸν λόγον, ἦ

171e

TD: That is how it seems to me, anyway.

171e

S: However, in civic affairs, concerning what is noble and disgraceful, just and unjust, sacred and profane, whatever each city believes and designates as lawful for itself is, in truth, lawful for that city. And in these matters, no citizen is wiser than another citizen, nor is any city wiser than another city. But when it comes to deciding what is advantageous or disadvantageous for itself, in these cases, if at all, the argument will accept that one adviser is superior to another, and the opinion of one city is in truth better than that of another, and would never dare to propose that whatever a city believes to be to its own advantage, and designates as such, will certainly turn out that way. But in the cases I referred to before, just and unjust, sacred and profane, people wish to insist that there is not one of them which by nature has an existence of its own. Instead, they say that whatever seems so to the people becomes true at the time that it seems so, and for as long as it seems so. And even people who do not entirely hold to Protagoras' argument somehow regard this formulation as wisdom. Argument after argument is descending upon us, Theodorus, and larger is emerging from smaller.

ἡμεῖς ὑπεγράψαμεν βοηθοῦντες Πρωταγόρα, ὥς τὰ μὲν πολλὰ ἤ δοκεῖ, ταύτῃ καὶ ἔστιν ἐκάστω, θερμά, ξηρά, γλυκέα, πάντα ὅσα τοῦ τύπου τούτου· εἰ δέ που ἔν τισι συγχωρήσεται διαφέρειν ἄλλον ἄλλου, περὶ τὰ ὑγιεινὰ καὶ νοσώδη ἐθελῆσαι ἂν φάναι μὴ πᾶν γύναιον καὶ παιδίον, καὶ θηρίον δέ, ἰκανὸν εἶναι ἰᾶσθαι αὐτὸ γιγνώσκον ἑαυτῷ τὸ ὑγιεινόν, ἀλλὰ ἐνταῦθα δὴ ἄλλον ἄλλου διαφέρειν, εἴπερ που; ΘΕΟ. ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ οὕτως. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ περὶ πολιτικῶν, καλὰ μὲν καὶ αἰσχρὰ καὶ δίκαια καὶ ἄδικα καὶ ὅσια καὶ μὴ, οἷα ἂν ἐκάστη πόλις οἰηθεῖσα θῆται νόμιμα αὐτῇ, ταῦτα καὶ εἶναι τῇ ἀληθείᾳ ἐκάστη, καὶ ἐν τούτοις μὲν οὐδὲν σοφώτερον οὔτε ἰδιώτην ἰδιώτου οὔτε πόλιν πόλεως εἶναι ἐν δὲ τῷ συμφέροντα ἑαυτῇ ἢ μὴ συμφέροντα τίθεσθαι, ἐνταῦθ', εἴπερ που, αὐτὸ ὁμολογήσει σύμβουλόν τε συμβούλου διαφέρειν καὶ πόλεως δόξαν ἑτέραν ἑτέρας πρὸς ἀλήθειαν, καὶ οὐκ ἂν πάνυ τολμήσειε φῆσαι, ἃ ἂν

θῆται πόλις συμφέροντα οἰηθεῖσα αὐτῇ, παντὸς μᾶλλον ταῦτα καὶ συνοίσειν· ἀλλ' ἐκεῖ οὐ λέγω, ἐν τοῖς δικαίοις καὶ ἀδίκτοις καὶ ὁσίοις καὶ ἀνοσίοις, ἐθέλουσιν ἰσχυρίζεσθαι ὥς οὐκ ἔστι φύσει αὐτῶν οὐδὲν οὐσίαν ἑαυτοῦ ἔχον, ἀλλὰ τὸ κοινῇ δόξαν τοῦτο γίγνεται ἀληθές τότε, ὅταν δόξη καὶ ὅσον ἂν δοκῇ χρόνον. καὶ ὅσοι γε ἂν μὴ παντάπασιν τὸν Πρωταγόρου λόγον λέγωσιν, ὧδέ πως τὴν σοφίαν ἄγουσι. λόγος δὲ ἡμᾶς, ὃ Θεόδωρε, ἐκ λόγου μείζων ἐξ ἐλάττονος

172c

TD: But haven't we plenty of free time, Socrates?

172c

S: It appears that we do, yes. And I have often reflected, my blessed friend, at one time or another, and indeed just now, that those who spend a lot of time in philosophic pursuits naturally prove to be amusing speakers if they end up in courts of law.

172c

TD: What do you mean by that?

172c

S: Those who have been hanging around law courts and such places from their younger years will surely seem like slaves rather than free-born men when compared to those brought up in philosophy and kindred pursuits.

καταλαμβάνει. ΘΕΟ. οὐκοῦν σχολὴν ἄγομεν, ὃ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. φαινόμεθα. καὶ πολλάκις μὲν γε δῆ, ὃ δαιμόνιε, καὶ ἄλλοτε κατενόησα, ἀτὰρ καὶ νῦν, ὥς εἰκότως οἱ ἐν ταῖς φιλοσοφίαις πολὺν χρόνον διατρίψαντες εἰς τὰ δικαστήρια ἰόντες γελοῖοι φαίνονται ῥήτορες. ΘΕΟ. πῶς δῆ οὖν λέγεις; ΣΩ. κινδυνεύουσιν οἱ ἐν δικαστηρίοις καὶ τοῖς τοιούτοις ἐκ νέων κυλινδούμενοι πρὸς τοὺς ἐν φιλοσοφίᾳ καὶ τῇ

172d

TD: But in what way?

172d

S: In the sense that the philosophers have the free time, which you mentioned, and they hold their discussions peacefully and in their own

time, just as we are doing now, taking up argument after argument. Indeed, we are already on our third. They can do exactly the same as us if a new topic interests them more than the current one, and they will not care at all whether the discussion be long or short, if only they may encounter what is.

But the other sort always speak under pressure of time, from the water that flows from the clock,²⁶ and they are not allowed to make speeches on matters close to their hearts. Their opponent stands over them, armed with compulsion and a written document that deals with every issue, from which they cannot depart. Their words are always about a fellow slave, addressed to a master who sits with some charge in his hands, and their disputes are not of a general nature, but the issue is always personal, and his life is often at stake. And in consequence of all this they become intense and shrewd, knowing how to flatter their master in words and beguile him in deed, but their souls become small and warped.

Slavishness from youth upwards has removed their growth, uprightness and freedom, and forced them into crooked ways, casting huge perils and trepidations on their still tender souls, which they are unable to bear with justice and truth. They turn directly to falsehood and mutual injustice, and are utterly bowed down and confined. The result is that they turn out as men who from childhood upwards are devoid of health of mind, though they believe that they have become clever and wise. So that is the sort of men they are, Theodorus. But what do you want to say about men of our sort? Do you want us to describe them, or leave the matter and return again to the argument in case we very much abuse this freedom in switching between topics that we referred to just now?

τοιᾶδε διατριβῇ τεθραμμένους ὥς οἰκέται πρὸς ἐλευθέρους τεθράφθαι.
ΘΕΟ. πῇ δὴ; ΣΩ. ἥι τοῖς μὲν τοῦτο ὃ σὺ εἶπες ἀεὶ πάρεστι, σχολή, καὶ τοὺς
λόγους ἐν εἰρήνῃ ἐπὶ σχολῆς ποιοῦνται· ὥσπερ ἡμεῖς νυνὶ τρίτον ἤδη

λόγον ἐκ λόγου μεταλαμβάνομεν, οὕτω κάκεινοι, ἐὰν αὐτοὺς ὁ ἐπελθὼν τοῦ προκειμένου μᾶλλον καθάπερ ἡμᾶς ἀρέσῃ· καὶ διὰ μακρῶν ἢ βραχέων μέλει οὐδὲν λέγειν, ἂν μόνον τύχῃ τοῦ ὄντος· οἱ δὲ ἐν ἀσχολίᾳ τε αἰεὶ λέγουσι—κατεπείγει γὰρ ὕδωρ ῥέον—καὶ οὐκ ἐγγωρεῖ περὶ οὗ ἂν ἐπιθυμήσωσι τοὺς λόγους ποιεῖσθαι, ἀλλ’ ἀνάγκην ἔχων ὁ ἀντίδικος ἐφέστηκεν καὶ ὑπογραφὴν παραναγιγνώσκομένην ὦν ἐκτὸς οὐ ῥητέον ἦν ἀντωμοσίαν καλοῦσιν· οἱ δὲ λόγοι αἰεὶ περὶ ὁμοδούλου πρὸς δεσπότην καθήμενον, ἐν χειρί τινα δίκην ἔχοντα, καὶ οἱ ἀγῶνες οὐδέποτε τὴν ἄλλως ἀλλ’ αἰεὶ τὴν περὶ αὐτοῦ, πολλάκις δὲ καὶ περὶ ψυχῆς ὁ δρόμος· ὥστ’ ἐξ ἀπάντων τούτων ἔντονται καὶ δριμεῖς γίνονται, ἐπιστάμενοι τὸν δεσπότην λόγῳ τε θωπεῦσαι καὶ ἔργῳ ὑπελθεῖν, σμικροὶ δὲ καὶ οὐκ ὀρθοὶ τὰς ψυχάς. ΣΩ. τὴν γὰρ αὖξιν καὶ τὸ εὐθύ τε καὶ τὸ ἐλευθέριον ἢ ἐκ νέων δουλείᾳ ἀφήρηται, ἀναγκάζουσα πράττειν σκολιά, μεγάλους κινδύνους καὶ φόβους ἔτι ἀπαλαῖς ψυχαῖς ἐπιβάλλουσα, οὓς οὐ δυνάμενοι μετὰ τοῦ δικαίου καὶ ἀληθοῦς ὑποφέρειν, εὐθύς ἐπὶ τὸ ψευδὸς τε καὶ τὸ ἀλλήλους ἀνταδικεῖν τρεπόμενοι πολλὰ κάμπτονται καὶ συγκλῶνται, ὥσθ’ ὕγιες οὐδὲν ἔχοντες τῆς διανοίας εἰς ἄνδρας ἐκ μεираκίων τελευτῶσι, δεινοὶ τε καὶ σοφοὶ γεγονότες, ὡς οἴονται. καὶ οὗτοι μὲν δὴ τοιοῦτοι, ὧ Θεόδωρε· τοὺς δὲ τοῦ ἡμετέρου χοροῦ πότερον βούλει διελθόντες ἢ ἐάσαντες πάλιν ἐπὶ τὸν λόγον τρεπώμεθα, ἵνα μὴ καί, ὃ νυνδὴ ἐλέγομεν, λίαν πολὺ τῇ ἐλευθερίᾳ καὶ μεταλήψει τῶν λόγων καταχρώμεθα; ΘΕΟ. μηδαμῶς, ὧ Σώκρατες, ἀλλὰ διελθόντες. πάνυ

173c

TD: Certainly not, Socrates. I want us to describe them! Indeed, you expressed this very well. We who move in such circles are not servants to these arguments, but our arguments are just like our servants, and each of them must wait to be concluded whenever we see fit. Nor, in fact, is there any jury or audience evaluating or dominating us, as if we were playwrights.

173c

S: Well, since that is your view, it seems we should talk about the best of them, for what could anyone say about the mediocre exemplars of

philosophy anyway? But the best of them, from their early years, do not even know the way to the Agora, nor the whereabouts of the law courts or the Council Chamber or any other public meeting place in the city. They neither hear the edicts being proclaimed nor look at the laws when they are written. They would not even dream of involvement with political parties struggling for power, alliances, banquets or revelling with flute-girls. Whether someone in the city is high-born or low-born, or there is some problem with their ancestry, male or female, concerns him no more than the number of pints in the ocean, as they say. Indeed, he does not even know that he does not know about these matters, for he does not avoid them for the sake of reputation, but in truth it is only his body that is situated in the city as a visitor, while his mind regards all this as small and insignificant, despises it and takes flight, as Pindar says, “above the heavens and beneath the earth”, measuring the earth’s vast surfaces, studying the stars, and searching out in every way the complete nature of each whole among the things that are, never lowering itself to anything that is near at hand.

γὰρ εὖ τοῦτο εἴρηκας, ὅτι οὐχ ἡμεῖς οἱ ἐν τῷ τοιῷδε χορεύοντες τῶν λόγων ὑπηρετάι, ἀλλ’ οἱ λόγοι ἡμέτεροι ὥσπερ οἰκέται, καὶ ἕκαστος αὐτῶν περιμένει ἀποτελεσθῆναι ὅταν ἡμῖν δοκῇ· οὔτε γὰρ δικαστῆς οὔτε θεατῆς ὥσπερ ποιηταῖς ἐπιτιμήσων τε καὶ ἄρξων ἐπιστατεῖ παρ’ ἡμῖν. ΣΩ. λέγωμεν δὴ, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἐπεὶ σοί γε δοκεῖ, περὶ τῶν κορυφαίων· τί γὰρ ἂν τις τοὺς γε φαύλως διατρίβοντας ἐν φιλοσοφίᾳ λέγοι; οὗτοι δὲ που ἐκ νέων πρῶτον μὲν εἰς ἀγορὰν οὐκ ἴσασι τὴν ὁδόν, οὐδὲ ὅπου δικαστήριον ἢ βουλευτήριον ἢ τι κοινὸν ἄλλο τῆς πόλεως συνέδριον· νόμους δὲ καὶ ψηφίσματα λεγόμενα ἢ γεγραμμένα οὔτε ὁρῶσιν οὔτε ἀκούουσι· σπουδαὶ δὲ ἐταιριῶν ἐπ’ ἀρχὰς καὶ σύνοδοι καὶ δεῖπνα καὶ σὺν αὐλητρίσι κῶμοι, οὐδὲ ὄναρ πράττειν προσίσταται αὐτοῖς. εὖ δὲ ἢ κακῶς τις γέγονεν ἐν πόλει, ἢ τί τῷ κακόν ἐστιν ἐκ προγόνων γεγονὸς ἢ πρὸς ἀνδρῶν ἢ γυναικῶν, μᾶλλον αὐτὸν λέληθεν ἢ οἱ τῆς θαλάττης λεγόμενοι χόρες. καὶ ταῦτα πάντ’ οὐδ’ ὅτι οὐκ οἶδεν, οἶδεν· οὐδὲ γὰρ αὐτῶν ἀπέχεται τοῦ εὐδοκιμεῖν χάριν, ἀλλὰ τῷ ὄντι τὸ

σῶμα μόνον ἐν τῇ πόλει κεῖται αὐτοῦ καὶ ἐπιδημεῖ, ἡ δὲ διάνοια, ταῦτα πάντα ἡγήσαμένη σμικρὰ καὶ οὐδέν, ἀτιμάσασα πανταχῇ πέτεται κατὰ Πίνδαρον τᾶς τε γᾶς ὑπένερθε καὶ τὰ ἐπίπεδα γεωμετροῦσα, οὐρανοῦ θ' ὑπερ ἀστρονομοῦσα,

174a

TD: What do you mean by this, Socrates?

174a

S: One example, Theodorus, is the case of Thales,²⁷ who fell into a well as he was gazing up at the stars, and some clever and witty Thracian maidservant mocked him, saying that he was so eager to know what was in the sky that he forgot about what was right there under his feet. Now, the same gibe will apply to everyone whose life is spent in philosophy. Indeed, such a person will actually be unaware of his next-door neighbour, not only of what the man does, but even whether he is human at all, or some other creature. What precisely man is, and what action or response is appropriate to human nature and distinguishes man from other creatures? This is his search, and these are the questions he is at pains to answer. I presume you understand now, Theodorus. Do you?

καὶ πᾶσαν πάντη φύσιν ἐρευνωμένη τῶν ὄντων ἐκάστου ὅλου, εἰς τῶν ἐγγύς οὐδὲν αὐτὴν συγκαθειῖσα. ΘΕΟ. πῶς τοῦτο λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. ὥσπερ καὶ Θαλῆν ἀστρονομοῦντα, ὦ Θεόδωρε, καὶ ἄνω βλέποντα, πεσόντα εἰς φρέαρ, Θραῦττά τις ἐμμελῆς καὶ χαρίεσσα θεραπαινὶς ἀποσκῶψαι λέγεται ὡς τὰ μὲν ἐν οὐρανῷ προθυμοῖτο εἰδέναι, τὰ δ' ἔμπροσθεν αὐτοῦ καὶ παρὰ πόδας λανθάνει αὐτόν. ταῦτόν δὲ ἀρκεῖ σκῶμμα ἐπὶ πάντας

174b

TD: I do indeed, and what you are saying is true.

ὅσοι ἐν φιλοσοφίᾳ διάγουσι. τῷ γὰρ ὄντι τὸν τοιοῦτον ὁ μὲν πλησίον καὶ ὁ γείτων λέληθεν, οὐ μόνον ὅτι πράττει, ἀλλ' ὀλίγου καὶ εἰ ἄνθρωπός ἐστιν ἢ τι ἄλλο θρέμμα· τί δέ ποτ' ἐστὶν ἄνθρωπος καὶ τί τῇ τοιαύτῃ φύσει προσήκει διάφορον τῶν ἄλλων ποιεῖν ἢ πάσχειν, ζητεῖ τε

καὶ πράγματ' ἔχει διερευνώμενος. μανθάνεις γάρ που, ὦ Θεόδωρε· ἢ οὐ;
 ΘΕΟ. ἔγωγε· καὶ ἀληθῆ λέγεις. ΣΩ. τοιγάρτοι, ὦ φίλε, ἰδίᾳ τε
 συγγιγνόμενος ὁ τοιοῦτος

174c

S: Therefore, my friend, such a person will provide amusement not only to Thracian girls but to the world in general, when he meets someone privately or in public, as I said in the beginning, and is compelled to discuss matters under his feet or before his eyes, in a courtroom or anywhere else. Through inexperience he falls into wells, and all manner of perplexity, and his clumsiness is terrible, giving rise to a reputation for silliness. Of course when it comes to slander, he has nothing special to say against anyone since he does not know anything bad about anyone, having never been interested in such matters, and being at a loss he becomes a figure of fun. When he hears the praises and the proud boasts of others, he is conspicuous for his unfeigned, genuine laughter that makes him seem ridiculous. And, indeed, when a tyrant or king is being praised, he believes he is hearing one of the stock-keepers, such as a swineherd or shepherd or some dairyman, being congratulated on a high milk yield, and he thinks that the rulers tend and exploit a more difficult and treacherous creature than the stock-keepers, and that his own busyness renders a king as uncouth and ill-educated within his city walls as any shepherd in a mountain enclosure.

Whenever the philosopher hears that someone has acquired an astonishing amount of land, as he has acquired thousands of acres or even more, he thinks it but a trifle, as he is accustomed to viewing the earth in its entirety. And when they sing the praises of families, as though someone is a nobleman if they have seven wealthy grandfathers to their credit, he thinks that the speaker is utterly dim, and partial in his view, as his lack of education renders him unable to see the universal, or to figure out that each person has had countless thousands of grandfathers and ancestors. Among them, in every case,

there were often rich and poor, kings and slaves, non-Greeks and Greeks, in their thousands. So boasting about a list of twenty-five ancestors stretching back to Heracles, the son of Amphitryon, appears remarkably small-minded to him, and he laughs because they cannot banish petty vanity from their unthinking soul by working out that the twenty-fifth descendant of Amphitryon was such a man as fate decreed he should be, and the fiftieth will be so too.

Now, in all these cases the philosopher will be derided by the world, partly because he seems to be above it all, and partly due to his ignorance and perplexity in the particulars of daily life.

ἐκάστῳ καὶ δημοσίᾳ, ὅπερ ἀρχόμενος ἔλεγον, ὅταν ἐν δικαστηρίῳ ἢ που ἄλλοθι ἀναγκασθῇ περὶ τῶν παρὰ πόδας καὶ τῶν ἐν ὀφθαλμοῖς διαλέγεσθαι, γέλῳτα παρέχει οὐ μόνον θράτταις ἀλλὰ καὶ τῷ ἄλλῳ ὅλῳ, εἰς φρέατά τε καὶ πᾶσαν ἀπορίαν ἐμπίπτων ὑπὸ ἀπειρίας, καὶ ἡ ἀσχημοσύνη δεινὴ, δόξαν ἀβελτερίας παρεχομένη· ἐν τε γὰρ ταῖς λοιδορίαις ἴδιον ἔχει οὐδὲν οὐδένα λοιδορεῖν, ἅτ' οὐκ εἰδὼς κακὸν οὐδὲν οὐδενὸς ἐκ τοῦ μὴ μεμελετηκέναι· ἀπορῶν οὖν γελοῖος φαίνεται. ἐν τε τοῖς ἐπαίνοις καὶ ταῖς τῶν ἄλλων μεγαλαυχίαις οὐ προσποιήτως ἀλλὰ τῷ ὄντι γελῶν ἐνδηλος γιγνόμενος ληρώδης δοκεῖ εἶναι. τύραννόν τε γὰρ ἢ βασιλέα ἐγκωμιαζόμενον, ἕνα τῶν νομέων, οἷον συβώτην ἢ ποιμένα ἢ τινα βουκόλον, ἡγεῖται ἀκούειν εὐδαιμονιζόμενον πολὺ βδάλλοντα· δυσκολώτερον δὲ ἐκείνων ζῶον καὶ ἐπιβουλότερον ποιμαίνειν τε καὶ βδάλλειν νομίζει αὐτούς, ἄγροικον δὲ καὶ ἀπαίδευτον ὑπὸ ἀσχολίας οὐδὲν ἤττον τῶν νομέων τὸν τοιοῦτον ἀναγκαῖον γίγνεσθαι, σηκὸν ἐν ὄρει τὸ τεῖχος περιβεβλημένον. γῆς δὲ ὅταν μυρία πλέθρα ἢ ἔτι πλείω ἀκούσῃ ὥς τις ἄρα κεκτημένος θαυμαστὰ πλήθει κέκτηται, πάνσμικρα δοκεῖ ἀκούειν εἰς ἅπασαν εἰώθως τὴν γῆν βλέπειν. ΣΩ. τὰ δὲ δὴ γένη ὑμνούντων, ὡς γενναῖός τις ἐπὶ πάππους πλουσίους ἔχων ἀποφῆναι, παντάπασιν ἀμβλὺ καὶ ἐπὶ σμικρὸν ὀρώντων ἡγεῖται τὸν ἔπαινον, ὑπὸ ἀπαιδευσίας οὐ δυναμένων εἰς τὸ πᾶν αἰεὶ βλέπειν οὐδὲ λογίζεσθαι ὅτι πάππων καὶ προγόνων μυριάδες ἐκάστῳ γεγόνασιν ἀναρίθμητοι, ἐν αἷς πλούσιοι

καὶ πτωχοὶ καὶ βασιλῆς καὶ δοῦλοι βάρβαροί τε καὶ Ἕλληνες πολλάκις μυρίοι γεγόνασιν ὁτῶοῦν· ἀλλ' ἐπὶ πέντε καὶ εἴκοσι καταλόγῳ προγόνων σεμνυνομένων καὶ ἀναφερόντων εἰς Ἡρακλέα τὸν Ἀμφιτρύωνος ἄτοπα αὐτῷ καταφαίνεται τῆς μικρολογίας, ὅτι

175b

TD: You are describing the situation very comprehensively, Socrates.

175b

S: However, my friend, the philosopher may sometimes draw someone upwards, and the person may wish, through him, to go beyond “What injustice have I done to you, or you to me?”, in favour of examining justice and injustice themselves, what each is in itself, and what distinguishes them from all else and from one another. Or he may go beyond “Is the king happy?”, “Is a wealthy man happy?”, and enquire into kingship and human happiness and misery in general, and what sort of states they both are, and the manner in which it is appropriate for a human being to acquire the one and avoid the other. Now, when that shrewd and litigious little soul must in turn give an account of all these matters, then the situation is again reversed. He is dizzy and suspended from on high. Looking down from the sky above, he is both troubled and perplexed by the strange experience. And his stammering provides no amusement to the girls from Thrace or any uneducated folk, since they are unaware of his plight. No, he amuses all who have been brought up, not in the manner of slaves, but the exact opposite.

There they are, Theodorus, the dispositions of the two types of men. One has been truly brought up in freedom and leisure, and you obviously call him a philosopher, to whom it is no disgrace to seem simple-minded and of no account when he encounters the menial tasks of a slave, and does not know how to tidy up bedclothes or make flavoursome food or a flattering speech. The other type can render all such services efficiently and promptly, but knows not how to dress like a free man or take the harmony of discourse, and sing the praises of the life of the gods or of blessed men.

δὲ ὁ ἀπ' Ἀμφιτρύωνος εἰς τὸ ἄνω πεντεκαεικοστὸς τοιοῦτος ἦν οἷα συνέβαινε αὐτῷ τύχη, καὶ ὁ πεντηκοστὸς ἀπ' αὐτοῦ, γελᾷ οὐ δυναμένων λογίζεσθαι τε καὶ χαυνότητα ἀνοήτου ψυχῆς ἀπαλλάττειν. ἐν ἅπασι δὴ τούτοις ὁ τοιοῦτος ὑπὸ τῶν πολλῶν καταγελάται, τὰ μὲν ὑπερηφάνως ἔχων, ὡς δοκεῖ, τὰ δ' ἐν ποσὶν ἀγνοῶν τε καὶ ἐν ἐκάστοις ἀπορῶν. ΘΕΟ. παντάπασι τὰ γινόμενα λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ὅταν δέ γέ τινα αὐτός, ὦ φίλε, ἐλκύσῃ ἄνω, καὶ ἐθελήσῃ τις αὐτῷ ἐκβῆναι ἐκ τοῦ τί ἐγὼ σὲ ἀδικῶ ἢ σὺ ἐμέ; εἰς σκέψιν αὐτῆς δικαιοσύνης τε καὶ ἀδικίας, τί τε ἐκάτερον αὐτοῖν καὶ τί τῶν πάντων ἢ ἀλλήλων διαφέρετον, ἢ ἐκ τοῦ εἰ βασιλεὺς εὐδαίμων, κεκτημένος τ' αὖ χρυσίον, βασιλείας πέρι καὶ ἀνθρωπίνης ὅλως εὐδαιμονίας καὶ ἀθλιότητος ἐπὶ σκέψιν, ποίῳ τέ τινε ἐστὸν καὶ τίνα τρόπον ἀνθρώπου φύσει προσήκει τὸ μὲν κτήσασθαι αὐτοῖν, τὸ δὲ ἀποφυγεῖν—περὶ τούτων ἀπάντων ὅταν αὖ δέῃ λόγον διδόναι τὸν σμικρὸν ἐκεῖνον τὴν ψυχὴν καὶ δριμὺν καὶ δικανικόν, πάλιν αὖ τὰ ἀντίστροφα ἀποδίδωσιν· ἐιλιγγίων τε ἀπὸ ὑψηλοῦ κρεμασθεῖς καὶ βλέπων μετέωρος ἄνωθεν ὑπὸ ἀηθείας ἀδημονῶν τε καὶ ἀπορῶν καὶ βατταρίζων γέλωτα θράτταις μὲν οὐ παρέχει οὐδ' ἄλλω ἀπαιδεύτῳ οὐδενί, οὐ γὰρ αἰσθάνονται, τοῖς δ' ἐναντίως ἢ ὡς ἀνδραπόδοις τραφεῖσι πᾶσιν. οὗτος δὲ ἐκατέρου τρόπος, ὦ Θεόδωρε, ὁ μὲν τῷ ὄντι ἐν ἐλευθερίᾳ τε καὶ σχολῇ τεθραμμένον, ὃν δὴ φιλόσοφον καλεῖς, ὃ ἀνεμέσητον εὐήθει δοκεῖν καὶ οὐδενὶ εἶναι ὅταν εἰς δουρικὰ ἐμπέσῃ διακονήματα, οἷον στρωματόδεσμον μὴ ἐπισταμένου συσκευάσασθαι μηδὲ ὄψον ἡδῦναι ἢ θῶπας λόγους· ὁ δ' αὖ τὰ μὲν τοιαῦτα πάντα δυναμένου τὸρῶς τε καὶ ὀξέως διακονεῖν, ἀναβάλλεσθαι δὲ οὐκ ἐπισταμένου ἐπιδέξια ἐλευθερίως οὐδέ γ' ἁρμονίαν λόγων

176a

TD: Socrates, if you were to persuade everyone with your words, as you have persuaded me, there would be more peace and less trouble among men.

176a

S: But evils cannot be eradicated, Theodorus, for there must always be something in opposition to the good. Neither can they be situated

among the gods, but they must haunt the mortal nature and prowl about the earth. So we should endeavour to flee from here to there as quickly as we can, and to flee is to be as like unto God as we can, and to be like God is to become just and holy with the help of wisdom. However, my friend, it is not very easy to convince people that the reasons we should be pursuing excellence and avoiding vice are not the reasons the world gives – namely, that we should practise the one and avoid the other so that we are reputed to be good men and not bad. This actually sounds to me like the idle talk of old women, as they say. So, we should speak the truth, which is that God is not unjust in any way whatsoever, but is as just as it is possible to be, and there is no one more like unto God than the person among us who has, in turn, become as just as possible. And therein lies the true measure of a man's accomplishment, and indeed his worthlessness and inhumanity, for knowledge of this is wisdom and true excellence, while ignorance of this is folly and manifest vice. Any other seeming accomplishment or wisdom is vulgar in the case of political sovereignty, and commonplace when it comes to the other arts. Therefore, it is best by far not to concede to an evildoer, or one whose words or deeds are unholy, that his roguery is an accomplishment, for they delight in that reproach and fancy they are hearing not that they are ridiculous burdens to the earth, but men well fitted for survival in the city. So the truth must be spoken, that they are the sort of people they believe they are not, and all the more so because they do not believe so. Indeed, they are ignorant of the penalty for injustice, which is the last thing they should be ignorant of. For the penalty is not what they think it is, scourging or execution, which offenders sometimes avoid suffering. No, this is a penalty that cannot be avoided.

λαβόντος ὀρθῶς ὑμῆσαι θεῶν τε καὶ ἀνδρῶν εὐδαιμόνων βίον ἀληθῆ. ΘΕΟ. εἰ πάντας, ὦ Σώκρατες, πείθοις ἃ λέγεις ὥσπερ ἐμέ, πλείων ἂν εἰρήνη καὶ κακὰ ἐλάττω κατ' ἀνθρώπους εἴη. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' οὐτ' ἀπολέσθαι τὰ κακὰ δυνατόν, ὦ Θεόδωρε— ὑπεναντίον γάρ τι τῷ ἀγαθῷ ἀεὶ εἶναι ἀνάγκη—οὐτ' ἐν θεοῖς αὐτὰ ἰδρῦσθαι, τὴν δὲ θνητὴν φύσιν καὶ τόνδε

τὸν τόπον περιπολεῖ ἐξ ἀνάγκης, διὸ καὶ πειραῖσθαι χρή ἐνθένδε ἐκεῖσε φεύγειν ὅτι τάχιστα. φυγὴ δὲ ὁμοίωσις θεῷ κατὰ τὸ δυνατόν· ὁμοίωσις δὲ δίκαιον καὶ ὅσιον μετὰ φρονήσεως γενέσθαι. ἀλλὰ γάρ, ὦ ἄριστε, οὐ πάνυ τι ῥάδιον πεῖσαι ὥς ἄρα οὐχ ὧν ἔνεκα οἱ πολλοὶ φασι δεῖν πονηρίαν μὲν φεύγειν, ἀρετὴν δὲ διώκειν, τούτων χάριν τὸ μὲν ἐπιτηδεύτεον, τὸ δ' οὐ, ἵνα δὴ μὴ κακὸς καὶ ἵνα ἀγαθὸς δοκῇ εἶναι· ταῦτα μὲν γάρ ἐστιν ὁ λεγόμενος γραῶν ὕθλος, ὥς ἐμοὶ φαίνεται· τὸ δὲ ἀληθὲς ὧδε λέγωμεν. θεὸς οὐδαμῇ οὐδαμῶς ἄδικος, ἀλλ' ὥς οἶόν τε δικαιοτάτος, καὶ οὐκ ἔστιν αὐτῷ ὁμοιότερον οὐδὲν ἢ ὅς ἂν ἡμῶν αὐτὸ γένηται ὅτι δικαιοτάτος. περὶ τοῦτο καὶ ἡ ὥς ἀληθῶς δεινότης ἀνδρὸς καὶ οὐδενία τε καὶ ἀνανδρία. ἡ μὲν γὰρ τούτου γνῶσις σοφία καὶ ἀρετὴ ἀληθινή, ἡ δὲ ἄγνοια ἀμαθία καὶ κακία ἐναργής· αἱ δ' ἄλλαι δεινότητές τε δοκοῦσαι καὶ σοφαί· ἐν μὲν πολιτικαῖς δυναστεαῖς γιγνόμεναι φορτικάι, ἐν δὲ τέχναις βάνανσοι. τῷ οὖν ἀδικοῦντι καὶ ἀνόσια λέγοντι ἢ πράττοντι μακρῷ ἄριστ' ἔχει τὸ μὴ συγχωρεῖν δεινῷ ὑπὸ πανουργίας εἶναι· ἀγάλλονται γὰρ τῷ ὀνειδίει καὶ οἶονται ἀκούειν ὅτι οὐ λῆροί εἰσι, γῆς ἄλλως ἄχθη, ἀλλ' ἄνδρες οἷους δεῖ ἐν πόλει τοὺς σωθησομένους. λεκτέον οὖν τάληθές, ὅτι τοσοῦτ' ἄλλ' οἶοι οὐκ οἶονται, ὅτι οὐχὶ οἶονται· ἀγνοοῦσι γὰρ ζημίαν ἀδικίας, ὃ δεῖ ἥκιστα ἀγνοεῖν. οὐ γάρ ἐστιν ἦν δοκοῦσιν, πληγαὶ τε καὶ θάνατοι, ὧν ἐνίστε πάσχουσιν

176e

TD: What penalty do you mean?

176e

S: There are two patterns established in what is – one of divine blessedness, the other of godless wretchedness – but they do not see that this is how things are. So, through their foolishness and utter mindlessness, they fail to realise that because of unjust actions they are becoming like one pattern and unlike the other. So their lives are like the pattern they resemble, and that is the penalty they pay. But if we should tell them that unless they set aside their accomplishment, the place that is pure of evils will not receive them when they die – but they will continue in their own pattern of living, evil men among

their own kind – they will listen to us as though we were mindless folk addressing clever rogues.

οὐδὲν ἀδικοῦντες, ἀλλὰ ἦν ἀδύνατον ἐκφυγεῖν. ΘΕΟ. τίνα δὴ λέγεις; ΣΩ. παραδειγμάτων, ὧ φίλε, ἐν τῷ ὄντι ἐστώτων, τοῦ μὲν θείου εὐδαιμονεστάτου, τοῦ δὲ ἀθέου ἀθλιωτάτου, οὐχ ὁρῶντες ὅτι οὕτως ἔχει, ὑπὸ ἡλιθιότητός τε καὶ τῆς ἐσχάτης

177a

TD: They certainly will, Socrates!

ἀνοίας λανθάνουσι τῷ μὲν ὁμοιούμενοι διὰ τὰς ἀδίκους πράξεις, τῷ δὲ ἀνομοιούμενοι. οὗ δὴ τίνουσι δίκην ζῶντες τὸν εἰκότα βίον ὧ ὁμοιοῦνται· ἐὰν δ' εἴπωμεν ὅτι, ἂν μὴ ἀπαλλαγῶσι τῆς δεινότητος, καὶ τελευτήσαντας αὐτοὺς ἐκεῖνος μὲν ὁ τῶν κακῶν καθαρὸς τόπος οὐ δέξεται, ἐνθάδε δὲ τὴν αὐτοῖς ὁμοιότητα τῆς διαγωγῆς ἀεὶ ἔξουσι, κακοὶ κακοῖς συνόντες, ταῦτα δὴ καὶ παντάπασιν ὡς δεινοὶ καὶ πανοῦργοι ἀνοήτων τινῶν ἀκούσονται. ΘΕΟ. καὶ μάλα δὴ, ὦ Σώκρατες.

177b

S: Yes, my friend, I know. However, there is one thing that happens to them in private whenever they must present an argument, and accept one in return, about the matters they disparage, and are prepared to persist manfully for an extended duration without running away like cowards. Strangely, my dear friend, they end up dissatisfied with what they themselves are saying, and their eloquence somehow dries up, so that they seem no different from children. Now, let us call a halt, since this is really a digression. Otherwise, the continued influx of issues will overwhelm our initial discussion. So if you agree, let's return to the previous topic.

ΣΩ. οἶδά τοι, ὦ ἑταῖρε. ἐν μέντοι τι αὐτοῖς συμβέβηκεν· ὅταν ἰδίᾳ λόγον δέῃ δοῦναι τε καὶ δέξασθαι περὶ ὧν ψέγουσι, καὶ ἐθελήσωσιν ἀνδρικῶς πολὺν χρόνον ὑπομεῖναι καὶ μὴ ἀνάνδρως φυγεῖν, τότε ἀτόπως, ὧ δαιμόνιε, τελευτῶντες οὐκ ἀρέσκουσιν αὐτοὶ αὐτοῖς περὶ ὧν λέγουσι, καὶ ἡ ῥητορική ἐκείνη πῶς ἀπομαρτάνεται, ὥστε παίδων μὴδὲν δοκεῖν

διαφέρειν. περὶ μὲν οὖν τούτων, ἐπειδὴ καὶ πάρεργα τυγχάνει λεγόμενα, ἀποστῶμεν—εἰ δὲ μή, πλείω

177c

TD: A digression like this makes quite pleasant listening for me, Socrates, since it is easier to follow at my age. However, let us go back to the other discussion again if you think fit.

177c

S: Well, I believe we were at a point in the discussion at which we said that the people who declare that being is in motion – and that whatever seems is for the person to whom it seems – are in general prepared to assert this confidently. And especially in the case of justice, they state most emphatically that whatever a city regards as just, and decrees to be just, is just for that city for as long as the decree remains in force. However, when it comes to what's good, there is no one so heroic that he would also dare to contend that whatever a city believes to be beneficial for itself, and decrees to be so, is actually beneficial for as long as the decree stands, unless he is referring to the mere name. But that would be making a joke of our discussion, wouldn't it?

ἀεὶ ἐπιρρέοντα καταχώσει ἡμῶν τὸν ἐξ ἀρχῆς λόγον—ἐπὶ δὲ τὰ ἔμπροσθεν ἴωμεν, εἰ καὶ σοὶ δοκεῖ. ΘΕΟ. ἐμοὶ μὲν τὰ τοιαῦτα, ὦ Σώκρατες, οὐκ ἀηδέστερα ἀκούειν· ῥάω γὰρ τηλικῶδε ὄντι ἐπακολουθεῖν. εἰ μέντοι δοκεῖ, πάλιν ἐπανίωμεν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἐνταῦθά που ἦμεν τοῦ λόγου, ἐν ᾧ ἔφαμεν τοὺς τὴν φερομένην οὐσίαν λέγοντας, καὶ τὸ ἀεὶ δοκοῦν ἐκάστω τοῦτο καὶ εἶναι τούτῳ ᾧ δοκεῖ, ἐν μὲν τοῖς ἄλλοις ἐθέλειν διισχυρίζεσθαι καὶ οὐχ ἥκιστα περὶ τὰ δίκαια, ὥς

177d

TD: It surely would.

παντὸς μᾶλλον ἢ ἂν θῆται πόλις δόξαντα αὐτῇ, ταῦτα καὶ ἔστι δίκαια τῇ θεμένῃ, ἕωσπερ ἂν κέηται· περὶ δὲ τὰγαθὰ οὐδένα ἀνδρεῖον ἔθ' οὕτως εἶναι ὥστε τολμᾶν διαμάχεσθαι ὅτι καὶ ἢ ἂν ὠφέλιμα οἰηθεῖσα πόλις ἐαυτῇ θῆται, καὶ ἔστι τοσοῦτον χρόνον ὅσον ἂν κέηται ὠφέλιμα, πλὴν

εἴ τις τὸ ὄνομα λέγοι· τοῦτο δέ που σκῶμ' ἂν εἴη πρὸς ὃ λέγομεν. ἢ οὐχί; ΘΕΟ. πάνυ γε.

177e

S: Yes, he should not refer to the mere name, but should consider the thing that is being named.

177e

TD: Of course.

177e

S: But whatever name it is given, a city surely legislates and enacts all the laws with the aim of maximising the benefit to itself, according to its understanding and ability. Or does it look to some other factor when it legislates?

177e

TD: Not at all.

ΣΩ. μὴ γὰρ λεγέτω τὸ ὄνομα, ἀλλὰ τὸ πρᾶγμα τὸ ὀνομαζόμενον θεωρεῖτω. ΘΕΟ. μὴ γάρ. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ὃ ἂν τοῦτο ὀνομάζη, τούτου δήπου στοχάζεται νομοθετουμένη, καὶ πάντας τοὺς νόμους, καθ' ὅσον οἴεται τε καὶ δύναται, ὥς ὠφελιμωτάτους ἑαυτῇ τίθεται· ἢ πρὸς ἄλλο τι βλέπουσα νομοθετεῖται;

178a

S: Now, does each city always succeed, or do they also frequently miss the mark?

178a

TD: Well, I think they also miss the mark.

178a

S: Then again, anyone at all might accept these same points more readily if someone were to ask about the entire kind to which benefit also belongs, and that, I believe, involves future time. For whenever we legislate, we enact laws that will be beneficial in time to come, and this we would properly designate as 'future'.

178a

TD: Yes, certainly.

ΘΕΟ. οὐδαμῶς. ΣΩ. ἢ οὖν καὶ τυγχάνει αἰεὶ, ἢ πολλὰ καὶ διαμαρτάνει ἐκάστη; ΘΕΟ. οἶμαι ἔγωγε καὶ ἀμαρτάνειν. ΣΩ. ἔτι τοίνυν ἐνθένδε ἂν μᾶλλον πᾶς τις ὁμολογήσειεν ταῦτα ταῦτα, εἰ περὶ παντός τις τοῦ εἶδους ἐρωτῶν ἐν ᾧ καὶ τὸ ὠφέλιμον τυγχάνει ὄν· ἔστι δέ που καὶ περὶ τὸν μέλλοντα χρόνον. ὅταν γὰρ νομοθετώμεθα, ὥς ἐσομένους ὠφελίμους τοὺς νόμους τιθέμεθα εἰς τὸν ἔπειτα χρόνον· τοῦτο δὲ μέλλον ὀρθῶς ἂν λέγοιμεν.

178b

S: Come on. Let us question Protagoras in this way, or anyone who says the same thing he says. “You say, Protagoras, that man is the measure of everything, including white, heavy, light, and everything like that, without exception. For having the criterion of these within himself as he experiences them, so he thinks they are, and what he thinks is true for him, and is so for him. Isn’t this so?”

178b

TD: Just so.

178b

S: “And what about future events, Protagoras? Shall we say that he has the criterion of these within himself, and that as he thinks they will be, so they also turn out for the person who thinks so? In the case of heat, suppose a layman thinks he is about to get a fever and will have a temperature, while his doctor thinks the opposite. Which opinion should we say that the future will confirm? Or will it confirm both, and for the doctor neither temperature nor fever will arise in the man, while for the man himself there will be both?”

ΘΕΟ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ἴθι δὴ, οὕτως ἐρωτῶμεν Πρωταγόραν ἢ ἄλλον τινὰ τῶν ἐκείνῳ τὰ αὐτὰ λεγόντων· πάντων μέτρον ἀνθρωπός ἐστιν, ὥς φατέ, ᾧ Πρωταγόρα, λευκῶν βαρέων κούφων, οὐδενὸς ὅτου οὐ τῶν τοιούτων· ἔχων γὰρ αὐτῶν τὸ κριτήριον ἐν αὐτῷ, οἷα πάσχει τοιαῦτα οἰόμενος, ἀληθῆ τε οἶται αὐτῷ καὶ ὄντα. οὐχ οὕτω; ΘΕΟ. οὕτω. ΣΩ. ἢ καὶ τῶν μελλόντων ἔσεσθαι, φήσομεν, ᾧ Πρωταγόρα,

178c

TD: That would be ridiculous.

178c

S: “Yes, and I think that the farmer’s opinion about wine, rather than the lute-player’s, is superior regarding the sweetness or bitterness of the future product.”

ἔχει τὸ κριτήριον ἐν αὐτῷ, καὶ οἷα ἂν οἰηθῇ ἔσεσθαι, ταῦτα καὶ γίγνεται ἐκεῖνῳ τῷ οἰηθέντι; οἷον θερμὴ ἄρ’ ὅταν τις οἰηθῇ ιδιώτης αὐτὸν πυρετὸν λήψεσθαι καὶ ἔσεσθαι αὐτὴν τὴν θερμότητα, καὶ ἕτερος, ἱατρὸς δέ, ἀντοιηθῇ, κατὰ τὴν ποτέρου δόξαν φῶμεν τὸ μέλλον ἀποβήσεσθαι, ἢ κατὰ τὴν ἀμφοτέρων, καὶ τῷ μὲν ἱατρῷ οὐ θερμὸς οὐδὲ πυρετῶν γενήσεται, ἑαυτῷ δὲ ἀμφοτέρα; ΘΕΟ. γελοῖον μεντὰν εἴη. ΣΩ. ἀλλ’ οἶμαι περὶ οἴνου γλυκύτητος καὶ αὐστηρότητος

178d

TD: Of course.

178d

S: “Nor again would the trainer judge better than the musician about what will be discordant or melodious, and what will seem to be melodious even to the trainer himself when he hears it.”

178d

TD: Not at all.

178d

S: “Or suppose that a meal is being prepared. The judgement of a waiting guest with no knowledge of cookery is inferior to the judgement of the cook about how pleasant the meal will be. So, let us not dispute about present pleasure or past pleasure for each person at this stage in the discussion. Let us discuss the future, and whether the person himself is the best judge of how things will seem, and what will be, and whether you, Protagoras, could at any rate anticipate better than any amateur, what speeches would be persuasive to any of us in a courtroom?”

μελλούσης ἔσεσθαι ἢ τοῦ γεωργοῦ δόξα ἀλλ’ οὐχ ἢ τοῦ κιθαριστοῦ κυρία. ΘΕΟ. τί μὴν; ΣΩ. οὐδ’ ἂν αὖ περὶ ἀναρμόστου τε καὶ εὐαρμόστου

έσομένου παιδοτρίβης ἂν βέλτιον δοξάσειεν μουσικοῦ, ὃ καὶ ἔπειτα αὐτῷ τῷ παιδοτρίβῃ δόξει εὐάρμοστον εἶναι. ΘΕΟ. οὐδαμῶς. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τοῦ μέλλοντος ἐστιάσεσθαι μὴ μαγειρικοῦ ὄντος, σκευαζομένης θοίνης, ἀκυροτέρα ἢ κρίσις τῆς τοῦ ὀψοποιοῦ περὶ τῆς ἐσομένης ἡδονῆς. περὶ μὲν γὰρ τοῦ

178e

TD: And, indeed, Socrates, he professed quite strongly to be better than anyone in that respect anyway.

ἤδη ὄντος ἐκάστῳ ἡδέος ἢ γεγονότος μηδὲν πω τῷ λόγῳ διαμαχώμεθα, ἀλλὰ περὶ τοῦ μέλλοντος ἐκάστῳ καὶ δόξειν καὶ ἔσεσθαι πότερον αὐτὸς αὐτῷ ἄριστος κριτής, ἢ σύ, ὦ Πρωταγόρα, τό γε περὶ λόγους πιθανὸν ἐκάστῳ ἡμῶν ἐσόμενον εἰς δικαστήριον βέλτιον ἂν προδοξάσαις ἢ τῶν ιδιωτῶν ὁστισοῦν; ΘΕΟ. καὶ μάλα, ὦ Σώκρατες, τοῦτό γε σφόδρα ὑπισχνεῖτο πάντων διαφέρειν αὐτός. ΣΩ. νῆ Δία, ὦ μέλε· ἢ οὐδεὶς γ' ἂν αὐτῷ διελέγετο

179a

S: Yes, by Zeus, dear friend, otherwise no one would have paid vast sums of money to talk to him. He must have persuaded them that no prophet, or anyone else, could judge better than himself how things will be in the future, and how they will seem.

179a

TD: Very true.

179a

S: Well, are legislation and benefit both concerned with the future? And would everyone agree that when a city legislates it must frequently fall short of obtaining the greatest possible benefit?

179a

TD: Yes, indeed.

διδούς πολὺ ἀργύριον, εἰ μὴ τοὺς συνόντας ἔπειθεν ὅτι καὶ τὸ μέλλον ἔσεσθαί τε καὶ δόξειν οὔτε μάντις οὔτε τις ἄλλος ἄμεινον κρίνειεν ἂν ἢ αὐτός αὐτῷ. ΘΕΟ. ἀληθέστατα. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ αἱ νομοθεσίαι καὶ τὸ ὠφέλιμον περὶ τὸ μέλλον ἐστί, καὶ πᾶς ἂν ὁμολογοῖ νομοθετουμένην

πόλιν πολλάκις ἀνάγκην εἶναι τοῦ ὠφελιμωτάτου ἀποτυγχάνειν; ΘΕΟ.
μάλα γε. ΣΩ. μετρίως ἄρα ἡμῖν πρὸς τὸν διδάσκαλόν σου εἰρήσεται

179b

S: So, I think it would be reasonable for us to put it to your teacher that he must agree that one person is wiser than another, and that such a person is the measure, while I, in my ignorance, must not become the measure of anything at all, though the argument, entered on his behalf just now, compelled me to be a measure whether I wanted to or not.

179b

TD: I think his argument, Socrates, is defeated convincingly by that, and it is also defeated by giving authority to the opinions of others, opinions which state that, in their view, Protagoras' argument is not true at all.

ὅτι ἀνάγκη αὐτῷ ὁμολογεῖν σοφώτερόν τε ἄλλον ἄλλου εἶναι καὶ τὸν μὲν τοιοῦτον μέτρον εἶναι, ἐμοὶ δὲ τῷ ἀνεπιστήμονι μηδὲ ὅπωςτιοῦν ἀνάγκην εἶναι μέτρῳ γίνεσθαι, ὥς ἄρτι με ἠνάγκαζεν ὁ ὑπὲρ ἐκείνου λόγος, εἴτ' ἐβουλόμην εἶτε μή, τοιοῦτον εἶναι. ΘΕΟ. ἐκείνη μοι δοκεῖ, ὦ Σώκρατες, μάλιστα ἀλίσκεσθαι ὁ λόγος, ἀλίσκόμενος καὶ ταύτη, ἥ τὰς τῶν ἄλλων δόξας κυρίας ποιεῖ, αὗται δὲ ἐφάνησαν τοὺς ἐκείνου λόγους οὐδαμῇ ἀληθεῖς ἡγούμεναι.

179c

S: An argument like this, Theodorus, that every opinion of every person is true, could be disproved in many other ways. But it is harder to grasp the untruth of the immediate experience of each person, from which perceptions and opinions about it arise. But perhaps I am talking nonsense and these cannot actually be challenged, and those who say that perceptions are self-evident and constitute knowledge may be describing the way things are, and Theaetetus here was not far wide of the mark in proposing that knowledge and perception are the same. So we should get closer and inspect this moving being, as Protagoras' proxy argument directs us, and tap it and test whether it

rings hollow or true. Anyway, it is no minor dispute that has arisen over this, and there are quite a few participants.

ΣΩ. πολλαχῇ, ὦ Θεόδωρε, καὶ ἄλλῃ ἂν τό γε τοιοῦτον ἀλοίη μὴ πᾶσαν παντὸς ἀληθῆς δόξαν εἶναι· περὶ δὲ τὸ παρὸν ἐκάστω πάθος, ἐξ ὧν αἱ αἰσθήσεις καὶ αἱ κατὰ ταύτας δόξαι γίνονται, χαλεπώτερον ἐλεῖν ὥς οὐκ ἀληθεῖς. ἴσως δὲ οὐδὲν λέγω· ἀνάλωτοι γάρ, εἰ ἔτυχον, εἰσίν, καὶ οἱ φάσκοντες αὐτὰς ἐναργεῖς τε εἶναι καὶ ἐπιστήμας τάχα ἂν ὄντα λέγοιεν, καὶ Θεαίτητος ὅδε οὐκ ἀπὸ σκοποῦ εἴρηκεν

179d

TD: Yes, it is far from being minor. In fact, it is spreading all over Ionia, as the followers of Heraclitus lead the chorus for this argument most vigorously.

αἰσθησιν καὶ ἐπιστήμην ταῦτὸν θέμενος. προσιτέον οὖν ἐγγυτέρω, ὥς ὁ ὑπὲρ Πρωταγόρου λόγος ἐπέταττε, καὶ σκεπτέον τὴν φερομένην ταύτην οὐσίαν διακρούοντα εἴτε ὑγιὲς εἴτε σαθρὸν φθέγγεται· μάχη δ' οὖν περὶ αὐτῆς οὐ φαύλη οὐδ' ὀλίγοις γέγονεν. ΘΕΟ. πολλοῦ καὶ δεῖ φαύλη εἶναι, ἀλλὰ περὶ μὲν τὴν Ἰωνίαν καὶ ἐπιδίδωσι πάμπολυ. οἱ γὰρ τοῦ Ἡρακλείτου ἐταῖροι χορηγοῦσι τούτου τοῦ λόγου μάλα ἐρρωμένως. ΣΩ. τῷ τοι, ὦ φίλε Θεόδωρε, μᾶλλον σκεπτέον καὶ ἐξ

179e

S: Well, in that case, dear Theodorus, we should consider it all the more from its very origin, just as they themselves present it.

179e

TD: Entirely so, Socrates. And in fact you could no more conduct a discussion on these Heraclitean doctrines, or the Homeric or more ancient ones you mention, with any of the Ephesians²⁸ who profess to be experts, than you could with madmen. Indeed, they simply keep moving as their doctrines say they should, while staying with a proposition or question, and quietly asking and answering in turn means less than nothing to them. Well, 'less than nothing' is an exaggeration, but there is no rest whatsoever in these men. Rather, if someone asks a question, they pull out enigmatic aphorisms like

arrows from a quiver and shoot them off, and if you seek an explanation of something they have said, you get struck with a new piece of wordplay. You will never make any progress with any of them, nor do they get anywhere with one another, but they are very careful not to permit anything certain in an argument, or in their own souls, believing, I presume, that this is fixity, their worst enemy, which they try as best they can to banish from the world.

ἀρχῆς, ὥσπερ αὐτοὶ ὑποτείνονται. ΘΕΟ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν. καὶ γάρ, ὦ Σώκρατες, περὶ τούτων τῶν Ἑρακλειτείων ἢ, ὥσπερ σὺ λέγεις, Ὀμηρείων καὶ ἔτι παλαιοτέρων, αὐτοῖς μὲν τοῖς περὶ τὴν Ἐφεσον, ὅσοι προσποιοῦνται ἔμπειροι, οὐδὲν μᾶλλον οἶόν τε διαλεχθῆναι ἢ τοῖς οἰστρῶσιν. ἀτεχνῶς γὰρ κατὰ τὰ συγγράμματα φέρονται, τὸ δ' ἐπιμεῖναι ἐπὶ λόγῳ καὶ ἐρωτήματι καὶ ἡσυχίῳ ἐν μέρει ἀποκρίνασθαι καὶ ἐρέσθαι ἤττον αὐτοῖς ἔνι ἢ τὸ μηδὲν μᾶλλον δὲ ὑπερβάλλει τὸ οὐδ' οὐδὲν πρὸς τὸ μηδὲ μικρὸν ἐνεῖναι τοῖς ἀνδράσιν ἡσυχίας. ἀλλ' ἂν τινὰ τι ἔρη, ὥσπερ ἐκ φαρέτρας ῥηματίσκια αἰνιγματώδη ἀνασπῶντες ἀποτοξεύουσι, κἂν τούτου ζητῆς λόγον λαβεῖν τί εἴρηκεν, ἐτέρῳ πεπλήξῃ καινῶς μετωνομασμένῳ. περανεῖς δὲ οὐδέποτε οὐδὲν πρὸς οὐδένα αὐτῶν· οὐδέ γε ἐκεῖνοι αὐτοὶ πρὸς ἀλλήλους, ἀλλ' εὖ πάνυ φυλάττουσι τὸ μηδὲν βέβαιον ἔαν εἶναι

180b

S: Perhaps, Theodorus, you have seen these men when they are being combative, and have not associated with them when they are at peace. Indeed, they are no friends of yours! But I think they do impart such matters, at leisure, to the pupils whom they want to make like themselves.

180b

TD: By heavens, what pupils? One of these fellows does not become the pupil of another. No, they grow up as they will and each of them takes inspiration from anywhere at all, and one man thinks that the other man knows nothing. As I was about to say, you would never get a rational account from these people, either willingly or under

compulsion. Instead, we must investigate the question ourselves as if we were taking on a mathematical problem.

μήτ' ἐν λόγῳ μήτ' ἐν ταῖς αὐτῶν ψυχαῖς, ἡγούμενοι, ὥς ἐμοὶ δοκεῖ, αὐτὸ στάσιμον εἶναι· τούτῳ δὲ πάνυ πολεμοῦσιν, καὶ καθ' ὅσον δύνανται πανταχόθεν ἐκβάλλουσιν. ΣΩ. ἴσως, ὦ Θεόδωρε, τοὺς ἄνδρας μαχομένους ἑώρακας, εἰρηνεύουσιν δὲ οὐ συγγέγονας· οὐ γὰρ σοὶ ἐταῖροί εἰσιν. ἀλλ' οἶμαι τὰ τοιαῦτα τοῖς μαθηταῖς ἐπὶ σχολῇ φράζουσιν, οὓς ἂν βούλωνται ὁμοίους αὐτοῖς ποιῆσαι. ΘΕΟ. ποίοις μαθηταῖς, ὦ δαιμόνιε; οὐδὲ γίνεται τῶν

180c

S: Well, that sounds reasonable at any rate. Haven't we taken on the problem from the ancients, who used poetry to conceal from the multitude that the origin of everything else is Oceanus and Tethys, which are streams, and that nothing is fixed? Don't we have it from the moderns, who, being wiser, put on a more open display so that even cobblers pick up the wisdom of these men and give up their silly belief that some things are at rest while others are in motion, learn that everything is in motion, and come to respect these teachers? But, Theodorus, I had almost forgotten that others, for their part, proclaim opposite views to these. "All should only be called unmoving", they say. And there is much else that the opponents of these doctrines say, when, like Melissus²⁹ and Parmenides, they assert that all is one, established within itself with no place to move in. So what are we to make of all this, my friend? For moving forward, little by little, we have unwittingly ended up between the two sides, and if we do not defend ourselves and escape, we shall pay for it, like men playing in the wrestling ground who are caught by both sides and dragged in opposite directions across the line. Now, I think we should consider the people we began with, the men of flux, and if they appear to be talking sense, we shall help them to drag us to their side and try to escape the others. However, if the words of those who say that all is at rest sound truer, we shall fly to them, away from the men who move the unmoving. But if they both appear to be unreasonable, we shall be

amusing in our belief that we common folk have something to say, when we have spurned the ancients and the utterly wise men. Well, Theodorus, do you think it is better to keep going in the face of such a danger?

τοιούτων ἕτερος ἑτέρου μαθητής, ἀλλ' αὐτόματοι ἀναφύονται ὁπόθεν ἂν τύχη ἕκαστος αὐτῶν ἐνθουσιάσας, καὶ τὸν ἕτερον ὁ ἕτερος οὐδὲν ἡγεῖται εἰδέναι. παρὰ μὲν οὖν τούτων, ὅπερ ἦα ἐρῶν, οὐκ ἂν ποτε λάβοις λόγον οὔτε ἐκόντων οὔτε ἀκόντων· αὐτοὺς δὲ δεῖ παραλαβόντας ὥσπερ πρόβλημα ἐπισκοπεῖσθαι. ΣΩ. καὶ μετρίως γε λέγεις. τὸ δὲ δὴ πρόβλημα ἄλλο τι παρειλήφαμεν παρὰ μὲν τῶν ἀρχαίων μετὰ ποιήσεως ἐπικρυπτομένων τοὺς πολλοὺς, ὡς ἡ γένεσις τῶν ἄλλων πάντων Ὡκεανός τε καὶ Τηθύς ρεύματα ὄντα τυγχάνει καὶ οὐδὲν ἔστηκε, παρὰ δὲ τῶν ὑστέρων ἅτε σοφωτέρων ἀναφανδὸν ἀποδεικνυμένων, ἵνα καὶ οἱ σκυτοτόμοι αὐτῶν τὴν σοφίαν μάθωσιν ἀκούσαντες καὶ παύσωνται ἡλιθίως οἰόμενοι τὰ μὲν ἐστάναι, τὰ δὲ κινεῖσθαι τῶν ὄντων, μαθόντες δὲ ὅτι πάντα κινεῖται τιμῶσιν αὐτούς; ὀλίγου δὲ ἐπελαθόμην, ὃ Θεόδωρε, ὅτι ἄλλοι αὖ τάναντία τούτοις ἀπεφύησαντο, οἷον ἀκίνητον τελέθει τῷ παντὶ ὄνομ' εἶναι καὶ ἄλλα ὅσα Μέλισσοί τε καὶ Παρμενίδαι ἐναντιούμενοι πᾶσι τούτοις δισχυρίζονται, ὡς ἔν τε πάντα ἐστὶ καὶ ἔστηκεν αὐτὸ ἐν αὐτῷ οὐκ ἔχον χώραν ἐν ᾗ κινεῖται. ΣΩ. τούτοις οὖν, ὃ ἐταῖρε, πᾶσι τί χρησόμεθα; κατὰ σμικρὸν γὰρ προϊόντες λελήθαμεν ἀμφοτέρων εἰς τὸ μέσον πεπτωκότες, καὶ ἂν μὴ πῃ ἀμυνόμενοι διαφύγωμεν, δίκην δώσομεν ὥσπερ οἱ ἐν ταῖς παλαιστραῖς διὰ γραμμῆς παίζοντες, ὅταν ὑπ' ἀμφοτέρων ληφθέντες ἔλκωνται εἰς τάναντία. δοκεῖ οὖν μοι τοὺς ἑτέρους πρότερον σκεπτέον, ἐφ' οὗσπερ ὠρμήσαμεν, τοὺς ῥέοντας, καὶ ἐὰν μὲν τι φαίνωνται λέγοντες, συνέλξομεν μετ' αὐτῶν ἡμᾶς αὐτούς, τοὺς ἑτέρους ἐκφυγεῖν πειρώμενοι· ἐὰν δὲ οἱ τοῦ ὅλου στασιῶται ἀληθέστερα λέγειν δοκῶσι, φευξόμεθα παρ'

181b

TD: It would be quite unacceptable, Socrates, not to investigate what each of these groups is saying.

181b

S: Let us investigate it since you are so enthusiastic. Now, I think that our investigation of motion starts by considering the sort of thing people actually mean when they say that all things are in motion. I want to ask whether they mean there is one form of motion, or, as it appears to me, two forms. But this should not be my opinion alone. You should join in too, so that whatever the outcome, we go through the process together. So tell me, when something changes from one location to another or when it revolves in the same place, do you call that motion?

αὐτοὺς ἀπ' αὐτῶν τὰ ἀκίνητα κινούντων. ἀμφοτέροι δ' ἂν φανῶσι μηδὲν μέτριον λέγοντες, γελοῖοι ἐσόμεθα ἡγούμενοι ἡμᾶς μὲν τι λέγειν φαύλους ὄντας, παμπαλαίους δὲ καὶ πασσόφους ἄνδρας ἀποδεδοκιμακότες. ὅρα οὖν, ὦ Θεόδωρε, εἰ λυσιτελεῖ εἰς τοσοῦτον προῖέναι κίνδυνον. ΘΕΟ. οὐδὲν μὲν οὖν ἀνεκτόν, ὦ Σώκρατες, μὴ οὐ διασκέψασθαι τί λέγουσιν ἐκάτεροι τῶν ἀνδρῶν. ΣΩ. σκεπτέον ἂν εἴη σοῦ γε οὕτω προθυμουμένου. δοκεῖ

181c

TD: I do, indeed.

181c

S: Then let that be one form of motion. But whenever something remains in the same place, yet grows old or goes from white to black or soft to hard or undergoes some other alteration, doesn't that deserve to be called another form of motion?

οὖν μοι ἀρχὴ εἶναι τῆς σκέψεως κινήσεως περί, ποῖόν τί ποτε ἄρα λέγοντές φασι τὰ πάντα κινεῖσθαι. βούλομαι δὲ λέγειν τὸ τοιόνδε· πότερον ἔν τι εἶδος αὐτῆς λέγουσιν ἢ, ὥσπερ ἐμοὶ φαίνεται, δύο; μὴ μέντοι μόνον ἐμοὶ δοκεῖτω, ἀλλὰ συμμετέχε καὶ σύ, ἵνα κοινῇ πάσχωμεν ἂν τι καὶ δέη. καὶ μοι λέγε· ἄρα κινεῖσθαι καλεῖς ὅταν τι χώραν ἐκ χώρας μεταβάλλῃ ἢ καὶ ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ στρέφεται; ΘΕΟ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. τοῦτο μὲν τοίνυν ἔν ἔστω εἶδος. ὅταν δὲ ἢ μὲν ἐν

181d

TD: I think so.

181d

S: So I am saying that there are two forms of motion – alteration and transposition.

181d

TD: And what you say is correct.

181d

S: So, having divided motion in this way, let us now engage in discussion with those who say that all things are in motion, and ask them whether everything exhibits both forms of motion, transposition and alteration, or do some things exhibit both, while some exhibit only one?

τῷ αὐτῷ, γηράσκη δέ, ἢ μέλαν ἐκ λευκοῦ ἢ σκληρὸν ἐκ μαλακοῦ γίγνηται, ἢ τινα ἄλλην ἀλλοίωσιν ἀλλοιῶται, ἄρα οὐκ ἄξιον ἕτερον εἶδος φάναι κινήσεως; ΘΕΟ. ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ ἀναγκαῖον μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. δύο δὴ λέγω τούτῳ εἶδει κινήσεως, ἀλλοίωσιν, τὴν δὲ φοράν. ΘΕΟ. ὀρθῶς γε λέγων. ΣΩ. τοῦτο τοίνυν οὕτω διελόμενοι διαλεγώμεθα ἥδη τοῖς τὰ πάντα φάσκουσιν κινεῖσθαι καὶ ἐρωτῶμεν· πότερον πᾶν

181e

TD: By Zeus, I really cannot say, but I believe they would reply that everything exhibits both.

181e

S: Yes, my friend, otherwise for them everything will turn out to be both moving and at rest, and it will be no more correct to say that all things are moving than all things are at rest.

181e

TD: What you say is perfectly true.

φατε ἀμφοτέρως κινεῖσθαι, φερόμενόν τε καὶ ἀλλοιούμενον, ἢ τὸ μὲν τι ἀμφοτέρως, τὸ δ' ἑτέρως; ΘΕΟ. ἀλλὰ μὰ Δί' ἔγωγε οὐκ ἔχω εἰπεῖν· οἶμαι δ' ἂν φάναι ἀμφοτέρως. ΣΩ. εἰ δέ γε μή, ὦ ἑταῖρε, κινούμενά τε αὐτοῖς καὶ ἐστῶτα φανεῖται, καὶ οὐδὲν μᾶλλον ὀρθῶς ἔξει εἰπεῖν ὅτι κινεῖται τὰ πάντα ἢ ὅτι ἔστηκεν. ΘΕΟ. ἀληθέστατα λέγεις. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἐπειδὴ κινεῖσθαι αὐτὰ δεῖ, τὸ δὲ μὴ κινεῖσθαι

182a

S: Well then, since they must be in motion, and absence of movement is not possible for anything, everything is continually exhibiting every kind of motion.

182a

TD: It must be so.

182a

S: Now consider the following aspect of their proposition with me. Didn't we say that they propose something like this about the origin of heat and whiteness and the like, that each of these is moving, along with perception, between the active and the passive, and that the passive becomes a perceiver, but not perception, while the active becomes something with a certain quality, but does not become a quality? But perhaps 'quality' seems like a strange term that you do not understand from common usage,³⁰ so listen to a few examples. Indeed, the active element does not become heat or whiteness, but hot or white, and the same applies to all else. For I presume you recall what we said before, that nothing just by itself is one, neither an active nor a passive, but from the mutual association of both of them, perceptions and perceptible things are brought to birth, and the active become things with qualities while the passive become perceivers.

μη ἐνεῖναι μηδενί, πάντα δὴ πᾶσαν κίνησιν ἀεὶ κινεῖται. ΘΕΟ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. σκόπει δὴ μοι τόδε αὐτῶν· τῆς θερμότητος ἢ λευκότητος ἢ ὅτουοῦν γένεσιν οὐχ οὕτω πως ἐλέγομεν φάναι αὐτούς, φέρεσθαι ἕκαστον τούτων ἅμα αἰσθήσει μεταξὺ τοῦ ποιοῦντός τε καὶ πάσχοντος, καὶ τὸ μὲν πάσχον αἰσθητικὸν ἀλλ' οὐκ αἴσθησιν ἔτι γίγνεσθαι, τὸ δὲ ποιοῦν ποιόν τι ἀλλ' οὐ ποιότητα; ἴσως οὖν ἡ ποιότης ἅμα ἀλλόκοτόν τε φαίνεται ὄνομα καὶ οὐ μαθήανεις ἀθρόον λεγόμενον· κατὰ

182b

TD: I remember. How could I forget?

μέρη οὖν ἄκουε. τὸ γὰρ ποιοῦν οὔτε θερμότης οὔτε λευκότης, θερμὸν δὲ καὶ λευκὸν γίγνεται, καὶ τᾶλλα οὕτω μέμνησαι γάρ που ἐν τοῖς

πρόσθεν ὅτι οὕτως ἐλέγομεν, ἐν μηδὲν αὐτὸ καθ' αὐτὸ εἶναι, μηδ' αὖ τὸ ποιοῦν ἢ πάσχον, ἀλλ' ἐξ ἀμφοτέρων πρὸς ἄλληλα συγγιγνομένων τὰς αἰσθήσεις καὶ τὰ αἰσθητὰ ἀποτίκτοντα τὰ μὲν ποι' ἅττα γίνεσθαι, τὰ δὲ αἰσθανόμενα. ΘΕΟ. μέμνημαι· πῶς δ' οὔ;

182c

S: So let us set aside whatever else they say, whether it accords with this or not, attend only to this one topic of our discussion and ask them, “Do you say that all things are in motion and flux? Is this so?”

182c

TD: Yes.

182c

S: Now are they moving with both motions, which we defined as transposition and alteration?

182c

TD: They must be, if they are to be completely in motion.

182c

S: And if they were only transposed, and not altered, I presume we would be able to say what sort of things are being transposed in flux, or is this how we should refer to it?

182c

TD: Yes, this way.

ΣΩ. τὰ μὲν τοίνυν ἄλλα χαίρειν ἐάσωμεν, εἴτε ἄλλως εἴτε οὕτως λέγουσιν· οὔ δ' ἔνεκα λέγομεν, τοῦτο μόνον φυλάττωμεν, ἐρωτῶντες· Κινεῖται καὶ ῥεῖ, ὥς φατε, τὰ πάντα; ἢ γάρ; ΘΕΟ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἀμφοτέρας ἅς διειλόμεθα κινήσεις, φερόμενά τε καὶ ἀλλοιούμενα; ΘΕΟ. πῶς δ' οὔ; εἴπερ γε δὴ τελέως κινήσεται. ΣΩ. εἰ μὲν τοίνυν ἐφέρετο μόνον, ἡλλοιοῦτο δὲ μή, εἴχομεν ἄν που εἰπεῖν οἷα ἅττα ῥεῖ τὰ φερόμενα· ἢ πῶς λέγομεν; ΘΕΟ. οὕτως.

182d

S: But since this is not stable either, the flux does not flow white, but changes so that there is also flux of this very whiteness, and it transforms into another colour lest it be convicted of being stable in

this respect. So how can we ever refer to a colour and call it by its proper name?

182d

TD: Yes, how can we do it, Socrates? Or how can we refer to anything else of that kind, if in fact it is constantly slipping away as we are speaking because it is in flux?

ΣΩ. ἐπειδὴ δὲ οὐδὲ τοῦτο μένει, τὸ λευκὸν ῥεῖν τὸ ῥέον, ἀλλὰ μεταβάλλει, ὥστε καὶ αὐτοῦ τούτου εἶναι ῥοήν, τῆς λευκότητος, καὶ μεταβολὴν εἰς ἄλλην χροάν, ἵνα μὴ ἀλῶ ταύτη μένον, ἄρά ποτε οἶόν τέ τι προσειπεῖν χρωμα, ὥστε καὶ ὀρθῶς προσαγορεύειν; ΘΕΟ. καὶ τίς μηχανή, ὦ Σώκρατες; ἢ ἄλλο γέ τι τῶν τοιούτων, εἴπερ αἰ λέγοντος ὑπεξέρχεται ἅτε δὴ ῥέον; ΣΩ. τί δὲ περὶ αἰσθήσεως ἐροῦμεν ὅποιασοῦν, οἶον τῆς

182e

S: But what if we ask about any perception at all, like that of seeing or hearing? Does it ever remain stable as just seeing, or just hearing?

182e

TD: No, it must not, if in fact all things are in motion.

182e

S: So it should no more be referred to as seeing than as not seeing, nor should any other perception be called perception rather than non-perception, if all things are in every kind of motion.

182e

TD: No, it should not.

182e

S: And yet, Theaetetus and I have stated that perception is actually knowledge.

182e

TD: Yes, that is what you said.

182e

S: So, when we were asked what knowledge is, we gave an answer that is no more knowledge than not knowledge.

182e

TD: It seems so.

τοῦ ὁρᾶν ἢ ἀκούειν; μένειν ποτὲ ἐν αὐτῷ τῷ ὁρᾶν ἢ ἀκούειν; ΘΕΟ. οὐκ οὐκ δεῖ γε, εἴπερ πάντα κινεῖται. ΣΩ. οὔτε ἄρα ὁρᾶν προσρητέον τι μᾶλλον ἢ μὴ ὁρᾶν, οὐδέ τιν' ἄλλην αἴσθησιν μᾶλλον ἢ μή, πάντων γε πάντως κινουμένων. ΘΕΟ. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν αἴσθησίς γε ἐπιστήμη, ὡς ἔφαμεν ἐγὼ τε καὶ Θεαίτητος. ΘΕΟ. ἦν ταῦτα. ΣΩ. οὐδὲν ἄρα ἐπιστήμην μᾶλλον ἢ μὴ ἐπιστήμην ἀπεκρινάμεθα ἐρωτώμενοι ὅτι ἐστὶν ἐπιστήμη.

183a

S: The correction to the answer may turn out well for us who were so keen to show that all things are in motion, so that our original answer would prove to be correct. But now it seems to be the case that if all things are in motion, every answer that anyone gives on any subject is equally correct, whether it proclaims 'this is so' or 'this is not so', or if you prefer, we could say 'becomes so', in case we stabilise these fellows with the word 'is'.

183a

TD: What you say is correct.

183a

S: Yes, Theodorus, except that I said 'so' and 'not so'. But the word 'so' should not be uttered, for what is 'so' is no longer in motion, nor again should we say 'not so', for it is not in motion either. Instead, those who propose this doctrine must establish some other language, since they do not currently have words appropriate to their hypothesis, unless perhaps 'not even thus', an indefinite phrase, would best suit their purposes.

ΘΕΟ. εἰοίκατε. ΣΩ. καλὸν ἂν ἡμῖν συμβαίνοι το ἐπανόρθωμα τῆς ἀποκρίσεως, προθυμηθεῖσιν ἀποδείξαι ὅτι πάντα κινεῖται, ἵνα δὴ ἐκείνη ἢ ἀπόκρισις ὀρθὴ φανῇ. τὸ δ', ὡς ἔοικεν, ἐφάνη, εἰ πάντα κινεῖται, πᾶσα ἀπόκρισις, περὶ ὅτου ἂν τις ἀποκρίνηται, ὁμοίως ὀρθὴ εἶναι, οὕτω τ' ἔχειν φάναι καὶ μὴ οὕτω, εἰ δὲ βούλει, γίγνεσθαι, ἵνα μὴ στήσωμεν

αὐτοὺς τῷ λόγῳ. ΘΕΟ. ὁρθῶς λέγεις. ΣΩ. πλήν γε, ὦ Θεόδωρε, ὅτι οὕτω τε εἶπον καὶ οὐχ οὕτω. δεῖ δὲ οὐδὲ τοῦτο τὸ οὕτω λέγειν—οὐδὲ

183b

TD: Yes, that might well be the most appropriate language for them.

183b

S: Well then, Theodorus, we have freed ourselves from your friend and do not yet agree with him that every man is the measure of all things, unless the man has understanding. And we shall not concede that knowledge is perception, not on the basis of the ‘all things are in motion’ approach anyway, unless Theaetetus here has another way of expressing it.

γὰρ ἂν ἔτι κινοῖτο τὸ οὕτω —οὐδ’ αὖ μὴ οὕτω — οὐδὲ γὰρ τοῦτο κίνησις —ἀλλά τιν’ ἄλλην φωνὴν θετέον τοῖς τὸν λόγον τοῦτον λέγουσιν, ὥς νῦν γε πρὸς τὴν αὐτῶν ὑπόθεσιν οὐκ ἔχουσι ῥήματα, εἰ μὴ ἄρα τὸ οὐδ’ οὕτως μάλιστα δ’ οὕτως ἂν αὐτοῖς ἀρμόττοι, ἅπειρον λεγόμενον. ΘΕΟ. οἰκειοτάτη γοῦν διάλεκτος αὕτη αὐτοῖς. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν, ὦ Θεόδωρε, τοῦ τε σοῦ ἐταίρου ἀπηλλάγμεθα, καὶ οὕτω συγχωροῦμεν αὐτῷ πάντ’ ἄνδρα πάντων

183c

TD: I am glad you said that, Socrates, for with these issues concluded I too am freed from answering your questions, as we agreed, since the discussion of Protagoras’ proposition has come to an end.

183c

TT: No, Theodorus, not until Socrates and yourself have dealt with those who assert that all is at rest, as you proposed earlier.

χρημάτων μέτρον εἶναι, ἂν μὴ φρόνιμός τις ἦ· ἐπιστήμην τε αἴσθησιν οὐ συγχωρησόμεθα κατὰ γε τὴν τοῦ πάντα κινεῖσθαι μέθοδον, ἢ εἰ μὴ τί πως ἄλλως Θεαίτητος ὅδε λέγει. ΘΕΟ. ἄριστ’ εἴρηκας, ὦ Σώκρατες· τούτων γὰρ περανθέντων καὶ ἐμὲ ἔδει ἀπηλλάχθαι σοὶ ἀποκρινόμενον κατὰ τὰς συνθήκας, ἐπειδὴ τὸ περὶ τοῦ Πρωταγόρου λόγου τέλος σχοίη. ΘΕΑΙ. μὴ πρίν γ’ ἂν, ὦ Θεόδωρε, Σωκράτης τε καὶ σὺ

183d

TD: Is a young man like you, Theaetetus, teaching his elders to be unjust and break their agreements? Prepare yourself instead to respond to Socrates for the remainder of the discussion.

183d

TT: I shall, if he wants me to. However, I would much rather listen to the other topic mentioned.

183d

TD: Calling Socrates into an argument is like calling cavalry to fight on open ground. So just ask, then sit back and listen.

183d

S: But, Theodorus, I do not think that I shall be persuaded to do what Theaetetus is asking.

τοὺς φάσκοντας αὖ τὸ πᾶν ἐστάναι διέλθῃτε, ὥσπερ ἄρτι προύθεσθε. ΘΕΟ. νέος ὢν, ὃ θεαίτῃτε, τοὺς πρεσβυτέρους ἀδικεῖν διδάσκεις ὁμολογίας παραβαίνοντας; ἀλλὰ παρασκευάζου ὅπως τῶν ἐπιλοίπων Σωκράτει δώσεις λόγον. ΘΕΑΙ. ἐάνπερ γε βούληται. ἥδιστα μεντᾶν ἤκουσα περὶ ὧν λέγω. ΘΕΟ. Ἰππέας εἰς πεδίον προκαλῇ Σωκράτῃ εἰς λόγους προκαλούμενος· ἐρώτα οὖν καὶ ἀκούσῃ. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μοι δοκῶ, ὃ Θεόδωρε, περὶ γε ὧν κελεύει

183e

TD: Why won't you be persuaded?

183e

S: I would be ashamed if we gave only cursory consideration to Melissus and the others who declare that all is at rest, but the shame would be greater in the case of the One – Parmenides. Parmenides appears to me, in Homer's phrase, to be at once 'venerable' and 'formidable'.³¹ Indeed, I met the man when I was very young and he was very old, and he seemed to me to have depth and total nobility.³² I am afraid that we may not come to terms with what he said, and that his intention in saying so may escape us all the more. Also, the major topic that began this discussion – namely, what exactly knowledge is – may go uninvestigated if we allow this disordered influx of propositions,

especially since the subject we are now raising is really immense and would not deserve to be investigated as a mere side issue. However, if we give it what it deserves, it will obscure our discussion about knowledge. So we should do neither. Instead, we should endeavour, through the midwife's art, to deliver Theaetetus of his conceptions about knowledge.

Θεαίτητος οὐ πείσεσθαι αὐτῷ. ΘΕΟ. τί δὴ οὖν οὐ πείσεσθαι; ΣΩ. μέλισσον μὲν καὶ τοὺς ἄλλους, οἳ ἐν ἐστὸς λέγουσι τὸ πᾶν, αἰσχυρόμενος μὴ φορτικῶς σκοπῶμεν, ἥττον αἰσχύνομαι ἢ ἓνα ὄντα Παρμενίδην. Παρμενίδης δέ μοι φαίνεται, τὸ τοῦ Ὀμήρου, αἰδοῖός τέ μοι εἶναι ἅμα δεινός τε. συμπροσέμειξα γὰρ δὴ τῷ ἀνδρὶ πάνυ νέος πάνυ πρεσβύτη, καὶ μοι ἐφάνη βάθος τι ἔχειν παντάπασι γενναῖον. φοβοῦμαι οὖν μὴ οὔτε τὰ λεγόμενα συνιῶμεν, τί τε διανοούμενος εἶπε πολὺ πλεον λειπώμεθα, καὶ τὸ μέγιστον, οὗ ἔνεκα ὁ λόγος ὥρμηται, ἐπιστήμης περί τί ποτ' ἐστίν, ἄσκεπτον γένηται ὑπὸ τῶν ἐπεισχωμαζόντων λόγων, εἴ τις αὐτοῖς πείσεται· ἄλλως τε καὶ ὄν νῦν ἐγείρομεν πλήθει ἀμήχανον, εἴτε τις ἐν παρέργῳ σκέπεται, ἀνάξι' ἂν πάθοι, εἴτε ἱκανῶς, μηχανούμενος τὸ τῆς ἐπιστήμης ἀφανιεῖ. δεῖ δὲ οὐδέτερα, ἀλλὰ Θεαίτητον

184b

TD: Well, if that's what you think, that's what should be done.

184b

S: In that case, Theaetetus, let us consider this additional point in relation to what has been said. You gave an answer whereby perception is, in fact, knowledge. Is this so?

184b

TT: Yes.

184b

S: Now if someone were to ask you, "With what does a person see black and white, and with what does he hear high and low pitch?", I presume you would say "with eyes and with ears".

184b

Tt: I would indeed.

ὦν κυεῖ περὶ ἐπιστήμης πειρᾶσθαι ἡμᾶς τῇ μαιευτικῇ τέχνῃ ἀπολῦσαι. ΘΕΟ. ἀλλὰ χρή, εἰ δοκεῖ, οὕτω ποιεῖν. ΣΩ. ἔτι τοίνυν, ὦ Θεαίτητε, τοσόνδε περὶ τῶν εἰρημένων ἐπίσκεψαι. αἰσθησιν γὰρ δὴ ἐπιστήμην ἀπεκρίνω· ἦ γάρ; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. εἰ οὖν τίς σε ὥδ' ἐρωτῶν· τῷ τὰ λευκὰ καὶ μέλανα ὅρᾳ ἄνθρωπος καὶ τῷ τὰ ὀξέα καὶ βαρέα ἀκούει; εἴποις ἂν οἶμαι ὁμμασί τε καὶ ὠσίν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔγωγε.

184c

S: A laxity in the use of words and phrases without any precise scrutiny is, for the most part, quite gentlemanly. Indeed, it is the opposite approach that is illiberal, though it is sometimes necessary, as in the present case, where we must take the answer you gave and consider a problem with it. Which answer is more correct, that the eyes are that with which we see, or by means of which we see? Are the ears that with which we hear, or by means of which we hear?

184c

Tt: I think that we perceive by means of eyes and ears, rather than with them.

ΣΩ. τὸ δὲ εὐχερὲς τῶν ὀνομάτων τε καὶ ῥημάτων καὶ μὴ δι' ἀκριβείας ἐξεταζόμενον τὰ μὲν πολλὰ οὐκ ἀγεννές, ἀλλὰ μᾶλλον τὸ τούτου ἐναντίον ἀνελεύθερον, ἔστι δὲ ὅτε ἀναγκαῖον, οἷον καὶ νῦν ἀνάγκη ἐπιλαβέσθαι τῆς ἀποκρίσεως ἣν ἀποκρίνη, ἥ οὐκ ὀρθή. σκόπει γάρ· ἀπόκρισις ποτέρα ὀρθότερα, ᾧ ὀρώμεν τοῦτο εἶναι ὀφθαλμούς, ἢ δι' οὗ ὀρώμεν, καὶ ᾧ ἀκούομεν ὦτα, ἢ δι' οὗ ἀκούομεν; ΘΕΑΙ. δι' ὧν ἕκαστα αἰσθανόμεθα, ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ, ὦ Σώκρατες, μᾶλλον ἢ οἷς.

184d

S: Yes, my boy, it would surely be strange if there were lots of senses lodged inside us, like soldiers in the Wooden Horse, and everything did not converge on some single form, be it soul or whatever it should be called, with which by means of the senses, as if they were instruments, we perceive whatever is perceptible.

184d

Tt: Yes, I think it is better to put it that way, rather than the other way.

184d

S: Now, I am being so precise with you about this for the following reason: I want to ask if there is some part of ourselves that is the same, with which we conclude by means of the eyes that things are white or black, or by means of the other sense organs that things have various qualities. If you were asked, would you be able to refer all such processes to the body? But perhaps it is better that you give the answer to the question rather than me doing the job for you. So tell me, by means of what do we perceive hot, hard, light and sweet? Wouldn't you propose that it is by means of the body that you perceive each of them? Or is it by something else?

ΣΩ. δεινὸν γάρ που, ὦ παῖ, εἰ πολλάί τινες ἐν ἡμῖν ὥσπερ ἐν δουρείοις ἵπποις αἰσθήσεις ἐγκάθηνται, ἀλλὰ μὴ εἰς μίαν τινὰ ιδέαν, εἴτε ψυχὴν εἴτε ὅτι δεῖ καλεῖν, πάντα ταῦτα συντείνει, ἥ διὰ τούτων οἷον ὀργάνων αἰσθανόμεθα ὅσα αἰσθητά. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλά μοι δοκεῖ οὕτω μᾶλλον ἢ ἐκείνως. ΣΩ. τοῦδέ τοι ἔνεκα αὐτά σοι διακριβοῦμαι, εἴ τιτι ἡμῶν αὐτῶν τῷ αὐτῷ διὰ μὲν ὀφθαλμῶν ἐφικνούμεθα λευκῶν τε

184e

Tt: Nothing else.

καὶ μελάνων, διὰ δὲ τῶν ἄλλων ἐτέρων αὖ τινῶν καὶ ἕξεις ἐρωτώμενος πάντα τὰ τοιαῦτα εἰς τὸ σῶμα ἀναφέρειν; ἴσως δὲ βέλτιον σὲ λέγειν αὐτὰ ἀποκρινόμενον μᾶλλον ἢ ἐμὲ ὑπὲρ σοῦ πολυπραγμονεῖν. καὶ μοι λέγε· θερμὰ καὶ σκληρὰ καὶ κοῦφα καὶ γλυκέα δι' ὧν αἰσθάνη, ἄρα οὐ τοῦ σώματος ἕκαστα τίθης; ἢ ἄλλου τινός; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδενός ἄλλου. ΣΩ. ἦ καὶ ἐθελήσεις ὁμολογεῖν ἃ δι' ἐτέρας δυνάμεως

185a

S: And are you prepared to agree that whatever can be perceived by means of one faculty cannot be perceived by means of a different faculty, so you cannot see sounds or hear sights?

185a

Tt: How could I disagree?

185a

S: So, if you think something of both, you could not be perceiving them both through only one or the other of the sense organs.

185a

Tt: I could not.

185a

S: Now in the case of sound or colour, do you first think this about both of them, that they both are?

185a

Tt: I do.

185a

S: And then, that each is different from the other, and the same as itself?

αἰσθάνη, ἀδύνατον εἶναι δι' ἄλλης ταῦτ' αἰσθέσθαι, οἷον ἂ δι' ἀκοῆς, δι' ὄψεως, ἢ ἂ δι' ὄψεως, δι' ἀκοῆς; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐκ ἐθελήσω; ΣΩ. εἴ τι ἄρα περὶ ἀμφοτέρων διανοῇ, οὐκ ἂν διὰ γε τοῦ ἑτέρου ὀργάνου, οὐδ' αὖ διὰ τοῦ ἑτέρου περὶ ἀμφοτέρων αἰσθάνοι' ἄν. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. ΣΩ. περὶ δὴ φωνῆς καὶ περὶ χροῆς πρῶτον μὲν αὐτὸ τοῦτο περὶ ἀμφοτέρων ἢ διανοῇ, ὅτι ἀμφοτέρω ἐστὸν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ ὅτι ἐκάτερον ἐκατέρου μὲν ἕτερον, ἑαυτῷ δὲ ταῦτόν;

185b

Tt: Indeed.

185b

S: And that both together are two, while each is one?

185b

Tt: That also.

185b

S: And can you also consider whether they are like or unlike one another?

185b

Tt: Perhaps.

185b

S: Now, by means of what do you think all these things about them both? Indeed, whatever is common to them cannot be apprehended by means of hearing or seeing. And there is also further evidence for what we are saying, for if it were possible to consider whether both are salty or not, you know you could say what you would use to investigate this, and that is evidently neither seeing nor hearing, but something else.

ΘΕΑΙ. τί μὴν; ΣΩ. καὶ ὅτι ἀμφοτέρω δύο, ἐκάτερον δὲ ἓν; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ τοῦτο. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ εἴτε ἀνομοίω εἴτε ὁμοίω ἀλλήλοις, δυνατός εἴ ἐπισκέψασθαι; ΘΕΑΙ. ἴσως. ΣΩ. ταῦτα δὴ πάντα διὰ τίνος περὶ αὐτοῖν διανοῆ; οὔτε γὰρ δι' ἀκοῆς οὔτε δι' ὄψεως οἷόν τε τὸ κοινὸν λαμβάνειν περὶ αὐτῶν. ἔτι δὲ καὶ τόδε τεκμήριον περὶ οὗ λέγομεν εἰ γὰρ δυνατόν εἶναι ἀμφοτέρω σκέψασθαι ἄρ' ἔστων ἀλμυρὸν ἢ οὐ,

185c

ΤΤ: Yes, of course, it is the capacity that is exercised by means of the tongue.

185c

S: Well expressed! But now, by means of what comes the power to show you what is common to these, and to everything, including what you refer to as 'is' and 'is not', and whatever we were asking about just now? What sort of organ will you assign to all these, by means of which our perceiving part perceives each of them?

185c

ΤΤ: You mean being and not being, likeness and unlikeness, same and different, as well as one, and number in general, associated with them. And obviously you are asking about odd and even and whatever else is associated with them, and you want to know the physical organ by means of which we perceive these with the soul.

οἷσθ' ὅτι ἔξεις εἰπεῖν ᾧ ἐπισκέψῃ, καὶ τοῦτο οὔτε ὄψις οὔτε ἀκοή φαίνεται, ἀλλὰ τι ἄλλο. ΘΕΑΙ. τί δ' οὐ μέλλει, ἢ γε διὰ τῆς γλώττης δύναμις; ΣΩ. καλῶς λέγεις. ἢ δὲ δὴ διὰ τίνος δύναμις τό τ' ἐπὶ πᾶσι κοινὸν καὶ τὸ ἐπὶ τούτοις δηλοῖ σοι, ᾧ τὸ ἔστιν ἐπονομάζεις καὶ τὸ οὐκ

ἔστι καὶ ἃ νυνδὴ ἠρωτῶμεν περὶ αὐτῶν; τούτοις πᾶσι ποῖα ἀποδώσεις ὄργανα δι' ὧν αἰσθάνεται ἡμῶν τὸ αἰσθανόμενον ἕκαστα; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐσίαν λέγεις καὶ τὸ μὴ εἶναι, καὶ ὁμοιότητα καὶ ἀνομοιότητα, καὶ τὸ ταῦτόν τε καὶ τὸ ἕτερον, ἔτι δὲ

185d

S: You are following excellently, Theaetetus. Those are the very things I am asking about.

185d

ΤΤ: Well, by Zeus, Socrates, I am quite unable to answer, except that I do not think at all that their source is some particular organ as in the other cases, but it appears to me that the soul itself, by means of itself, investigates what is common to them all.

ἐν τε καὶ τὸν ἄλλον ἀριθμὸν περὶ αὐτῶν. δῆλον δὲ ὅτι καὶ ἄρτιόν τε καὶ περιττόν ἐρωτᾷς, καὶ τᾶλλα ὅσα τούτοις ἔπεται, διὰ τίνος ποτὲ τῶν τοῦ σώματος τῇ ψυχῇ αἰσθανόμεθα. ΣΩ. ὑπέρευ, ὦ Θεαίτητε, ἀκολουθεῖς, καὶ ἔστιν ἃ ἐρωτῶ αὐτὰ ταῦτα. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ μὰ Δία, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔγωγε οὐκ ἂν ἔχοιμι εἰπεῖν, πλήν γ' ὅτι μοι δοκεῖ τὴν ἀρχὴν οὐδ' εἶναι τοιοῦτον οὐδὲν τούτοις ὄργανον ἴδιον ὥσπερ ἐκείνοις, ἀλλ'

185e

S: You are a beauty, Theaetetus, and not ugly as Theodorus said, for he who speaks beautifully is beautiful and good. Indeed, as well as being beautiful, you have done me a favour by saving me from a lengthy exposition, since it seems to you that the soul investigates some things itself, by means of itself, and other things by means of bodily powers. That is actually what I was thinking myself, but I wanted you to think so too.

185e

ΤΤ: Well, that's how it appears anyway.

αὐτὴ δι' αὐτῆς ἡ ψυχὴ τὰ κοινὰ μοι φαίνεται περὶ πάντων ἐπισκοπεῖν. ΣΩ. καλὸς γὰρ εἶ, ὦ Θεαίτητε, καὶ οὐχ, ὡς ἔλεγε Θεόδωρος, αἰσχρὸς· ὁ γὰρ καλῶς λέγων καλὸς τε καὶ ἀγαθός. πρὸς δὲ τῷ καλῷ εὖ ἐποίησάς με μάλα συχνοῦ λόγου ἀπαλλάξας, εἰ φαίνεται σοι τὰ μὲν αὐτὴ δι' αὐτῆς

ἡ ψυχὴ ἐπισκοπεῖν, τὰ δὲ διὰ τῶν τοῦ σώματος δυνάμεων. τοῦτο γὰρ ἦν ὃ καὶ αὐτῷ μοι ἐδόκει, ἐβουλόμην δὲ καὶ σοὶ δόξαι.

186a

S: Now, in which of the categories do you place ‘being’? For it is surely common to everything.

186a

Tt: I place it among those things that the soul reaches for, just by itself.

186a

S: Along with like and unlike, same and different?

186a

Tt: Yes.

186a

S: And what about beautiful and ugly, good and bad?

186a

Tt: Yes, I think the soul considers the being of these in particular, in relation to one another, as it reflects within itself upon past and present in relation to the future.

ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ μὴν φαίνεται γε. ΣΩ. ποτέρων οὖν τίθης τὴν οὐσίαν; τοῦτο γὰρ μάλιστα ἐπὶ πάντων παρέπεται. ΘΕΑΙ. ἐγὼ μὲν ὧν αὐτὴ ἡ ψυχὴ καθ’ αὐτὴν ἐπορέγεται. ΣΩ. ἦ καὶ τὸ ὅμοιον καὶ τὸ ἀνόμοιον καὶ τὸ ταῦτόν καὶ ἕτερον; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. τί δέ; καλὸν καὶ αἰσχρὸν καὶ ἀγαθὸν καὶ κακόν; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ τούτων μοι δοκεῖ ἐν τοῖς μάλιστα πρὸς ἄλληλα σκοπεῖσθαι τὴν οὐσίαν, ἀναλογιζομένη ἐν ἑαυτῇ τὰ

186b

S: Hold on! Won’t the hardness of anything hard, and the softness of anything soft, be perceived by means of touch?

186b

Tt: Yes.

186b

S: But the soul, by reviewing them and comparing them to another, tries to determine for us their being, that they both are, and their

oppositeness to one another, and again, the being of the oppositeness.

186b

Tt: Yes, certainly.

186b

S: Now as soon as they are born, man or beast is naturally capable of perceiving whatever experiences are referred to the soul by means of the body. But reflection upon the being of these, and their benefit, arises gradually over time through much application and education on the part of those who actually attain it.

γεγονότα καὶ τὰ παρόντα πρὸς τὰ μέλλοντα. ΣΩ. ἔχε δὴ ἄλλο τι τοῦ μὲν σκληροῦ τὴν σκληρότητα διὰ τῆς ἐπαφῆς αἰσθήσεται, καὶ τοῦ μαλακοῦ τὴν μαλακότητα ὡσαύτως; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. τὴν δέ γε οὐσίαν καὶ ὅτι ἐστὸν καὶ τὴν ἐναντιότητα πρὸς ἀλλήλῳ καὶ τὴν οὐσίαν αὖ τῆς ἐναντιότητος αὐτὴ ἢ ψυχὴ ἐπανιοῦσα καὶ συμβάλλουσα πρὸς ἄλληλα κρίνειν πειρᾶται ἡμῖν. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὰ μὲν εὐθὺς γενομένοις πάρεστι φύσει

186c

Tt: Entirely so.

186c

S: Now, can someone encounter truth who has not even encountered being?

186c

Tt: Impossible.

186c

S: And if someone does not encounter the truth of something, will he ever have knowledge of it?

αἰσθάνεσθαι ἀνθρώποις τε καὶ θηρίοις, ὅσα διὰ τοῦ σώματος παθήματα ἐπὶ τὴν ψυχὴν τείνει· τὰ δὲ περὶ τούτων ἀναλογίσματα πρὸς τε οὐσίαν καὶ ὠφέλειαν μόγισ καὶ ἐν χρόνῳ διὰ πολλῶν πραγμάτων καὶ παιδείας παραγίγνεται οἷς ἂν καὶ παραγίγνηται; ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασιν μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. οἷόν τε οὖν ἀληθείας τυχεῖν, ᾧ μὴδὲ οὐσίας; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀδύνατον. ΣΩ. οὐ δὲ ἀληθείας τις ἀτυχήσει, ποτὲ τούτου ἐπιστήμων ἔσται;

186d

TT: How could he, Socrates?

186d

S: So knowledge is not in these experiences, but in the process of reasoning about them, for it seems that we are able to apprehend truth and being in this way, but not through the experiences.

186d

TT: So it appears.

186d

S: Well then, should you call them both by the same name when they are so different?

186d

TT: No, that would not be right.

186d

S: Then what name do you give to the first, to seeing, hearing, smelling and feeling cold or hot?

ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ πῶς ἄν, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. ἐν μὲν ἄρα τοῖς παθήμασιν οὐκ ἔνι ἐπιστήμη, ἐν δὲ τῷ περὶ ἐκείνων συλλογισμῷ· οὐσίας γὰρ καὶ ἀληθείας ἐνταῦθα μὲν, ὡς ἔοικε, δυνατόν ἄψασθαι, ἐκεῖ δὲ ἀδύνατον. ΘΕΑΙ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. ἥ οὖν ταῦτόν ἐκεῖνό τε καὶ τοῦτο καλεῖς, τοσαύτας διαφορὰς ἔχοντες; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκ οὖν δὴ δίκαιόν γε. ΣΩ. τί οὖν δὴ ἐκείνῳ ἀποδίδως ὄνομα, τῷ ὁρᾶν ἀκούειν ὁσφραίνεσθαι ψύχεσθαι θερμαίνεσθαι;

186e

TT: I call it perception, Socrates. Is there another option?

186e

S: So you refer to it collectively as perception?

186e

TT: I must.

186e

S: And we say it has no share in the apprehension of truth, for it has no share in the apprehension of being.

186e

Tt: No.

186e

S: Then, Theaetetus, perception and knowledge could never be the same.

186e

Tt: Apparently not, Socrates, and now it really has become abundantly clear that knowledge is different from perception.

ΘΕΑΙ. αἰσθάνεσθαι ἔγωγε· τί γὰρ ἄλλο; ΣΩ. σύμπαν ἄρ' αὐτὸ καλεῖς αἰσθησιν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. ὦι γε, φαμέν, οὐ μέτεστιν ἀληθείας ἄψασθαι· οὐδὲ γὰρ οὐσίας. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. ΣΩ. οὐδ' ἄρ' ἐπιστήμης. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ γάρ. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄρ' ἂν εἴη ποτέ, ὦ Θεαίτητε, αἰσθησίς τε καὶ ἐπιστήμη ταυτόν. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ φαίνεται, ὦ Σώκρατες. καὶ μάλιστά γε νῦν καταφανέστατον γέγονεν ἄλλο ὃν αἰσθήσεως ἐπιστήμη.

187a

S: But this was not the reason we embarked upon our discussion. Its aim was to find out what knowledge actually is, not what it is not. Nevertheless, we have made enough progress not to look for it in perception at all, but in what the soul is engaged in when it is concerned, just by itself, with things that are, whatever we call it.

187a

Tt: Yes, Socrates, and I believe this is called forming opinions.

ΣΩ. ἀλλ' οὐ τι μὲν δὴ τούτου γε ἔνεκα ἡρχόμεθα διαλεγόμενοι, ἵνα εὕρωμεν τί ποτ' οὐκ ἔστ' ἐπιστήμη, ἀλλὰ τί ἔστιν. ὅμως δὲ τοσοῦτόν γε προβεβήκαμεν, ὥστε μὴ ζητεῖν αὐτὴν ἐν αἰσθήσει τὸ παράπαν ἀλλ' ἐν ἐκείνῳ τῷ ὀνόματι, ὅτι ποτ' ἔχει ἡ ψυχὴ, ὅταν αὐτὴ καθ' αὐτὴν πραγματεύεται περὶ τὰ ὄντα. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ μὴν τοῦτο γε καλεῖται, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὡς ἐγώ μαι, δοξάζειν. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς γὰρ οἶει, ὦ φίλε. καὶ ὅρα δὴ νῦν πάλιν ἐξ

187b

S: Yes, your belief is correct, my friend. And now review this again from the beginning. Wipe all our previous discussion from your mind

and see if you have a better perspective having made this much progress. Say once more what knowledge actually is.

187b

Tt: Well, Socrates, I cannot say that it is all opinions, since there is false opinion, so knowledge is most likely to be true opinion. Take that as my answer. However, as we proceed, if that turns out to be incorrect, as happened just now, we shall try another way of putting it.

187b

S: Now, that is how you should speak, Theaetetus, eagerly, rather than answering hesitatingly as you did at first. For if we act like this, there are two possibilities: either we shall find what we are pursuing, or be less inclined to think that we know what we do not know at all, and an outcome like that would actually be no poor recompense. So what are you saying now? Are there two kinds of opinion, one true and the other false, and do you define knowledge as true opinion?

ἀρχῆς, πάντα τὰ πρόσθεν ἐξαλείψας, εἴ τι μᾶλλον καθορᾶς, ἐπειδὴ ἐνταῦθα προελήλυθας. καὶ λέγε αὖθις τί ποτ' ἐστὶν ἐπιστήμη. ΘΕΑΙ. δόξαν μὲν πᾶσαν εἰπεῖν, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἀδύνατον, ἐπειδὴ καὶ ψευδὴς ἐστὶ δόξα· κινδυνεύει δὲ ἡ ἀληθὴς δόξα ἐπιστήμη εἶναι, καὶ μοι τοῦτο ἀποκεκρίσθω. ἐὰν γὰρ μὴ φανῇ προῖοῦσιν ὥσπερ τὸ νῦν, ἄλλο τι πειρασόμεθα λέγειν. ΣΩ. οὕτω μέντοι χρή, ὃ Θεαίτητε, λέγειν προθύμως μᾶλλον, ἢ ὡς τὸ πρῶτον ὥκνεις ἀποκρίνεσθαι. ἐὰν γὰρ

187c

Tt: I do, that's how it seems to me at the moment.

187c

S: Then is it worth taking up an issue concerning opinion?

187c

Tt: What sort of issue?

οὕτω δρῶμεν, δυοῖν θάτερα, ἢ εὐρήσομεν ἐφ' ὃ ἐρχόμεθα, ἢ ἥττον οἰησόμεθα εἰδέναι ὃ μηδαμῇ ἴσμεν· καίτοι οὐκ ἂν εἴη μεμπτὸς μισθὸς ὁ τοιοῦτος. καὶ δὴ καὶ νῦν τί φῆς; δυοῖν ὄντοιιν ἰδέαιν δόξης, τοῦ μὲν ἀληθινοῦ, ψευδοῦς δὲ τοῦ ἑτέρου, τὴν ἀληθεῖ δόξαν ἐπιστήμην ὀρίζῃ;

ΘΕΑΙ. ἔγωγε· τοῦτο γὰρ αὖ νῦν μοι φαίνεται. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν ἔτ' ἄξιον περὶ δόξης ἀναλαβεῖν πάλιν— ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον δὴ λέγεις;

187d

S: It is somehow bothering me now, and has done so many times before, generating great perplexity in relation to myself and others, since I am unable to say what precisely this experience of ours is, and how it arises in us.

187d

TT: What are you referring to?

187d

S: The formation of false opinion. Thinking about it now, I am even more hesitant as to whether we should accept it, or investigate it in a different way than we did a while ago.

187d

TT: Why not, Socrates, if it seems at all necessary? For what yourself and Theodorus said earlier about leisure was quite true, in matters of this sort there is no hurry.

187d

S: You are right to remind me, for perhaps this is not a bad time to retrace our steps. Better, indeed, to accomplish a little and do it well than to do a great deal but do it inadequately.

ΣΩ. θράττει μέ πως νῦν τε καὶ ἄλλοτε δὴ πολλάκις, ὥστ' ἐν ἀπορίᾳ πολλῇ πρὸς ἑμαυτὸν καὶ πρὸς ἄλλον γεγονέναι, οὐκ ἔχοντα εἰπεῖν τί ποτ' ἐστὶ τοῦτο τὸ πάθος παρ' ἡμῖν καὶ τίνα τρόπον ἐγγιγνόμενον. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον δὴ; ΣΩ. τὸ δοξάζειν τινὰ ψευδῆ. σκοπῶ δὴ καὶ νῦν ἔτι διστάζων, πότερον ἐάσωμεν αὐτὸ ἢ ἐπισκεψώμεθα ἄλλον τρόπον ἢ ὀλίγον πρότερον. ΘΕΑΙ. τί μὲν, ὦ Σώκρατες, εἴπερ γε καὶ ὀνητιοῦν φαίνεται δεῖν; ἄρτι γὰρ οὐ κακῶς γε σὺ καὶ Θεόδωρος ἐλέγετε σχολῆς πέρι, ὥς οὐδὲν ἐν τοῖς τοιοῖσδε κατεπείγει.

187e

TT: Of course.

187e

S: How shall we proceed? What do we actually mean? Are we saying that whenever there is false opinion, one of us forms a false opinion, while someone else, by contrast, forms a true one, as this is the natural state of affairs?

187e

TT: Yes, that is what we are saying.

187e

S: Now, isn't each and everything we encounter either known by us or not known? Indeed, at the moment, I am omitting mention of the intermediate states of learning and forgetting, for they are not relevant to us just now.

ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς ὑπέμνησας· ἴσως γὰρ οὐκ ἀπὸ καιροῦ πάλιν ὥσπερ ἵχνος μετελθεῖν. κρεῖττον γάρ που σμικρὸν εὖ ἢ πολὺ μὴ ἱκανῶς περᾶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. τί μήν; ΣΩ. πῶς οὖν; τί δὴ καὶ λέγομεν; ψευδῇ φαμεν ἐκάστοτε εἶναι δοξάν, καὶ τίνα ἡμῶν δοξάζειν ψευδῇ, τὸν δ' αὖ ἀληθῇ, ὡς φύσει οὕτως ἐχόντων; ΘΕΑΙ. φαμὲν γὰρ δῆ.

188a

TT: Well, in that case, Socrates, there is nothing else left in each case, apart from knowing or not knowing.

188a

S: Then whoever forms an opinion must form an opinion, either about what he knows or what he does not know.

188a

TT: He must.

188a

S: And, indeed, isn't it impossible for someone who has come to know something, not to know that same thing, or for someone who does not know, to know?

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τόδε γ' ἔσθ' ἡμῖν περὶ πάντα καὶ καθ' ἕκαστον, ἥτοι εἰδέναι ἢ μὴ εἰδέναι; μανθάνειν γὰρ καὶ ἐπιμανθάνεσθαι μεταξὺ τούτων ὡς ὄντα χαίρειν λέγω ἐν τῷ παρόντι· νῦν γὰρ ἡμῖν πρὸς λόγον ἐστὶν οὐδέν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ μήν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἄλλο γ' οὐδὲν λείπεται περὶ

ἕκαστον πλὴν εἰδέναι ἢ μὴ εἰδέναι. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἤδη ἀνάγκη τὸν δοξάζοντα δοξάζειν ἢ ὧν τι οἶδεν ἢ μὴ οἶδεν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν εἰδότα γε μὴ εἰδέναι τὸ αὐτὸ ἢ μὴ εἰδότα

188b

TT: This must be so.

188b

S: So then, does someone who forms false opinions think that things that he knows are not those things, but different things that he knows, and having known both, does he then fail to recognise either?

188b

TT: No, that would be impossible, Socrates.

188b

S: Well, could he think that things that he does not know are other things that he does not know, and is it possible that someone who knows neither Theaetetus nor Socrates could take a notion that Socrates is Theaetetus, or that Theaetetus is Socrates?

188b

TT: How could he?

εἰδέναι ἀδύνατον. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν ὁ τὰ ψευδῇ δοξάζων, ἃ οἶδε, ταῦτα οἶεται οὐ ταῦτα εἶναι ἀλλὰ ἕτερα ἄττα ὧν οἶδε, καὶ ἀμφοτέρω εἰδὼς ἀγνοεῖ αὐτὰ ἀμφοτέρω; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλ' ἀδύνατον, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἄρα, ἃ μὴ οἶδεν, ἡγεῖται αὐτὰ εἶναι ἕτερα ἄττα ὧν μὴ οἶδε, καὶ τοῦτ' ἔστι τῷ μήτε Θεαίτητον μήτε Σωκράτη εἰδότι εἰς τὴν διάνοιαν λαβεῖν ὡς ὁ Σωκράτης Θεαίτητος ἢ ὁ Θεαίτητος Σωκράτης;

188c

S: Nor indeed does he think that things he knows are somehow things he does not know, nor that things he does not know are things that he knows.

188c

TT: No, that would be very strange.

188c

S: So how could someone ever form a false opinion? For it is impossible to form an opinion based on anything but these options, seeing that everything is either known or not known, but based on these considerations, it seems impossible to form false opinion.

188c

TT: Very true.

188c

S: So then, we should not investigate what we are looking for in this way, on the basis of knowing and not knowing. Should we proceed instead on the basis of being and not being?

ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ πῶς ἄν; ΣΩ. ἀλλ' οὐ μὴν, ἃ γέ τις οἶδεν, οἵεται ποὺ ἃ μὴ οἶδεν αὐτὰ εἶναι, οὐδ' αὖ ἃ μὴ οἶδεν, ἃ οἶδεν. ΘΕΑΙ. τέρας γὰρ ἔσται. ΣΩ. πῶς οὖν ἂν ἔτι ψευδῇ δοξάσειεν; ἐκτὸς γὰρ τούτων ἀδύνατόν ποὺ δοξάζειν, ἐπεὶ περ πάντ' ἢ ἴσμεν ἢ οὐκ ἴσμεν, ἐν δὲ τούτοις οὐδαμοῦ φαίνεται δυνατόν ψευδῇ δοξάσαι. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθέστατα. ΣΩ. ἅρ' οὖν οὐ ταύτη σκεπτέον ὃ ζητοῦμεν, κατὰ τὸ

188d

TT: What do you mean?

188d

S: Perhaps it is as simple as this. Whoever, on any subject, is thinking things that are not, will inevitably form false opinions, whatever the general state of his mind may be.

188d

TT: Quite likely, Socrates.

188d

S: But how? What would we reply, Theaetetus, if someone were to ask, “Is it possible for anyone to do what you are saying, and is there some person who could think what is not, either just by itself, or about some of the things that are?” And it seems we would say in reply, “Yes, whenever he thinks and thinks what is not true.” Is that how we would answer?

εἰδέναι καὶ μὴ εἰδέναι ἰόντας, ἀλλὰ κατὰ τὸ εἶναι καὶ μὴ; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς λέγεις; ΣΩ. μὴ ἀπλοῦν ἢ ὅτι ὁ τὰ μὴ ὄντα περὶ ὅτουσιν δοξάζων οὐκ ἔσθ' ὡς οὐ ψευδῇ δοξάσει, καὶ ὅπως οὖν ἄλλως τὰ τῆς διανοίας ἔχῃ. ΘΕΑΙ. εἰκός γ' αὖ, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. πῶς οὖν; τί ἐροῦμεν, ὦ Θεαίτητε, ἐάν τις ἡμᾶς ἀνακρίνη· δυνατὸν δὲ ὅτωσιν ὃ λέγεται, καὶ τις ἀνθρώπων τὸ μὴ ὄν δοξάσει, εἴτε περὶ τῶν ὄντων του εἴτε αὐτὸ καθ' αὐτό; καὶ ἡμεῖς δὴ, ὡς ἔοικεν, πρὸς ταῦτα φήσομεν· ὅταν

188e

ΤΤ: Just so.

188e

S: Now, does that sort of thing happen in any other instances?

188e

ΤΤ: What sort of thing?

188e

S: Well, that a person sees something yet sees nothing.

188e

ΤΤ: How could he?

188e

S: Well then, if he sees any one thing, he sees something that is, or do you imagine that one is ever included among things that are not?

188e

ΤΤ: I do not.

188e

S: So a person who sees any one thing, sees something that is.

188e

ΤΤ: Apparently.

γε μὴ ἀληθῇ οἴηται οἰόμενος· ἢ πῶς ἐροῦμεν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΣΩ. ἢ οὖν καὶ ἄλλοθι που τὸ τοιοῦτόν ἐστιν; ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. εἴ τις ὁρᾷ μὲν τι, ὁρᾷ δὲ οὐδέν. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ πῶς; ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν εἰ ἔν γέ τι ὁρᾷ, τῶν ὄντων τι ὁρᾷ. ἢ σὺ οἶει ποτέ τὸ ἔν ἐν τοῖς μὴ οὖσιν εἶναι; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκ ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. ὁ ἄρα ἔν γέ τι ὁρῶν ὄν τι ὁρᾷ. ΘΕΑΙ. φαίνεται.

189a

S: And so, a person who hears something is hearing some one thing, something that is.

189a

TT: Yes.

189a

S: And a person who touches something is also touching some one thing, something that is, since he is touching one.

189a

TT: That is also true.

189a

S: And doesn't a person who is thinking, think some one thing?

189a

TT: He must.

189a

S: And in thinking one thing, he is thinking something that is.

189a

TT: I agree.

189a

S: So, a person who is thinking what is not, is thinking nothing.

189a

TT: So it appears.

189a

S: However, a person who is thinking nothing, is not thinking at all.

189a

TT: That seems obvious.

ΣΩ. καὶ ὁ ἄρα τι ἀκούων ἔν γέ τι ἀκούει καὶ ὃν ἀκούει. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. καὶ ὁ ἀπτόμενος δὴ τοῦ ἐνός γέ τοῦ ἅπτεται καὶ ὄντος, εἴπερ ἐνός; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ τοῦτο. ΣΩ. ὁ δὲ δὴ δοξάζων οὐχ ἔν γέ τι δοξάζει; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. ὁ δ' ἔν τι δοξάζων οὐκ ὃν τι; ΘΕΑΙ. συγχωρῶ. ΣΩ. ὁ ἄρα μὴ ὃν δοξάζων οὐδὲν δοξάζει. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ φαίνεται. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν ὅ γε μηδὲν δοξάζων τὸ παράπαν οὐδὲ δοξάζει. ΘΕΑΙ. δῆλον, ὥς ἔοικεν.

189b

S: So it is not possible to think what is not, either just by itself, or about things that are.

189b

TT: Apparently not.

189b

S: Then forming false opinions is different from thinking what is not.

189b

TT: Yes, they seem to be different.

189b

S: So we have not found false opinion within ourselves based on this approach or the previous one.

189b

TT: No, we have not.

189b

S: Then, does so-called false opinion arise in the following way?

189b

TT: How?

ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄρα οἷόν τε τὸ μὴ ὄν δοξάζειν, οὔτε περὶ τῶν ὄντων οὔτε αὐτὸ καθ' αὐτό. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ φαίνεται. ΣΩ. ἄλλο τι ἄρ' ἐστὶ τὸ ψευδῇ δοξάζειν τοῦ τὰ μὴ ὄντα δοξάζειν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἄλλο ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. οὔτ' ἄρ' οὕτως οὔτε ὡς ὀλίγον πρότερον ἐσκοποῦμεν, ψευδῆς ἐστὶ δόξα ἐν ἡμῖν. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ γὰρ οὖν δή. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἄρα ὧδε γιγνόμενον τοῦτο προσαγορεύομεν; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΣΩ. ἀλλοδοξίαν τινὰ οὕσαν ψευδῇ φαμεν εἶναι δόξαν,

189c

S: We say that false opinion is a confusion of thought whereby someone says that one of the things that are is actually another of the things that are, having mixed them up in his mind. For in this way, though he always thinks what is, he thinks that one thing is another, falls into error in the investigation, and may properly be said to form a false opinion.

189c

TT: What you have just said sounds perfect to me. For whenever someone thinks beautiful to be ugly, or conversely, ugly to be beautiful, then he truly is forming false opinions.

189c

S: Theaetetus, you obviously hold me in contempt rather than awe.

189c

TT: What exactly do you mean?

ὅταν τίς τι τῶν ὄντων ἄλλο αὖ τῶν ὄντων ἀνταλλαζάμενος τῇ διανοίᾳ φῇ εἶναι. οὕτω γὰρ ὃν μὲν αἰὶ δοξάζει, ἕτερον δὲ ἀνθ' ἑτέρου, καὶ ἀμαρτάνων οὗ ἑσκόπει δικαίως ἂν καλοῖτο ψευδῇ δοξάζων. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθότατά μοι νῦν δοκεῖς εἰρηκέναι. ὅταν γάρ τις ἀντὶ καλοῦ αἰσχροῦ ἢ ἀντὶ αἰσχροῦ καλὸν δοξάζῃ, τότε ὡς ἀληθῶς δοξάζει ψευδῇ. ΣΩ. δῆλος εἶ, ὦ Θεαίτητε, καταφρονῶν μου καὶ οὐ δεδιώς. ΘΕΑΙ. τί μάλιστα; ΣΩ. οὐκ ἂν οἶμαι σοὶ δοκῶ τοῦ ἀληθῶς ψευδοῦς ἀντιλαβέσθαι,

189d

S: I suppose you think I shall not pick you up on this ‘truly false’, and ask about the ‘slowly fast’ or the ‘heavily light’ or some other opposite, and whether it is possible for something to behave oppositely to itself, and not according to its own nature, but according to the nature of its opposite. Yet I shall let that go so that your spiritedness will not be in vain. However, you are satisfied, you say, that forming false opinions is a confusion of thought.

189d

TT: I am.

189d

S: So according to your opinion, it is possible for the mind to posit that something is different from what it is.

189d

TT: Yes, indeed.

ἐρόμενος εἰ οἷόν τε ταχὺ βραδέως ἢ κοῦφον βαρέως ἢ ἄλλο τι ἐναντίον μὴ κατὰ τὴν αὐτοῦ φύσιν ἀλλὰ κατὰ τὴν τοῦ ἐναντίου γίγνεσθαι αὐτοῦ ἐναντίως. τοῦτο μὲν οὖν, ἵνα μὴ μάτην θαρρήσης, ἀφήμι. ἀρέσκει δέ,

ὥς φής, τὸ τὰ ψευδῇ δοξάζειν ἀλλοδοξεῖν εἶναι; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔμοιγε. ΣΩ. ἔστιν ἄρα κατὰ τὴν σὴν δόξαν ἕτερόν τι ὥς ἕτερον καὶ μὴ ὥς ἐκεῖνο τῇ διανοίᾳ τίθεσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστι μέντοι.

189e

S: Now, whenever the mind does this, mustn't it actually be thinking of both things, or one or other of them?

189e

TT: Yes it must, either both together, or in succession.

189e

S: Excellent! But do you call thinking what I call thinking?

189e

TT: What do you call thinking?

189e

S: Speech that the soul itself carries on with itself about the matters it is considering. I am demonstrating my ignorance here, yet it seems to me that when the soul is engaging in thought, it is really engaging in discourse, asking questions to itself and answering them, and making assertions or denials. But when it has come to a determination, whether slowly or through sudden realisation, and it unwaveringly asserts the same thing, that we designate as its opinion. So then, I, for my part, refer to thinking as speaking, and opinion as speech, not spoken to another person or voiced, but delivered in silence to oneself. What do you say?

ΣΩ. ὅταν οὖν τοῦθ' ἡ διάνοιά του δρᾷ, οὐ καὶ ἀνάγκη αὐτὴν ἥτοι ἀμφοτέρω ἢ τὸ ἕτερον διανοεῖσθαι; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀνάγκη μὲν οὖν· ἥτοι ἅμα γε ἢ ἐν μέρει. ΣΩ. κάλλιστα. τὸ δὲ διανοεῖσθαι ἄρ' ὅπερ ἐγὼ καλεῖς; ΘΕΑΙ. τί καλῶν; ΣΩ. λόγον ὃν αὐτὴ πρὸς αὐτὴν ἡ ψυχὴ διεξέρχεται περὶ ὧν ἂν σκοπῇ. ὥς γε μὴ εἰδὼς σοι ἀποφαίνομαι. τοῦτο γάρ μοι ἰνδάλλεται διανοουμένη οὐκ ἄλλο τι ἢ διαλέγεσθαι, αὐτὴ

190a

TT: I agree.

190a

S: So whenever someone thinks of one thing as another, he also seems to be telling himself that one thing is the other.

190a

TT: Indeed.

ἐαυτὴν ἐρωτῶσα καὶ ἀποκρινομένη, καὶ φάσκουσα καὶ οὐ φάσκουσα. ὅταν δὲ ὀρίσασα, εἴτε βραδύτερον εἴτε καὶ ὀξύτερον ἐπάξασα, τὸ αὐτὸ ἤδη φῆ καὶ μὴ διστάζῃ, δόξαν ταύτην τίθεμεν αὐτῆς. ὥστ' ἔγωγε τὸ δοξάζειν λέγειν καλῶ καὶ τὴν δόξαν λόγον εἰρημένον, οὐ μέντοι πρὸς ἄλλον οὐδὲ φωνῇ, ἀλλὰ σιγῇ πρὸς αὐτόν· σὺ δὲ τί; ΘΕΑΙ. κἀγώ. ΣΩ. ὅταν ἄρα τις τὸ ἕτερον ἕτερον δοξάζῃ, καὶ φησὶν, ὡς ἔοικε, τὸ ἕτερον ἕτερον εἶναι πρὸς ἑαυτόν.

190b

S: Now, try to recall if you have ever said to yourself that beauty is most assuredly ugly, or that injustice is just. In short, consider whether you ever tried to persuade yourself that one thing is in fact another. No, on the contrary, you have never dared, even in your sleep, to say to yourself that odd is even, or anything of that sort.

190b

TT: What you say is true.

190b

S: And do you think that anyone else, sane or insane, ever seriously tried to tell himself, with any conviction, that an ox must be a horse or that two must be one?

ΘΕΑΙ. τί μήν; ΣΩ. ἀναμιμνήσκου δὴ εἰ πώποτ' εἶπες πρὸς σεαυτὸν ὅτι παντὸς μᾶλλον τό τοι καλὸν αἰσχρόν ἐστιν ἢ τὸ ἄδικον δίκαιον. ἢ καί, τὸ πάντων κεφάλαιον, σκόπει εἴ ποτ' ἐπεχείρησας σεαυτὸν πείθειν ὡς παντὸς μᾶλλον τὸ ἕτερον ἕτερόν ἐστιν, ἢ πᾶν τούναντίον οὐδ' ἐν ὕπνῳ πώποτε ἐτόλμησας εἰπεῖν πρὸς σεαυτὸν ὡς παντάπασιν ἄρα τὰ περιττὰ ἄρτιά ἐστιν ἢ τι ἄλλο τοιοῦτον. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ λέγεις.

190c

TT: By Zeus, I don't think so.

190c

S: Now, if speaking to yourself is thinking, no one who speaks and thinks of two things and is apprehending both with the soul, would say or think that one is the other. And you must allow me to use that expression, for what I mean is that nobody thinks that ugliness is beautiful, or anything else of that sort.

ΣΩ. ἄλλον δέ τινα οἶει ὑγιαίνοντα ἢ μαινόμενον τολμῆσαι σπουδῇ πρὸς ἑαυτὸν εἰπεῖν ἀναπείθοντα αὐτὸν ὡς ἀνάγκη τὸν βούν ἵππον εἶναι ἢ τὰ δύο ἓν; ΘΕΑΙ. μὰ Δί' οὐκ ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἰ τὸ λέγειν πρὸς ἑαυτὸν δοξάζειν ἐστίν, οὐδεὶς ἀμφοτέρᾳ γε λέγων καὶ δοξάζων καὶ ἐφαπτόμενος ἀμφοῖν τῇ ψυχῇ εἴποι ἂν καὶ δοξάσειεν ὡς τὸ ἕτερον ἕτερόν ἐστιν. ἑατέον δὲ καὶ σοὶ τὸ ῥῆμα περὶ τοῦ ἐτέρου λέγω

190d

TT: Yes, Socrates, I shall allow it and I agree with what you say.

190d

S: So when thinking of both, it is impossible to think that one is the other.

190d

TT: So it seems.

190d

S: However, thinking about only one, and not thinking of the other at all, he would never think that one is the other.

190d

TT: What you say is true, for in that case he would also have to be apprehending the one he is not thinking about.

190d

S: So confusion of thought is not possible, either through thinking of both of them, or of one of them. So then, anyone who defines false opinion as thinking that one thing is another would be talking nonsense, for there is evidently no false opinion in us, either on this basis or on the basis of our previous discussions.

γὰρ αὐτὸ τῇδε, μηδένα δοξάζειν ὡς τὸ αἰσχρὸν καλὸν ἢ ἄλλο τι τῶν τοιούτων. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλ', ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐῷ τε καὶ μοι δοκεῖ ὡς λέγεις. ΣΩ.

ἄμφω μὲν ἄρα δοξάζοντα ἀδύνατον τό γε ἕτερον ἕτερον δοξάζειν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν τὸ ἕτερόν γε μόνον δοξάζων, τὸ δὲ ἕτερον μηδαμῇ, οὐδέποτε δοξάσει τὸ ἕτερον ἕτερον εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῇ λέγεις· ἀναγκάζοιτο γὰρ ἂν ἐφάπτεσθαι καὶ οὗ μὴ δοξάζει. ΣΩ. οὐτ' ἄρ' ἀμφοτέρω οὔτε τὸ ἕτερον δοξάζοντι ἐγχωρεῖ

190e

TT: It seems not.

190e

S: However, Theaetetus, if we cannot show that there is false opinion, we shall be forced to admit a number of absurdities.

190e

TT: What sort of absurdities?

190e

S: I shall not tell you until I have tried to explore this in every way possible. Indeed, I would be ashamed on our behalf if in our present difficulty we were forced to agree with anything I am saying. However, if we find what we are seeking, and become free, then we shall discuss this as something that happens to others while we stand aloof from the ridicule. But if we become utterly perplexed and humbled, I think we shall surrender to the argument and let it walk on us and do with us as it will, as though we had come down with an illness. Now listen, I find there is still one way of enquiry open to us.

ἀλλοδοξεῖν. ὥστ' εἴ τις ὀριεῖται δόξαν εἶναι ψευδῇ τὸ ἑτεροδοξεῖν, οὐδὲν ἂν λέγοι· οὔτε γὰρ ταύτη οὔτε κατὰ τὰ πρότερα φαίνεται ψευδὴς ἐν ἡμῖν οὕσα δόξα. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκ ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μέντοι, ὦ Θεαίτητε, εἰ τοῦτο μὴ φανήσεται ὄν, πολλὰ ἀναγκασθησόμεθα ὁμολογεῖν καὶ ἄτοπα. ΘΕΑΙ. τὰ ποῖα δή; ΣΩ. οὐκ ἔρῳ σοι πρὶν ἂν πανταχῇ πειραθῶ σκοπῶν. αἰσχυνοίμην γὰρ ἂν ὑπὲρ ἡμῶν, ἐν ᾧ ἀποροῦμεν, ἀναγκαζομένων

191a

TT: Just tell me.

191a

S: I say that we were wrong when we agreed that it is impossible for someone to be deceived and think that the things that he knows are things he does not know, for in a way this is possible.

ὁμολογεῖν οἷα λέγω. ἀλλ' ἐὰν εὕρωμεν καὶ ἐλεύθεροι γενώμεθα, τότε ἤδη περὶ τῶν ἄλλων ἐροῦμεν ὡς πασχόντων αὐτὰ ἐκτὸς τοῦ γελοίου ἐστῶτες· ἐὰν δὲ πάντῃ ἀπορήσωμεν, ταπεινωθέντες οἶμαι τῷ λόγῳ παρέξομεν ὡς ναυτιῶντες πατεῖν τε καὶ χρῆσθαι ὅτι ἂν βούληται. ἦ οὖν ἔτι πόρον τινὰ εὐρίσκω τοῦ ζητήματος ἡμῖν, ἄκουε. ΘΕΑΙ. λέγε μόνον. ΣΩ. οὐ φήσω ἡμᾶς ὀρθῶς ὁμολογήσαι, ἡνίκα ὠμολογήσαμεν ἅ τις οἶδεν, ἀδύνατον δοξάσαι ἃ μὴ οἶδεν εἶναι αὐτὰ

191b

TT: You are expressing what I suspected at the time, when we said that such a thing could happen. Is it that I, who know Socrates, see someone else at a distance whom I do not know and believe that person to be Socrates, whom I do know? For what you describe could happen in that way.

191b

S: Didn't we reject that idea, because it made out that we do not know the things we know when we have known them?

191b

TT: Yes, certainly.

καὶ ψευσθῆναι· ἀλλά πῃ δυνατόν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἄρα λέγεις ὃ καὶ ἐγὼ τότε ὑπώπτευσα, ἡνίκ' αὐτὸ ἔφαμεν τοιοῦτον εἶναι, ὅτι ἐνίῳτ' ἐγὼ γινώσκων Σωκράτῃ, πόρρωθεν δὲ ὀρῶν ἄλλον ὃν οὐ γινώσκω, ᾧ ἦθην εἶναι Σωκράτῃ ὃν οἶδα; γίγνεται γὰρ δὴ ἐν τῷ τοιούτῳ οἷον λέγεις. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἀπέστημεν αὐτοῦ, ὅτι ἃ ἴσμεν ἐποίει ἡμᾶς εἰδότας μὴ εἰδέναί; ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. μὴ γὰρ οὕτω τιθῶμεν, ἀλλ' ὥδε· ἴσως πῃ ἡμῖν

191c

S: Well, let us not propose that but the following, which may be somewhat acceptable to us or may challenge us. But really, we are in such a state that we must thoroughly test every turn of an argument.

Consider whether this makes sense. Is it possible to learn something that you did not know previously?

191c

TT: It is, indeed.

191c

S: And then something else, and so on?

191c

TT: Why not?

191c

S: Now assume, for the sake of the argument, that there is a block of wax in our souls, larger in some, smaller in others, some made of purer wax, others of more impure wax, some harder, others softer, while there are others with the proper balance.

συγχωρήσεται, ἴσως δὲ ἀντιτενεῖ. ἀλλὰ γὰρ ἐν τοιούτῳ ἐχόμεθα, ἐν ᾧ ἀνάγκη πάντα μεταστρέφοντα λόγον βασανίζειν. σκόπει οὖν εἰ τί λέγω. ἄρα ἔστιν μὴ εἰδότα τι πρότερον ὕστερον μαθεῖν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστι μέντοι. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ αὐθις ἔτερον καὶ ἔτερον; ΘΕΑΙ. τί δ' οὐ; ΣΩ. θὲς δὴ μοι λόγου ἔνεκα ἐν ταῖς ψυχαῖς ἡμῶν ἐνὸν κήρινον ἐκμαγεῖον, τῷ μὲν μεῖζον, τῷ δ' ἔλαττον, καὶ τῷ μὲν καθαρωτέρου κηροῦ, τῷ δὲ κοπρωδεστέρου, καὶ σκληροτέρου,

191d

TT: I am assuming this.

191d

S: Let us declare that this is indeed a gift from Memory, the mother of the Muses, and that whatever we may wish to remember of what we see, or hear, or think up for ourselves, is stamped on the wax, like impressions on wax seals, by holding the wax under the perceptions or concepts. Whatever is imprinted is remembered and known for as long as its image may endure, while anything that is erased or that cannot get imprinted is forgotten and not known.

ἐνίοις δὲ ὑγροτέρου, ἔστι δ' οἷς μετρίως ἔχοντος. ΘΕΑΙ. τίθημι. ΣΩ. δῶρον τοίνυν αὐτὸ φῶμεν εἶναι τῆς τῶν Μουσῶν μητρὸς

Μνημοσύνης, καὶ εἰς τοῦτο ὅτι ἂν βουλευθῶμεν μνημονεῦσαι ὧν ἂν ἴδωμεν ἢ ἀκούσωμεν ἢ αὐτοὶ ἐννοήσωμεν, ὑπέχοντας αὐτὸ ταῖς αἰσθήσεσι καὶ ἐννοαίαις, ἀποτυποῦσθαι, ὥσπερ δακτυλίων σημεῖα ἐνσημαινομένους· καὶ ὁ μὲν ἂν ἐκμαγῇ, μνημονεύειν τε καὶ ἐπίστασθαι ἕως ἂν ἐνῇ τὸ εἶδωλον αὐτοῦ· ὁ δ' ἂν ἐξαλειφθῇ ἢ μὴ οἶόν τε γένηται

191e

TT: Let's accept that.

191e

S: Well, consider whether someone who has knowledge of things, and is considering something he has seen or heard, could form a false opinion in such a manner.

191e

TT: In what manner?

191e

S: By believing that things that he knows are, at one time, things that he knows, and at another, things he does not know, occurrences that we improperly agreed to be impossible in our previous discussion.

191e

TT: And what do you say now?

ἐκμαγῆναι, ἐπιλελῆσθαι τε καὶ μὴ ἐπίστασθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστω οὕτως. ΣΩ. ὁ τοίνυν ἐπιστάμενος μὲν αὐτά, σκοπῶν δέ τι ὧν ὁρᾷ ἢ ἀκούει, ἄθρει εἰ ἄρα τοιῷδε τρόπῳ ψευδῇ ἂν δοξάσαι. ΘΕΑΙ. ποίῳ δὴ τινι; ΣΩ. ἃ οἶδεν, οἰηθεὶς εἶναι τοτὲ μὲν ἃ οἶδε, τοτὲ δὲ ἃ μὴ. ταῦτα γὰρ ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν οὐ καλῶς ὠμολογήσαμεν ὁμολογοῦντες ἀδύνατα. ΘΕΑΙ. νῦν δὲ πῶς λέγεις;

192a

S: We must begin discussing the issues again, making the following distinctions. It is impossible for a person to believe that something he knows and has in memory in the soul, and that he is not perceiving, is another thing he knows and whose wax stamp he also possesses, though he is not perceiving it. Nor again, can he believe that what he knows is something he does not know, and whose wax impression he

does not possess. Nor could he think that something he doesn't know is another thing he does not know, nor something he does know. Neither could he imagine that something he is actually perceiving is another thing he is perceiving, nor that something he is perceiving is something he is not perceiving. Nor that something he is not perceiving is something else he is not perceiving, nor something he actually is perceiving. And furthermore, to believe that something he knows and is perceiving, and whose wax impression accords with his perception, is in fact another thing he knows and perceives, and whose impression accords with the perception, is even more impossible, if that is actually possible, than the other instances. And he cannot believe that what he knows and perceives and remembers properly is another thing he knows, nor another thing he perceives. Nor again, can he think that what he neither knows nor perceives is something else he neither knows nor perceives. Nor that what he neither knows nor perceives is something else he does not know. Nor that what he neither knows nor perceives is something else he does not perceive. All these instances compete in their inability to form any false opinion in anyone. Indeed, it is in the remaining instances, if anywhere, that false opinion must lie.

ΣΩ. δεῖ ὥδε λέγεσθαι περὶ αὐτῶν ἐξ ἀρχῆς διοριζομένους ὅτι ὁ μὲν τις οἶδεν, σχὼν αὐτοῦ μνημεῖον ἐν τῇ ψυχῇ, αἰσθάνεται δὲ αὐτὸ μή, οἰηθῆναι ἕτερόν τι ὧν οἶδεν, ἔχοντα καὶ ἐκείνου τύπον, αἰσθανόμενον δὲ μή, ἀδύνατον. καὶ ὃ γε οἶδεν αὖ, οἰηθῆναι εἶναι ὃ μὴ οἶδε μὴδ' ἔχει αὐτοῦ σφραγίδα· καὶ ὃ μὴ οἶδεν, ὃ μὴ οἶδεν αὖ· καὶ ὃ μὴ οἶδεν, ὃ οἶδε· καὶ ὃ αἰσθάνεται γε, ἕτερόν τι ὧν αἰσθάνεται οἰηθῆναι εἶναι· καὶ ὃ αἰσθάνεται, ὧν τι μὴ αἰσθάνεται· καὶ ὃ μὴ αἰσθάνεται, ὧν μὴ αἰσθάνεται· καὶ ὃ μὴ αἰσθάνεται, ὧν αἰσθάνεται. καὶ ἔτι γε αὖ καὶ ὃ οἶδε καὶ αἰσθάνεται καὶ ἔχει τὸ σημεῖον κατὰ τὴν αἴσθησιν, οἰηθῆναι αὖ ἕτερόν τι ὧν οἶδε καὶ αἰσθάνεται καὶ ἔχει αὖ καὶ ἐκείνου τὸ σημεῖον κατὰ τὴν αἴσθησιν, ἀδυνατώτερον ἔτι ἐκείνων, εἰ οἷόν τε. καὶ ὃ οἶδε καὶ ὃ αἰσθάνεται ἔχων τὸ μνημεῖον ὀρθῶς, ὃ οἶδεν οἰηθῆναι ἀδύνατον· καὶ ὃ οἶδε καὶ αἰσθάνεται ἔχων

192c

TT: In what instances? Perhaps I would learn more from them, for at the moment I am not following.

192c

S: In cases where someone knows, but thinks the things are other things that he knows and perceives, or that he does not know but yet perceives. Or where he thinks what he knows and perceives are other things he knows and perceives.

κατὰ ταῦτά, ὃ αἰσθάνεται· καὶ ὃ αὖ μὴ οἶδε μὴδὲ αἰσθάνεται, ὃ μὴ οἶδε μὴδὲ αἰσθάνεται· καὶ ὃ μὴ οἶδε μὴδὲ αἰσθάνεται, ὃ μὴ οἶδε· καὶ ὃ μὴ οἶδε μὴδὲ αἰσθάνεται, ὃ μὴ αἰσθάνεται· πάντα ταῦτα ὑπερβάλλει ἀδυναμία τοῦ ἐν αὐτοῖς ψευδῇ τινα δοξάσαι. λείπεται δὴ ἐν τοῖς τοιοῖσδε, εἴπερ που ἄλλοθι, τὸ τοιοῦτον γενέσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. ἐν τίσι δὴ; ἐὰν ἄρα ἐξ αὐτῶν τι μᾶλλον μάθω· νῦν μὲν γὰρ οὐχ ἔπομαι. ΣΩ. ἐν οἷς οἶδεν, οἰηθῆναι αὐτὰ ἕτερ' ἅττα εἶναι ὧν οἶδε καὶ αἰσθάνεται· ἢ ὧν μὴ οἶδεν, αἰσθάνεται δέ· ἢ ὧν

192d

TT: Now I am even more adrift than before.

192d

S: Well, listen to this once more. I know Theodorus, and I remember within myself what he is like, and the same applies to Theaetetus. At certain times I see them, and sometimes I do not. At times I touch them, and other times not, or I hear them, or have other perceptions of them, while at other times I have no perception of them whatsoever. But do I remember you, nonetheless, and do I know you within myself?

192d

TT: Yes, certainly.

οἶδε καὶ αἰσθάνεται, ὧν οἶδεν αὖ καὶ αἰσθάνεται. ΘΕΑΙ. νῦν πολὺ πλέον ἀπελείφθην ἢ τότε. ΣΩ. ὧδε δὴ ἀνάπαλιν ἄκουε. ἐγὼ εἰδὼς Θεόδωρον καὶ ἐν ἑμαυτῷ μεμνημένος οἷός ἐστι, καὶ Θεαίτητον κατὰ ταῦτά, ἄλλο τι ἐνίστε μὲν ὁρῶ αὐτούς, ἐνίστε δὲ οὐ, καὶ ἄπτομαί ποτ' αὐτῶν, τοτὲ δ' οὐ, καὶ ἀκούω ἢ τινα ἄλλην αἴσθησιν αἰσθάνομαι, τοτὲ δ' αἴσθησιν μὲν

οὐδεμίαν ἔχω περὶ ὑμῶν, μέμνημαι δὲ ὑμᾶς οὐδὲν ἦττον καὶ ἐπίσταμαι αὐτὸς ἐν ἑμαυτῷ;

192e

S: Now this is the first point I wish to make clear, that someone can perceive or not perceive the things he knows.

192e

TT: True.

192e

S: And in the case of things he does not know, he frequently cannot perceive them either, but often he can merely perceive them.

192e

TT: This is true also.

192e

S: Let us see if you can follow me better now. If Socrates knows Theodorus and Theaetetus, but sees neither of them, nor has he any other present perception of them, he would never form an opinion within himself that Theaetetus is Theodorus. Am I making any sense?

ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. τοῦτο τοίνυν πρῶτον μάθε ὧν βούλομαι δηλῶσαι, ὅτι ἔστι μὲν ἃ οἶδε μὴ αἰσθάνεσθαι, ἔστιν δὲ αἰσθάνεσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ ἃ μὴ οἶδε, πολλάκις μὲν ἔστι μὴδὲ αἰσθάνεσθαι, πολλάκις δὲ αἰσθάνεσθαι μόνον; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστι καὶ τοῦτο. ΣΩ. ἰδὲ δὴ ἐάν τι μᾶλλον νῦν ἐπίσπῃ. Σωκράτης

193a

TT: Yes, this is true.

193a

S: Now this was the first of these instances I referred to.

193a

TT: It was indeed.

193a

S: Then the second instance is that knowing one of you, not knowing the other, and perceiving neither of you, I would never think that the one I know is the one I do not know.

193a

Tt: Correct.

193a

S: And thirdly, neither knowing nor perceiving either of you, I would not believe that one whom I do not know is another whom I do not know. Now, assume you have heard again all the previous instances in which I never form a false opinion about you and Theodorus, if I know you both, or do not know you both, or if I know one and not the other. And the same argument applies to perceiving. Do you follow?

εἰ γινώσκει Θεόδωρον καὶ Θεαίτητον, ὁρᾷ δὲ μηδέτερον, μηδὲ ἄλλη αἴσθησις αὐτῷ πάρεστι περὶ αὐτῶν, οὐκ ἂν ποτε ἐν ἑαυτῷ δοξάσειεν ὡς ὁ Θεαίτητός ἐστι Θεόδωρος. λέγω τὶ ἢ οὐδέν; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί, ἀληθῆ γε. ΣΩ. τοῦτο μὲν τοίνυν ἐκείνων πρῶτον ἦν ὧν ἔλεγον. ΘΕΑΙ. ἦν γάρ. ΣΩ. δεύτερον τοίνυν, ὅτι τὸν μὲν γινώσκων ὑμῶν, τὸν δὲ μὴ γινώσκων, αἰσθανόμενος δὲ μηδέτερον, οὐκ ἂν ποτε αὖ οἰηθείην ὃν οἶδα εἶναι ὃν μὴ οἶδα. ΘΕΑΙ. ὁρθῶς.

193b

Tt: I follow.

193b

S: Then what remains is the formation of false opinion in cases where I know you and Theodorus, and have the imprints of both of you in that wax, just like the impressions from seals. Seeing you both from afar, but not very well, I hurry to match your particular imprint to your particular visual appearance, by fitting it precisely onto its own trace in memory in order to bring about recognition. But I get these wrong, and just like people who put their shoes on the wrong feet, I swap them around and set the appearance of one against the imprint of the other. Or my error is like what happens to the appearance of things in mirrors where left turns into right, and it is in these cases that varieties in opinion, and false opinion, occur.

ΣΩ. τρίτον δέ, μηδέτερον γινώσκων μηδὲ αἰσθανόμενος οὐκ ἂν οἰηθείην ὃν μὴ οἶδα ἕτερόν τιν' εἶναι ὧν μὴ οἶδα. καὶ τᾶλλα τὰ πρότερα

πάνθ' ἐξῆς νόμιζε πάλιν ἀκηκοέναι, ἐν οἷς οὐδέποτ' ἐγὼ περὶ σοῦ καὶ Θεοδώρου τὰ ψευδῇ δοξάσω, οὔτε γινώσκων οὔτε ἀγνοῶν ἄμφω, οὔτε τὸν μὲν, τὸν δ' οὐ γινώσκων· καὶ περὶ αἰσθήσεων κατὰ ταυτά, εἰ ἄρα ἔπῃ. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔπομαι. ΣΩ. λείπεται τοίνυν τὰ ψευδῇ δοξάσαι ἐν τῷδε, ὅταν γινώσκων σὲ καὶ Θεόδωρον, καὶ ἔχων ἐν ἐκείνῳ τῷ κηρίῳ ὥσπερ δακτυλίων σφῶν ἄμφοιν τὰ σημεῖα, διὰ μακροῦ καὶ μὴ ἱκανῶς ὁρῶν ἄμφω προθυμηθῶ, τὸ οἰκεῖον ἐκατέρου σημεῖον ἀποδοὺς τῇ οἰκείᾳ ὄψει, ἐμβιβάσας προσαρμόσαι εἰς τὸ ἐαυτῆς ἵχνος, ἵνα γένηται ἀναγνώρισις, εἴτα τούτων ἀποτυχὼν καὶ ὥσπερ οἱ ἔμπαλιν ὑποδούμενοι παραλλάξας προσβάλω τὴν ἐκατέρου ὄψιν πρὸς τὸ ἀλλότριον σημεῖον, ἢ καὶ οἷα τὰ ἐν τοῖς κατόπτροις τῆς ὄψεως πάθη, δεξιὰ εἰς

193d

TT: That is quite likely, Socrates. You are giving a wonderful account of what happens to opinion.

193d

S: There is also the case where I know both of you and I am perceiving one and not the other, but my perception of the former does not accord with my knowledge. This is the case I was describing earlier, when you did not understand me.

193d

TT: No, I did not.

ἀριστερὰ μεταρρεούσης, ταῦτὸν παθὼν διαμάρτω· τότε δὴ συμβαίνει ἢ ἑτεροδοξία καὶ τὸ ψευδῇ δοξάζειν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔοικε γάρ, ὦ Σώκρατες. θαυμασίως ὥς λέγεις τὸ τῆς δόξης πάθος. ΣΩ. ἔτι τοίνυν καὶ ὅταν ἀμφοτέρους γινώσκων τὸν μὲν πρὸς τῷ γινώσκειν αἰσθάνωμαι, τὸν δὲ μὴ, τὴν δὲ γνῶσιν τοῦ ἑτέρου μὴ κατὰ τὴν αἴσθησιν ἔχω, ὃ ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν οὕτως ἔλεγον καὶ μου τότε οὐκ ἐμάνθανες. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. ΣΩ. τοῦτο μὴν ἔλεγον, ὅτι γινώσκων τὸν ἕτερον καὶ

193e

S: Well, I was saying that if you know someone and perceive them and your knowledge of them accords with your perception, you will never

think they are someone else whom you know and perceive, the knowledge of whom also, in turn, accords with your perception. Was that the point?

193e

TT: Yes.

193e

S: What remains, I presume, is the current formulation in which we say that false opinion arises for someone who knows both of you, and sees or has some other perception of both without having the wax imprints in accord with his perception of them. And so he shoots wide of the target like a poor archer and misses the mark, and we have come to refer to this as falsehood.

αἰσθανόμενος, καὶ τὴν γνῶσιν κατὰ τὴν αἴσθησιν αὐτοῦ ἔχων, οὐδέποτε οἰήσεται εἶναι αὐτὸν ἕτερόν τινα ὃν γινώσκει τε καὶ αἰσθάνεται καὶ τὴν γνῶσιν αὖ καὶ ἐκείνου ἔχει κατὰ τὴν αἴσθησιν. ἦν γὰρ τοῦτο; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. παρελείπετο δέ γε πού τὸ νῦν λεγόμενον, ἐν ᾧ δὴ φαμεν τὴν ψευδῇ δόξαν γίνεσθαι τὸ ἄμφοι γινώσκοντα

194a

TT: And properly so.

194a

S: And whenever there is present perception corresponding to one of the imprints, but not to another, and the one whose perception is absent is matched with the present perception, in all these cases the mind is deceived. To sum up, in cases where one does not know, and has perceived, it seems there is no possibility of deception or false opinion if what we are saying is in any way sound. But it is in the particular cases where we both know and perceive that opinion twists and turns and becomes true or false, being true when it directly associates things in line with the proper impressions and imprints, but false when it goes crosswise to the wrong ones.

καὶ ἄμφοι ὁρῶντα ἢ τινα ἄλλην αἴσθησιν ἔχοντα ἀμφοῖν τῷ σημείῳ μὴ κατὰ τὴν αὐτοῦ αἴσθησιν ἐκάτερον ἔχειν, ἀλλ' οἷον τοξότην φαῦλον

ιέντα παραλλάξαι τοῦ σκοποῦ καὶ ἀμαρτεῖν, ὃ δὴ καὶ ψευδὸς ἄρα ὠνόμασται. ΘΕΑΙ. εἰκότως γε. ΣΩ. καὶ ὅταν τοίνυν τῷ μὲν παρῇ αἴσθησις τῶν σημείων, τῷ δὲ μή, τὸ δὲ τῆς ἀπούσης αἰσθήσεως τῇ παρούσῃ προσαρμόσῃ, πάντῃ ταύτῃ ψεύδεται ἡ διάνοια. καὶ ἐνὶ λόγῳ, περὶ ὧν μὲν μὴ οἶδέ τις μηδ' ἐπῆσθετο πώποτε, οὐκ ἔστιν,

194b

TT: Isn't that beautifully described, Socrates?

ὥς ἔοικεν, οὔτε ψεύδεσθαι οὔτε ψευδὴς δόξα, εἴ τι νῦν ἡμεῖς ὑγιὲς λέγομεν· περὶ δὲ ὧν ἴσμεν τε καὶ αἰσθανόμεθα, ἐν αὐτοῖς τούτοις στρέφεται καὶ ἐλίττεται ἡ δόξα ψευδὴς καὶ ἀληθὴς γιγνομένη, καταντικρὺ μὲν καὶ κατὰ τὸ εὐθὺ τὰ οἰκεῖα συνάγουσα ἀποτυπώματα καὶ τύπους ἀληθείας, εἰς πλάγια δὲ καὶ σκολιὰ ψευδῆς. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκοῦν καλῶς, ὦ Σώκρατες, λέγεται;

194c

S: When you have heard what is coming next you will say so all the more. Indeed, forming opinions is beautiful when they are true, but shameful when they are false.

194c

TT: This must be so.

194c

S: Now they say that these differences arise in the following way. When the wax in a person's soul is deep and plentiful, smooth and evenly wrought, and the perceptions that come in through the senses are impressed upon this waxen heart of the soul, as Homer poetically calls its resemblance to wax,³³ then the impressions generated by the perceptions are clear, and as they have sufficient depth, they are enduring. And such people learn easily and then remember, since they do not confuse the imprints from the perceptions, but form opinions that are true. As the imprints are also clear and have abundant space, they quickly assign them to their own individual impressions, that are called things that are, and these people are called wise. Don't you agree?

ΣΩ. ἔτι τοίνυν καὶ τάδε ἀκούσας μᾶλλον αὐτὸ ἐρεῖς, τὸ μὲν γὰρ τάληθές δοξάζειν καλόν, τὸ δὲ ψεύδεσθαι αἰσχρόν. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΣΩ. ταῦτα τοίνυν φασὶν ἐνθένδε γίγνεσθαι. ὅταν μὲν ὁ κηρός του ἐν τῇ ψυχῇ βαθύς τε καὶ πολὺς καὶ λεῖος καὶ μετρίως ὠργασμένος ᾖ, τὰ ἰόντα διὰ τῶν αἰσθήσεων, ἐνσημαινόμενα εἰς τοῦτο τὸ τῆς ψυχῆς κέαρ, ὃ ἔφη "Ὁμηρος αἰνιττόμενος τὴν τοῦ κηροῦ ὁμοιότητα, τότε μὲν καὶ τούτοις

194d

TT: I couldn't agree more.

καθαρὰ τὰ σημεῖα ἐγγιγνόμενα καὶ ἱκανῶς τοῦ βάθους ἔχοντα πολυχρόνιά τε γίγνεται καὶ εἰσὶν οἱ τοιοῦτοι πρῶτον μὲν εὐμαθεῖς, ἔπειτα μνήμονες, εἴτα οὐ παραλλάττουσι τῶν αἰσθήσεων τὰ σημεῖα ἀλλὰ δοξάζουσιν ἀληθῆ. σαφῇ γὰρ καὶ ἐν εὐρυχωρίᾳ ὄντα ταχὺ διανέμουςιν ἐπὶ τὰ αὐτῶν ἕκαστα ἐκμαγεῖα, ἃ δὴ ὄντα καλεῖται, καὶ σοφοὶ δὴ οὗτοι καλοῦνται. ἢ οὐ δοκεῖ σοι; ΘΕΑΙ. ὑπερφυῶς μὲν οὖν.

194e

S: But when a person's heart is rugged, a condition praised by the all-wise poet, or when it is sullied or made from impure wax, or is extremely soft or hard, those with soft wax learn readily but are prone to forgetfulness, while the opposite applies to those with hard wax. Those who have rugged and coarse hearts, somewhat stony with plentiful admixture of earth and filth, retain unclear impressions. And anyone whose wax is hard also retains unclear impressions, as there is no depth in them, while if their wax is soft the impressions quickly become indistinct as they melt into one another. And if, besides all this, they are jumbled together due to the confined space in someone's tiny little soul, they are even more unclear. All these people are inclined to form false opinions, for whenever they see or hear or think of anything, they are unable to assign it quickly to its proper imprint. Instead, they are slow, and as they assign them incorrectly, they missee, mishear and misconceive most things, and are said, in turn, to be ignorant and deceived about things that are.

ΣΩ. ὅταν τοίνυν λάσιόν του τὸ κέαρ ᾗ, ὃ δὴ ἐπὶήνεσεν ὁ πάσσοφος ποιητής, ἢ ὅταν κοπρῶδες καὶ μὴ καθαροῦ τοῦ κηροῦ, ἢ ὕγρὸν σφόδρα ἢ σκληρόν, ὧν μὲν ὕγρὸν εὐμαθεῖς μὲν, ἐπιλήσμονες δὲ γίνονται, ὧν δὲ σκληρόν, τάναντία. οἱ δὲ δὴ λάσιον καὶ τραχὺ λιθῶδές τι ἢ γῆς ἢ κόπρου συμμιγείσης ἔμπλεων ἔχοντες ἀσαφῆ τὰ ἐκμαγεῖα ἴσχουσιν. ΣΩ. ἀσαφῆ δὲ καὶ οἱ τὰ σκληρά· βάθος γὰρ οὐκ ἔνι. ἀσαφῆ

195a

TT: You are describing these men very accurately, Socrates.

δὲ καὶ οἱ τὰ ὑγρά· ὑπὸ γὰρ τοῦ συγχεῖσθαι ταχὺ γίγνεται ἀμυδρά. ἐὰν δὲ πρὸς πᾶσι τούτοις ἐπ' ἀλλήλων συμπεπτωκότα ᾗ ὑπὸ στενοχωρίας, ἐὰν του σμικρὸν ᾗ τὸ ψυχάριον, ἔτι ἀσαφέστερα ἐκείνων. πάντες οὖν οὗτοι γίνονται οἷοι δοξάζειν ψευδῆ. ὅταν γάρ τι ὁρῶσιν ἢ ἀκούουσιν ἢ ἐπινοῶσιν, ἕκαστα ἀπονέμειν ταχὺ ἐκάστοις οὐ δυνάμενοι βραδεῖς τέ εἰσι καὶ ἀλλοτριονομοῦντες παρορῶσί τε καὶ παρακούουσι καὶ παρανοοῦσι πλεῖστα, καὶ καλοῦνται αὖ οὗτοι ἐψευσμένοι τε δὴ τῶν ὄντων καὶ ἀμαθεῖς.

195b

S: So should we say that there are false opinions within us?

195b

TT: Definitely.

195b

S: And true opinions?

195b

TT: True also.

195b

S: Now, at this stage, do we think we have reached adequate agreement that there really are these two kinds of opinion?

195b

TT: Very much so.

195b

S: But, Theaetetus, a talkative man is inclined to be truly formidable and disagreeable!

195b

TT: Why? What are you talking about?

195b

S: I am annoyed about my own stupidity and how truly verbose I am. Indeed, what other word could you use for someone who drags discussions this way and that, and cannot be convinced because he is stupid and is hard to tear away from any proposal?

ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθότατα ἀνθρώπων λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. φῶμεν ἄρα ἐν ἡμῖν ψευδεῖς δόξας εἶναι; ΘΕΑΙ. σφόδρα γε. ΣΩ. καὶ ἀληθεῖς δὴ; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ ἀληθεῖς. ΣΩ. ἤδη οὖν οἰόμεθα ἱκανῶς ὡμολογήσθαι ὅτι παντὸς μᾶλλον ἐστὸν ἀμφοτέρω τούτῳ τῷ δόξαι; ΘΕΑΙ. ὑπερφυῶς μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. δεινόν τε, ὦ Θεαίτητε, ὡς ἀληθῶς κινδυνεύει καὶ ἀηδὲς εἶναι ἀνὴρ ἀδολεσχής. ΘΕΑΙ. τί δέ; πρὸς τί τοῦτ' εἶπες;

195c

TT: Oh, but why are you annoyed?

195c

S: Not only am I annoyed, but I am fearful about how I would respond if someone were to ask me, “Socrates, have you really discovered false opinion, that it lies neither in the relation of perceptions to one another, nor in the interrelationship of thoughts, but in the connection between perception and thought?” I think I would agree, priding myself as though we had made a fine discovery.

ΣΩ. τὴν ἐμαυτοῦ δυσμαθίαν δυσχεράνας καὶ ὡς ἀληθῶς ἀδολεσχίαν. τί γὰρ ἂν τις ἄλλο θεῖτο ὄνομα, ὅταν ἄνω κάτω τοὺς λόγους ἔλκη τις ὑπὸ νωθείας οὐ δυνάμενος πεισθῆναι, καὶ ἧ̃ δυσπαλλάκτος ἀφ' ἐκάστου λόγου; ΘΕΑΙ. σὺ δὲ δὴ τί δυσχεραίνεις; ΣΩ. οὐ δυσχεραίνω μόνον ἀλλὰ καὶ δέδοικα ὅτι ἀποκρινοῦμαι ἂν τις ἔρηταί με· ὦ Σώκρατες, ἡύρηκας δὴ ψευδῇ δόξαν, ὅτι οὔτε ἐν ταῖς αἰσθήσεσιν ἐστὶ πρὸς ἀλλήλας οὔτ'

195d

TT: Well, Socrates, I don't think we need be ashamed of what we have just demonstrated.

195d

S: “In that case,” says he, “does that mean that we shall never believe that a man, whom we only think of but do not see, is a horse, which we neither see nor touch but only think of, though we perceive nothing else about it?” I presume I shall confirm that this is what we mean.

195d

TT: And rightly so.

195d

S: “Well then,” he continues, “based on this account, one could never believe that the eleven that one merely thinks of are twelve, which again one merely thinks of.” Come on, you give the response this time.

ἐν ταῖς διανοαῖς ἀλλ’ ἐν τῇ συνάψει αἰσθήσεως πρὸς διάνοιαν; φήσω δὲ ἐγὼ οἶμαι καλλωπιζόμενος ὥς τι ἡύρηκόντων ἡμῶν καλόν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ, ὦ Σώκρατες, οὐκ αἰσχρὸν εἶναι τὸ νῦν ἀποδεδειγμένον. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν, φησί, λέγεις ὅτι αὖ τὸν ἄνθρωπον ὃν διανοούμεθα μόνον, ὁρῶμεν δ’ οὐ, ἵππον οὐκ ἄν ποτε οἰηθείημεν εἶναι, ὃν αὖ οὔτε ὁρῶμεν οὔτε ἀπτόμεθα, διανοούμεθα δὲ μόνον καὶ ἄλλ’ οὐδὲν αἰσθανόμεθα περὶ αὐτοῦ; ταῦτα οἶμαι φήσω λέγειν. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ ὀρθῶς γε.

195e

TT: Well, I reply that someone who is seeing them or touching them may think that the eleven are twelve. However, he would never form that opinion about the numbers which he holds in mind.

195e

S: What about this? Do you think anyone ever considered five and seven within himself, and I do not mean that he has five men and seven men in front of him or anything like that; I mean just five and seven themselves, which we say have memorial imprints in the wax, and cannot be the subject of false opinion? Now, if someone considered these numbers themselves, talking to himself and asking how much precisely they are, would one person say and think it is eleven, while another says twelve, or would everyone say and think that it is twelve?

ΣΩ. τί οὖν, φησί, τὰ ἑνδεκα ἃ μηδὲν ἄλλο ἢ διανοεῖται τις, ἄλλο τι ἐκ τούτου τοῦ λόγου οὐκ ἄν ποτε οἰηθείη δώδεκα εἶναι ἃ μόνον αὖ

διανοεῖται; ἴθι οὖν δή, σὺ ἀποκρίνου. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλ' ἀποκρινουῖμαι ὅτι ὁρῶν μὲν ἄν τις ἢ ἐφαπτόμενος οἰηθείη τὰ ἑνδεκα δώδεκα εἶναι, ἃ μέντοι ἐν τῇ διανοίᾳ ἔχει, οὐκ ἂν ποτε περὶ αὐτῶν ταῦτα δοξάσειεν οὕτως. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; οἶει τινὰ πώποτε αὐτὸν ἐν αὐτῷ πέντε καὶ

196a

TT: No, by Zeus, there are obviously many who would say eleven, and in the case of larger numbers there are more errors, for I presume you are talking about all numbers.

ἐπτά, λέγω δὲ μὴ ἀνθρώπους ἐπτά καὶ πέντε προθέμενον σκοπεῖν μηδ' ἄλλο τοιοῦτον, ἀλλ' αὐτὰ πέντε καὶ ἐπτά, ἃ φαμεν ἐκεῖ μνημεῖα ἐν τῷ ἐκμαγεῖω εἶναι καὶ ψευδῇ ἐν αὐτοῖς οὐκ εἶναι δοξάσαι, ταῦτα αὐτὰ εἴ τις ἀνθρώπων ἥδη πώποτε ἐσκέψατο λέγων πρὸς αὐτὸν καὶ ἐρωτῶν πόσα ποτ' ἐστίν, καὶ ὁ μὲν τις εἶπεν οἰηθεὶς ἑνδεκα αὐτὰ εἶναι, ὁ δὲ δώδεκα, ἢ πάντες λέγουσί τε καὶ οἴονται δώδεκα αὐτὰ εἶναι;

196b

S: Yes, your presumption is correct. Now consider what is happening in this instance, and whether twelve itself, imprinted on the wax, is thought to be eleven.

196b

TT: So it seems.

196b

S: Hasn't our discussion arrived back at the initial proposals? For anyone involved in this error believes that something he knows is another thing that he also knows, and we said that this is impossible. Indeed, this was the very point which forced us to deny that there can be false opinion, lest the same person be constrained to know and not know the same things at the same time.

ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ μὰ τὸν Δία, ἀλλὰ πολλοὶ δὴ καὶ ἑνδεκα· ἐὰν δέ γε ἐν πλείονι ἀριθμῷ τις σκοπῇται, μᾶλλον σφάλλεται. οἶμαι γάρ σε περὶ παντὸς μᾶλλον ἀριθμοῦ λέγειν. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς γὰρ οἶει καὶ ἐνθυμοῦ μή τι τότε γίγνεται ἄλλο ἢ αὐτὰ τὰ δώδεκα τὰ ἐν τῷ ἐκμαγεῖω ἑνδεκα οἰηθῆναι. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔοικέ γε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἰς τοὺς πρῶτους πάλιν ἀνήκει λόγους; ὁ

γὰρ τοῦτο παθών, ὃ οἶδεν, ἕτερον αὐτὸ οἶται εἶναι ὧν αὖ οἶδεν, ὃ ἔφαμεν ἀδύνατον, καὶ τούτῳ αὐτῷ ἡναγκάζομεν μὴ εἶναι

196c

TT: Very true.

196c

S: In that case, we must explain the formation of false opinion in some other way than by the misalignment of thought relative to perception. For if it was this, we would never be deceived in the internal thoughts themselves. But now, either there is actually no false opinion or it is possible for a person not to know the things which he knows. Which of these options would you choose?

196c

TT: You are presenting an impossible choice, Socrates.

ψευδῇ δόξαν, ἵνα μὴ τὰ αὐτὰ ὃ αὐτὸς ἀναγκάζεται εἰδὼς μὴ εἰδέναι ἅμα. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθέστατα. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἄλλ' ὅτιοῦν δεῖ ἀποφαίνειν τὸ τὰ ψευδῇ δοξάζειν ἢ διανοίας πρὸς αἴσθησιν παραλλαγὴν. εἰ γὰρ τοῦτ' ἦν, οὐκ ἂν ποτε ἐν αὐτοῖς τοῖς διανοήμασιν ἐψευδόμεθα. νῦν δὲ ἥτοι οὐκ ἔστι ψευδῆς δόξα, ἢ ἃ τις οἶδεν, οἷόν τε μὴ εἰδέναι. καὶ τούτων πότερα αἰρή; ΘΕΑΙ. ἄπορον αἵρεσιν προτίθης, ὦ Σώκρατες.

196d

S: And yet the argument is not going to permit both of them. Nonetheless, should we risk everything and try something audacious?

196d

TT: How?

196d

S: Let us decide to state what knowing is actually like.

196d

TT: What is so audacious about that?

196d

S: You seem not to appreciate that our entire discourse from the beginning has been a search for knowledge on the basis that we do not know what it actually is.

196d

TT: I do appreciate this.

196d

S: Then does it not seem audacious to be elucidating what knowing is like without knowing what knowledge is? But in fact, Theaetetus, we have been infected for some time by impure discourse. For we have repeatedly said ‘we realise’ and ‘we do not realise’, ‘we know’ and ‘we do not know’, as if we understood one another, though we still did not know about knowledge. Even now, if you don’t mind, at this very moment we resorted again to ‘not knowing’ and ‘understanding’, as if it were appropriate for us to use them, when we are actually deprived of knowledge.

ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μέντοι ἀμφοτέρᾳ γε κινδυνεύει ὁ λόγος οὐκ ἑάσειν. ὅμως δέ —πάντα γὰρ τολμητέον— τί εἰ ἐπιχειρήσαιμεν ἀναισχυντεῖν; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΣΩ. ἐθελήσαντες εἰπεῖν ποῖόν τί ποτ’ ἐστὶ τὸ ἐπίστασθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ τί τοῦτο ἀναίσχυτον; ΣΩ. ἔοικας οὐκ ἐννοεῖν ὅτι πᾶς ἡμῖν ἐξ ἀρχῆς ὁ λόγος ζητήσις γέγονεν ἐπιστήμης ὡς οὐκ εἰδόσι τί ποτ’ ἐστίν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἐννοῶ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. ἔπειτ’ οὐκ ἀναιδὲς δοκεῖ μὴ εἰδότας ἐπιστήμην ἀποφαίνεσθαι τὸ ἐπίστασθαι οἷόν ἐστιν; ἀλλὰ γάρ, ὦ

196e

TT: But how could you conduct discourse at all, Socrates, if you avoided these phrases?

Θεαίτητε, πάλαι ἐσμέν ἀνάπλεω τοῦ μὴ καθαρῶς διαλέγεσθαι. μυριάκις γὰρ εἰρήκαμεν τὸ γινώσκομεν καὶ οὐ γινώσκομεν, καὶ ἐπιστάμεθα καὶ οὐκ ἐπιστάμεθα, ὥς τι συνιέντες ἀλλήλων ἐν ᾧ ἔτι ἐπιστήμην ἀγνοοῦμεν· εἰ δὲ βούλει, καὶ νῦν ἐν τῷ παρόντι κεχρήμεθ’ αὐτῷ ἀγνοεῖν τε καὶ συνιέναι, ὡς προσῆκον αὐτοῖς χρῆσθαι εἴπερ στερόμεθα ἐπιστήμης. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ τίνα τρόπον διαλέξῃ, ὦ Σώκρατες, τούτων ἀπεχόμενος;

197a

S: Well, I couldn’t, being the man I am, unless I was an argumentative fellow, the sort of man who, if he were here now, would tell us to avoid

these phrases and would rebuke us fiercely for the deficiencies I am referring to. But since we are ordinary folk, would you like me to venture a statement on what knowing is like? It appears to me that this might be of some assistance.

197a

TT: Venture away, by Zeus, and you will be generously forgiven if you do not avoid these phrases.

197a

S: Well, have you heard what they declare that knowing is these days?

197a

TT: I probably have but I cannot recall just now.

ΣΩ. οὐδένα ὦν γε ὃς εἰμί, εἰ μέντοι ἡ ἀντιλογικός· οἷος ἀνὴρ εἰ καὶ νῦν παρῆν, τούτων τ' ἂν ἔφη ἀπέχεσθαι καὶ ἡμῖν σφόδρ' ἂν ἃ ἐγὼ λέγω ἐπέπληττεν. ἐπειδὴ οὖν ἐσμεν φαῦλοι, βούλει τολμήσω εἰπεῖν οἷόν ἐστι τὸ ἐπίστασθαι; φαίνεται γάρ μοι προὔργου τι ἂν γενέσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. τόλμα τοίνυν νῆ Δία. τούτων δὲ μὴ ἀπεχομένῳ σοι ἔσται πολλὴ συγγνώμη. ΣΩ. ἀκήκοας οὖν ὃ νῦν λέγουσιν τὸ ἐπίστασθαι; ΘΕΑΙ. ἴσως· οὐ μέντοι ἔν γε τῷ παρόντι μνημονεύω.

197b

S: I believe they say that it is 'having knowledge'.

197b

TT: True.

197b

S: Now, we shall change it slightly and say 'the acquisition of knowledge'.

197b

TT: But how can you say that this is different from the other wording?

197b

S: Perhaps it is not, but when you have heard what I think, then we shall examine it together.

197b

TT: Yes, if I am actually able to.

197b

S: Well, having does not appear to me to be the same as acquiring. For example, if someone buys a cloak and it is at his disposal but he does not wear it, we would say that he has acquired it but does not have it.³⁴

197b

Tt: Quite right.

197b

S: Look now, is it also possible on this basis to acquire knowledge and not have it, just as if someone had captured wild birds, pigeons or the like, and provided an aviary at his home and reared them, we would probably say that in a certain sense he always has them because he has acquired them. Is this so?

ΣΩ. ἐπιστήμης που ἔξιν φασὶν αὐτὸ εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ. ΣΩ. ἡμεῖς τοίνυν σμικρὸν μεταώμεθα καὶ εἰπώμεν ἐπιστήμης κτήσιν. ΘΕΑΙ. τί οὖν δὴ φήσεις τοῦτο ἐκείνου διαφέρειν; ΣΩ. ἴσως μὲν οὐδέν· ὃ δ' οὖν δοκεῖ ἀκούσας συνδοκίμαζε. ΘΕΑΙ. ἐάνπερ γε οἷός τ' ᾧ. ΣΩ. οὐ τοίνυν μοι ταῦτὸν φαίνεται τῷ κεκτηῖσθαι τὸ ἔχειν. οἷον ἱμάτιον πριάμενός τις καὶ ἐγκρατὴς ὢν μὴ φορῶν, ἔχειν μὲν οὐκ ἂν αὐτὸν αὐτό, κεκτηῖσθαι γε μὴν φαίμεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθῶς γε.

197c

Tt: Yes.

197c

S: And yet in another sense he does not have any of them but he has gained power over them, since he has made them available in an enclosure at home to catch and hold whenever he wishes, capturing the one he wants and releasing it again, and being able to do this as often as he wants.

ΣΩ. ὅρα δὴ καὶ ἐπιστήμην εἰ δυνατόν οὕτω κεκτημένον μὴ ἔχειν, ἀλλ' ὥσπερ εἴ τις ὄρνιθας ἀγρίας, περιστεράς ἢ τι ἄλλο, θηρεύσας οἴκοι κατασκευασάμενος περιστερεῶνα τρέφοι, τρόπον μὲν γὰρ ἂν πού τινα φαίμεν αὐτὸν αὐτὰς αἰεὶ ἔχειν, ὅτι δὴ κέκτηται. ἦ γάρ; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. τρόπον δέ γ' ἄλλον οὐδεμίαν ἔχειν, ἀλλὰ δύναμιν μὲν αὐτῷ περὶ αὐτὰς

παραγεγονέναι, ἐπειδὴ ἐν οἰκείῳ περιβόλῳ ὑποχειρίους ἐποιήσατο, λαβεῖν καὶ σχεῖν ἐπειδὴν

197d

Tt: This is so.

197d

S: Again, just as we provided the souls with some undefined lump of wax in our previous discussion, we are now building an aviary for a great variety of birds in each soul. Some of these are arranged in flocks and they keep apart from the rest, others form smaller groups, while some birds are solitary and fly as they will among all their fellows.

197d

Tt: Let the aviary be built. What happens next?

βούληται, θηρευσαμένῳ ἦν ἂν ἀεὶ ἐθέλῃ, καὶ πάλιν ἀφιέναι, καὶ τοῦτο ἐξεῖναι ποιεῖν ὅποσάκις ἂν δοκῇ αὐτῷ. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστι ταῦτα. ΣΩ. πάλιν δὴ, ὥσπερ ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν κήρινόν τι ἐν ταῖς ψυχαῖς κατεσκευάζομεν οὐκ οἶδ' ὅτι πλάσμα, νῦν αὖ ἐν ἐκάστη ψυχῇ ποιήσωμεν περισσερεῶνά τινα παντοδαπῶν ὀρνίθων, τὰς μὲν κατ' ἀγέλας οὔσας χωρὶς τῶν ἄλλων, τὰς δὲ κατ' ὀλίγας, ἐνίας δὲ μόνας διὰ πασῶν ὅπῃ ἂν τύχωσι πετομένας.

197e

S: Well, we should say that while we are infants this structure is empty, and we should appreciate that the birds are things which are known. A person who has acquired knowledge confines it in the enclosure, and we say that he has learned or discovered the matter of which this is the knowledge, and that is what knowing is.

197e

Tt: So be it.

197e

S: Now, consider the process by which we recapture this knowledge whenever we wish, retain it, and then let it go again. Consider whether these deserve the same name as the initial acquisition, or a different name. You may understand my meaning more clearly from this example. Is there a subject you call arithmetic?

ΘΕΑΙ. πεποιήσθω δὴ, ἀλλὰ τί τούντεῦθεν; ΣΩ. παιδίων μὲν ὄντων φάναι χρή εἶναι τοῦτο τὸ ἀγγεῖον κενόν, ἀντὶ δὲ τῶν ὀρνίθων ἐπιστήμας νοῆσαι· ἦν δ' ἂν ἐπιστήμην κτησάμενος καθείρξῃ εἰς τὸν περίβολον, φάναι αὐτὸν μεμαθηκέναι ἢ ἡύρηκέναι τὸ πρᾶγμα οὗ ἦν αὕτη ἡ ἐπιστήμη, καὶ τὸ ἐπίστασθαι τοῦτ' εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστω.

198a

TT: Yes.

198a

S: Now, assume that this is a hunt for items of knowledge about all odd or even numbers.

198a

TT: I am assuming this.

198a

S: And I presume that, by means of this subject, a man has items of knowledge about number at his disposal, and also transmits them to someone else.

ΣΩ. τὸ τοίνυν πάλιν ἦν ἂν βούληται τῶν ἐπιστημῶν θηρεύειν καὶ λαβόντα ἴσχειν καὶ αὐθις ἀφιέναι σκόπει τίνων δεῖται ὀνομάτων, εἴτε τῶν αὐτῶν ὧν τὸ πρῶτον ὅτε ἐκτᾶτο εἴτε ἐτέρων. μαθήσῃ δ' ἐνθένδε σαφέστερον τί λέγω. ἀριθμητικὴν μὲν γὰρ λέγεις τέχνην; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. ταύτην δὴ ὑπόλαβε θήραν ἐπιστημῶν ἀρτίου τε καὶ περιττοῦ παντός. ΘΕΑΙ. ὑπολαμβάνω. ΣΩ. ταύτη δὴ οἶμαι τῇ τέχνῃ αὐτός τε ὑποχειρίους τὰς

198b

TT: Yes.

198b

S: And we refer to transmitting as teaching, apprehending as learning, and having an acquisition within that aviary as knowing.

198b

TT: Yes, certainly.

198b

S: Now pay attention to the following. Will the arithmetician who is perfect have knowledge of all number and nothing less, since he has the details of the knowledge of all numbers in his soul?

198b

TT: Of course.

198b

S: Well, would a man like this, in mind, ever enumerate anything, either the numbers themselves, or external objects which have number?

ἐπιστήμας τῶν ἀριθμῶν ἔχει καὶ ἄλλω παραδίδωσιν ὁ παραδιδούς. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. καὶ καλοῦμέν γε παραδιδόντα μὲν διδάσκειν, παραλαμβάνοντα δὲ μανθάνειν, ἔχοντα δὲ δὴ τῷ κεκτῆσθαι ἐν τῷ περισσερεῶνι ἐκείνῳ ἐπίστασθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. τῷ δὲ δὴ ἐντεῦθεν ἤδη πρόσσχεσ τὸν νοῦν. ἀριθμητικὸς γὰρ ὢν τελέως ἄλλο τι πάντας ἀριθμοὺς ἐπίσταται; πάντων γὰρ ἀριθμῶν εἰσιν αὐτῷ ἐν τῇ ψυχῇ ἐπιστῆμαι. ΘΕΑΙ. τί μῆν;

198c

TT: Of course.

198c

S: And we shall propose that enumeration is the process of finding out what the relevant number actually is.

198c

TT: It is.

198c

S: So we have agreed that this man knows all number, and yet he is trying to find out what he knows, as if he did not know it. Indeed, I presume you are aware of such contradictory statements.

198c

TT: Yes, I am.

ΣΩ. ἦ οὖν ὁ τοιοῦτος ἀριθμοῖ ἄν ποτέ τι ἢ αὐτὸς πρὸς αὐτὸν αὐτὰ ἢ ἄλλο τι τῶν ἔξω ὅσα ἔχει ἀριθμόν; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. τὸ δὲ ἀριθμεῖν γε οὐκ ἄλλο τι θήσομεν τοῦ σκοπεῖσθαι πόσος τις ἀριθμὸς τυγχάνει ὧν.

ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΣΩ. ὃ ἄρα ἐπίσταται, σκοπούμενος φαίνεται ὡς οὐκ εἰδώς, ὃν ὠμολογήκαμεν ἅπαντα ἀριθμὸν εἰδέναι. ἀκούεις γάρ που τὰς τοιαύτας ἀμφισβητήσεις. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔγωγε.

198d

S: Now, when we compared this to the acquisition and hunting of pigeons, we said that the hunt had two aspects. The first is prior to the acquisition for the sake of acquiring something, and then, once acquired, there is capturing and having to hand whatever had previously been acquired. And in this way too, it is possible for a man to learn the same things again, things of which he had previous knowledge, having learned them and known them. Can't he take up the knowledge of each of them again and retain it, knowledge which he does not have immediately in mind?

198d

TT: True.

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἡμεῖς ἀπεικάζοντες τῇ τῶν περιστερῶν κτήσει τε καὶ θήρᾳ ἐροῦμεν ὅτι διττὴ ἦν ἡ θήρα, ἡ μὲν πρὶν ἐκτῆσθαι τοῦ κεκτῆσθαι ἔνεκα, ἡ δὲ κεκτημένῳ τοῦ λαβεῖν καὶ ἔχειν ἐν ταῖς χερσὶν ἃ πάλοι ἐκέκτητο. οὕτως δὲ καὶ ὧν πάλοι ἐπιστῆμαι ἦσαν αὐτῷ μαθόντι καὶ ἠπίστατο αὐτά, πάλιν ἔστι καταμανθάνειν ταῦτά ταῦτα ἀναλαμβάνοντα τὴν ἐπιστήμην ἐκάστου καὶ ἴσχοντα, ἦν ἐκέκτητο μὲν πάλοι, πρόχειρον δ' οὐκ εἶχε τῇ διανοίᾳ; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ.

198e

S: This is what I was asking earlier. What terms should be used to describe the arithmetician who sets about calculating, or the grammarian who goes to read something? In such cases, is a person who knows, going to learn again for himself that which he already knows?

198e

TT: That would be strange, Socrates.

ΣΩ. τοῦτο δὴ ἄρτι ἡρώτων, ὅπως χρὴ τοῖς ὀνόμασι χρώμενον λέγειν περὶ αὐτῶν, ὅταν ἀριθμήσων ἦ ὁ ἀριθμητικὸς ἢ τι ἀναγνώσόμενος ὁ

γραμματικός, ὡς ἐπιστάμενος ἄρα ἐν τῷ τοιούτῳ πάλιν ἔρχεται μαθησόμενος παρ' ἑαυτοῦ ἃ ἐπίσταται; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλ' ἄτοπον, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἃ οὐκ ἐπίσταται φῶμεν αὐτὸν ἀναγνώσεσθαι

199a

S: But should we say that he is going to read or compute things which he does not know, when we have conceded that he knows all letters and all numbers?

199a

TT: No, that too is unreasonable.

199a

S: Well, would you like us to say that we do not care about names, and that someone can drag knowing and learning wherever they please? But since we have defined the acquisition of knowledge as one thing, and having it as another, it is impossible for someone not to have acquired that which he has acquired, and consequently it never happens that someone does not know that which he knows. However, we do say that it is possible to pick up a false opinion about it, for it is possible not to hold the knowledge of that, but another knowledge instead. This happens when someone is on the hunt for an item of knowledge which is flying about the aviary, but mistakenly grabs a different one instead of the one he wanted. So, in the case where he thought that the eleven was twelve, he had caught within himself the knowledge of the eleven rather than the twelve, like catching a dove instead of a pigeon.

καὶ ἀριθμήσειν, δεδωκότες αὐτῷ πάντα μὲν γράμματα πάντα δὲ ἀριθμὸν ἐπίστασθαι; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ καὶ τοῦτ' ἄλογον. ΣΩ. βούλει οὖν λέγωμεν ὅτι τῶν μὲν ὀνομάτων οὐδὲν ἡμῖν μέλει, ὅπη τις χαίρει ἔλκων τὸ ἐπίστασθαι καὶ μανθάνειν, ἐπειδὴ δὲ ὠρισάμεθα ἕτερον μὲν τι τὸ κεκτῆσθαι τὴν ἐπιστήμην, ἕτερον δὲ τὸ ἔχειν, ὃ μὲν τις ἔκτεται μὴ κεκτῆσθαι ἀδύνατόν φαμεν εἶναι, ὥστε οὐδέποτε συμβαίνει ὃ τις οἶδεν μὴ εἰδέναι, ψευδῇ μέντοι δόξαν οἶόν τ' εἶναι περὶ αὐτοῦ λαβεῖν;

199b

Tt: Yes, that makes sense.

199b

S: But, whenever he catches what he is trying to catch, he is unerring and he thinks things that are. And so in this way there can be both true and false opinion, and the issues which troubled us earlier no longer present an obstacle. Perhaps you will agree with me, or will you take a different approach?

ΣΩ. μὴ γὰρ ἔχειν τὴν ἐπιστήμην τούτου οἷόν τε, ἀλλ' ἐτέραν ἀντ' ἐκείνης, ὅταν θηρεύων τινὰ πού ποτ' ἐπιστήμην διαπετομένων ἀνθ' ἐτέρας ἐτέραν ἀμαρτῶν λάβῃ, τότε ἄρα τὰ ἔνδεκα δώδεκα ὥθηται εἶναι, τὴν τῶν ἔνδεκα ἐπιστήμην ἀντὶ τῆς τῶν δώδεκα λαβῶν τὴν ἐν αὐτῷ οἷον φάτταν ἀντὶ περιστερᾶς. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔχει γὰρ οὖν λόγον. ΣΩ. ὅταν δέ γε ᾖ ἐπιχειρεῖ λαβεῖν λάβῃ, ἀψευδεῖν τε καὶ τὰ ὄντα δοξάζειν τότε, καὶ οὕτω δὴ εἶναι ἀληθῆ τε καὶ

199c

Tt: I take this approach.

199c

S: Well then, we are rid of the issue of people not knowing things that they know, for it can never turn out that we have not acquired the things we have acquired, whether we are deceived about something or not. But it seems to me that another more formidable issue is looming.

199c

Tt: What sort of issue?

199c

S: Whether the interchange of pieces of knowledge will ever give rise to false opinion.

199c

Tt: How so?

ψευδῇ δόξαν, καὶ ὧν ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν ἐδυσχεραίνομεν οὐδὲν ἐμποδὼν γίγνεσθαι; ἴσως οὖν μοι συμφήσεις· ἢ πῶς ποιήσεις; ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΣΩ. καὶ γὰρ τοῦ μὲν ἃ ἐπίστανται μὴ ἐπίστασθαι ἀπηλλάγμεθα· ἃ γὰρ κεκτήμεθα μὴ κεκτῆσθαι οὐδαμοῦ ἔτι συμβαίνει, οὔτε ψευθεῖσί τινος

οὔτε μή. δεινότερον μέντοι πάθος ἄλλο παραφαίνεσθαί μοι δοκεῖ. ΘΕΑΙ.
τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. εἰ ἡ τῶν ἐπιστημῶν μεταλλαγὴ ψευδὴς γενήσεται ποτε
δόξα. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δῆ;

199d

S: The first concern is that someone who has knowledge of something is ignorant of that very thing, not on account of ignorance, but on account of his own knowledge. Then comes the statement that he thinks that this thing is something different, and the different thing is this thing. Is it not very unreasonable that when knowledge is present, the soul knows nothing and is utterly ignorant? For based on this account, why couldn't the presence of ignorance enable us to know something, or blindness make us see, if knowledge ever really does make someone ignorant?

199d

TT: Well, Socrates, perhaps we went wrong when we proposed that these birds stand only for items of knowledge, and we should also propose that there are ignorances flying around in the soul at the same time, and the seeker sometimes gets hold of knowledge and sometimes of ignorance concerning the same thing. He then forms false opinions on account of the ignorance, and true opinions on account of the knowledge.

ΣΩ. πρῶτον μὲν τό τινας ἔχοντα ἐπιστήμην τοῦτο αὐτὸ ἀγνοεῖν, μὴ ἀγνωμοσύνη ἀλλὰ τῇ ἑαυτοῦ ἐπιστήμῃ ἔπειτα ἕτερον αὖ τοῦτο δοξάζειν, τὸ δ' ἕτερον τοῦτο, πῶς οὐ πολλὴ ἀλογία, ἐπιστήμης παραγενομένης γινῶναι μὲν τὴν ψυχὴν μηδέν, ἀγνοῆσαι δὲ πάντα; ἐκ γὰρ τούτου τοῦ λόγου κωλύει οὐδέν καὶ ἄγνοιαν παραγενομένην γινῶναι τι ποιῆσαι καὶ τυφλότητα ἰδεῖν, εἴπερ καὶ ἐπιστήμη ἀγνοῆσαι ποτέ τινα ποιήσει.

199e

S: I can hardly refrain from praising you, Theaetetus. However, you should examine what you have said once more. Now, let it be as you say, that someone who gets hold of ignorance will form false opinions, according to you. Is that so?

ΘΕΑΙ. ἴσως γάρ, ὦ Σώκρατες, οὐ καλῶς τὰς ὀρνιθας ἐτίθεμεν ἐπιστήμας μόνον τιθέντες, ἔδει δὲ καὶ ἀνεπιστημοσύνας τιθέναι ὁμοῦ συνδιαπετομένας ἐν τῇ ψυχῇ, καὶ τὸν θηρεύοντα τοτὲ μὲν ἐπιστήμην λαμβάνοντα, τοτὲ δ' ἀνεπιστημοσύνην τοῦ αὐτοῦ περὶ ψευδῆ μὲν δοξάζειν τῇ ἀνεπιστημοσύνῃ, ἀληθῆ δὲ τῇ ἐπιστήμῃ. ΣΩ. οὐ ῥαδίον γε, ὦ Θεαίτητε, μὴ ἐπαινεῖν σε· ὁ μέντοι εἶπες πάλιν ἐπίσκεψαι. ἔστω μὲν γὰρ ὡς λέγεις· ὁ δὲ δὴ τὴν

200a

TT: Yes.

200a

S: Of course he will not think that he is forming false opinions.

200a

TT: How could he?

200a

S: Indeed, he will think they are actually true, and he will adopt the stance of a man who knows on matters where he is in error.

200a

TT: Yes, he will.

200a

S: So he will believe he is in possession of knowledge, not ignorance, because that is what he has hunted down.

200a

TT: Obviously.

200a

S: Well, we are back again at our initial difficulty after a very circuitous diversion. Indeed, that disputatious man will laugh and say, “How does this work, my good fellows? Does someone who knows both believe that some item of knowledge which he knows is some ignorance which he also knows? Or does he know neither of them, and think that one which he does not know is another which he does not know? Or having known one and not the other, does he believe that the one he knows is the one he does not know, or that the one he does not know is

the one he does know? Or again, will you go on to say to me that there are additional knowledges about the items of knowledge and the ignorances, and that he acquires these knowledges and keeps them in some other ridiculous aviaries or in wax imprints? Does he know these as long as he possesses them, though he may not have them immediately at his disposal, in his soul? Well, are you going to be compelled to go through this same cycle indefinitely without getting anywhere?" How shall we respond to these questions, Theaetetus?

ἀνεπιστημοσύνην λαβὼν ψευδῇ μὲν, φής, δοξάσει. ἦ γάρ; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐ δῆπου καὶ ἡγήσεται γε ψευδῇ δοξάζειν. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γάρ; ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἀληθῇ γε, καὶ ὥς εἰδὼς διακείσεται περὶ ὧν ἔψευσται. ΘΕΑΙ. τί μήν; ΣΩ. ἐπιστήμην ἄρα οἴησεται τεθηρευκῶς ἔχειν ἀλλ' οὐκ ἀνεπιστημοσύνην. ΘΕΑΙ. δῆλον. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν μακρὰν περιελθόντες πάλιν ἐπὶ τὴν πρώτην πάρεσμεν ἀπορίαν. ὁ γὰρ ἐλεγκτικὸς ἐκεῖνος γελάσας φήσει· πότερον, ὦ βέλτιστοι, ἀμφοτέρας τις εἰδὼς, ἐπιστήμην τε καὶ ἀνεπιστημοσύνην, ἣν οἶδεν, ἐτέραν αὐτὴν οἶεται τίνα εἶναι ὧν οἶδεν; ἢ οὐδετέραν αὐτὴν εἰδὼς, ἣν μὴ οἶδε, δοξάζει ἐτέραν ὧν οὐκ οἶδεν; ἢ τὴν μὲν εἰδὼς, τὴν δ' οὐ, ἣν οἶδεν, ἣν μὴ οἶδεν; ἢ ἣν μὴ οἶδεν, ἣν οἶδεν ἡγεῖται; ἢ πάλιν αὖ μοι ἐρεῖτε ὅτι τῶν ἐπιστημῶν καὶ ἀνεπιστημοσυνῶν εἰσὶν αὖ ἐπιστήμαι, ἃς ὁ κεκτημένος ἐν ἐτέροις τισὶ γελοίοις

200c

TT: By Zeus, Socrates, I don't know what we should say.

200c

S: So in that case, my boy, was the argument right to rebuke us and show that we were wrong to set knowledge aside and seek false opinion first, something which it is impossible to understand until we have a proper grasp of what knowledge actually is?

περιστερεῶσιν ἢ κηρίνοις πλάσμασι καθεύρξας, ἕωσπερ ἂν κεκτῇται ἐπίσταται, καὶ ἐὰν μὴ προχείρους ἔχη ἐν τῇ ψυχῇ; καὶ οὕτω δὴ ἀναγκασθήσεσθε εἰς ταῦτόν περιτρέχειν μυριάκις οὐδὲν πλέον ποιοῦντες; τί πρὸς ταῦτα, ὦ Θεαίτητε, ἀποκρινόμεθα; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ μὰ Δί', ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔγωγε οὐκ ἔχω τί χρὴ λέγειν. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν ἡμῖν, ὦ παῖ,

καλῶς ὁ λόγος ἐπιπλήττει καὶ ἐνδείκνυται ὅτι οὐκ ὀρθῶς ψευδῇ δόξαν προτέραν ζητοῦμεν

200d

TT: As things stand, Socrates, we must believe what you are saying.

200d

S: So what are we to say that knowledge is? For I presume we are not going to give up yet.

200d

TT: Far from it, unless you yourself have had enough.

200d

S: Tell me then, what definite statement can we make that involves us in the least selfcontradiction?

200d

TT: The very proposition we tried before. In fact, it is the only one I have.

ἐπιστήμης, ἐκείνην ἀφέντες; τὸ δ' ἐστὶν ἀδύνατον γινῶναι πρὶν ἂν τις ἐπιστήμην ἱκανῶς λάβῃ τί ποτ' ἐστίν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀνάγκη, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐν τῷ παρόντι ὡς λέγεις οἴεσθαι. ΣΩ. τί οὖν τις ἐρεῖ πάλιν ἐξ ἀρχῆς ἐπιστήμην; οὐ γάρ που ἀπεροῦμέν γε πω; ΘΕΑΙ. ἥκιστα, ἐάνπερ μὴ σύ γε ἀπαγορεύῃς. ΣΩ. λέγε δὴ, τί ἂν αὐτὸ μάλιστα εἰπόντες ἥκιστ' ἂν ἡμῖν αὐτοῖς ἐναντιωθεῖμεν;

200e

S: What is it?

200e

TT: That knowledge is true opinion. Forming true opinions is, after all, a process which is supposedly free from error, and whatever arises on this basis is entirely noble and good.

200e

S: The guide by the river bank says, “You will be shown the depth, Theaetetus”, and in this case, once we proceed with our search, perhaps something which turns up along the way may reveal what we are seeking, but if we wait, nothing will become clear.

ΘΕΑΙ. ὅπερ ἐπεχειροῦμεν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐν τῷ πρόσθεν· οὐ γὰρ ἔχω ἔγωγε ἄλλο οὐδέν. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΘΕΑΙ. τὴν ἀληθὴ δόξαν ἐπιστήμην εἶναι. ἀναμάρτητόν γέ πού ἐστιν τὸ δοξάζειν ἀληθῆ, καὶ τὰ ὑπ' αὐτοῦ γιγνόμενα πάντα καλὰ καὶ ἀγαθὰ γίγνεται. ΣΩ. ὁ τὸν ποταμὸν καθηγούμενος, ὦ Θεαίτητε, ἔφη ἄρα δείξειν αὐτό· καὶ τοῦτο ἐὰν ἰόντες ἐρευνῶμεν, τάχ' ἂν

201a

TT: You're right, so let's go ahead and consider this.

201a

S: Well, this will be a brief investigation, for there is a whole profession pointing out to you that true opinion is not knowledge.

201a

TT: How is that? What profession?

201a

S: The profession of the wisest men of all, whom we call orators and advocates. For these men use their skill to persuade rather than teach, and they make people form the opinions they want them to form. Or do you believe that there are teachers so clever that they can adequately teach the truth about what happened to people whose money was stolen or who were otherwise assaulted to people who were not present? Can they do this in the little time allowed by the water-clock in the court?

ἐμπόδιον γενόμενον αὐτὸ φήνειεν τὸ ζητούμενον, μένουσι δὲ δῆλον οὐδέν. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθῶς λέγεις· ἀλλ' ἴωμέν γε καὶ σκοπῶμεν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τοῦτό γε βραχείας σκέψεως τέχνη γάρ σοι ὅλη σημαίνει μὴ εἶναι ἐπιστήμην αὐτό. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δῆ; καὶ τίς αὕτη; ΣΩ. ἡ τῶν μεγίστων εἰς σοφίαν, οὓς δὴ καλοῦσιν ῥήτοράς τε καὶ δικανικούς. οὗτοι γάρ που τῇ ἑαυτῶν τέχνῃ πείθουσιν οὐ διδάσκοντες ἀλλὰ δοξάζειν ποιοῦντες ἃ ἂν βούλωνται. ἢ σὺ οἶε δεινούς τινας οὕτω διδασκάλους εἶναι,

201b

TT: I don't believe that they can teach them at all, but they may persuade them.

201b

S: And don't you say that persuading them is making them form an opinion?

201b

TT: Of course.

201b

S: Now, when a jury is justly persuaded about matters that only an eyewitness and no one else could know, on that occasion they are judging from hearsay. They have caught hold of a true opinion, but haven't they judged without knowledge, having been persuaded of what is right, if their adjudication is actually sound?

ὥστε οἷς μὴ παρεγένοντό τινες ἀποστερουμένοις χρήματα ἢ τι ἄλλο βιαζομένοις, τούτοις δύνασθαι πρὸς ὕδωρ σμικρὸν διδάξαι ἱκανῶς τῶν γενομένων τὴν ἀλήθειαν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδαμῶς ἔγωγε οἶμαι, ἀλλὰ πεῖσαι μὲν. ΣΩ. τὸ πεῖσαι δ' οὐχὶ δοξάσαι λέγεις ποιῆσαι; ΘΕΑΙ. τί μήν; ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὅταν δικαίως πεισθῶσιν δικασταὶ περὶ ὧν ἰδόντι μόνον ἔστιν εἰδέναι, ἄλλως δὲ μή, ταῦτα τότε ἐξ

201c

TT: Entirely so.

201c

S: But, my friend, if knowledge and true opinion are really the same, the best of jurors could never form a correct opinion in the absence of knowledge. So in that case, it seems they are different from one another.

201c

TT: Oh, Socrates, I had forgotten something that I once heard someone saying, but I remember now. He said that true opinion along with an account is knowledge, while in the absence of an account it is outside the realm of knowledge. And whatever is without an account is not knowable – yes, that's the very term he used – while anything that has an account is knowable.

ἀκοῆς κρίνοντες, ἀληθῆ δόξαν λαβόντες, ἄνευ ἐπιστήμης ἔκριναν, ὀρθὰ πεισθέντες, εἴπερ εὖ ἐδίκασαν; ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄν, ὦ φίλε, εἴ γε ταῦτ' ἦν δόξα τε ἀληθὴς καὶ δικαστήρια καὶ ἐπιστήμη, ὀρθὰ ποτ' ἂν δικαστὴς ἄκρος ἐδόξαζεν ἄνευ ἐπιστήμης· νῦν δὲ ἔοικεν ἄλλο τι ἐκάτερον εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. ὃ γε ἐγώ, ὦ Σώκρατες, εἰπόντος τοῦ ἀκούσας ἐπελελήσμεν, νῦν δ' ἐννοῶ ἔφη δὲ τὴν μὲν μετὰ λόγου

201d

S: Well said, but now explain how he distinguished the knowable things from the unknowable, for I may have heard the same things you have heard.

201d

Tt: Well, I don't know if I can work that out. However, if someone else were to explain it, I think that I could follow.

ἀληθῆ δόξαν ἐπιστήμην εἶναι, τὴν δὲ ἄλογον ἐκτὸς ἐπιστήμης· καὶ ὧν μὲν μὴ ἐστὶ λόγος, οὐκ ἐπιστητὰ εἶναι, οὕτως καὶ ὀνομάζων, ἃ δ' ἔχει, ἐπιστητὰ. ΣΩ. ἥ καλῶς λέγεις. τὰ δὲ δὴ ἐπιστητὰ ταῦτα καὶ μὴ πῇ διήρει, λέγε, εἰ ἄρα κατὰ ταῦτα σύ τε κἀγὼ ἀκηκόαμεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλ' οὐκ οἶδα εἰ ἐξευρήσω· λέγοντος μεντὰν ἐτέρου, ὥς ἐγὼμαι, ἀκολουθήσαιμ' ἄν. ΣΩ. ἄκουε δὴ ὄναρ ἀντὶ ὀνειράτος. ἐγὼ γὰρ αὖ ἐδόκουν

201e

S: Then listen to a dream in return for a dream, for I too imagined that I heard from some people that the primary so-called elements from which we and all else are compounded lack any account. For since each, just by itself, may only be named, and nothing else can be said of it, either that it is or that it is not, for in that case we would be assigning being or non-being to it, but we must apply nothing if we are to speak of itself alone. So we should not apply 'it' or 'that' or 'each' or 'only' or 'this' or the numerous other terms like them, for these are in circulation and are applied generally, being different from whatever they are assigned to. But if it were possible to describe an element and it had its own particular account, it would have to be described without all of the others. But as things stand, it is impossible for any of the primals to be expressed in an account, for they can only be named,

since name is all they have. But when things are compounded from the primals, their names are woven together just as they themselves are woven, and they generate an account, for the essence of an account is an interweaving of names. Thus, the elements have no account and are unknowable, and yet they are perceivable, while the compounds are knowable and describable and can be the object of true opinion. Now, whenever someone has acquired a true opinion of something, without an account, then his soul has arrived at the truth about it, but does not know it, for a man who can neither give nor receive an account of a thing is ignorant about it. But once he has acquired an account, all these other things can happen, and he is perfected in knowledge. Was your dream like that or was it different?

ἀκούειν τινῶν ὅτι τὰ μὲν πρῶτα οἰονπερεὶ στοιχεῖα, ἐξ ὧν ἡμεῖς τε συγκείμεθα καὶ τᾶλλα, λόγον οὐκ ἔχοι. ΣΩ. αὐτὸ γὰρ καθ' αὐτὸ ἕκαστον ὀνομάσαι μόνον εἴη, προσεῖπεῖν δὲ οὐδὲν ἄλλο δυνατόν, οὔθ' ὡς ἔστιν, οὔθ' ὡς οὐκ ἔστιν· ἤδη γὰρ ἂν οὐσίαν ἢ μὴ οὐσίαν αὐτῷ προστίθεται, δεῖν δὲ οὐδὲν προσφέρειν, εἴπερ αὐτὸ ἐκεῖνο μόνον τις ἐρεῖ. ἐπεὶ οὐδὲ τὸ αὐτὸ οὐδὲ τὸ ἐκεῖνο οὐδὲ τὸ ἕκαστον οὐδὲ τὸ μόνον οὐδὲ τοῦτο προσοιστέον οὐδ' ἄλλα πολλὰ τοιαῦτα· ταῦτα μὲν γὰρ περιτρέχοντα πᾶσι προσφέρεσθαι, ἕτερα ὄντα ἐκείνων οἷς προστίθεται, δεῖν δέ, εἴπερ ἦν δυνατόν αὐτὸ λέγεσθαι καὶ εἶχεν οἰκεῖον αὐτοῦ λόγον, ἄνευ τῶν ἄλλων ἀπάντων λέγεσθαι. νῦν δὲ ἀδύνατον εἶναι ὅτιοῦν τῶν πρώτων ῥηθῆναι λόγῳ· οὐ γὰρ εἶναι αὐτῷ ἄλλ' ἢ ὀνομάζεσθαι μόνον—ὄνομα γὰρ μόνον ἔχειν—τὰ δὲ ἐκ τούτων ἤδη συγκείμενα, ὥσπερ αὐτὰ πέπλεκται, οὕτω καὶ τὰ ὀνόματα αὐτῶν συμπλακέντα λόγον γεγενῆσθαι· ὀνομάτων γὰρ συμπλοκὴν εἶναι λόγου οὐσίαν. οὕτω δὴ τὰ μὲν στοιχεῖα ἄλογα καὶ ἄγνωστα εἶναι, αἰσθητὰ δέ· τὰς δὲ συλλαβὰς γνωστάς τε καὶ ῥητάς καὶ ἀληθεῖ δόξῃ δοξαστάς. ὅταν μὲν οὖν ἄνευ λόγου τὴν ἀληθεῖ δόξαν τινὸς τις λάβῃ,

202c

TT: It was exactly like that.

202c

S: Are you satisfied then, and are you proposing that true opinion with an account is knowledge?

202c

TT: Quite so.

202c

S: Well, Theaetetus, have we really captured something this very day that generations of wise men have sought and grown old without finding?

ἀληθεύειν μὲν αὐτοῦ τὴν ψυχὴν περὶ αὐτό, γινώσκειν δ' οὐ τὸν γὰρ μὴ δυνάμενον δοῦναί τε καὶ δέξασθαι λόγον ἀνεπιστήμονα εἶναι περὶ τούτου· προσλαβόντα δὲ λόγον δυνατόν τε ταῦτα πάντα γεγονέναι καὶ τελείως πρὸς ἐπιστήμην ἔχειν. οὕτως σὺ τὸ ἐνύπνιον ἢ ἄλλως ἀκήκοας; ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτω μὲν οὖν παντάπασιν. ΣΩ. ἀρέσκει οὖν σε καὶ τίθεσαι ταύτη, δόξαν ἀληθῆ μετὰ λόγου ἐπιστήμην εἶναι; ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ μὲν οὖν.

202d

TT: Socrates, I really believe that what we have just said is an excellent description.

202d

S: And that is quite likely so, for what knowledge could there be in the absence of an account and true opinion? However, there is one thing we said which is bothering me.

202d

TT: What is it?

202d

S: What seems like the cleverest statement of all: that the elements are unknowable, while the class of compounds is knowable.³⁵

ΣΩ. ἄρ', ὦ Θεαίτητε, νῦν οὕτω τῇδε τῇ ἡμέρᾳ εἰλήφαμεν ὃ πάλαι καὶ πολλοὶ τῶν σοφῶν ζητοῦντες πρὶν εὑρεῖν κατεγήρασαν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἐμοὶ γοῦν δοκεῖ, ὦ Σώκρατες, καλῶς λέγεσθαι τὸ νῦν ῥηθέν. ΣΩ. καὶ εἰκός γε αὐτὸ τοῦτο οὕτως ἔχειν· τίς γὰρ ἂν καὶ ἔτι ἐπιστήμη εἴη χωρὶς τοῦ λόγου τε καὶ ὀρθῆς δόξης; ἐν μέντοι τί με τῶν ῥηθέντων ἀπαρέσκει. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον δῆ; ΣΩ. ὃ καὶ δοκεῖ λέγεσθαι κομψότατα, ὥς τὰ μὲν

202e

Tt: What's wrong with that?

202e

S: Well, we need to know, for we are holding the patterns of the argument like hostages, patterns used by the very person who said all this.

202e

Tt: What patterns?

202e

S: The elements and syllables of writing, or do you imagine that the person who said all we are recounting had something else in view?

202e

Tt: No, only these.

202e

S: Now let us test them, and let us test ourselves in particular, as to whether we learned writing on this basis or not. Well, in the first place, do the syllables have an account while the letters do not?

στοιχεῖα ἄγνωστα, τὸ δὲ τῶν συλλαβῶν γένος γνωστόν. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκοῦν ὀρθῶς; ΣΩ. ἰστέον δὴ ὥσπερ γὰρ ὁμήρους ἔχομεν τοῦ λόγου τὰ παραδείγματα οἷς χρώμενος εἶπε πάντα ταῦτα. ΘΕΑΙ. ποῖα δὴ; ΣΩ. τὰ τῶν γραμμάτων στοιχεῖά τε καὶ συλλαβάς. ἢ οἷε ἄλλοσέ ποι βλέποντα ταῦτα εἰπεῖν τὸν εἰπόντα ἃ λέγομεν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκ, ἀλλ' εἰς ταῦτα.

203a

Tt: Perhaps.

203a

S: That is certainly how it seems to me. If someone were to ask about the first syllable of 'Socrates', and said "Theaetetus, what is SO?", how would you respond?

203a

Tt: That it is S and O.³⁶

203a

S: And isn't that your account of the syllable?

203a

TT: It is.

203a

S: Very well, now give an account of S in the same way.

ΣΩ. βασανίζωμεν δὴ αὐτὰ ἀναλαμβάνοντες, μᾶλλον δὲ ἡμᾶς αὐτούς, οὕτως ἢ οὐχ οὕτως γράμματα ἐμάθομεν. φέρε πρῶτον· ἄρ' αἱ μὲν συλλαβαὶ λόγον ἔχουσι, τὰ δὲ στοιχεῖα ἄλογα; ΘΕΑΙ. ἴσως. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν καὶ ἐμοὶ φαίνεται. Σωκράτους γοῦν εἴ τις ἔροιτο τὴν πρώτην συλλαβὴν οὕτως· ὦ Θεαίτητε, λέγε τί ἐστι ΣΩ; τί ἀποκρινῇ; ΘΕΑΙ. ὅτι σῖγμα καὶ ὦ. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τοῦτον ἔχεις λόγον τῆς συλλαβῆς; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔγωγε.

203b

TT: But how could anyone speak of the letters of a letter? Actually, Socrates, the S is one of the voiceless letters, it is just a sound like a hissing of the tongue, while B, for its part, has neither voice nor sound, nor have most of the letters. So it is quite appropriate to say they have no account, when even the clearest of them, the seven vowels, have a voice alone, but no account at all.³⁷

203b

S: So, my friend, we have come to this conclusion about knowledge.

203b

TT: It appears that we have.

203b

S: But what about this? Have we really shown that the elements are unknowable, though the syllables are knowable?

ΣΩ. ἴθι δὴ, οὕτως εἰπὲ καὶ τὸν τοῦ σῖγμα λόγον. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ πῶς τοῦ στοιχείου τις ἐρεῖ στοιχεῖα; καὶ γὰρ δὴ, ὦ Σώκρατες, τό τε σῖγμα τῶν ἀφώνων ἐστί, ψόφος τις μόνον, οἷον συριττούσης τῆς γλώττης· τοῦ δ' αὖ βῆτα οὔτε φωνὴ οὔτε ψόφος, οὐδὲ τῶν πλείστων στοιχείων. ὥστε πάνυ εὖ ἔχει τὸ λέγεσθαι αὐτὰ ἄλογα, ὧν γε τὰ ἐναργέστατα αὐτὰ τὰ ἐπτα φωνὴν μόνον ἔχει, λόγον δὲ οὐδ' ὄντινοῦν. ΣΩ. τουτὶ μὲν ἄρα, ὦ ἐταῖρε, κατωρθώκαμεν περὶ ἐπιστήμης. ΘΕΑΙ. φαινόμεθα.

203c

TT: Quite likely.

203c

S: Well then, are we saying that the syllable is both letters, or all of them if there are more than two, or is it a single form which arises from putting them together?

203c

TT: I presume we are referring to all of them.

203c

S: Then consider two, the S and the O. This pair is the first syllable of my name. Can someone who knows the syllable avoid knowing both letters?

ΣΩ. τί δέ; τὸ μὴ γνωστὸν εἶναι τὸ στοιχεῖον ἀλλὰ τὴν συλλαβὴν ἄρ' ὀρθῶς ἀποδεδεῖγμεθα; ΘΕΑΙ. εἰκός γε. ΣΩ. φέρε δὴ, τὴν συλλαβὴν πότερον λέγομεν τὰ ἀμφοτέρω στοιχεῖα, καὶ ἐὰν πλείω ἢ ἢ δύο, τὰ πάντα, ἢ μίαν τινὰ ιδέαν γεγονυῖαν συντεθέντων αὐτῶν; ΘΕΑΙ. τὰ ἅπαντα ἔμοιγε δοκοῦμεν. ΣΩ. ὅρα δὴ ἐπὶ δυοῖν, σῖγμα καὶ ὦ. ἀμφοτέρω ἐστὶν ἢ πρώτη συλλαβὴ τοῦ ἐμοῦ ὀνόματος. ἄλλο τι ὃ γινώσκων αὐτὴν τὰ ἀμφοτέρω γινώσκει;

203d

TT: Of course not.

203d

S: So he knows the S and the O.

203d

TT: Yes.

203d

S: Yes, but does he know both without knowing one or the other?

203d

TT: No, that would be bizarre and illogical, Socrates.

203d

S: However, if it really is necessary for someone to know each letter if he is to know both, then anyone who is ever going to know the

syllable absolutely must have prior knowledge of the letters. On this basis, our nice proposition has taken to its heels and fled.

ΘΕΑΙ. τί μήν; ΣΩ. τὸ σῖγμα καὶ τὸ ὦ ἄρα γινώσκει. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. τί δ'; ἐκάτερον ἄρ' ἄγνοεῖ καὶ οὐδέτερον εἰδὼς ἀμφοτέρω γινώσκει; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ δεινὸν καὶ ἄλογον, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μέντοι εἴ γε ἀνάγκη ἐκάτερον γινώσκειν, εἴπερ ἀμφοτέρω τις γινώσκειται, προγινώσκειν τὰ στοιχεῖα ἅπαντα ἀνάγκη τῷ μέλλοντί ποτε γινώσσεσθαι συλλαβὴν, καὶ οὕτως ἡμῖν ὁ καλὸς λόγος ἀποδεδρακῶς οἰχίσηται.

203e

TT: And very suddenly too!

203e

S: Yes, we are not being careful enough with it. Perhaps we should be proposing that the syllable is not the letters, but a single form arising from them, having a single form of its own that is different from the letters.

203e

TT: Yes, indeed, and that is probably a better suggestion than the other one.

203e

S: We should consider this, and not give up like cowards on a significant and serious proposition.

203e

TT: We should not.

ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ μάλα γε ἐξαίφνης. ΣΩ. οὐ γὰρ καλῶς αὐτὸν φυλάττομεν. χρῆν γὰρ ἴσως τὴν συλλαβὴν τίθεσθαι μὴ τὰ στοιχεῖα ἀλλ' ἐξ ἐκείνων ἓν τι γεγονὸς εἶδος, ιδέαν μίαν αὐτὸ αὐτοῦ ἔχον, ἕτερον δὲ τῶν στοιχείων. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν καὶ τάχα γ' ἂν μᾶλλον οὕτως ἢ 'κείνως ἔχοι. ΣΩ. σκεπτέον καὶ οὐ προδοτέον οὕτως ἀνάνδρως μέγαν τε καὶ σεμνὸν λόγον. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ γὰρ οὖν.

204a

S: Then let our present statement stand, that a syllable is a single form which arises from joining the individual elements together, such as

occurs in writing and in all other situations.

204a

TT: Yes, certainly.

204a

S: Therefore, it must not have parts.

204a

TT: Why is that?

204a

S: Because the whole must be all the parts of anything which has parts, or do you also say that the whole is a single form that arises from the parts, and is different from all the parts?

204a

TT: I do.

ΣΩ. ἐχέτω δὴ ὡς νῦν φαμεν, μία ἰδέα ἐξ ἐκάστων τῶν συναρμοπτόντων στοιχείων γιγνομένη ἡ συλλαβή, ὁμοίως ἔν τε γράμμασι καὶ ἐν τοῖς ἄλλοις ἅπασι. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν μέρη αὐτῆς οὐ δεῖ εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. τί δὴ; ΣΩ. ὅτι οὗ ἂν ἦ μέρη, τὸ ὅλον ἀνάγκη τὰ πάντα μέρη εἶναι. ἢ καὶ τὸ ὅλον ἐκ τῶν μερῶν λέγεις γεγονὸς ἔν τι εἶδος ἕτερον τῶν πάντων μερῶν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. τὸ δὲ δὴ πᾶν καὶ τὸ ὅλον πότερον ταῦτόν καλεῖς ἢ

204b

S: But do you refer to the entire and the whole as different from one another, or the same?

204b

TT: I am not clear about that, but because you are asking me to respond readily, I'll take a chance and say that they are different.

204b

S: Well, Theaetetus, you have the readiness right, but we should consider whether the answer is right.

204b

TT: Yes, we must do that.

204b

S: So wouldn't the whole be different from the entire, according to the current argument?

204b

TT: Yes.

204b

S: What about this? Is there any difference between 'the entire' and 'them all'? For instance, when we say one, two, three, four, five, six, or twice three, or thrice two, or four plus two, or three plus two plus one, are we talking about the same thing or something different in all such cases?

ἕτερον ἐκάτερον; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔχω μὲν οὐδὲν σαφές, ὅτι δὲ κελεύεις προθύμως ἀποκρίνασθαι, παρακινδυνεύων λέγω ὅτι ἕτερον. ΣΩ. ἢ μὲν προθυμία, ὧ Θεαίτητε, ὀρθή; εἰ δὲ καὶ ἡ ἀπόκρισις, σκεπτέον. ΘΕΑΙ. δεῖ γε δῆ. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν διαφέροι ἂν τὸ ὅλον τοῦ παντός, ὥς ὁ νῦν λόγος; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. τί δὲ δῆ; τὰ πάντα καὶ τὸ πᾶν ἔσθ' ὅτι διαφέρει; οἷον ἐπειδὴν λέγωμεν ἓν, δύο, τρία, τέτταρα, πέντε, ἕξ, καὶ

204c

TT: The same.

204c

S: And is that different from six?

204c

TT: No.

204c

S: Then, with each statement haven't we referred to all six?

204c

TT: Yes.

204c

S: But if we say 'the entire', aren't we referring again to one thing?

204c

TT: We must be.

204c

S: And is that a different thing from the six?

204c

Tt: No.

204c

S: So, in any cases involving number, do we refer to ‘the entire’ and ‘them all’ as the same?

ἐὰν δις τρία ἢ τρὶς δύο ἢ τέτταρά τε καὶ δύο ἢ τρία καὶ δύο καὶ ἓν, πότερον ἐν πᾶσι τούτοις τὸ αὐτὸ ἢ ἕτερον λέγομεν; ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ αὐτό. ΣΩ. ἄρ’ ἄλλο τι ἢ ἕξ; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδέν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἐφ’ ἐκάστης λέξεως πάντα ἐξ εἰρήκαμεν; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. πᾶν δ’ οὐδὲν λέγομεν τὰ πάντα λέγοντες; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. ἢ ἄλλο τι ἢ τὰ ἕξ; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδέν.

204d

Tt: It appears so.

204d

S: Then let us talk about them as follows: the number of a mile and a mile are the same, aren’t they?

204d

Tt: Yes.

204d

S: This also applies to the number of a furlong.

204d

Tt: Yes.

204d

S: Similarly, in the case of an army and the number of an army, and everything of that kind, the entire number is what each of them entirely is.

204d

Tt: Yes.

204d

S: But is the number of each, anything other than the parts?

204d

Tt: Nothing other.

ΣΩ. ταῦτόν ἄρα ἔν γε τοῖς ὅσα ἐξ ἀριθμοῦ ἐστὶ τό τε πᾶν
προσαγορεύομεν καὶ τὰ ἅπαντα; ΘΕΑΙ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. ὥδε δὴ περὶ αὐτῶν
λέγωμεν. ὁ τοῦ πλέθρου ἀριθμὸς καὶ τὸ πλέθρον ταυτόν· ἢ γάρ; ΘΕΑΙ.
ναί. ΣΩ. καὶ ὁ τοῦ σταδίου δὴ ὡσαύτως. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν καὶ ὁ τοῦ
στρατοπέδου γε καὶ τὸ στρατόπεδον, καὶ πάντα τὰ τοιαῦτα ὁμοίως; ὁ
γὰρ ἀριθμὸς πᾶς τὸ ὄν πᾶν ἕκαστον αὐτῶν ἐστίν. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί.

204e

S: And in so far as something has parts, it would consist of parts?

204e

TT: It appears so.

204e

S: But we did agree that all the parts are the entire, if in fact the entire number is also the entire.

204e

TT: So we did.

204e

S: Then the whole does not consist of parts, for if it were all the parts, the whole would be the entire.

204e

TT: So it seems.

204e

S: But is a part, as such, part of anything other than a whole?

204e

TT: Yes, of the entire.

204e

S: Well, you are putting up a brave fight, Theaetetus, but isn't the entire actually entire whenever there is nothing missing?

ΣΩ. ὁ δὲ ἐκάστων ἀριθμὸς μῶν ἄλλο τι ἢ μέρη ἐστίν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδέν. ΣΩ.
ὅσα ἄρα ἔχει μέρη, ἐκ μερῶν ἂν εἴη; ΘΕΑΙ. φαίνεται. ΣΩ. τὰ δέ γε πάντα
μέρη τὸ πᾶν εἶναι ὡμολόγηται, εἴπερ καὶ ὁ πᾶς ἀριθμὸς τὸ πᾶν ἔσται.
ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΣΩ. τὸ ὅλον ἄρ' οὐκ ἔστιν ἐκ μερῶν. πᾶν γὰρ ἂν εἴη τὰ

πάντα ὃν μέρη. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκ ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. μέρος δ' ἔσθ' ὅτου ἄλλου ἐστὶν ὅπερ ἐστὶν ἢ τοῦ ὅλου; ΘΕΑΙ. τοῦ παντός γε.

205a

TT: Necessarily.

205a

S: But won't that same thing from which nothing is missing be a whole? And that from which something is missing is neither whole nor entire; from the same effect, the same cause arises in both.

205a

TT: It seems to me now that there is no difference between whole and entire.

205a

S: Were we not saying that for anything with parts, the whole and also the entire will be all the parts?

205a

TT: Yes, indeed.

205a

S: Now, returning to my previous enquiry, if the syllable is not the letters, it must not have the letters as parts of itself, or else it will be the same as them and be just as knowable as they are. Is that it?

ΣΩ. ἀνδρικῶς γε, ὦ Θεαίτητε, μάχη. τὸ πᾶν δὲ οὐχ ὅταν μηδὲν ἀπῇ, αὐτὸ τοῦτο πᾶν ἐστίν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. ὅλον δὲ οὐ ταὐτὸν τοῦτο ἔσται, οὔ ἂν μηδαμῇ μηδὲν ἀποστατῇ; οὔ δ' ἂν ἀποστατῇ, οὔτε ὅλον οὔτε πᾶν, ἅμα γενόμενον ἐκ τοῦ αὐτοῦ τὸ αὐτό; ΘΕΑΙ. δοκεῖ μοι νῦν οὐδὲν διαφέρειν πᾶν τε καὶ ὅλον. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἐλέγομεν ὅτι οὔ ἂν μέρη ᾦ, τὸ ὅλον τε καὶ πᾶν τὰ πάντα μέρη ἔσται; ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. πάλιν δὴ, ὅπερ ἄρτι ἐπεχείρουν, οὐκ, εἶπερ ἢ

205b

TT: That's it.

205b

S: And to prevent this from happening, didn't we propose that it was different from the letters?

205b

Tt: Yes.

205b

S: Well then, if the letters are not parts of the syllable, can you propose other candidates that are part of the syllable, without, however, being the letters of the syllable?

205b

Tt: Certainly not, Socrates, for if I were to agree that it has some parts, it would be a bit ridiculous to ignore the letters and look for other candidates.

205b

S: Yes, entirely so, Theaetetus, based upon the current proposition, a syllable would be a single indivisible form.

συλλαβὴ μὴ τὰ στοιχεῖά ἐστιν, ἀνάγκη αὐτὴν μὴ ὡς μέρη ἔχειν ἑαυτῆς τὰ στοιχεῖα, ἢ ταὐτὸν οὔσαν αὐτοῖς ὁμοίως ἐκείνοις γνωστὴν εἶναι; ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τοῦτο ἵνα μὴ γένηται, ἕτερον αὐτῶν αὐτὴν ἐθέμεθα; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. τί δ'; εἰ μὴ τὰ στοιχεῖα συλλαβῆς μέρη ἐστίν, ἔχεις ἄλλ' ἅττα εἰπεῖν ἃ μέρη μὲν ἐστὶ συλλαβῆς, οὐ μέντοι στοιχεῖά γ' ἐκείνης; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδαμῶς. εἰ γάρ, ὦ Σώκратες, μόρι' ἅττ' αὐτῆς συγχωροίην, γελοῖόν που τὰ στοιχεῖα ἀφέντα ἐπ' ἄλλα ἰέναι.

205c

Tt: So it seems.

205c

S: Now, my friend, do you remember a little while ago we accepted what we regarded as a sound proposal, that there is no account of the primals from which all else is compounded because each of them, just by itself, is uncompounded, and neither the terms 'is' nor 'this' can properly be applied to them as they describe different and distinct things, and this is the reason why a primal is indescribable and unknowable?

205c

Tt: I remember.

ΣΩ. παντάπασι δὴ, ὦ Θεαίτητε, κατὰ τὸν νῦν λόγον μία τις ἰδέα ἀμέριστος συλλαβὴ ἂν εἴη. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. μέμνησαι οὖν, ὦ φίλε, ὅτι ὀλίγον ἐν τῷ πρόσθεν ἀπεδεχόμεθα ἡγούμενοι εὖ λέγεσθαι ὅτι τῶν πρώτων οὐκ εἴη λόγος ἐξ ὧν τᾶλλα σύγκειται, διότι αὐτὸ καθ' αὐτὸ ἕκαστον εἴη ἀσύνθετον, καὶ οὐδὲ τὸ εἶναι περὶ αὐτοῦ ὁρθῶς ἔχει προσφέροντα εἰπεῖν, οὐδὲ τοῦτο, ὡς ἕτερα καὶ ἀλλότρια λεγόμενα, καὶ αὕτη δὴ ἡ αἰτία ἄλογόν τε καὶ ἄγνωστον αὐτὸ ποιοῖ; ΘΕΑΙ. μέμνημαι.

205d

S: Well, is this the reason why it is uniform and indivisible, or is there another? Indeed, I can discern no other.

205d

Tt: No, it appears that there is no other.

205d

S: Doesn't the compound fall into the same category as the element, if in fact it has no parts and is one form?

205d

Tt: Entirely so.

205d

S: So then, if the compound is many elements, and is a whole with the elements as its parts, the compounds will be just as knowable and expressible as the elements, since the many parts have turned out to be the same as the whole.

ΣΩ. ἥ οὖν ἄλλη τις ἢ αὕτη ἡ αἰτία τοῦ μονοειδές τε καὶ ἀμέριστον αὐτὸ εἶναι; ἐγὼ μὲν γὰρ οὐχ ὁρῶ ἄλλην. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ γὰρ οὖν δὴ φαίνεται. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἰς ταῦτον ἐμπέπτωκεν ἡ συλλαβὴ εἶδος ἐκείνῳ, εἵπερ μέρη τε μὴ ἔχει καὶ μία ἐστὶν ἰδέα; ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. εἰ μὲν ἄρα πολλὰ στοιχεῖα ἡ συλλαβὴ ἐστὶν καὶ ὅλον τι, μέρη δ' αὐτῆς ταῦτα, ὁμοίως αἱ τε συλλαβαὶ γνωσταὶ καὶ ῥηταὶ καὶ τὰ στοιχεῖα, ἐπεὶπερ τὰ πάντα μέρη τῷ ὅλῳ ταῦτον ἐφάνη.

205e

Tt: Certainly.

205e

S: But if, on the other hand, the compound is one and partless, the compound, like the element, will be just as indescribable and unknowable for the same reason. The unity and indivisibility will make them so.

205e

TT: I cannot disagree with you.

205e

S: So we should not accept it when someone says that the compound is knowable and expressible while the element is not.

205e

TT: No, indeed not, if we are persuaded by this argument.

ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ μάλα. ΣΩ. εἰ δέ γε ἓν τε καὶ ἀμερές, ὁμοίως μὲν συλλαβή, ὡσαύτως δὲ στοιχεῖον ἄλογόν τε καὶ ἄγνωστον· ἡ γὰρ αὕτη αἰτία ποιήσει αὐτὰ τοιαῦτα. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκ ἔχω ἄλλως εἰπεῖν. ΣΩ. τοῦτο μὲν ἄρα μὴ ἀποδεχόμεθα, ὅς ἂν λέγῃ συλλαβὴν μὲν γνωστὸν καὶ ῥητόν, στοιχεῖον δὲ τούναντίον. ΘΕΑΙ. μὴ γάρ, εἴπερ τῷ λόγῳ πειθόμεθα.

206a

S: Well then, would it be better to agree with someone who says the opposite, because of what you yourself discern in the process of learning to write?

206a

TT: What do I discern?

206a

S: In learning to write, you have achieved no more than the ability to recognise each letter, just by itself, with your eyes and ears, so that its position in speech or writing does not confuse you.

206a

TT: What you say is very true.

ΣΩ. τί δ' αὖ; τούναντίον λέγοντος ἄρ' οὐ μᾶλλον ἂν ἀποδέξαιο ἐξ ὧν αὐτὸς σύνοισθα σαυτῷ ἐν τῇ τῶν γραμμάτων μαθήσει; ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. ὥς οὐδὲν ἄλλο μανθάνων διετέλεσας ἢ τὰ στοιχεῖα ἐν τε τῇ ὄψει διαγιγνώσκειν πειρώμενος καὶ ἐν τῇ ἀκοῇ αὐτὸ καθ' αὐτὸ ἕκαστον, ἵνα

μή ἢ θέσις σε τaráττοι λεγομένων τε καὶ γραφομένων. ΘΕΑΙ.
ἀληθέστατα λέγεις. ΣΩ. ἐν δὲ κιθαριστοῦ τελέως μεμαθηκέναι μῶν
ἄλλο τι

206b

S: And isn't the perfectly trained lyre player able to follow each note and say what string it came from? And wouldn't anyone agree that these notes are the letters of music?

206b

TT: They would.

206b

S: Now, if we had to generalise to others from the letters and syllables within our own experience, we would say that having knowledge of the elemental category is much more critical and important in the complete apprehension of each subject than knowledge of the compound. And if anyone says that the compound is knowable while the element is by nature unknowable, we shall assume that he is joking, either deliberately or unwittingly.

206b

TT: We certainly will.

ἦν ἢ τὸ τῷ φθόγγῳ ἐκάστῳ δύνασθαι ἐπακολουθεῖν, ποίας χορδῆς εἴη ἃ
δὴ στοιχεῖα πᾶς ἂν ὁμολογήσειε μουσικῆς λέγεσθαι; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδὲν ἄλλο.
ΣΩ. ὦν μὲν ἄρ' αὐτοῖ ἔμπειροὶ ἐσμεν στοιχείων καὶ συλλαβῶν, εἰ δεῖ
ἀπὸ τούτων τεκμαίρεσθαι καὶ εἰς τὰ ἄλλα, πολὺ τὸ τῶν στοιχείων γένος
ἐναργεστέραν τε τὴν γνῶσιν ἔχειν φήσομεν καὶ κυριωτέραν τῆς
συλλαβῆς πρὸς τὸ λαβεῖν τελέως ἕκαστον μάθημα, καὶ ἐάν τις φῇ
συλλαβὴν μὲν γνωστόν, ἄγνωστον δὲ πεφυκέναι στοιχεῖον, ἐκόντα ἢ
ἄκοντα παίζειν ἡγησόμεθ' αὐτόν. ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ μὲν οὔν.

206c

S: Now, I think even more proofs of this may turn up, but we must not forget the current issue because of them. We want to see what is meant by the statement that the most complete knowledge arises from the addition of an account to true opinion.

206c

TT: Yes, we need to see that.

206c

S: Come then, what exactly are we supposed to understand by ‘an account’? For it seems to me to mean one of three things.

206c

TT: What are they?

ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ δὴ τούτου μὲν ἔτι κἂν ἄλλαι φανεῖεν ἀποδείξεις, ὥς ἐμοὶ δοκεῖ· τὸ δὲ προκείμενον μὴ ἐπιλαθώμεθα δι’ αὐτὰ ἰδεῖν, ὅτι δὴ ποτε καὶ λέγεται τὸ μετὰ δόξης ἀληθοῦς λόγον προσγεγόμενον τὴν τελεωτάτην ἐπιστήμην γεγονέναι. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκοῦν χρή ὁρᾶν. ΣΩ. φέρε δὴ, τί ποτε βούλεται τὸν λόγον ἡμῖν σημαίνειν; τριῶν γὰρ ἓν τί μοι δοκεῖ λέγειν. ΘΕΑΙ. τίνων δὴ;

206d

S: The first would involve making one’s thoughts manifest in sound, using verbs and nouns, forming the opinion into an image in the stream issuing from the mouth, just like an image in a mirror or in water. Or don’t you think that an account is something of that sort?

206d

TT: I do. Anyway, we do say that a person who is doing this is giving an account.

206d

S: What is more, this can actually be done quite easily by everybody, so anyone who is not born deaf and dumb can explain what they think about every issue. This being the case, anyone who forms a right opinion will turn out to have that opinion with an account, and right opinion without knowledge will never arise at all.

ΣΩ. τὸ μὲν πρῶτον εἴη ἂν τὸ τὴν αὐτοῦ διάνοιαν ἐμφανῆ ποιεῖν διὰ φωνῆς μετὰ ῥημάτων τε καὶ ὀνομάτων, ὥσπερ εἰς κάτοπτρον ἢ ὕδωρ τὴν δόξαν ἐκτυπούμενον εἰς τὴν διὰ τοῦ στόματος ῥοήν. ἢ οὐ δοκεῖ σοι τὸ τοιοῦτον λόγος εἶναι; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔμοιγε. τὸν γοῦν αὐτὸ δρῶντα λέγειν φαμέν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν αὖ τοῦτό γε πᾶς ποιεῖν δυνατὸς θᾶπτον ἢ

σχολαίτερον, τὸ ἐνδείξασθαι τί δοκεῖ περὶ ἐκάστου αὐτῷ, ὃ μὴ ἐνεὸς ἢ κωφὸς ἀπ' ἀρχῆς· καὶ οὕτως ὅσοι τι ὀρθὸν

206e

TT: True.

206e

S: Well, we should not be too quick to accuse the person who made the statement about knowledge, which we are now considering, of talking nonsense, for perhaps he did not mean this, but did not have the ability to give an answer in terms of the elements when asked what anything is.

δοξάζουσι, πάντες αὐτὸ μετὰ λόγου φανοῦνται ἔχοντες, καὶ οὐδαμοῦ ἔτι ὀρθὴ δόξα χωρὶς ἐπιστήμης γενήσεται. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ. ΣΩ. μὴ τοίνυν ῥαδίως καταγιγνώσκωμεν τὸ μηδὲν εἰρηκέναι τὸν ἀποφηνάμενον ἐπιστήμην ὃ νῦν σκοποῦμεν. ἴσως γὰρ ὁ λέγων οὐ τοῦτο ἔλεγεν, ἀλλὰ τὸ ἐρωτηθέντα τί ἕκαστον δυνατὸν εἶναι τὴν ἀπόκρισιν διὰ τῶν στοιχείων

207a

TT: Can you give an example, Socrates?

207a

S: Yes, it is like Hesiod referring to “the one hundred wooden parts of a wagon”.³⁸ Now, I could not say what they are, nor, I imagine, could you, but if we were asked what a wagon is, we would be satisfied if we could say “wheels, an axle, body, rails and yoke”.

207a

TT: Yes, certainly.

207a

S: And yet, he might think we were ridiculous, just as if we responded based upon the syllables when asked what your name was. Ridiculous because, although what we said was correctly conceived and expressed, we thought we were grammarians who had a grammatical account of Theaetetus’ name and were expressing it. Whereas, it is not possible to give a knowledgeable account of anything until you can describe that

by means of the elements combined with true opinion, as I think we said before.

ἀποδοῦναι τῷ ἐρομένῳ. ΘΕΑΙ. οἷον τί λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. οἷον καὶ Ἡσίοδος περὶ ἀμάξης λέγει τὸ ἑκατὸν δέ τε δούραθ' ἀμάξης. ἃ ἐγὼ μὲν οὐκ ἂν δυνάμην εἰπεῖν, οἶμαι δὲ οὐδὲ σύ· ἀλλ' ἀγαπῶμεν ἂν ἐρωτηθέντες ὅτι ἐστὶν ἅμαξα, εἰ ἔχοιμεν εἰπεῖν τροχοί, ἄξων, ὑπερτερία, ἄντυγες, ζυγόν. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὔν. ΣΩ. ὁ δέ γε ἴσως οἶοιτ' ἂν ἡμᾶς, ὥσπερ ἂν τὸ σὸν ὄνομα ἐρωτηθέντας καὶ ἀποκρινομένους κατὰ συλλαβήν,

207b

TT: Yes, we said that.

207b

S: Now, he will accept that while we really do have true opinion about the wagon in this way, someone who is able to describe its being by means of those one hundred parts, once he has also attained this, has added an account to the true opinion, and becomes expert and knowledgeable about the being of the wagon rather than merely opinionated, as he has described the whole by means of the elements.

γελοίους εἶναι, ὀρθῶς μὲν δοξάζοντας καὶ λέγοντας ἃ λέγομεν, οἰομένους δὲ γραμματικούς εἶναι καὶ ἔχειν τε καὶ λέγειν γραμματικῶς τὸν τοῦ Θεαιτήτου ὀνόματος λόγον· τὸ δ' οὐκ εἶναι ἐπιστημόνως οὐδὲν λέγειν, πρὶν ἂν διὰ τῶν στοιχείων μετὰ τῆς ἀληθοῦς δόξης ἕκαστον περαίνει τις, ὅπερ καὶ ἐν τοῖς πρόσθε που ἐρρήθη. ΘΕΑΙ. ἐρρήθη γάρ. ΣΩ. οὕτω τοίνυν καὶ περὶ ἀμάξης ἡμᾶς μὲν ὀρθὴν ἔχειν δόξαν, τὸν δὲ διὰ τῶν ἑκατὸν ἐκείνων δυνάμενον διελθεῖν

207c

TT: Don't you think this is sound, Socrates?

207c

S: Tell me whether you think so, my friend, and whether you accept that a description of anything based upon the elements is an account, while it is not an account if it is based on compounds or larger units. Tell me so that we can consider it.

αὐτῆς τὴν οὐσίαν, προσλαβόντα τοῦτο, λόγον τε προσειληφέναι τῇ ἀληθεῖ δόξῃ καὶ ἀντὶ δοξαστικοῦ τεχνικόν τε καὶ ἐπιστήμονα περὶ ἀμάξης οὐσίας γεγονέναι, διὰ στοιχείων τὸ ὅλον περάναντα. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκοῦν εὖ δοκεῖ σοι, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. εἰ σοί, ὦ ἑταῖρε, δοκεῖ, καὶ ἀποδέχῃ τὴν διὰ στοιχείου διέξοδον περὶ ἐκάστου λόγον εἶναι, τὴν δὲ κατὰ συλλαβὰς ἢ καὶ κατὰ μεῖζον ἔτι ἀλογίαν, τοῦτό μοι λέγε,

207d

TT: Yes, I certainly accept this.

207d

S: And do you regard anyone as knowledgeable about something when he thinks that the same element is part of something at one moment, and part of something different the next, or when he thinks one element, and then a different element, belongs to the same thing?

207d

TT: By Zeus, I do not.

207d

S: Then, are you forgetting that this is what you and the other boys did when you began learning to read and write?

207d

TT: Do you mean that we first believed that one letter, then a different letter, belonged to the same syllable, or we placed the same letter sometimes in the appropriate syllable, and at other times in a different one?

ἴν' αὐτὸ ἐπισκοπῶμεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ πάνυ ἀποδέχομαι. ΣΩ. πότερον ἡγούμενος ἐπιστήμονα εἶναι ὄντινοῦν ὅτουοῦν, ὅταν τὸ αὐτὸ τοτὲ μὲν τοῦ αὐτοῦ δοκῇ αὐτῷ εἶναι, τοτὲ δὲ ἑτέρου, ἢ καὶ ὅταν τοῦ αὐτοῦ τοτὲ μὲν ἕτερον, τοτὲ δὲ ἕτερον δοξάζῃ; ΘΕΑΙ. μὰ Δί' οὐκ ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. εἴτα ἀμνημονεῖς ἐν τῇ τῶν γραμμάτων μαθήσει κατ' ἀρχὰς σαυτόν τε καὶ τοὺς ἄλλους δρῶντας αὐτά; ΘΕΑΙ. ἄρα λέγεις τῆς αὐτῆς συλλαβῆς τοτὲ μὲν ἕτερον,

207e

S: That is what I mean.

207e

Tt: By Zeus, I certainly have not forgotten, nor do I regard people as knowledgeable when they are at that stage.

207e

S: What about a situation where someone is writing ‘Theaetetus’ and writes TH and E because he thinks he should, but when he goes on to try to write ‘Theodorus’, he writes T and E because he thinks he should?³⁹ Shall we say that this fellow knows the first syllable of both your names?

τοτὲ δὲ ἕτερον ἡγουμένους γράμμα, καὶ τὸ αὐτὸ τοτὲ μὲν εἰς τὴν προσήκουσαν, τοτὲ δὲ εἰς ἄλλην τιθέντας συλλαβὴν; ΣΩ. ταῦτα λέγω. ΘΕΑΙ. μὰ Δί' οὐ τοίνυν ἀμνημονῶ, οὐδέ γέ πω ἡγοῦμαι ἐπίστασθαι τοὺς οὕτως ἔχοντας. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; ὅταν ἐν τῷ τοιούτῳ καιρῷ Θεαίτητον γράφων τις θῇτα καὶ εἴ οἴηταί τε δεῖν γράφειν καὶ γράψῃ,

208a

Tt: No, we have already agreed that when a person is at that stage he does not yet know.

208a

S: And could he be in a similar predicament about the second syllable, and the third and the fourth?

208a

Tt: There is no reason why not.

208a

S: Therefore, when he has a description based on the letters, he will write ‘Theaetetus’ with right opinion, once he writes it in the proper sequence.

208a

Tt: Obviously.

καὶ αὖ Θεόδωρον ἐπιχειρῶν γράφειν ταῦ καὶ εἴ οἴηταί τε δεῖν γράφειν καὶ γράψῃ, ἅρ' ἐπίστασθαι φήσομεν αὐτὸν τὴν πρώτην τῶν ὑμετέρων ὀνομάτων συλλαβὴν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλ' ἄρτι ὡμολογήσαμεν τὸν οὕτως ἔχοντα μήπω εἰδέναι. ΣΩ. κωλύει οὖν τι καὶ περὶ τὴν δευτέραν συλλαβὴν καὶ

τρίτην καὶ τετάρτην οὕτως ἔχειν τὸν αὐτόν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδέν γε. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν τότε τὴν διὰ στοιχείου διέξοδον ἔχων γράψει Θεαίτητον μετὰ ὀρθῆς δόξης, ὅταν ἐξῆς γράφῃ; ΘΕΑΙ. δῆλον δή.

208b

S: Isn't he still devoid of knowledge, though he is forming a right opinion according to us?

208b

TT: Yes.

208b

S: Yet he has an account along with right opinion, for he was writing using an approach by means of the elements, and we agreed that this constitutes an account.

208b

TT: True.

208b

S: So, my friend, here we have right opinion combined with an account that should not yet be called knowledge.

208b

TT: I'm afraid so.

208b

S: Well, it seems our wealth was but a dream when we imagined we had a perfectly true account of knowledge. But are we condemning it too soon? Perhaps an account should not be defined like this, for there were three options available to a person who defines knowledge as right opinion together with an account, and the last of the three still remains.

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἔτι ἀνεπιστήμων ὢν, ὀρθὰ δὲ δοξάζων, ὥς φαμεν; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. λόγον γε ἔχων μετὰ ὀρθῆς δόξης. τὴν γὰρ διὰ τοῦ στοιχείου ὁδὸν ἔχων ἔγραφεν, ἣν δὴ λόγον ὠμολογήσαμεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ. ΣΩ. ἔστιν ἄρα, ᾧ ἐταῖρε, μετὰ λόγου ὀρθὴ δόξα, ἣν οὐπω δεῖ ἐπιστήμην καλεῖν. ΘΕΑΙ. κινδυνεύει. ΣΩ. ὅναρ δή, ὥς ἔοικεν, ἐπλουτήσαμεν

οἰηθέντες ἔχειν τὸν ἀληθέστατον ἐπιστήμης λόγον. ἢ μήπω κατηγορῶμεν;

208c

TT: You are right to remind me. Yes, there is one remaining option. The first was an image of thought expressed in speech, the one we have just discussed was the approach to the entire based upon the elements. Now, what do you say the third option is?

208c

S: Exactly what most people would say it is – being able to express some indication by which the item in question is distinguished from everything else.

208c

TT: Can you give me an example of an account of something?

ΣΩ. ἴσως γὰρ οὐ τοῦτό τις αὐτὸν ὀριεῖται, ἀλλὰ τὸ λοιπὸν εἶδος τῶν τριῶν, ὧν ἓν γέ τι ἔφαμεν λόγον θήσεσθαι τὸν ἐπιστήμην ὀριζόμενον δόξαν εἶναι ὀρθὴν μετὰ λόγου. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθῶς ὑπέμνησας· ἔτι γὰρ ἐν λοιπόν. τὸ μὲν γὰρ ἦν διανοίας ἐν φωνῇ ὥσπερ εἶδωλον, τὸ δ' ἄρτι λεχθὲν διὰ στοιχείου ὁδὸς ἐπὶ τὸ ὅλον· τὸ δὲ δὴ τρίτον τί λέγεις; ΣΩ. ὅπερ ἂν οἱ πολλοὶ εἴποιεν, τὸ ἔχειν τι σημεῖον εἰπεῖν ὃ τῶν ἀπάντων διαφέρει τὸ ἐρωτηθέν. ΘΕΑΙ. οἷον τίνα τίνος ἔχεις μοι λόγον εἰπεῖν;

208d

S: If you wish. For instance, the statement that the sun is the brightest of the heavenly bodies moving round the earth would, I believe, be quite acceptable to you.

208d

TT: Yes, certainly.

208d

S: Now, understand why such a statement is made, and in fact we have just given the reason. Once you understand the distinguishing characteristic by which something is distinguished from others, you will, some say, have obtained an account of it. But as long as you

apprehend some common feature, your account will relate to whatever entities have this in common.

ΣΩ. οἶον, εἰ βούλει, ἡλίου περί ικανὸν οἶμαί σοι εἶναι ἀποδέξασθαι, ὅτι τὸ λαμπρότατόν ἐστι τῶν κατὰ τὸν οὐρανὸν ἰόντων περὶ γῆν. ΘΕΑΙ. πάννυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. λαβὲ δὴ οὗ χάριν εἴρηται. ἔστι δὲ ὅπερ ἄρτι ἐλέγομεν, ὥς ἄρα τὴν διαφορὰν ἐκάστου ἂν λαμβάνῃς ἢ τῶν ἄλλων διαφέρει, λόγον, ὥς φασί τινες, λήψῃ ἕως δ' ἂν κοινοῦ τινος ἐφάπτη, ἐκείνων περὶ σοι ἔσται ὁ λόγος ὧν ἂν ἡ κοινότης ᾖ.

208e

TT: I understand, and I think it is appropriate to refer to this sort of thing as an account.

208e

S: Once someone with right opinion about any one of the things that are also grasps its distinction from the others, he will become knowledgeable about that of which he was previously just opinionated.

208e

TT: So we say anyway.

208e

S: Well now, Theaetetus, since I have come closer to this statement, I understand it even less. It is like those shadow drawings which only seem to make sense as long as you stand far away from them.

208e

TT: What do you mean?

ΘΕΑΙ. μανθάνω· καί μοι δοκεῖ καλῶς ἔχειν λόγον τὸ τοιοῦτον καλεῖν. ΣΩ. ὅς δ' ἂν μετ' ὀρθῆς δόξης περὶ ὁτουοῦν τῶν ὄντων τὴν διαφορὰν τῶν ἄλλων προσλάβῃ, αὐτοῦ ἐπιστήμων γεγονῶς ἔσται οὗ πρότερον ἢν δοξαστής. ΘΕΑΙ. φαμέν γε μὴν οὕτω. ΣΩ. νῦν δὴτα, ὦ Θεαίτητε, παντάπασιν ἔγωγε, ἐπειδὴ ἐγγὺς ὥσπερ σκιαγραφήματος γέγονα τοῦ λεγομένου, συνίημι οὐδὲ σμικρόν· ἕως δὲ ἀφειστήκη πόρρωθεν, ἐφαίνετό τί μοι λέγεσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς τί τοῦτο;

209a

S: I shall tell you if I can. I have right opinion about you, and if I also obtain an account of you, I shall actually know you, but otherwise I shall only be forming opinions.

209a

Tt: Yes.

209a

S: But the account is an explanation of your distinctiveness.

209a

Tt: So it is.

209a

S: Therefore, while I was only forming opinions, I had no mental grasp of anything at all by which you are distinguished from others.

209a

Tt: Apparently not.

209a

S: So, I had some common qualities in mind that you, as well as anyone else, possess.

209a

Tt: So you must.

ΣΩ. φράσω, ἐὰν οἷός τε γένωμαι. ὀρθὴν ἔγωγε ἔχων δόξαν περὶ σοῦ, ἐὰν μὲν προσλάβω τὸν σὸν λόγον, γινώσκω δὴ σε, εἰ δὲ μή, δοξάζω μόνον. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. λόγος δέ γε ἦν ἡ τῆς σῆς διαφορότητος ἐρμηνεία. ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΣΩ. ἡνίκ' οὖν ἐδόξαζον μόνον, ἄλλο τι ὧ τῶν ἄλλων διαφέρεις, τούτων οὐδενὸς ἡπτόμην τῇ διανοίᾳ; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκ ἔοικε. ΣΩ. τῶν κοινῶν τι ἄρα διανοοῦμένην, ὧν οὐδὲν σὺ μᾶλλον ἢ τις ἄλλος ἔχει.

209b

S: Come, by Zeus, in that case how did I ever form an opinion about you rather than anyone else? For I suppose I am thinking that this is Theaetetus, who is human and has a nose, eyes and mouth, and so on for each of the organs. Will these ideas themselves enable me to think of Theaetetus rather than Theodorus, or any out-and-out Mysian, as the saying goes?

209b

Tt: How could they?

209b

S: However, if I do not think only of people with a nose and eyes, but of those with a snub-nose and protruding eyes, won't I form an opinion, in that case, which applies to you as much as to myself or anyone else like us?

ΘΕΑΙ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. φέρε δὴ πρὸς Διός· πῶς ποτε ἐν τῷ τοιούτῳ σὲ μᾶλλον ἐδόξαζον ἢ ἄλλον ὄντινόν; θές γάρ με διανοούμενον ὡς ἔστιν οὗτος Θεαίτητος, ὃς ἂν ἦ τε ἄνθρωπος καὶ ἔχη ῥίνα καὶ ὀφθαλμοὺς καὶ στόμα καὶ οὕτω δὴ ἐν ἑκάστῳ τῶν μελῶν. αὕτη οὖν ἡ διάνοια ἔσθ' ὅτι μᾶλλον ποιήσει με Θεαίτητον ἢ Θεόδωρον διανοεῖσθαι, ἢ τῶν λεγομένων Μυσῶν τὸν ἔσχατον; ΘΕΑΙ. τί γάρ; ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἐὰν δὴ μὴ μόνον τὸν ἔχοντα ῥίνα καὶ ὀφθαλμοὺς

209c

Tt: Yes.

209c

S: In fact, Theaetetus will register no opinion within me until this snub-nosedness forms a distinct record imprinted within me, which is different from the record of any other snubnosedness which I have seen. The same goes for your other characteristics, and this imprint will act as a reminder if I meet you tomorrow, and will enable me to form a correct opinion about you.

209c

Tt: Very true.

209c

S: So, in each case, right opinion would be concerned with distinctiveness.

διανοηθῶ, ἀλλὰ καὶ τὸν σιμόν τε καὶ ἐξόφθαλμον, μή τι σὲ αὖ μᾶλλον δοξάσω ἢ ἑμαυτὸν ἢ ὅσοι τοιοῦτοι; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδέν. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' οὐ πρότερόν γε, οἶμαι, Θεαίτητος ἐν ἐμοὶ δοξασθήσεται, πρὶν ἂν ἡ σιμότης αὕτη τῶν ἄλλων σιμοτήτων ὧν ἐγὼ ἐώρακα διάφορόν τι μνημεῖον παρ' ἐμοὶ

ένσημναμένη κατάθεται—καὶ τᾶλλα οὕτω ἐξ ὧν εἶ σύ—ἢ με, καὶ ἐὰν αὖριον ἀπαντήσω, ἀναμνήσει καὶ ποιήσει ὀρθὰ δοξάζειν περὶ σοῦ. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθέστατα.

209d

TT: Apparently.

209d

S: In that case, what more can the account add to right opinion? For if you say it adds an opinion by which something is distinguished from the others, then the process becomes quite ridiculous.

209d

TT: How?

209d

S: When we have right opinion of things, by which they are distinguished from the others, we are asked to add another right opinion of the same things, by which they will differ from the others. So, the circuitousness of a roller, or a pestle, or anything like that, would be nothing in comparison to this process which may properly be called the directions of a blind man. Indeed, asking us to acquire what we already have so that we may understand the things about which we form opinions, is really and truly a deed of darkness.

ΣΩ. περὶ τὴν διαφορότητα ἄρα καὶ ἡ ὀρθὴ δόξα ἂν εἴη ἐκάστου πέρι. ΘΕΑΙ. φαίνεται γε. ΣΩ. τὸ οὖν προσλαβεῖν λόγον τῇ ὀρθῇ δόξῃ τί ἂν ἔτι εἴη; εἰ μὲν γὰρ προσδοξάσαι λέγει ἢ διαφέρει τι τῶν ἄλλων, πάνυ γελοία γίνεται ἡ ἐπίταξις. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΣΩ. ὧν ὀρθὴν δόξαν ἔχομεν ἢ τῶν ἄλλων διαφέρει, τούτων προσλαβεῖν κελεύει ἡμᾶς ὀρθὴν δόξαν ἢ τῶν ἄλλων διαφέρει. καὶ οὕτως ἡ μὲν σκυτάλης ἢ ὑπέρου ἢ ὅτου δὴ

209e

TT: Is there another option? What else were you going to suggest a moment ago?

209e

S: Well, my boy, if adding an account means knowing the distinctiveness, rather than having an opinion about it, our most

perfect account of knowledge would be an oddity indeed. For knowing presumably means acquiring knowledge, doesn't it?

λέγεται περιτροπή πρὸς ταύτην τὴν ἐπίταξιν οὐδὲν ἂν λέγοι, τυφλοῦ δὲ παρακéléυσις ἂν καλοῖτο δικαιότερον· τὸ γάρ, ἃ ἔχομεν, ταῦτα προσλαβεῖν κελεύειν, ἵνα μάθωμεν ἃ δοξάζομεν, πάνυ γενναίως ἔοικεν ἐσκοτωμένῳ. ΘΕΑΙ. εἰπὲ δὴ τί νυνδὴ ὡς ἐρῶν ἐπύθου; ΣΩ. εἰ τὸ λόγον, ὃ παῖ, προσλαβεῖν γνῶναι κελεύει, ἀλλὰ μὴ δοξάσαι τὴν διαφορότητα, ἥδ' ἔτι χρῆμ' ἂν εἴη τοῦ καλλίστου τῶν περὶ ἐπιστήμης λόγου. τὸ γὰρ γνῶναι

210a

TT: Yes.

210a

S: Therefore, it seems that when asked what knowledge is, this account replies that it is right opinion along with knowledge of distinctiveness, for that is what acquisition of an account is according to this.

210a

TT: So it seems.

210a

S: And it is really quite simple-minded, when we are in search of knowledge, to say that it is right opinion along with knowledge, be it of distinctiveness or anything at all. So, Theaetetus, knowledge turns out to be neither perception nor true opinion, nor an account along with true opinion.

ἐπιστήμην που λαβεῖν ἐστίν· ἥ γάρ; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἐρωτηθεῖς, ὡς ἔοικε, τί ἐστὶν ἐπιστήμη, ἀποκρινεῖται ὅτι δόξα ὀρθὴ μετὰ ἐπιστήμης διαφορότητος. λόγου γὰρ πρόσληψις τοῦτ' ἂν εἴη κατ' ἐκεῖνον. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. καὶ παντάπασί γε εὗθες, ζητούντων ἡμῶν ἐπιστήμην, δόξαν φάναι ὀρθὴν εἶναι μετ' ἐπιστήμης εἴτε διαφορότητος εἴτε ὁτουοῦν. οὔτε ἄρα αἴσθησις, ὃ Θεαίτητε, οὔτε

210b

TT: It seems not.

210b

S: Well then, my friend, are we still pregnant or in labour in relation to knowledge, or have we brought forth all there is?

210b

TT: Oh yes, by Zeus, because of you I have spoken more than I had within myself.

210b

S: Isn't our art of midwifery saying that all these are wind-eggs and not worth rearing?

210b

TT: Most emphatically.

δόξα ἀληθὴς οὔτε μετ' ἀληθοῦς δόξης λόγος προσγιγνώμενος ἐπιστήμη ἂν εἴη. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκ ἔοικεν. ΣΩ. ἦ οὖν ἔτι κυοῦμέν τι καὶ ὠδίνομεν, ὦ φίλε, περὶ ἐπιστήμης, ἢ πάντα ἐκτετόκαμεν; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ ναὶ μὰ Δί' ἔγωγε πλείω ἢ ὅσα εἶχον ἐν ἑμαυτῷ διὰ σέ εἴρηκα. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ταῦτα μὲν πάντα ἢ μαιευτικὴ ἡμῖν τέχνη ἀνεμιαῖά φησι γεγενῆσθαι καὶ οὐκ ἄξια τροφῆς; παντάπασιν μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. ἐὰν τοίνυν ἄλλων μετὰ ταῦτα ἐγκύμων ἐπιχειρῇς

210c

S: Well, Theaetetus, if you attempt to conceive other thoughts in future, if you do conceive, you will be filled with better thoughts because of our present enquiry. But should you remain barren, you will be less oppressive to your associates, and gentler, as you will refrain, wisely, from thinking that you know what you do not know. This is as much as my skill can accomplish, it can do no more, and I know nothing that is known by the great and wonderful men of the past or the present. This midwifery has been allotted to me and my mother, by God, she for women, and I for the young and noble and all who are good.

Now, I must go to the Royal Stoa to answer the charge which Meletus has laid against me.⁴⁰ But in the morning, Theodorus, let us meet here again.

γίγνεσθαι, ὦ Θεαίτητε, ἔαντε γίγνη, βελτιόνων ἔση πλήρης διὰ τὴν νῦν ἐξέτασιν, ἔαντε κενὸς ᾗς, ἥττον ἔση βαρὺς τοῖς συνοῦσι καὶ ἡμερώτερος σωφρόνως οὐκ οἰόμενος εἰδέναι ἢ μὴ οἶσθα. τοσοῦτον γὰρ μόνον ἢ ἐμὴ τέχνη δύναται, πλεον δὲ οὐδέν, οὐδέ τι οἶδα ὧν οἱ ἄλλοι, ὅσοι μεγάλοι καὶ θαυμάσιοι ἄνδρες εἰσὶ τε καὶ γεγόνασιν· τὴν δὲ μαιείαν ταύτην ἐγὼ τε καὶ ἡ μήτηρ ἐκ θεοῦ ἐλάχομεν, ἡ μὲν τῶν γυναικῶν, ἐγὼ δὲ τῶν νέων τε καὶ γενναίων καὶ ὅσοι καλοί. νῦν μὲν οὖν ἀπαντητέον μοι εἰς τὴν τοῦ βασιλέως στοὰν ἐπὶ τὴν Μελήτου γραφὴν ἣν με γέγραπται· ἔωθεν δέ, ὦ Θεόδωρε, δεῦρο πάλιν ἀπαντῶμεν.

Notes

¹ The dialogue's first two speakers, Euclides and Terpsion of Megara, were both followers of Socrates. Euclides is credited with having founded the Megarian school of philosophy.

² Theaetetus was mortally wounded in the war between Athens and Sparta.

³ Cyrene, Theodorus' home town, was a Greek city in north Africa.

⁴ The Cape of Sounion marks the southernmost part of Attica, the territory belonging to Athens.

⁵ Socrates the Younger was a companion of Theaetetus, later a member of Plato's Academy. He is also mentioned in the two dramatic successor dialogues to the *Theaetetus* – the *Sophist*, in which he is mentioned briefly, and the *Statesman*, in which, together with the Eleatic Stranger, he is one of the main interlocutors.

⁶ A flat number is a square whose area is equal to the number, and so the side of the square, here called the line, is equal to the square root of the number. So, in the examples given, 3 as a flat number has a common measure with 4, but the side of the flat number 3 is $\sqrt{3}$, while the side of the flat number 4 is 2, and they have no common measure since $\sqrt{3}$ cannot be expressed as a fraction so as to yield a simple numerical ratio of 2. The term irrational is used to describe $\sqrt{3}$, but the entire process here is being described geometrically rather than arithmetically, and the lack of a common measure, called incommensurability, captures the essence of the problem. Contrast 4 and 9 where the sides (of the

square) or magnitudes are 2 and 3, and so they have a common measure, and relate as 2/3, as also do 16 and 36: $\sqrt{16} = 4$, $\sqrt{36} = 6$, $4:6 \rightarrow 2:3$. However, this process will not work with, for example, 15 and 36.

⁷ Socrates' mother's name means 'she who brings excellence to light'.

⁸ Artemis, goddess of the hunt and sister of Apollo, was the protectress of young animals and of women, particularly at the time of childbirth.

⁹ Aristides II was the grandson of a famous Athenian military and political leader of the same name. His education by Socrates is part of the subject matter of Plato's *Laches*.

¹⁰ Socrates describes his daimon as the usual sign that comes to him and always holds him back from something he is about to do. Plato, *Apology* 31c-e, 40a-c, 41d.

¹¹ Prodicus, a contemporary of Socrates, was a distinguished sophist from Ceos who taught semantics and rhetoric. He is portrayed in Plato's *Protagoras*, and is mentioned in quite a few of Plato's other dialogues.

¹² Protagoras of Abdera was a renowned sophist who taught rhetoric and virtue, and wrote several books. He is depicted extensively in Plato's *Protagoras*.

¹³ This seems to have been the title of one of Protagoras' books.

¹⁴ Parmenides from Elea in Italy, Heraclitus from Ephesus in Ionia, and Empedocles from Sicily were all influential pre-Socratic philosophers. Epicharmus was a comic poet from Syracuse in Sicily. Homer was a bard and epic poet, composer of the *Iliad* and the *Odyssey*.

¹⁵ *Iliad* xiv.201, 302.

¹⁶ *Iliad* viii.17-27. Zeus says he could bind everything in a golden cord and tether it to Mount Olympus, leaving it to hang in mid-air.

¹⁷ The reference is to Euripides, *Hippolytus*, line 612. Hippolytus says of an oath he has made but not kept, "my tongue has sworn, but my mind is unsworn".

¹⁸ Hesiod, *Theogony* 265. Thaumás means 'wonder', and Iris is the personification of the rainbow and a messenger of the Olympian gods.

¹⁹ This is, in essence, the dictum attributed to Protagoras at 152a, with the addition of 'for me'.

²⁰ Once a newborn baby reached five days old, it was carried round the family hearth as a symbolic introduction to the household gods and a request for their protection.

²¹ This is a reference to Protagoras' statement: "Concerning gods I am unable to know whether they exist or do not exist, or what they are like in appearance; for there are many hindrances to knowledge, the obscurity of the subject and the brevity of human life". Diogenes Laërtius, *Lives of Eminent Philosophers* ix.51.

²² Callias III, son of the richest man in Greece, was a student of Protagoras, Prodicus and Hippias, all prominent sophists.

²³ Sciron was a legendary brigand on the coastal road at the Isthmus of Corinth. He had a reputation for kicking travellers off the cliffs into the sea, where they were eaten by a giant turtle. The hero Theseus, on his way to Athens, dispatched him in the same way.

²⁴ Antaeus was reputed to have been a giant who forced all passers-by to wrestle with him. He drew his invincible strength from the earth, but was finally defeated by Heracles, who lifted him in the air and then crushed him to death.

²⁵ *Odyssey* xvi.121.

²⁶ In law courts and elsewhere, speeches were timed by means of a water clock. Water flowed from one vessel to another and measured out the desired time.

²⁷ Thales from Miletus in Ionia was the first of the Greek natural philosophers. He was an engineer, geometer and astronomer, and was counted among the Seven Sages.

²⁸ The inhabitants of Heraclitus' home city of Ephesus.

²⁹ Melissus, from the island of Samos off the coast of Ionia, was a pre-Socratic philosopher in the tradition of Parmenides.

³⁰ This is the first usage of the Greek term *poiōtēs*, which literally means 'what-sort-ness' but is usually rendered in English as 'quality'.

³¹ *Iliad* iii.172; *Odyssey* viii.22, xiv.234.

³² This encounter, whether it is historically accurate or not, is depicted in Plato's *Parmenides*.

³³ *Iliad* ii.851, xvi.554. The Homeric word for heart is *kear* or *ker*, which superficially resembles the word for wax, *kēros*.

³⁴ The Greek verb for 'I have' can mean not only 'I possess', but also 'I have hold of it' or 'I have it on', e.g. in the case of an article of clothing.

³⁵ The Greek word for element and letter is the same. The initial reference here is to a response based upon syllables rather than letters or elements.

³⁶ Theaetetus actually says, “That it’s sigma and omega”, using the names of the first two Greek letters in Socrates’ name.

³⁷ The ‘seven’ are the seven vowels of ancient Greek, as contrasted with two classes of consonant – mutes like B, which cannot be pronounced without a vowel, and semi-vowels like S, which can.

³⁸ Hesiod, *Works and Days* 456.

³⁹ Socrates actually says, “he thinks he should write *theta* and *epsilon*”, using the names of the Greek letters in the first syllable of Theaetetus’ name. There are only two such letters because Greek represents the sound ‘th’ by the single letter *theta*. Moreover, this sound was a plosive (as in English ‘fathead’) rather than a fricative (as in English ‘thin’), and so easy enough to confuse with ‘te’.

⁴⁰ The Stoa Basileios (Royal Stoa) housed the office of Athens’ chief religious officer. Here Meletus made his formal accusation of impiety against Socrates in front of the King Archon.